

Catapult HLS User View Scheduling Rules

Stuart Swan, Platform Architect, Siemens EDA

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Introduction

In a high-level synthesis (HLS) design methodology, much of the benefit is lost if design verification and debug must still be performed at the RTL level. In manual RTL design flows, RTL verification is typically one of the most costly and time-consuming phases of the overall flow. In HLS flows, RTL-level verification is even more challenging, because the RTL is machine-generated rather than hand-crafted.

This document presents a user-visible scheduling contract, modeling methodology, and collection of formal proofs that together support a flow in which full-system design verification and debug can be performed primarily on the pre-HLS SystemC model. The practical purpose of the contract is to give HLS users and verification engineers “no surprises”: interface scheduling is reduced to a small set of uniform rules for message-passing operations, signal I/O, and explicit synchronization, so that a common verification intent can be reused across pre-HLS and post-HLS models, while still allowing aggressive implementation optimizations such as loop pipelining, added FSM states, memory-access scheduling and reordering where permitted, direct-input late sampling, and bounded or elaborated channel buffering. The same bounded-capacity modeling also lets the pre-HLS SystemC model be made capacity-accurate and throughput-accurate with respect to the post-HLS RTL — for example, when modeled with a library such as Matchlib — so that throughput behavior and capacity effects can be assessed at the pre-HLS level rather than deferred to RTL simulation.

The formal guarantees are subject to the explicitly stated assumptions, observation-boundary choices, witness-selection conditions, and liveness/progress premises described in the formal appendices. The formal safety guarantee is an observable trace-compatibility result: for every reachable RTL_B prefix whose process-local, channel-local, atomic-interaction, environment, and reset certificates satisfy Definition J.LocalGWR, Theorem J.GWR-Comp constructs a globally witness-realizable package (Definition J.GWR) and a matching Sys_ref behavior under the fixed stimulus. A flow may alternatively provide a directly validated J.GWR package. Transfer of a particular source-side simulation execution to RTL_B remains restricted to annotated RTL-consistent source prefixes or to source executions selected by the Appendix L snooping / witness-selection mechanism. The liveness/deadlock guarantee is separate and conditional. Corollary J.1 and the CF-0 certificate connect a selected RTL cutpoint to one reachable Sys_ref cutpoint through a common KObs record consisting of the canonical replay history and the complete attributed residual-offer set. Under the additional fairness, progress, drain, waiver, environment, and structural assumptions stated in the appendices, an RTL-matched prohibited wait structure therefore reconstructs to the corresponding source-side predicate, where the selected A5-L discharge can rule it out.

The methodology and proofs are organized around a latency-insensitive design style, while still fully supporting real-world techniques such as:

- both sequential and combinational logic
- pipelined designs

- shared memories between sequential processes (covered by the formal theorems under the J.Mem mapping-layer lowering condition; see Common Formal Definitions)
- reordering of RAM accesses to optimize hardware pipelines
- removal of pipeline registers for stable signal inputs to hardware pipelines
- latency-sensitive signal-level protocols and localized latency-sensitive islands, including cycle-accurate transactors, non-blocking arbiters, and one-way handshake protocols

These techniques capture the requirements gathered from hundreds of Catapult HLS customer tape-outs and are needed to meet the demanding quality-of-results (QOR) targets traditionally achieved with manual RTL design.

The methodology presented here builds on established verification practices such as SystemVerilog UVM, constrained-random stimulus generation, and functional and code coverage. The system under test is modeled and verified in SystemC, while RTL verification is focused on establishing that the synthesized or otherwise implemented RTL falls within the scope of the formal theorem instances. The proofs do not, by themselves, prove that any particular HLS tool invocation or generated RTL instance satisfies the required obligations. In particular, the RTL-side scheduling obligations, the per-channel E4 realization obligations, B-faithfulness — the faithfulness of each back-annotated capacity $B(c)$ to the chosen explicit abstract boundary and to the RTL storage/credit represented at that boundary — and the other named side conditions must be established by the tool, by tool documentation, by generated certificates, by static checks, by RTL/interface checks, or by another validation method appropriate to the flow.

Although the focus of this document is HLS, the underlying modeling methodology and formal proof framework are not limited to HLS-generated RTL. The safety/liveness distinction introduced above is central to that generality: safety decomposes primarily into local process and channel-boundary obligations, while liveness has a more global dependency structure. The following paragraphs summarize these two decompositions.

For safety, the key benefit is compositionality in a strong local sense. Each process is verified independently against the scheduling, replay, dynamic-operation, action-footprint, and endpoint obligations at its own observable boundaries. Each explicit abstract channel is verified independently against its fixed rendezvous, bounded-FIFO, staged, bundle, join, or epoch-gate semantics, including B-faithfulness, same-cycle buffered updates, complete request snapshots, and non-blocking outcome consistency. Atomic interactions are checked only across their named participants. Theorem J.GWR-Comp then performs one generic local-to-global construction: it generates and proves complete an acyclic dependency graph, derives the canonical construction order, lifts and commutes the certified process-local segments, evaluates shared-state non-blocking decisions from one common boundary snapshot, proves the next complete observable unit enabled, and inductively constructs a single reachable `Sys_ref` execution. Proposition J.0 separately composes the already-selected source/RTL trace pair into system-level compatibility. Thus the design-specific evidence remains local even though the theorem conclusion is necessarily global.

This safety decomposition is what makes the approach applicable beyond HLS. The local certificates concern individual processes, explicit channel boundaries, and named atomic interactions; they may be established for HLS-generated, hand-written, or otherwise generated RTL. The global gluing argument is supplied once by Theorem J.GWR-Comp rather than repeated as an ad hoc full-system proof for each design. RTL verification is therefore focused on showing that each process and channel realization

satisfies the theorem's local side conditions and that duplicated interface fields agree, not on supplying an unexplained system-wide replay certificate.

The single most important deadlock-avoidance property is worth stating in plain terms, because a designer experiences it directly: HLS cannot by default reverse the order of the message-passing calls written in the source, so it cannot introduce new deadlocks via call-order reversal. This is the intuitive benefit underlying the formal liveness result described below. That result additionally covers deadlock behavior that depends on timing rather than call order — most notably the overlapped execution of pipelined loops and finite-capacity (bounded-FIFO) effects — which is handled by the pipelined-loop discipline (automatic flush) and the machinery summarized below, not by the no-reverse rule alone.

Liveness and deadlock preservation decompose differently. The preserved property is absence of reachable closed internal wait-cycle cutpoints. The core theorem, Theorem K.1A, remains conditioned on the scheduler-robust source premise A5-L: no finite Policy-L prefix admissible under Definition R.LAdm reaches a prohibited internal deadlock cutpoint. The primary user-facing discharge is the actual deterministic Policy-S pre-HLS simulator. Premise SDet fixes the Policy-S simulator semantics as part of the selected theorem instance—including the concrete scheduler, arbitration, environment, reset, witness, issue, and ϵ -normalization conventions—and selects one Policy-S run artifact p_S^{det} . A5-S/CF-S separately establish that p_S^{det} is maximal, fair, and complete under K.CompleteS; provide K.RespCov proof dispositions for every dynamically reachable instance of every internal process-facing blocking site in the selected instance, with environment-facing sites handled by the separate StandardEnv/monitor/exclusion rule; and prove K.RespClean, namely that no covered frontier exceeds its finite bound, remains pending at a maximal finite run, or is cancelled while pending without an explicit waiver. Lemma K.2b, deterministic serial-source dominance, states that a Policy-L internal deadlock forces that same selected Policy-S artifact to produce a finite K.RespFail witness. Thus A5-S checks one selected Policy-S artifact; shorter finite artifacts may be prefixes of it, but there is no quantification over alternate incompatible Policy-S histories and no confluence theorem is involved. The older Dead_KS owner-walk, EnvStop, DoneStop, K.EnvOrd, and K.Done machinery is retained only as an optional diagnostic taxonomy.

Thus, the methodology provides two related but distinct forms of scalability. Safety scales largely by local process and channel-boundary checking. Liveness/deadlock preservation scales by separating the proof into the scheduler-robust selected-Sys_ref premise A5-L, a recorded A5-L discharge route—primarily the Policy-S/A5-S route through serial dominance, but alternatively a structural, direct Policy-L, invariant, exploration, or tool-certificate route—and explicit RTL/environment/channel progress assumptions.

Together, these results support a verification flow in which much of the design reasoning can be performed at the pre-HLS SystemC level. For RTL produced by a compliant HLS flow, the required implementation-side obligations are expected to be discharged primarily by the tool and its associated flow evidence, such as tool documentation, generated certificates, static checks, or targeted RTL/interface checks. For hand-written RTL, modified generated RTL, or RTL produced by other generation methods, RTL verification or equivalent implementation checks must establish the same obligations to bring the implementation within the scope of the formal guarantees.

Because these rules are expressed as a user-visible, tool-neutral scheduling contract rather than as the internals of any particular HLS tool, a further goal of this document is to serve as a starting point for a standardization proposal — for example, within the Accellera Synthesis Working Group (SWG). A

standardized scheduling contract would let design and verification teams write models and testbenches against a single, vendor-independent set of interface scheduling rules, rather than against the specifics of any one tool's implementation.

A document abstract is provided in Appendix M.

Document Goals

This document presents HLS tool scheduling rules and a modeling methodology. The goals are:

1. To provide easy-to-understand rules to HLS users.
2. To ensure precise and consistent rules in both SystemC and C++.
3. To offer rules that are effectively compatible with how Catapult currently operates.
4. To enable the best possible *quality of results* (QOR) in Catapult synthesis.
5. To cover all known user requirements and scenarios.
6. To serve as a suitable starting point for a standardization proposal (e.g., in Accellera SWG).

To illustrate the goals of this document more specifically, consider what an engineer writing a testbench for an HLS model needs to understand about how HLS tools operate. This engineer may be using SystemVerilog UVM or may be writing a testbench in C++/SystemC.

They likely are not an expert in any specific HLS tool (and may not want to be), but their testbench should be usable across both the pre-HLS model and the post-HLS model, subject to the latency-insensitivity, observation-boundary, and witness-selection conditions stated in this document. Thus, it is crucial for the DV engineer to have a precise understanding of how the HLS tool will transform the design while still enabling the resulting RTL behavior to be checked against the prescribed source reference model. This document describes what transformations the HLS tool is allowed to perform so that the pre-HLS and post-HLS models can be effectively verified with a common verification intent, and in the deterministic or annotated RTL-consistent cases with the same directly corresponding testbench execution. The overarching philosophy of the scheduling rules is to present “no surprises” to such a DV engineer, while still giving the HLS tool ample freedom to optimize the design.

The main body of this document is intended to be sufficiently precise and complete to support the Accellera standardization effort while still being understandable to HW architects. The formal appendices are intended to have a very high degree of precision and completeness sufficient to support AI-driven Lean mechanization of the formal theorems.

Background

HLS tools generate RTL from C++ models. Broadly speaking, this conversion takes a sequential C++ model and turns it into concurrent hardware that maintains the same behavior. HLS tools identify concurrent processes within the C++/SystemC model and then independently synthesize each process. Briefly, some of the techniques that HLS tools use to achieve good HW QOR when synthesizing each process include:

- Optimized scheduling based on the selected silicon target technology.

- Automatic HW pipeline construction according to the user's specifications.
- Automatic HW resource sharing.
- Automatic scheduling of memory accesses.

The internal behavior of each process is specified by the control and dataflow behavior of the C++ code within the process. However, the external communication that each process has with other processes and HW blocks is specified via IO operations that are coded within the model. To enable a reliable, scalable, and verifiable HLS flow that generates high quality hardware, the scheduling behavior of these IO operations needs to be precisely handled at all steps of the flow. This document specifies the rules that govern the scheduling behavior for these IO operations within HLS models.

These rules are specified with respect to an individual process, but the intent of the rules is to enable reliable and verifiable behavior of large sets of interacting processes operating as a system in real-world designs. (Appendix G provides the formal trace-compatibility guarantees between the prescribed source reference model and the post-HLS system, including the unrestricted Post $\rightarrow$ Ref direction and the restricted annotated RTL-consistent / witness-selected reverse use.)

By default, HLS tools can insert additional clock cycles (or latency) anywhere within a process -- for example, when pipelining a loop or to enable HW resource sharing. The overall approach used in this document is to make the entire design and testbench system *latency insensitive* to the maximum extent possible, while still fully enabling key HW optimizations. In addition, the overall approach enables the pre-HLS system simulation to be capacity-accurate and throughput-accurate with respect to the post-HLS RTL system.

In some cases, designs or testbenches may use protocols which are latency-sensitive. These situations can be handled by isolating the latency-sensitive portions to small, self-contained parts of the design or testbench, and then keeping the rest of the design and testbench latency insensitive. See Appendix D for more information.

In many cases the overall design will need to satisfy end-to-end latency requirements. For these designs it is still highly advantageous to use a latency-insensitive modeling approach and verify in the post-HLS model that the overall design latency requirements have been satisfied, since this is typically easy to do.

This document focuses on sequential HW processes. Combinational HW processes are supported but mostly not discussed since their synthesis is straightforward. All the examples and discussion in this document are for SystemC processes that are sensitive only to a single rising clock edge. (Appendix O discusses support for multiple clock domains.)

This document distinguishes between the following:

1. The *conceptual model* for the scheduling rules.
2. The simulation behavior of a model using the rules in C++ or SystemC.
3. The synthesis of a C++/SystemC model using the rules in an HLS tool such as Catapult.

The goal is to align each of these three cases as closely as possible, so that the user has easy-to-understand rules, while simulation and synthesis work without surprises. However, as we will see, there are practical considerations which may in certain cases cause small deviations from the conceptual model in either simulation or HLS.

A simple real-world example that illustrates the motivation for the scheduling rules is provided in Appendix A of this document.

The examples referred to in this document are available here:

<https://github.com/Stuart-Swan/Matchlib-Examples-Kit-For-Accellera-Synthesis-WG/tree/master>

The most up-to-date version of this document is available here:

https://github.com/Stuart-Swan/Matchlib-Examples-Kit-For-Accellera-Synthesis-WG/blob/master/matchlib_examples/doc/catapult_user_view_scheduling_rules.pdf

A summary of the scheduling rules is available here:

https://github.com/Stuart-Swan/Matchlib-Examples-Kit-For-Accellera-Synthesis-WG/blob/master/matchlib_examples/doc/brief_scheduling_rules.txt

An Analogy from RTL Synthesis

To better understand the specific purpose of this document, let's consider how RTL synthesis works. Say you have a sequential block that you are modeling in Verilog RTL, and it has an output port coded like:

```
Out1 <= #some_delay new_val;
```

In Verilog simulation, if `some_delay` is less than the clock period of the block, then it will probably not affect the overall cycle-level behavior of the system during simulation. However, if `some_delay` is more than the clock period, it probably will.

During RTL synthesis, all RTL synthesis tools will ignore all delays in the input model, in this case even if `some_delay` is greater than the clock period. Some RTL synthesis tools might give a warning or error for code like the above such as "Simulation and synthesis results are likely to mismatch because the delay in model is greater than clock period." Some RTL synthesis tools might outright reject a model containing such delays.

One might argue that RTL synthesis tools should always match the Verilog simulation behavior of the input model. But the overall approach works well because RTL is a good and simple *conceptual model* that users and tool vendors can align around. The slight differences between the *simulation model* and the *conceptual model* used by RTL synthesis tools can be easily managed.

We'll return to this example later in this document.

Next, let's clarify some terminology related to signal IO. Say you have a Verilog model like:

```
forever begin
  @(posedge clk); // wait for 1st rising clock edge
  output1 <= input1 + 10;
```

```

    @(posedge clk); // wait for 2nd rising clock edge
end

```

In this example, input1 is sampled when the process wakes on the first @(posedge clk) and evaluates the RHS. For the purposes of the scheduling rules, we anchor that Read(input1,.) to the most recent synchronization point. The resulting Write(output1,.) is anchored to the next synchronization point (the cycle in which the written value is treated as stable for others to observe).

Cycle-level anchoring convention (used throughout this document). For cycle-level reasoning, each signal IO is assigned an anchor cycle relative to surrounding synchronization calls (e.g., wait() / SyncChannel / @(posedge clk)):

- Read(sig, val) is anchored to the closest preceding synchronization call, i.e. pred_S(Read).
- Write(sig, val) is anchored to the closest succeeding synchronization call, i.e. succ_S(Write).

This convention is only for cycle-level reasoning and does not depend on simulator update regions or delta-cycle ordering.

Catapult HLS Status Concerning Rules in this Document

A separate document provides a list of clarifications related to support within Catapult HLS for the rules described in this document. The items in the list are named *Cat#*, so that each item has a unique number.

This document annotates certain rules with *Cat#* to refer to the items in the separate document.

These *Cat#* annotations are not part of the formal proof itself. They identify tool-support and tool-conformance points that must be satisfied for a Catapult-generated RTL instance to fall within the scope of the formal guarantees. Where the appendices assume an RTL-side property such as E3 issue-order conformance, E4 channel-realization conformance, automatic-flush behavior for pipelined or otherwise overlapped control, an equivalent drain-only blocked-frontier discharge for ordinary non-overlapped control, finite explicit boundary storage/credit, or faithful back-annotation of B(c), the corresponding *Cat#* item or other tool-flow evidence is the mechanism by which that compliance obligation is expected to be discharged.

Terms Used in this Document

Latency-Insensitive: In digital hardware design, *latency-insensitive* refers to a system that operates correctly despite variable communication delays between components. This is achieved by using mechanisms to decouple computation from communication timing. Such designs improve scalability and reliability in complex systems with unpredictable or variable latencies. ARM's AXI4 and APB are examples of latency-insensitive protocols. ARM's AMBA 5 CHI credit-based NOC protocol is also an example of a latency-insensitive protocol.

Process: In Verilog, a process is an *always block* and its equivalent constructs. In SystemC, a process is an instance of an SC_THREAD or SC_METHOD.

Message-passing Interface: A *message-passing interface* reliably delivers messages (or transactions) from one process to another. This document uses this term to denote the type of communication found in Kahn Process Networks. See https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Kahn_process_networks

Message-passing read interfaces are always separate from message-passing write interfaces – there are no bidirectional message-passing interfaces. In this document, message-passing channels are assumed to be point-to-point: for each channel *c*, exactly one producer performs all Push_*c* operations and exactly one consumer performs all Pop_*c* operations.

Synchronization Interface: A *synchronization interface* synchronizes one process with another and/or with a global clock. For an example of a synchronization interface, see [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Barrier_\(computer_science\)](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Barrier_(computer_science))

Signal IO: In digital HW design, signals are the fundamental communication mechanism. Signals enable communication between two HW blocks/processes, but communication with signals in real HW always incurs at least some delay because communication cannot be faster than the speed of light. In HDLs and in SystemC, signal delays are modeled with the *delayed update* semantics.

blocking / non-blocking: In this document, a blocking message-passing operation is modeled as issuing a persistent request that remains asserted (and with stable payload, if applicable) until the operation commits (the message is sent or received). A non-blocking message-passing operation returns immediately with a status indicating whether the operation committed in that cycle.

One-way / two-way handshake protocols: A one-way handshake protocol only has one signal between a sender and receiver to synchronize communication. A two-way handshake protocol has two signals (one in each direction) between a sender and receiver to synchronize communication.

shall: This term indicates that a compliant tool or flow is required to follow the indicated rule.

may: This term indicates that a compliant tool or flow is allowed to follow the indicated rule but is not required to do so.

Classes of Operations Involved in Scheduling Rules

There are three classes of operations involved in the scheduling rules:

1. Calls to message-passing interfaces (which are all ac_channel methods, all SystemC Push/PushNB/Pop/PopNB calls except calls to SyncChannel)
2. Calls to synchronization interfaces (which are calls to ac_sync and Matchlib SyncChannel, also ac_wait and SystemC wait)
3. Signal IO (which are SystemC signal reads and writes, also C++ model *direct inputs*)

All the operations above are referred to as *IO operations*.

Basic Conceptual Model

The basic conceptual model encompasses processes that have no loop pipelining but may have preserved loops. If a process has a preserved loop, then the user may place a wait statement in the loop. Wait statements explicitly placed in the model are called explicit wait statements in this document and are classified as calls to a synchronization interface. However, for a loop to be treated as an HLS-

pipelined loop under the formal guarantees in this document, the loop body shall not contain any `wait/ac_wait` statement or other explicit synchronization call used as an in-loop wait boundary. Such synchronization boundaries must be placed outside the pipelined loop, or the loop must be treated as non-pipelined/preserved or outside the theorem instance.

The basic conceptual model rules are:

1. Synchronization interface calls within a process always remain in the source code order.
2. Signal read operations occur at the closest preceding call to a synchronization interface. (Cat1)
3. Signal write operations occur at the closest succeeding call to a synchronization interface.
4. Message-passing operations may be shifted in time, issued in the same cycle, or overlapped by simulation or synthesis, subject to the following constraints:
 - All message-passing operations before a call to a synchronization interface shall be issued before or in the same cycle in which the synchronization interface commits. (Here “the synchronization interface commits” refers to the commit of that synchronization call in the calling process’s trace. For blocking message-passing operations (Push/Pop), the process cannot complete the synchronization call until any earlier issued blocking message requests in that interval have committed.)
 - All message-passing operations after a call to a synchronization interface shall be issued after the cycle in which the synchronization interface call commits.
 - Message-passing operations on the same message-passing interface shall be issued in source order; they shall not be reversed. This same-interface order requirement applies both within a single source interval and across overlapped iterations of a pipelined loop.
 - Two message-passing operations on separate interfaces which appear in sequence in the model are source-ordered. They may be issued in the same source sequence, and the later operation may in some permitted modes issue before the earlier operation commits, including in the same clock cycle where allowed by the issue policy. They shall not be issued in the reverse sequence. (Cat2)

Here “parallel” issue means timing overlap or same-cycle request assertion; it does not mean that ordinary source-level message calls on distinct interfaces become unordered or incomparable. The source order used by the formal rules remains the dynamic program order of the executed source calls, after applying the explicit signal-anchoring rules for signal IO. Any true message-operation multi-frontier behavior used by the formal proof must be introduced by the selected source reference model through explicit `Sys_B^elab` staged/bundle/join/epoch-gate structure, rather than inferred merely from the fact that two ordinary calls use distinct interfaces.

Some explanation for the very last point: While pure message-passing systems with unbounded FIFOs are immune to reordering concerns, real-world hardware implementations have finite buffer sizes. Reversing the order of message-passing calls in a system with bounded FIFOs can introduce deadlocks that were not present in the original model. The last rule prevents HLS from introducing deadlocks via this specific mechanism: reversing the dynamic source order of message-passing calls that appear in sequence in the source. However, deadlock behavior can still be affected by transformations that change the timing of request/commit while preserving source order—most notably overlapped execution in pipelined loops, eager same-interval issue under Policy L, and finite-capacity effects.

Pipelined Loops

When a loop is pipelined in HLS, the body of the loop is split into pipeline stages. HLS may start the next iteration of the loop before the current iteration has completed, thus increasing throughput as compared to a non-pipelined implementation.

A loop selected for HLS pipelining shall not contain `wait/ac_wait` statements, `SyncChannel/ac_sync` calls, or any other explicit synchronization interface call inside the loop body. The pipelined-loop rules in this document therefore apply to wait-free pipelined loop bodies, with ordinary synchronization boundaries only outside the pipelined loop or around the pipelined region. If a design requires a synchronization call inside the loop body, the flow shall either reject that loop for pipelining under this contract, require the source to be rewritten so that the synchronization boundary is outside the pipelined loop, or exclude that pipelined-loop instance from the Appendices G-K formal guarantees unless a separate specialized theorem/certificate is supplied.

This restriction keeps R1/E1 and R3/E5 simple: the observable synchronization set S contains only real synchronization calls outside the pipelined loop body, and a pipelined loop does not introduce additional in-body synchronization events that would have to be ordered or used to split intervals under loop overlap.

To guarantee equivalent behavior between the pre-HLS and post-HLS systems, pipelined loops must be implemented with automatic flush to prevent deadlocks. See Appendix B for a formal presentation of pipelined loops.

When HLS pipelines a loop, multiple iterations of the loop are overlapped and execute at the same time. During loop pipelining, for all IO operations, HLS shall ensure that an access to a specific message-passing interface, signal, or synchronization interface shall not be reordered relative to same-interface accesses from other iterations.

During pipelining, signal reads and writes are physically embedded in specific pipeline stages, but the loop body itself contains no explicit `wait/ac_wait` or other in-body synchronization call under the formal contract above. The logical anchor of an ordinary signal Read/Write is therefore still determined by the surrounding real synchronization calls selected into S under R2/E2, not by an in-body wait. Considering the entire set of signals read or written by the process, if HLS pipelining would cause the order of signal IO to differ between the pre-HLS and post-HLS models, or if any two signal IO operations that occur on the same clock edge in the pre-HLS model would not occur on the same clock edge in the post-HLS model, then the HLS tool shall detect such a situation and require the user to explicitly indicate in the model source (e.g., via a pragma) that HLS pipelining can still be used. (Cat7) In other words, if a process communicates with other processes using only latency-insensitive protocols, then HLS pipelining by default shall not break any of the protocols.

Synchronization boundary for pipelined loops

If a pipelined loop is separated from later work by an explicit synchronization interface call, then while the process is pending at that synchronization call, any back-annotated message-passing capacity $B(c)$ whose accepted data could otherwise be consumed only by work after that synchronization call shall be treated as unavailable to upstream producers until the synchronization call commits. Equivalently, the producer-facing availability corresponding to such capacity is temporarily withdrawn at the synchronization boundary. Work already accepted before the boundary may drain

under the automatic-flush rules, but no new transfer may be accepted across that boundary into the next post-sync interval before the sync commits.

Formal modeling requirement

This withdrawal is not a hidden exception to E4 at an otherwise ordinary bounded-FIFO boundary. The prescribed source reference model shall represent this behavior in Sys_B^{elab}, using explicit sync-boundary / epoch-gate abstract channels, or equivalent explicit staged realization structure, so that the refusal to accept new post-sync work appears as ordinary ChannelDisabled behavior at an explicit abstract boundary. Thus the pre-HLS back-annotated model ramps down in the same sense as the RTL: already accepted work may drain, but capacity belonging only to suff_S(s) is not producer-facing available until s commits.

Direct Inputs

Ordinary SystemC signal reads occur at the closest preceding synchronization interface call (e.g., wait statement) in both the pre-HLS and post-HLS models. (Cat1). If the HLS tool adds states to the process, or if it pipelines the process, then this implies that the HLS tool must add registers for each such read operation such that the read occurs where specified in the pre-HLS model, and the value is stored until the point where it is consumed in the post-HLS model. The area cost of such registers may be high if there are a lot of signals, and in some cases, it may be unneeded area since the value of the signals may not actually need to be stored internally to the process.

The simplest case is if such external signals are held stable after the process comes out of reset. In this case, HLS may assume that it is free to physically sample the signal values as late as possible, with no need for register storage, while the logical Σ -visible Read event remains anchored as specified by E2. This case is handled with the following pragma on SystemC signals and ports (Cat6):

```
#pragma hls_direct_input
```

To ensure that there are no pre-HLS versus post-HLS simulation mismatches, the environment that drives the signal shall hold it stable within each relevant reset epoch: after all receiving processes that use this signal with this pragma have come out of a reset boundary, the signal value shall remain stable until the next reset boundary that affects those receiving processes, unless the signal is instead governed by an explicit hls_direct_input_sync update contract as described below. A *dynamic reset* starts a new stability epoch for the affected receiving logic and its associated direct-input signals. Thus it remains allowable to have *dynamic resets*, i.e. activation of block resets and associated resetting of direct input signals as part of the normal operation of the HW.

A related but somewhat more complex case is where input signals to the HW block may only be changed at “agreed upon” times, typically while the portion of the HW block that relies on them is temporarily idle. For example, a block may process 2D images. At the start of each new image, it may be desirable for the TB or external environment to update the control signals for how the block will process the next image. Typically HLS designs are pipelined, and the HW pipeline for the current iteration must be fully *ramped down* before the input signals can be updated to affect the next iteration. In the pipelined-loop case, this relies on the general synchronization-boundary rule for pipelined loops: while the process is pending at the designated sync, any back-annotated message-passing capacity whose accepted data would belong to the next post-sync interval is temporarily unavailable to upstream producers until the

sync commits. In this case we can use the SystemC *SyncChannel* or C++ *ac_sync* primitives to precisely synchronize the DUT with the TB/environment to enable the input signals to be updated at the correct time. The `#pragma hls_direct_input_sync` directive shown below associates the sync operation with the direct inputs that it controls. The precise synchronization scheme shown here ensures that there are no pre-HLS versus post-HLS simulation mismatches even though we are using direct inputs and also changing their values while the design is executing.

When a signal or port covered by `#pragma hls_direct_input` is also included in the scope of a later `#pragma hls_direct_input_sync` directive, the sync directive selects the effective update contract for that controlled signal set. Such signals remain direct inputs for purposes of late physical sampling, but they are not required to remain stable for the entire reset epoch; instead, they must satisfy the sync-controlled discipline described here: updates may occur only at the designated synchronization handshake, and the values must remain stable between permitted sync-controlled updates and reset boundaries.

```
// This is example 61 in Catapult Matchlib examples
sc_in<bool> SC_NAMED(clk);
sc_in<bool> SC_NAMED(rst_bar);

Connections::Out<uint32_t> SC_NAMED(out1);
Connections::In<uint32_t> sample_in[num_samples];
Connections::SyncIn SC_NAMED(sync_in);
#pragma hls_direct_input
sc_in<uint32_t> direct_inputs[num_direct_inputs];

void main() {
    out1.Reset();
    sync_in.Reset();

#pragma hls_unroll yes
    for (int i=0; i < num_samples; i++) {
        sample_in[i].Reset();
    }

    wait(); // reset state

    while (1) {
#pragma hls_direct_input_sync all
        sync_in.sync_in();

#pragma hls_pipeline_init_interval 1
#pragma hls_stall_mode flush
        for (uint32_t x=0; x < direct_inputs[0]; x++) {
            for (uint32_t y=0; y < direct_inputs[1]; y++) {
                uint32_t sum = 0;
#pragma hls_unroll yes
                for (uint32_t s=0; s < num_samples; s++) {
                    sum += sample_in[s].Pop() * direct_inputs[2 + s];
                }
                ac_int<32, false> ac_sum = sum;
                ac_int<32, false> sqrt = 0;
                ac_math::ac_sqrt(ac_sum, sqrt); // internal loop unrolled in cat .tcl
file
                if (sqrt > direct_inputs[7])
                    out1.Push(sqrt);
            }
        }
    }
}
```

```

    }
  }
}
};

```

From the perspective of the testbench or the environment, the updating of the signals controlled by the `hls_direct_input_sync` directive shall only occur at a precise point. The TB shall first wait for the `rdy` signal for the sync to be asserted by the DUT, and then the TB shall update all the input signals it wishes to change while simultaneously driving the sync `vald` signal high for one cycle.

It is important to note that the only safe operation to use to synchronize the updating of direct inputs is the sync operation as shown above. Other operations such as Push/Pop or `ac_channel` operations should not be used for this. In terms of the Appendix G trace model, the Σ -visible Read(sig,val) events remain anchored to their synchronization points; any additional internal sampling made by the implementation between anchors is treated as an ϵ -step and must not change the recorded value label.

In the example above the DUT block that is being synthesized determines when to call sync, and thus it determines when the direct inputs will be updated. In some cases, it may be necessary for the environment around the DUT to determine when the direct inputs should be updated. In this case the same approach as shown above should be used; however a separate input from the environment to the DUT (either using a signal or a message-passing interface) should request that the DUT call sync as soon as feasible. This will ensure that the DUT has properly ramped down its pipeline and is ready to receive the newly updated direct inputs as per the overall synchronization scheme described above.

Additional Options for Scheduling Message-passing Interfaces

The following option may be added during HLS (Cat2):

```
STRICT_IO_SCHEDULING=relaxed
```

When this is specified, the HLS tool is allowed to reorder message-passing interface calls freely on distinct interfaces (still not moving calls across synchronization interface calls). This relaxed mode may violate the default no-reverse discipline and therefore may introduce deadlocks that are not present under the default rules. It is recommended that this relaxed option only be used when the user wants to see what order the HLS tool prefers to schedule message-passing interface calls (e.g., to achieve best QOR).

Once the user knows the preferred order, it is recommended that the user modify the pre-HLS source code to reflect the preferred order, and then return to the use of the default scheduling modes. This methodology ensures that HLS cannot introduce new deadlocks *via reversal of source order on distinct message interfaces* as described earlier. Deadlock behavior may still depend on bounded-capacity effects and on overlapped execution (e.g., loop pipelining); those cases are addressed separately in this document via the pipelined-loop discussion (automatic flush / WFG-inertness) and the later deadlock reasoning. The formal equivalence and deadlock-preservation results in Appendices G–K assume `STRICT_IO_SCHEDULING` is not set to relaxed.

Scheduling of Array Accesses

Arrays may appear in HLS models, and they may be preserved through synthesis and mapped to RAMs. Pointers may also appear in HLS models, and pointer dereferences are resolved to array accesses during HLS.

There are two cases to consider for arrays for the purposes of the scheduling rules:

1. Array instantiation in the HW is internal to the process
 - The array accesses are not visible outside the process, and thus their scheduling is also not visible externally.
 - All the scheduling rules described elsewhere in this document remain unaffected in this case.
2. Array instantiation in the HW is external to the process
 - In this case the user model shall indicate how array accesses are mapped onto IO operations that are external to the process.
 - We call this the *array access mapping layer*. The *array access mapping layer* maps array accesses onto IO operations described above (signal IO, message-passing interface calls, and synchronization calls).
 - The user model may indicate that it is allowable for HLS to transform array accesses, for example, to cache, merge, split, or reorder array accesses (e.g., to improve QOR). These transformed operations, if allowed, are an outcome of using the *array access mapping layer*.
 - In all cases the scheduling rules described elsewhere in this document for the core IO operations (signal IO, message-passing calls, synchronization calls) remain unaffected.
 - In all cases array accesses shall remain constrained by any explicit synchronization interface calls present in the process in the source model. Precisely speaking, all array reads or writes before a synchronization call shall commit before or in the same cycle at which the synchronization call commits, and all array reads or writes after a synchronization call shall commit in a cycle after the synchronization call commits. This rule is stated in terms of commit cycles (the cycle the mapped memory storage is accessed); the scheduler enforces it by choosing issue cycles consistent with the fixed access latency defined by the array access mapping layer.
 - Note that if transformed operations occur and array accesses are visible externally in both the pre-HLS and post-HLS model, then comparison of pre-HLS and post-HLS behaviors may need to account for the transformed operations.

When a loop is pipelined, multiple iterations of the loop are overlapped and execute at the same time. During loop pipelining, an access to a memory interface (or array) may be moved over or in parallel with an access to the same memory if the HLS tool can prove the reordering is conflict-free. If the array/memory is external to the process, the *array access mapping layer* shall indicate that such reordering is allowable if such reordering is to occur during loop pipelining.

Definitions: Issue vs. Commit

Informally, we can define **commit** and **issue** as follows:

Definition: Commit (message channel) — as observed by an external clocked observer

Commit is the cycle in which an external clocked observer sees a transfer *complete*:

- A message commits in the cycle when the observer sees **both valid and ready high at the same time**.
- The committed payload is the data value seen in that same cycle.

Definition: Issue (message channel) — request assertion, with scheduler/witness attribution

Issue(q) is the cycle assigned to a source-level message operation instance *q* at the chosen message-channel boundary when the calling process begins requesting the corresponding transfer. Its observable boundary manifestation is the endpoint-owned request signal: for a Push, *vld* is asserted; for a Pop, *rdy* is asserted.

Unlike Commit, Issue(*q*) is not, in general, fully reconstructible from external observation alone. An external clocked observer can see the request level, but the attribution of that request to a particular dynamic operation instance *q* is supplied by the scheduler/witness and by the Issue/Commit linkage conditions in Appendix C. This distinction matters for continuously asserted requests, back-to-back operations, failed non-blocking polls, and witness-selected executions.

Sequential-result availability for sequential processes. In both the pre-HLS source model and the post-HLS RTL model, each sequential process is clocked. If a message operation commits in cycle *t* and a dynamically succeeding operation's reachability, control choice, address, endpoint selection, or payload depends on the committed value or status, the succeeding operation may not issue in cycle *t*; its first permitted Issue is in a strictly later cycle. A same-cycle rendezvous or same-cycle buffered-channel update may complete requests that were already established independently before the cycle boundary, but it does not permit a newly committed value or status to propagate through the owning sequential process and create another dependent request in that same cycle. Policy-L eager or same-cycle issue therefore applies only when the succeeding operation has already been reached and all required operands and control predecessors were available independently before the relevant boundary, including operations from independently active iterations of an HLS pipeline.

See Appendix C for formal definitions of **issue** and **commit**.

For RAM reads/writes as presented above, **commit** denotes the precise cycle the memory storage is accessed; since the access latency is fixed and known to the HLS scheduler, it can schedule the operation's issue cycle so that the commit cycle satisfies the required ordering relative to Sync. The "Scheduling of Array Accesses" constraints above are therefore written in commit-time.

Additional States Added by HLS Synthesis

By default, HLS synthesis tools may add additional states to processes (e.g. add latency to enable resource sharing), which may introduce latency differences in the interface behavior between the pre-HLS and post-HLS models. These additional states are never included in the set of *synchronization interface calls* as described above.

When the directive `IMPLICIT_FSM=true` is set on a process, the HLS synthesis tool shall ensure that the cycle-level behavior of the interfaces of the pre-HLS and post-HLS models shall be identical. With this option, the internal state machines of the pre-HLS and post-HLS models will be the same.

When the directive `IO_MODE=FIXED` is set on a process, the HLS synthesis tool shall ensure that the cycle-level behavior of the interfaces of the pre-HLS and post-HLS models shall be identical. With this option, it is still possible that the state machine internal to the process is different between the pre-HLS and post-HLS models (e.g. the post-HLS model may choose to use a pipelined multiplier where the pre-HLS model did not.)

Avoiding Pre-HLS and Post-HLS Simulation Mismatches

The scheduling rules described in this document are designed to be easy to understand, while providing good QOR via HLS and generally avoiding any mismatches between the pre-HLS and post-HLS simulation behaviors.

Non-blocking message-passing operations (PushNB/PopNB in SystemC, C++ `ac_channel nb_read/nb_write`) are a potential source of mismatches between pre-HLS and post-HLS simulations since their behavior is inherently dependent on the latency within the model, which often changes during HLS. Because of this, non-blocking message-passing interfaces should only be used when no alternative approach is possible. For example, non-blocking message-passing interfaces are required to model time-based arbitration of multiple message streams which access a shared resource. A full discussion of recommended guidelines on the use and verification of non-blocking message-passing interfaces is provided in Appendix L. Note that the scheduling rules described previously in this document fully specify how HLS tools are required to schedule such operations.

Unidirectional message-passing between two processes should not be relied on to achieve synchronization between the two processes, since in general the message latency and storage capacity between the processes may be variable. Also, depending on buffering/pipelining in the realization, the time between a producer's committed Push and the consumer's committed Pop (and the transient in-flight occupancy) may vary. Two unidirectional message-passing channels in opposite directions can be relied upon for synchronization between two processes. (An example of this is the AXI4 `ar` and `r`, and `aw` and `b`, channels). Note that such synchronization is weaker than explicit synchronization like `SyncChannel` or signal IO that uses a two-way handshake.

SystemC signal IO operations are a potential source of pre-HLS versus post-HLS simulation mismatches since timing behaviors may change between the two models. The following section provides guidance and rules to help avoid potential mismatches due to signal IO.

When signal IO operations are synchronized with a wait statement, there generally should be a proper two-way handshake associated with the wait statement so that the signal IO is latency insensitive. (Note that this statement does not apply to the signal synchronization approaches described in the Direct Inputs section.)

For example, here's a simple two-way handshake protocol when writing the signal `out_dat`:

```
out_dat = value;
out_vld = 1;
do {
    wait();
} while (out_rdy != 1);
out_vld = 0;
```


And here's a two-way handshake example when reading signal `in_dat`:

```
in_rdy = 1;
do {
    wait();
} while (in_vld != 1);
value = in_dat;
in_rdy = 0;
```

Some signal-level protocols have different two-way handshaking approaches (e.g. ARM APB), but they are still latency insensitive.

If signal IO operations are associated with a wait statement and that wait statement does not have a proper two-way handshake, then the signal IO is likely to be latency-sensitive and may result in pre-HLS versus post-HLS simulation mismatches. In some systems a one-way signal handshake is sufficient for reliable system operation. See Appendix E for further discussion.

The scheduling rules state that signal IO operations occur at either SystemC wait statements or SyncChannel calls (`sync_in` and `sync_out`). In the remainder of this section, we will use *wait* statements to refer to both.

RULE 1: It is always best coding style to group signal write operations just before their corresponding wait statement, and signal read operations just after their corresponding wait statement. (Cat3). An example is below:

```
sc_in<int> i1;
sc_in<bool> go;
sc_out<int> o1;
void my_thread() {
    int new_val=0;
    while (1) {
        o1.write(new_val);
        do {
            wait();
        } while (!go.read());
        new_val = i1.read();
        new_val = some_function(new_val); // function has no internal IO
    }
}
```

By placing the signal IO operations as close as possible to their corresponding wait statement, the HW intent is very clear. And there is no benefit either in terms of simulation performance or HLS QOR if they are placed further away from their corresponding wait statement.

Let's look at another similar example, which now also uses a Matchlib Connections blocking Pop operation:

```
sc_in<int> i1;
sc_in<bool> go;
sc_out<int> o1;
Connections::In<int> pop1;
void my_thread() {
```

```

int new_val=0;
while (1) {
    o1.write(new_val);
    do {
        wait();
    } while (!go.read());
    int pop_val = pop1.Pop();
    new_val = i1.read();
    new_val = some_function(new_val + pop_val); // function has no internal
IO
    }
}

```

Under the anchoring rules, `i1.read()` remains associated with the same synchronization point regardless of the intervening `Pop`. However, in raw pre-HLS simulation, a blocking `Pop` may stall for one or more cycles, so `i1` can change before the `i1.read()` executes—creating behavior that differs from the anchored interpretation (and potentially from post-HLS scheduling). The fix is simply to place `i1.read()` immediately after its intended `wait()` anchor; this removes the mismatch risk without affecting QOR or simulation performance.

For a proof-backed flow, RULE 1 conformance is a source well-formedness obligation, not merely a recommended diagnostic. If a blocking message-passing operation separates a signal read or write operation from its corresponding synchronization interface call, then the flow shall either reject the model for purposes of applying the formal guarantees, require the source to be rewritten so the signal IO is adjacent to its intended anchor, or discharge an explicit source-level well-formedness argument showing that the signal IO has a unique unconditional real synchronization anchor on every dynamic path and cannot observe a value inconsistent with that anchor. HLS tools may implement this requirement using errors, warnings, lint checks, or other diagnostics, but an unresolved warning is not sufficient to claim the RULE 1 / RULE 2-based guarantees.

Another scenario in which RULE 1 applies is shown below:

```

sc_in<bool> go;
sc_out<int> o1;
void my_thread() {

    while (1) {
        wait(); // WAIT 1
        o1.write(some_value);
        if (go.read()) {
            some_value = some_function();
        }
        else {
            wait(); // WAIT 2
        }
        some_other_function();
        wait(); // WAIT 3
    }
}

```

The signal read of `go` is clearly and uniquely associated with WAIT 1. However, the signal write of `o1` associates with WAIT 2 if `go` is false and WAIT 3 if it is not. This is a violation of RULE 1 and should be flagged as an error during HLS. The fix, as before, is to move the signal IO operation as close as possible to its intended wait statement so that the association is unconditional.

Next, let's consider *rolled* (or *preserved*) loops that perform signal IO within the loop body. Consider the following example:

```
sc_in<int> i1;
sc_out<int> o1;
void my_thread() {
    wait(); // reset state
    while (1) {
        wait(); // start of while loop
        #pragma hls_unroll no
        for (int i=0; i < 10; i++) {
            o1.write(i1.read() * i);
        }
    }
}
```

Note that the `i1.read()` operation is located inside the `for` loop, so presumably the user's intent is that it should be read as the loop iterates. *If that is not the user's intent, they simply should move the `i1.read()` operation before the loop start.*

In the post-HLS simulation, each iteration of the loop will consume at least one clock cycle, and a new value for `i1` will be read (and a new value for `o1` written) on each iteration. Again, this is the user's intent as per the code. In the pre-HLS simulation, the `for` loop body will execute in zero time, and only the last write to `o1` will have any effect. The solution to avoid this mismatch is to manually place a `wait()` statement within the `for` loop body so that the signal IO synchronization is explicit in the pre-HLS simulation.

RULE 2: If you have signal IO operations within *rolled* (or *preserved*) loops, manually place a `wait` statement within the body of the loop to avoid pre-HLS versus post-HLS simulation mismatches, and while doing so also follow **RULE 1**.

Scope of RULE 2 for pipelining. RULE 2 applies only to rolled or preserved loops that are not selected for pipelining under this contract. A loop body selected for pipelining shall not contain `wait/ac_wait` statements, `SyncChannel/ac_sync` calls, or any other explicit synchronization interface call. Therefore, if ordinary per-iteration signal IO inside a loop requires a per-iteration wait anchor, that loop is outside the pipelined-loop contract unless the source is rewritten: move the signal IO outside the pipelined loop, model the interaction through message-passing, use `hls_direct_input` / `hls_direct_input_sync` under their stated contracts, or forgo pipelining for that loop. Without an in-body synchronization anchor, repeated per-iteration signal reads or writes inside one surrounding source interval do not become distinct per-iteration Σ -visible Read/Write events merely because HLS later pipelines the loop; their logical anchors remain the surrounding synchronization calls selected into S under R2/E2.

For a proof-backed flow, a rolled loop with signal IO operations but no `wait` statement in the loop body shall be treated as a source well-formedness failure unless an explicit source-level argument shows that each observable signal Read/Write still has a unique real synchronization anchor on every dynamic path. HLS tools may implement this requirement using errors, warnings, lint checks, or other diagnostics. However, if a diagnostic is emitted as a warning rather than an error, the warning must be resolved, waived with an explicit well-formedness justification, or treated as excluding that model from the formal guarantees. (Cat4)

If a pre-HLS model has established RULE 1 and RULE 2 conformance, then all signal IO in the post-HLS model shall occur only at clock cycles that correspond to explicit wait statements or explicit synchronization statements. For direct-input signals/ports (e.g., `#pragma hls_direct_input` and `#pragma hls_direct_input_sync`), this requirement refers to the logical (Σ -visible) anchor cycle of the Read/Write: the event is still considered to occur at its synchronization point even if HLS physically samples a stable signal later; such late-sampling micro-steps are ϵ -steps and are not Σ -visible. User designs that do not adhere to both RULE 1 and RULE 2 are ill-formed and are outside the formal guarantees unless the nonconformance has been eliminated or explicitly discharged by a valid source-level well-formedness argument.

Returning to the Analogy from RTL Synthesis

At the beginning of this document, we presented the example of a Verilog sequential block with an output coded like:

```
Out1 <= #some_delay new_val;
```

Recall that in Verilog simulation, if `some_delay` is less than the clock period of the block, then it will probably not affect the overall cycle-level behavior of the system during simulation. However, if `some_delay` is more than the clock period, it probably will.

During RTL synthesis, all RTL synthesis tools will ignore all delays in the input model, in this case even if `some_delay` is greater than the clock period. Some RTL synthesis tools might give a warning for the code above like “Simulation and synthesis results are likely to mismatch because delay in model is greater than clock period.”

HLS tools or associated lint/qualification flows that adhere closely to the conceptual model presented in this document should provide a concrete mechanism for detecting or discharging violations of RULE 1 and RULE 2 as described in the section above. This is analogous to the error or warning that the RTL synthesis tool would provide in the example directly above.

However, the formal guarantees in this document do not depend on any particular diagnostic mechanism. If an HLS synthesis tool does not report a RULE 1 / RULE 2 issue, the design is not thereby made well-formed. The proof-backed flow must still establish that the source model satisfies the RULE 1 / RULE 2 well-formedness obligation before applying the trace-compatibility guarantees.

Summary

At the beginning of this document, we said that the intent was to present “no surprises” to a DV engineer who wants a common verification methodology for the pre-HLS and post-HLS models. The key aspects of the document which support this are:

- Three groups of IO operations are defined (message-passing, signal IO, and synchronization calls) and each is treated uniformly. These IO operations are easy for verification engineers to understand because they are already using them in their testbenches.

- The document specifically avoids complex constructs such as *protocol regions* used in some HLS tools.
- The document preserves the ability of the pre-HLS SystemC model to be *throughput accurate* by using a library such as Matchlib.
- Synchronization calls can affect the scheduling (anchoring) of signal IO operations, and synchronization calls can affect the scheduling of message-passing calls. In the conceptual anchoring semantics of this document, message-passing calls do not affect the anchor cycle of signal IO operations (and signal IO does not affect the legality/order of committed message transfers) except through explicit synchronization. Practically, in raw pre-HLS SystemC simulation a blocking message operation may introduce additional cycles of waiting, so signal IO statements that are lexically separated from their intended anchor can observe different values; RULE 1 addresses this by recommending placement of signal IO adjacent to its anchor.
- HLS cannot by default reverse the order of message-passing calls, so it cannot introduce new deadlocks *via call-order reversal*. For pipelined loops (overlapped iterations) and other transformations that change the timing of request/commit under bounded capacities, deadlock preservation depends on the additional pipelined-loop discipline described in this document (automatic flush / WFG-inertness), not on the no-reverse rule alone.
- HLS pipelining is largely a *don't care* from the perspective of the verification engineer. If the design and the testbench are insensitive to changes in latency, and if external array accesses are not reordered or rearranged during loop pipelining, then the possible use of HLS pipelining will not affect verification, provided the pipelines flush automatically. Even if the design or testbench are sensitive to changes in latency, or if they are sensitive to reordering or rearranging of external memory accesses due to the use of HLS loop pipelining, then the behavior of the DUT will only change in expected (rather than unexpected) ways, provided the applicable observation-boundary and witness-selection conditions are satisfied. (Appendix G provides formal trace-compatibility guarantees rather than an unrestricted bidirectional equivalence theorem.)
- For sequential processes, signal IO operations in the post-HLS model always occur exactly at synchronization points (e.g., wait statements) that are explicit in the pre-HLS source. For direct-input signals/ports, “occur at synchronization points” is meant in the logical/anchoring sense: the Σ -visible Read/Write is timestamped at the synchronization point even if the implementation samples the stable signal later; those internal late samples are ϵ -steps. For combinational processes, observable signal Read/Write events are instead interpreted at the cycle's ϵ -quiescent combinational fixed point, as specified by R2C.
- The primary deterministic Policy-S route for discharging scheduler-robust source deadlock freedom uses default-total process-facing bounded-response coverage. Every dynamically reachable internal blocking site has a monitor, equivalent bounded-response proof, or selected-instance unreachability proof, and the complete selected Policy-S run must contain no timeout, maximal-pending, or non-waived cancellation failure. This is source-side evidence used to establish A5-L; it is separate from the KObs RTL/source cutpoint interface and does not impose the same response-time bound on RTL.

- The formal proof architecture separates four concerns. Operational semantics retain Issue, Policy L/S, fairness, DrainDiscipline, and the named fair-extension obligation; the safety/replay layer proves observable compatibility and canonical-history agreement; the KObs cutpoint layer adds only the current attributed residual offers needed to reconstruct channel state, frontiers, WFG/WFG+, and the selected deadlock predicate; and the separate CF-S complete-run layer checks K.CompleteS, default-total K.RespCov, and K.RespClean for the selected Policy-S execution. Certificates record the instance, replay history, request inventory, monitor configuration, and proof evidence, while independent checkers reconstruct the applicable cutpoint and complete-run facts.

Appendix A – Factory Analogy

The scheduling rules described in this document apply to pre-HLS and post-HLS HW models. Although the rules may seem abstract and perhaps even arbitrary, they are shaped by the need to model systems in the real world that are required to have predictable behavior.

To understand the motivation behind the rules, it might be helpful to draw a simple real-world analogy and its correspondence to the rules described earlier.

Consider a factory that produces various types of wooden furniture:

The factory consists of people (processes) stationed at workbenches with various tools.

Each person is given written instructions about the specific tasks they are to perform (C++ code within a process).

People are instructed to send or receive objects (messages) to or from other people in the factory.

Sending or receiving objects may be blocking or non-blocking from the perspective of a person.

There is a clock with a second hand on the factory wall that everyone can see. (HW clock).

People have colored flags they can raise or lower to communicate with other people (signals).

If someone raises or lowers a flag, this is only seen by others the next time the clock second hand is at the top of the clock. (propagation delay of signals between sequential processes)

A person can choose to pipeline the tasks that they were assigned by hiring subordinates (pipeline stages) and having each one do a subtask. In general, this will improve the throughput for the tasks that the person was assigned.

It is possible for two people to explicitly synchronize their work by communicating via a synchronization protocol such as a barrier (synchronization).

It is possible to restart the work of some or all the people by raising a reset flag (HW resets).

Assume:

1. That the time that people take to complete their various tasks is in general variable, and similarly that the time that objects (messages) take to pass between people is in general variable.
2. That each person in general wants to complete their tasks as quickly and efficiently as possible.
3. That the factory needs to be able to make multiple types of furniture at the same time. For example, it might make chairs that need to be different colors or have different styles.

To reliably produce output, each person in the factory will need to adhere to rules like those described in this document.

Here's a sketch of a specific way the above example relates to the scheduling rules:

Person 1 sends chair seats and chair backs to Person 2. This is done with blocking operations, and there is no storage capacity between the people when the objects are sent. (This means that a Push operation cannot complete until the corresponding Pop operation is performed.) Assume that the fastest an object can be sent between people is 1 minute.

The written instructions that person 1 is given are:

```
while (1) {
    // internal processing code for seats and backs ...
    seats.Push(seat_object);
    backs.Push(back_object);
}
```

The written instructions that person 2 is given are:

```
while (1) {
    seat_object = seats.Pop();
    back_object = backs.Pop();
    // internal processing code for seats and backs ...
}
```

If both person 1 and person 2 choose to perform their tasks sequentially as written, then objects will be passed over time as:

	Person 1	Person 2
Minute 1:	seats.Push(seat1);	
Minute 2:	backs.Push(back1);	seat1 = seats.Pop();
Minute 3:	seats.Push(seat2);	back1 = backs.Pop();
Minute 4:	backs.Push(back2);	seat2 = seats.Pop();
Minute 5:		back2 = backs.Pop();

If both person 1 and person 2 choose to perform their IO operations in parallel, then objects will be passed over time as:

	Person 1	Person 2
Minute 1:	seats.Push(seat1); backs.Push(back1);	
Minute 2:	seats.Push(seat2); backs.Push(back2);	seat1 = seats.Pop(); back1 = backs.Pop();
Minute 3:		seat2 = seats.Pop(); back2 = backs.Pop();

If person 1 chooses to perform their IO operations in parallel, and person 2 chooses to perform their IO operations sequentially as written, then objects will be passed over time as:

	Person 1	Person 2
Minute 1:	seats.Push(seat1); backs.Push(back1);	
Minute 2:		seat1 = seats.Pop();
Minute 3:	seats.Push(seat2); backs.Push(back2);	back1 = backs.Pop();
Minute 4:		seat2 = seats.Pop();
Minute 5:		back2 = backs.Pop();

If person 1 chooses to perform their IO operations sequentially as written, but person 2 chooses to perform their IO operations sequentially in the reverse order as it was written, then objects will be passed over time as:

	Person 1	Person 2
Minute 1:	seats.Push(seat1);	
Minute 2:	backs.Push(back1);	back1 = backs.Pop();
Minute 3:		seat1 = seats.Pop();

In this case the person 1 seats.Push(seat1) operation at minute 1 will not complete at the start of minute 2. This means that the person 1 backs.Push(back1) operation will never start, and thus the Person 2 back1 backs.Pop() operation will never complete. So, the system will be in deadlock.

This example directly corresponds to the ordering rules related to message-passing operations in the *basic conceptual model* within this document, and in particular the specific rule that disallows reversing the order of message-passing operations.

Appendix B – Formal Presentation of Pipelined Loops

Modeling convention for pipelined-loop overlap.

Pipelined-loop body no-wait condition. The formal pipelined-loop model in this appendix applies only to HLS-pipelined loop bodies that contain no wait/ac_wait statement, SyncChannel/ac_sync call, or other explicit synchronization interface call inside the loop body. All ordinary synchronization calls selected into S must be outside the pipelined loop body or at explicit boundaries around the pipelined region. This is a well-formedness condition for applying the Appendices G-K theorem stack to a pipelined-loop instance; an in-loop synchronization call requires source rewriting, non-pipelined/preserved-loop treatment, or a separate proof/certificate outside this appendix.

The post-HLS pipelined-loop implementation may overlap iterations and may internally accept/stage up to the finite bound $B(c_in)$ of input values for younger overlapped iterations before older iterations' outputs are produced. This internal accept/stage behavior is part of the back-annotated channel realization counted in $B(c_in)$ between the Σ -visible endpoints of c_in (producer $Push_c_in$ and consumer Pop_c_in). Here $B(c_in)$ is an effective abstract-boundary capacity/credit bound, not a claim that the RTL contains a single physical FIFO named c_in ; the proof obligation is that the chosen Sys_ref boundary exposes E4-consistent ChannelEnabled/ChannelDisabled behavior, with hidden physical storage represented as ϵ -state unless it is explicitly elaborated into $Sys_B^{\epsilon}elab$ channels. These internal accept/stage movements are modeled as ϵ -steps. **Σ records only the committed boundary transfers at the Σ -visible endpoints.** In particular, the consumer-side boundary Pop_c_in is the loop-body Pop_c_in operation from the pre-HLS source when that Pop is included in the chosen Σ / Σ_DUT

projection. The externally relevant effect of pipelining is therefore captured entirely by $B(c_in)$ (via boundary backpressure/acceptance behavior and overlap timing at the Σ -visible boundary), without introducing any new auxiliary or duplicate Σ -visible boundary Pops: the Σ -visible consumer-side Pop_c_in commits are still the same loop-body Pop_c_in operations from the pre-HLS source, though they may commit at different times (and thus at different prefixes) than in an unpipelined execution. Once the pipeline reaches a quiescent blocked state under the automatic flush discipline below, it does not initiate new blocking request assertions for younger overlapped iterations.

B-faithfulness obligation

The use of $B(c_in)$ in this modeling convention assumes that the selected abstract boundary and the reported capacity faithfully summarize the corresponding RTL realization: all storage/credit that can accept, hold, or backpressure messages between the chosen producer and consumer endpoints is either counted in $B(c_in)$ or represented as an explicit Sys_B^{elab} boundary, and movements inside that realization are ϵ -steps that do not create, delete, duplicate, reorder, or relabel Σ -visible boundary transfers. This is a tool/RTL-flow compliance obligation, not a fact derived by Appendix B.

Multi-input Pop points and coupler policies.

When a pipelined loop consumes from multiple input channels (e.g., $c1, c2$), back-annotation still assigns a separate finite bound $B(c_i)$ and cycle-boundary occupancy $occ_ci(t)$ to each outer Σ -visible boundary channel c_i . However, in the multi-input / coupler cases of Appendix Q the formal source-side proof target is no longer merely the outer-boundary Sys_B ; it is the elaborated reference model Sys_B^{elab} of Appendix J, Remark 2. In Sys_B^{elab} , $B(\cdot)$, $occ_c(t)$, $E4$, $BoundaryReq$, $ChannelEnabled/ChannelDisabled$, and the Appendix K blocking/WFG machinery are interpreted per explicit abstract channel, including any introduced staged/bundle/join channels. Any conjunctive/join dependency (e.g., “join not met”) shall therefore be represented only via such explicit staged/bundle/join boundary channels in Sys_B^{elab} (not as cross-channel disablement at the outer Σ -visible endpoints), so that for Appendix K the blocking point is that explicit boundary and the relevant $Front_P(o)$ members there are jointly channel-disabled (“ALL disabled $\Rightarrow$ stall”). For the detailed elaboration patterns and examples, see Appendix Q.

Practical note (outer Σ_DUT projection and proof-internal Σ)

The loop-body Pop_c_in in the pre-HLS source (i.e., the consumer-side Pop_c_in operation, conceptually after the in-flight capacity $B(c_in)$) may be exposed in the outer DUT/testbench-visible alphabet Σ_DUT if desired, but is typically omitted since it is latency-insensitive, and it is often practically difficult to expose/collect in the post-HLS RTL. The liveness/deadlock reasoning still accounts for this blocking point without requiring it to be Σ_DUT -visible: Appendix K defines WFG edges using the $ChannelEnabled/ChannelDisabled$ status of the corresponding pending boundary operation instance q with $kind(q)=Pop_c_in$ (via $E4/occ_c/B(c)$). In ordinary non-elaborated Sys_B cases, this does not require introducing any additional proof-internal abstract channel. In elaborated cases $Sys_ref = Sys_B^{elab}$, however, any introduced staged/bundle/join channel needed to represent a blocking point is an explicit proof-internal Σ boundary for Appendix K, even if its committed Push/Pop events are projected away from the outer Σ_DUT trace by Π_elab .

Drain-only blocked-frontier discipline and automatic flush.

Potential deadlocks are avoided by having the pipeline automatically flush.

In this document, “automatic flush” does not mean a global pipeline clear or a mandatory drain-to-empty phase. It is the pipelined or otherwise overlapped implementation of the more general drain-only blocked-frontier discipline used by Appendix K. Once the minimal pending blocking frontier is fully channel-disabled after ε -settling, the process is blocked at that frontier; no new later source work may issue past that frontier; already asserted blocking requests remain asserted until commit; and already-issued downstream work may continue to drain only insofar as it does not create new WFG-relevant blocking causes. For ordinary non-overlapped control, the same Appendix K discipline may instead be discharged structurally, as described below.

Terminology (pending blocking frontier / $\text{Front_P}(\sigma)$)

In an ε -quiescent cycle, consider the set of pending source-level blocking message-operation frontier items $x \in \Omega_{\text{msg},P}$ in the current interval between adjacent synchronization calls, where each such item has an owning dynamic message-call instance $q = \text{MsgOf_P}(x)$ whose $\text{Issue}(q)$ has occurred and whose $\text{Commit}(q)$ has not yet occurred. By the Issue/Commit linkage (Appendix C) together with BoundaryReq ’s definition at the Σ -visible boundary (as given in “Common Formal Definitions for Appendices I-K”), each such pending blocking frontier item x has its endpoint-owned boundary request asserted through q (Push: vld, Pop: rdy) until q commits; purely combinational channel-side structure (including couplers) may affect only the complementary mirror signal (Push: rdy, Pop: vld) and thus whether x commits in that cycle after ε -settling. Define $\text{Front_P}(\sigma)$ to be the set of such pending blocking message-operation frontier items that are minimal with respect to the source-induced order $\leq_P$ within that interval. Under the default ordinary source-order convention, source-level message calls that appear in sequence in one process are ordered, so an ordinary non-elaborated source interval has at most one minimal pending blocking message-operation frontier item. If $\text{Front_P}(\sigma)$ has multiple message-operation members, that multiplicity must come from explicit $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$ proof-internal structure such as staged/bundle/join/epoch-gate abstract channels; it is not inferred merely from the fact that ordinary source calls use distinct interfaces. We refer to $\text{Front_P}(\sigma)$ as the pending blocking frontier (or “minimal pending blocking frontier”). This $\text{Front_P}(\sigma)$ notion is distinct from NextFront_P (Definition R.6; reconstructed from KObs by Lemma R.21b and Corollary J.1), which denotes the next source-level frontier-item set over Ω_P and may include synchronization-call items, signal-anchored action items, and message-operation items. A message-operation item in NextFront_P may be pending before it contributes any committed Σ -event.

A pipelined loop supplies the drain-only blocked-frontier discipline by automatically flushing if, whenever the pending blocking frontier $\text{Front_P}(\sigma)$ is non-empty and every frontier item $x \in \text{Front_P}(\sigma)$ cannot make progress because it is not channel-enabled (evaluated after combinational ready/valid/backpressure has ε -settled for the cycle), then:

1. **Block point.** The process is blocked on message passing at that pending blocking frontier $\text{Front_P}(\sigma)$, as in the unpipelined source.
2. **No new later work.** While blocked at that frontier (i.e., while $\text{Front_P}(\sigma)$ remains non-empty and all of its members are channel-disabled), the implementation does not issue any new blocking Pop/Push message-operation frontier item $y \in \Omega_{\text{msg},P}$ that is later in source order than some $x \in \text{Front_P}(\sigma)$, including any younger overlapped iteration, and therefore does not begin asserting $\text{BoundaryReq}(y, \cdot)$ for such later work. Here issue is read through the owning message instance $q_y = \text{MsgOf_P}(y)$.

3. **No withdrawal.** While blocked, the implementation does not withdraw any already-asserted blocking Pop/Push request (no “try-and-withdraw”); outstanding blocking requests remain asserted until their owning message instances commit.
4. **Clarification (Frontier-minimality vs. other asserted requests).** The Wait-For Graph in Appendix K is intentionally defined from the minimal pending blocking frontier $\text{Front_P}(\sigma)$, i.e., the current blocking causes. Accordingly, an already-asserted blocking request whose frontier item is not in $\text{Front_P}(\sigma)$ (for example, a request from a younger overlapped iteration that was issued before the blocked condition, or a downstream request draining work already past the frontier) may persist as protocol state under the “no withdrawal” rule, but it is not treated as a wait-for source while an earlier pending blocking frontier item remains frontier-minimal. Such a request contributes WFG blocking only if/when its frontier item later becomes a member of $\text{Front_P}(\sigma)$.
5. **Drain-only downstream progress.** Work that has already passed the blocked frontier point(s) may continue to drain, and any already-asserted resulting output-Push requests may commit when channel-enabled, provided no work advances past the blocked frontier point(s). (Formally: “no work advances past” is meant in the $\leq_P$ / issue sense—while $\text{Front_P}(\sigma)$ is fully disabled, P does not issue any new blocking message-operation frontier item y , with owning instance $q_y = \text{MsgOf_P}(y)$, such that, for some $x \in \text{Front_P}(\sigma)$, $x \leq_P y$ and $x \neq y$; downstream drain may only complete/commit operations whose BoundaryReq was already asserted prior to reaching this blocked condition.) (Equivalently: this is the “ALL disabled $\Rightarrow$ stall” policy— P stalls only when none of the frontier items in $\text{Front_P}(\sigma)$ are channel-enabled; downstream work may drain while $\text{Front_P}(\sigma)$ is fully disabled.)
6. **Finite explicit boundary storage/credit.** Every selected abstract boundary that can hold or credit already accepted work has a finite declared capacity $B(c)$, or is represented by an explicit finite $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$ boundary chain whose component capacities are finite and B -faithful. Together with “no new later work,” this makes the set of drainable work finite and non-replenishing.
7. **Synchronization-boundary withdrawal of future-epoch acceptance.** Let s be an explicit synchronization interface call that separates the current source interval from later work. While the process is pending at s , the implementation shall not present producer-facing availability for any back-annotated capacity intended only for $\text{suff_S}(s)$; equivalently, any asserted upstream producer request targeting such capacity shall remain channel-disabled until s commits. This does not prevent drain of work already accepted before reaching s . **Formal elaboration requirement.** For purposes of Appendices J–K, this withdrawal shall be represented in Sys_ref by the elaborated source model $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$, not by adding a hidden extra enablement predicate to an otherwise E4-enabled outer channel. $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$ shall introduce explicit sync-boundary / epoch-gate abstract channels, or equivalent explicit staged realization structure, so that capacity usable only by $\text{suff_S}(s)$ is separated from capacity available to the current interval. While s is pending, the gate/boundary for future-epoch acceptance is channel-disabled in the ordinary E4 sense at that explicit abstract boundary. After s commits, the corresponding post-sync capacity may again become producer-facing available according to the ordinary ChannelEnabled rules for the elaborated channels.

General drain-only blocked-frontier obligation used by Appendix K

Appendix K applies the drain-only blocked-frontier discipline to every source interval in which Policy L can leave source-later same-interval blocking work issued while an earlier minimal blocking frontier remains uncommitted. This includes pipelined-loop overlap and other explicitly modeled eager/overlapped issue admitted by the selected Sys_ref transition system; it is not a license to treat ordinary source-sequenced operations as incomparable, and it is not limited to physically pipelined control.

For pipelined or otherwise overlapped control, Appendix B automatic flush is the implementation-side discharge. For ordinary non-overlapped control, the obligation may be discharged by proving that, after the process reaches a channel-disabled blocked point, its control cannot launch any new source-later dynamic operation until the blocker commits. In both cases, Appendix C supplies the non-withdrawal discipline, and E4/B-faithfulness plus explicit $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$ accounting supply finite boundary storage or credit. The resulting drain set may shrink through already-issued commits but cannot be replenished across the blocked frontier.

Example (II=1, latency=4, automatic flush): a loop that performs one blocking $\text{Pop}_{\{c_in\}}$ and one blocking $\text{Push}_{\{c_out\}}$ per iteration in the pre-HLS source may, after pipelining in the post-HLS RTL, internally accept/stage up to four input values into pipeline staging (pipeline overlap) before the first output $\text{Push}_{\{c_out\}}$ commits, subject to the back-annotated bound $B(c_in)$ (E4). Values may then reside for several cycles in internal pipeline storage; such internal staging/hand-off is ϵ -state within the back-annotated realization and does not create any new auxiliary or duplicate Σ -visible $\text{Push}_c/\text{Pop}_c$ events beyond the boundary commits at the Σ -visible endpoints (it may change only the timing of those boundary commits under overlapped execution). The drain-only blocking behavior is as defined above under “automatic flush”; in particular, if the blocked operation is in a late pipeline stage (e.g., the final Push), there may be little or no downstream work to drain.

Appendix C – Formal Definitions of Issue and Commit

Scope / shared definitions

The definitions below are with respect to the Σ -visible endpoints of the chosen source reference model Sys_ref (Appendix J, Remark 2)—i.e., the ready/valid interfaces at which Σ records message-transfer events in the raw rendezvous case Sys , the ordinary bounded-FIFO case Sys_B , or the elaborated back-annotated case $\text{Sys}_B^{\text{elab}}$. All shared notions about (i) Σ vs. ϵ steps, (ii) BoundaryReq / ChannelEnabled / ChannelDisabled , (iii) non-blocking polls as ϵ on failure, and (iv) the $B(c)$ / $\text{occ}_c(t)$ (cycle-boundary, non-fall-through) interpretation of E4 are as defined in “Common Formal Definitions for Appendices I-K” and are to be interpreted over the explicit abstract channels of Sys_ref . Appendix C defines only Commit, Issue, and the Issue/Commit linkage conditions that make $\text{Issue}(q)$ well-defined.

Definition: Commit (message channel) — as observed by an external clocked observer
Commit is the cycle in which an external clocked observer sees a transfer complete at a Σ -visible boundary endpoint: A message commits in the cycle when the observer sees both valid and ready high at the same time. The committed payload is the data value seen in that same cycle.

Definition: Issue (message channel) — as an auxiliary (scheduler/witness) timestamp
Issue(q) is an auxiliary timestamp used to state scheduling constraints (R4/E3/E5). Intuitively, it is the first cycle in which the calling process begins requesting the transfer corresponding to the source-level message operation instance q at the chosen Σ -visible boundary endpoint.

Same-cycle rendezvous clarification. For a rendezvous channel $B(c)=0$, if a matched Push_c operation instance and Pop_c operation instance first assert their endpoint-owned requests in the same cycle t , and the ready/valid rendezvous is selected/observed in that cycle, then both operation instances have $\text{Issue} = t$ and both committed transfer events occur in cycle t . There is no implicit extra cycle between same-cycle matching endpoint requests and the corresponding rendezvous commit. If one endpoint

request was already asserted from an earlier blocking operation, then its Issue may be earlier than t , but the matched Push_c/Pop_c commit is still a same-cycle commit in cycle t .

Issue/Commit linkage (well-formedness conditions)

Fix a Σ -visible endpoint direction, and let $\text{req}(t)$ denote the endpoint-owned boundary request signal in cycle t (valid for Push, ready for Pop), i.e., the process-driven request level captured by BoundaryReq at that boundary (per “Common Formal Definitions for Appendices I-K”). For each source-level message operation instance q on that endpoint direction:

- Boundary-request soundness (blocking requests are non-withdrawable). $\text{req}(\text{Issue}(q)) = 1$. If q is a blocking Push/Pop, then once issued it remains the unique outstanding request on that endpoint direction until it commits: $\text{req}(t)=1$ in every cycle t from $\text{Issue}(q)$ through the commit cycle of q (inclusive), with stable payload while asserted for Push. (This is the “no deassert-before-commit” discipline used throughout the document.)
- Stable attribution for a single outstanding source-level request. If $\text{req}(t)=1$ and no transfer commits on that endpoint direction in cycle t , then any continued assertion $\text{req}(t+1)=1$ is attributed to the same outstanding source-level message-operation instance q only so long as the requesting source-level operation remains that same outstanding instance. For blocking Push/Pop, this is the mandatory non-withdrawable case above, so attribution cannot change before commit. For non-blocking PushNB/PopNB, continuous assertion of the endpoint request signal, by itself, does not identify later executed non-blocking call instances as the same q ; a new executed source-level non-blocking call creates a new dynamic instance $q' \in Q_{\text{exec},P}$ for the owning process P , even if req does not deassert between cycles.
- Back-to-back issuance under continuously asserted req . If q_0 commits in cycle t and the next source-level operation q_1 on the same endpoint direction is issued back-to-back, then $\text{Issue}(q_1)=t+1$ (even if the request signal does not deassert between commits), provided q_0 and q_1 lie within the same source interval between adjacent ordinary synchronization calls selected into S .
- **Sequential-result availability (no same-cycle dependent continuation).** Let q_0 commit in cycle t in a sequential process P . If a dynamically succeeding operation q_1 is reachable only after q_0 commits, or if q_1 ’s control choice, endpoint, address, payload, or other required operand depends on the value or status returned by q_0 , then $\text{Issue}(q_1) > t$. This rule applies across distinct channels and endpoint directions as well as on the same endpoint. Same-cycle issue or commit remains permitted only when q_1 was independently reached and all required inputs and control predecessors were available before the cycle- t boundary; overlap between independently active pipeline iterations is not prohibited.
- Sync-boundary discipline. If $q_0 \in \text{pref}_S(s)$ and $q_1 \in \text{suff}_S(s)$ for an ordinary synchronization call s selected into S , then $\text{Issue}(q_1)$ is strictly after s ’s commit in the same trace (i.e., $\text{Issue}(q_1) > \text{clk_pre}(s)$ in τ_{pre} and $\text{Issue}(q_1) > \text{clk_post}(s)$ in τ_{post}). Any boundary request assertion that persists while the process is still pending at s is attributed to the outstanding operation(s) in $\text{pref}_S(s)$ and does not constitute issuance of any operation in $\text{suff}_S(s)$. Under the pipelined-loop body no-wait condition, there are no in-body wait events that create additional sync-boundary cuts inside an HLS-pipelined loop.

For non-blocking message passing (PushNB/PopNB), a failed poll produces no Σ -event and is modeled as an ϵ -step, while a successful poll contributes the corresponding committed Push_c(v) / Pop_c(v) event; see “Non-blocking message-passing” in “Common Formal Definitions for Appendices I-K” and Appendix I.2. Each executed non-blocking call is a distinct dynamic source-level message-call instance $q \in Q_{\text{exec},P}$ for the owning process P . Thus, if repeated PopNB/PushNB polls occur in later loop iterations

or at later source-level call instances, they are distinct q 's even if the endpoint request remains continuously asserted and no intervening commit occurs. Stable attribution therefore applies to a single outstanding source-level request instance; it does not collapse distinct non-blocking dynamic call instances across iterations into one q . Successful non-blocking calls that commit induce message-operation frontier items $x \in \Omega_msg, P$ when their committed transfer is relevant to Ω_P , with owning message instances $q = \text{MsgOf_P}(x)$ in Q_P . Failed non-blocking polls remain only in Q_exec, P and contribute no Ω_P or Ω_msg, P item.

Appendix D – Modeling Latency-Sensitive Protocols

In some cases, designs or testbenches may use protocols or local control policies which are latency-sensitive. These situations are handled by isolating the latency-sensitive portions into small, self-contained parts, and then keeping the rest of the design and testbench latency insensitive. A latency-sensitive portion is any local block of logic whose functional or externally visible behavior depends on cycle-level timing that is not represented by the ordinary latency-insensitive Σ interface. This includes ordinary signal-level protocols with fixed cycle timing, global interrupt/request ordering logic, non-blocking arbitration whose winner depends on request arrival timing, and non-blocking retry/timeout logic whose later behavior depends on the number or cadence of failed PushNB/PopNB polls before success.

For such logic, the intended methodology is not to treat the hidden timing dependence as part of the ordinary latency-insensitive source-core proof. Instead, the latency-sensitive portion should be isolated behind an explicit boundary. On one side of the boundary, the transactor or local protocol block may be modeled cycle-accurately, snooped, or otherwise verified with its detailed timing behavior. On the other side of the boundary, the rest of the system should see a latency-insensitive interface, such as message-passing transactions, synchronization events, or a properly handshaken signal protocol.

Consider a case where a signal-level protocol is latency-sensitive. The protocol will have specific timing behavior that it must meet. To handle this, we create a transactor that has two sides: the first side interacts with the signals and handles the detailed timing requirements, and the second side sends and receives messages with the rest of the system. The message-passing side is latency insensitive. The same pattern applies to cadence-sensitive non-blocking polling logic: if retry counters, timeout counters, or arbitration decisions depend on the number or cadence of failed non-blocking polls, that polling loop is part of the latency-sensitive local protocol block. Its detailed failed-poll cadence should be contained inside the isolated block or aligned by the Appendix L snooping mechanism; it should not leak as an unmodeled hidden timing dependence into the ordinary Appendix I/J latency-insensitive proof. To properly model the detailed timing behavior, the latency-sensitive transactor or local protocol block is modeled at the cycle-accurate level in SystemC, or is otherwise covered by an explicit snooping/alignment argument. There is an example of such a transactor model in the following document and example:

https://github.com/Stuart-Swan/Matchlib-Examples-Kit-For-Accellera-Synthesis-WG/blob/master/matchlib_examples/examples/53_transactor_modeling/transactor_modeling.pdf

For purposes of the formal appendices, once the latency-sensitive portion has been isolated, the ordinary Appendix I/J proof is applied at the chosen observable boundary of that isolated block. The

failed-poll cadence internal to the isolated block remains local timing behavior; the rest of the system observes only the latency-insensitive or explicitly modeled boundary behavior.

Appendix E – One-Way Handshake Protocols

In some systems a one-way signal handshake is sufficient for reliable system operation. When using a one-way handshake, the implicit assumption is that the “missing” handshake isn’t required since it is always true.

For example, in time-domain signal processing hardware designs, signal processing HW blocks may input new samples at a fixed rate. The HW blocks are always ready to receive new samples on each clock, but they need to know if the samples are valid. These types of designs can be modeled with the one-way handshake `dat/vld` protocol demonstrated in this example:

https://github.com/Stuart-Swan/Matchlib-Examples-Kit-For-Accellera-Synthesis-WG/tree/master/matchlib_examples/examples/32_dat_vld

Appendix F – Scheduling Rules: Modeling Guidelines Summary

- 1) Prefer to use `Connections::In/Out + SyncChannel` over signal IO and `wait()`.
- 2) Prefer to use `Pop()/Push()` over `PopNB()/PushNB()`.
- 3) When pipelining a loop, prefer to use `hls_stall_mode flush`.

When using signal IO:

- 4) If modeling a cycle-accurate process, use `disable_spawn` and follow the example `53_transactor_modeling` style and do not use `Push/Pop` in the process.
- 5) If modeling a *direct input*, use `hls_direct_input` and possibly `hls_direct_input_sync`, and only change the signal at allowed times.
- 6) If combining signal IO with `Connections::In/Out` in the same process, use proper signal IO handshake that does not rely on `In/Out` ports for process synchronization. Place signal IO operations very close to their `wait()` statements.
- 7) Unless you are modeling a cycle-accurate process, you should expect that latency will change between the pre-HLS and post-HLS models.

Appendix G – Trace Compatibility Rules

This document informally states that a primary goal is to present “no surprises” to a DV engineer using the same testbench to verify the pre-HLS and post-HLS models.

Somewhat more formally, we can show how the scheduling rules within this document establish a set of trace-compatibility rules between the pre-HLS and post-HLS models that provide strong guarantees about their behaviors.

The *basic conceptual model* establishes the base behavior for a single process:

- 1) Synchronization interface calls always remain in source code order.
- 2) Signal reads occur at closest preceding synchronization interface call.
- 3) Signal writes occur at closest succeeding synchronization interface call.
- 4) All message-passing operations before a call to a synchronization interface shall be issued before or in the same cycle in which the synchronization interface commits.
(For blocking message-passing operations (Push/Pop), this implies the corresponding commits occur no later than the synchronization call's commit cycle.)
- 5) All message-passing operations after a call to a synchronization interface shall be issued after the cycle in which the synchronization interface call commits.
- 6) Two message-passing operations on separate interfaces which appear in sequence in the model are source-ordered. They may issue with timing overlap or in the same clock cycle where the selected issue policy allows, but they shall not be issued in the reverse sequence. Operations on the same message-passing interface are issued in source order (they are never reversed).
- 7) Synchronization calls can affect the scheduling of signal IO operations, and synchronization calls can affect the scheduling of message-passing calls, but message-passing calls cannot affect the scheduling of signal IO operations and vice-versa.
- 8) The STRICT_IO_SCHEDULING=relaxed option is not used.
- 9) We distinguish the rendezvous source model Sys (B(c)=0 for all channels) from the buffered source interpretation Sys_B, which uses bounded-FIFO channel capacities B(c) matching the post-HLS RTL (Appendices I–K).

Conceptually, systems are composed of many such processes which follow the basic conceptual model, and which communicate using only synchronization interface calls, latency-insensitive signal-level protocols, and committed message-passing transfers. If a design uses non-blocking message-passing calls (PushNB/PopNB), then unsuccessful polls are treated as internal ϵ -steps (no Σ -event), and each successful completion is represented in Σ as the corresponding committed Push_c/Pop_c transfer (Σ records transfers, not failed polls). If the resulting latency-sensitive behavior is externally visible at the DUT boundary, the snooping wrapper of Appendix L may be used to align the selected admissible pre-HLS execution with the RTL. Here we call this system of processes the *conceptual system*.

Practically, the modeling approach described above is too restrictive for real-world systems with optimized HW, so the scheduling rules in this document allow for key HW optimizations. But this is done in a carefully controlled manner, such that the HW optimizations do not break equivalent behavior with the *conceptual system*.

Here is a summary of the HW optimizations that the scheduling rules allow, and a brief description of how we maintain equivalent behavior with the *conceptual system*:

1. Pipelined loops: In the post-HLS RTL, the pipeline may overlap iterations to improve throughput. See Appendix B for a formal presentation of pipelined loops.
2. Pipelined loops: HLS by default will not break any latency-insensitive signal IO protocols when pipelining loops.

3. Direct inputs: Signals that do not change after a process comes out of reset can be read as late as possible using *hls_direct_input*, saving register area.
4. Direct inputs: When *hls_direct_input_sync* is used, signals read by a process are updated at the precise point at which the HW pipeline is guaranteed to be ramped down, so the signal values do not need to be saved within pipeline registers, saving register area.
5. Memory accesses: HLS can reorder memory accesses within a process only if it can prove that the reordering is conflict-free.
6. Shared memories: Memories shared between processes are modeled as simple C arrays but always include explicit synchronization between processes in both the pre-HLS and post-HLS models. For the formal results of Appendices I–K, the value-carrying accesses must additionally satisfy the J.Mem lowering condition (Common Formal Definitions).
7. Non-blocking message-passing interfaces: They are modeled at the level of committed transfers (successful completion), with unsuccessful polls treated as ϵ -steps and thus not part of Σ . If latency differences in these committed-transfer events are externally visible at the DUT boundary and must be aligned for verification, equivalent behavior between pre-HLS and post-HLS systems can be maintained by snooping the post-HLS system and using this to delay pre-HLS message arrival (Appendix L).
8. Latency-sensitive global signal IO: If latency differences are externally visible to the DUT, equivalent behavior between pre-HLS and post-HLS systems can be maintained by snooping the post-HLS system and using this to delay pre-HLS signals.
9. Latency-sensitive local signal IO: Isolate local latency-sensitive protocols to small, dedicated transactors, and use latency-insensitive signal IO or message-passing to communicate with the rest of the system.
10. One-way signal handshake protocols: Only use in cases where backpressure is not possible and embed assertions into the model to check that this is always true.
11. Combinational processes: If the pre-HLS model contains combinational processes, their observable signal Read/Write behavior is interpreted at each cycle's ϵ -quiescent combinational fixed point. Under the well-formedness requirement that the combinational network is deterministic and reaches a unique fixed point, the RTL/tool-flow conformance obligation is to preserve the fixed-point signal relation, so combinational signal IO can be included in Σ without using synchronization anchors.

Taken as a whole, these rules support a verification methodology in which full-system verification is performed primarily on the pre-HLS system model, and post-HLS RTL verification can be reduced to targeted checks that the formal side conditions are met. The precise guarantee is the execution-level guarantee of Appendix J: for every reachable RTL_B prefix whose local certificate package satisfies Definition J.LocalGWR, Theorem J.GWR-Comp constructs a globally witness-realizable package and a matching Sys_ref behavior (Post $\rightarrow$ Ref). A directly validated J.GWR package is an alternate route. The reverse direction applies only to annotated RTL-consistent source-side prefixes or to source-side

executions selected by the Appendix L snooping / witness-selection mechanism. Thus a source-side pass justifies the corresponding RTL_B behavior only within that annotated RTL-consistent / witness-selected subset. For liveness/deadlock guarantees, the results additionally assume the Appendix K/N progress, fairness, drain, and A5 premises; the cycle-by-cycle R/E rules and the safety construction alone do not imply those liveness properties.

Formalization of the Trace Compatibility Rules in Appendix G

The following notation is used in this section.

Symbol Meaning

P	A process (thread or method) in the design
Σ	The alphabet of observable IO actions
τ_P	A (finite or infinite) per-cycle trace of observable actions executed by process P: for each global clock cycle t , $\tau_P[t]$ is the (possibly empty) set of Σ -actions committed by P at t . Actions committed in the same cycle are treated as simultaneous (unordered); only cross-cycle order (and the explicit E1–E5 constraints) is semantically significant.
S	The subset of Σ that are synchronization calls (explicit wait, SyncChannel, START_P/FINISH_P indicating process start/finish)
R	The subset of Σ that are signal reads
W	The subset of Σ that are signal writes
M	The subset of Σ that are committed message-passing transfers (i.e., committed Push_c / Pop_c events on message-passing channels, including successful non-blocking transfers). Unsuccessful non-blocking polls contribute no Σ -event and are modeled as ϵ -steps, and therefore are not members of M .
Q_{exec}	The execution-level set of dynamic source-level message-call instances executed by a process at the Σ -visible endpoints (blocking Push/Pop, and non-blocking PushNB/PopNB calls). Elements of Q_{exec} may or may not commit. In particular, failed non-blocking polls are elements of Q_{exec} , have no committed Σ -event, and are modeled as ϵ -steps. The frontier-item universe Ω_P , defined below, is separate from Q_{exec} .
Ω_P	The local dynamic frontier-item universe for process P in the selected execution / witness. It contains synchronization-call items, signal-action items, and message-operation frontier items; it is distinct from $Q_{\text{exec},P}$, the universe of dynamic source-level message-call instances.
$\Omega_{\text{msg},P}$	The message-operation slice of Ω_P : frontier items x for which $\text{MsgOf}_P(x)$ is defined.
$\text{MsgOf}_P(x)$	Partial projection from a message-operation frontier item $x \in \Omega_{\text{msg},P}$ to its owning dynamic source-level message-call instance $q \in Q_{\text{exec},P}$. In $\text{Sys}_B^{\text{elab}}$, MsgOf_P need not be injective: one source-level q may own several elaborated frontier items.

P	A process (thread or method) in the design
BoundaryOf_P(x)	The explicit abstract channel boundary at which frontier item x is evaluated for BoundaryReq, ChannelEnabled, ChannelDisabled, Front_P, and Appendix K WFG reasoning. In ordinary unelaborated cases this boundary is unique for the owning source-level operation; in Sys_B ^{elab} it is declared by the elaboration package.

A *system trace* is the tuple

$\tau = (\tau_P)_P$, one component per process.

For any action $a \in \Sigma$, let $\text{clk_pre}(a) / \text{clk_post}(a)$ be the clock cycle at which a is committed.

For any issued message-call instance $q \in Q_{\text{exec}}$, $\text{issue_pre}(q) / \text{issue_post}(q)$ denotes the auxiliary Issue timestamp for q in the pre-HLS / post-HLS trace, respectively, as defined in Appendix C and required to satisfy the associated Issue/Commit linkage (well-formedness) conditions with respect to the Σ -visible boundary request signal on q's endpoint direction.

If q commits, it contributes a unique committed transfer $m(q) \in M$ with commit cycle $\text{clk_pre}(m(q)) / \text{clk_post}(m(q))$. If q does not commit (e.g., an unsuccessful non-blocking call), then $m(q)$ is undefined / absent and no Σ -event is added to M.

(Q_exec-matching / witness convention.) Because unsuccessful non-blocking polls are ϵ -steps and produce no Σ -event, Q_{exec} is not in general reconstructible from the Σ -projection alone. Whenever E3, E5, or any later proof compares executed message-call instances across Sys_ref and RTL_B, the comparison is made relative to the chosen execution witness. That witness supplies a partial matching μ_Q between dynamic source-level message-call instances in the compared traces, preserving process identity, endpoint/interface identity, dynamic source-order position, and source-level call-instance identity where applicable. If q commits, then $\mu_Q(q)$ commits the corresponding matched transfer $m(\mu_Q(q))$ with the same Σ -label/value under the event-matching convention. If q is an unsuccessful non-blocking poll, then q has no $m(q)$ and no Σ -label; its presence and its match are supplied only by the witness-compatibility condition WC, by the sufficient NB-CF condition when applicable, or by the Appendix L snooping / witness-selection construction. Thus E3/E5 quantify over Q_{exec} only relative to this chosen witness; they do not require failed non-blocking polls to be inferable from Σ alone.

(No deassert-before-commit assumption.) For blocking message requests $q \in Q_{\text{exec}}$, once q is issued, its Σ -visible boundary request is not withdrawable: it remains asserted in every cycle from $\text{issue_pre}(q)$ (resp. $\text{issue_post}(q)$) through q's commit cycle (if it commits), and for Push the payload remains stable while the request is outstanding.

Dynamic source-order convention

The order relation used below is over dynamic source-level operation/frontier items in the compared execution / witness, not over all syntactic call sites in the source text.

For a process P, let $Q_{\text{exec},P}$ denote the execution-level set of dynamic source-level message-call instances of P at the chosen abstract boundary. $Q_{\text{exec},P}$ includes blocking Push/Pop calls, successful non-blocking PushNB/PopNB calls, and failed non-blocking PushNB/PopNB polls.

Separately, let Ω_P denote the witness-specific dynamic universe of source-level frontier items that are actually reached under the fixed stimulus / selected witness and that are relevant to

observable/frontier/deadlock reasoning. Items in Ω_P include synchronization-call instances, anchored signal Read/Write action instances, and message-operation frontier items at the chosen abstract boundaries. A message-operation frontier item is either (i) a blocking Push/Pop item that has been reached, whether pending or committed, or (ii) a successful non-blocking PushNB/PopNB item that contributes a committed Push_c(v) / Pop_c(v) event. A failed non-blocking poll q is an element of $Q_{\text{exec},P}$, has no committed Σ -event $m(q)$, and is not an element of Ω_P merely because it executed.

Because $Q_{\text{exec},P}$ is a universe of dynamic message-call instances while Ω_P is a universe of source-level frontier items, their message-operation overlap is not a literal set intersection. Let $\text{MsgOf}_P(x)$ be the partial projection from a frontier item $x \in \Omega_P$ to its owning dynamic message-call instance, defined exactly for message-operation frontier items and undefined for pure synchronization or signal-anchor items. Define the message-frontier slice

$$\Omega_{\text{msg},P} := \{ x \in \Omega_P \mid \exists q \in Q_{\text{exec},P} : \text{MsgOf}_P(x) = q \}.$$

Define the corresponding message-instance slice induced by Ω_P as

$$Q_{\Omega,P} := \{ q \in Q_{\text{exec},P} \mid \exists x \in \Omega_{\text{msg},P} : \text{MsgOf}_P(x) = q \}.$$

Let Σ_P denote the corresponding observable labels/events contributed by items of Ω_P when they are Σ -visible. For a message-call instance $q \in Q_{\text{exec},P}$, the committed Σ -event $m(q) \in M$ exists only if q commits; if q is a failed non-blocking poll, $m(q)$ is absent and q contributes no Σ -event. For a message-operation frontier item $x \in \Omega_{\text{msg},P}$ with $\text{MsgOf}_P(x)=q$, item x contributes the committed Σ -event $m(q)$ only if q commits. A pending blocking message-operation frontier item x may therefore be in Ω_P and $\Omega_{\text{msg},P}$, and its owning message instance q may be in $Q_{\Omega,P}$, even though $m(q)$ is not yet present.

Operations on untaken branches and unexecuted loop iterations are not members of Ω_P , $\Omega_{\text{msg},P}$, $Q_{\Omega,P}$, or $Q_{\text{exec},P}$. Distinct loop iterations, unrolled instances, and repeated calls are represented by distinct dynamic instances.

Default source order for ordinary message calls. For dynamic items x and y of process P , write $x <_{\text{src}} y$, or equivalently $x <_P y$ when the process must be explicit, to mean that P 's source control flow and the R-rules force x to precede y in that dynamic execution / witness. For ordinary user-written source-level message-call instances in a sequential process, this is the dynamic program order along the executed control path. Thus, if two executed message-call instances $q_1, q_2 \in Q_{\text{exec},P}$ appear in sequence in the same process, exactly one of $q_1 <_{\text{src}} q_2$ or $q_2 <_{\text{src}} q_1$ holds according to that dynamic program order, including when q_1 and q_2 use distinct message-passing interfaces, occur in the same synchronization interval, arise from repeated loop iterations, or arise from unrolled instances whose source-level expansion is ordered by the selected source elaboration. Same-cycle issue, same-cycle commit, or issue of a later operation before an earlier operation commits is a timing/issue-policy freedom; it does not make ordinary source message-call instances incomparable. The no-reverse rule R4/E3 is therefore stated over this ordered dynamic source relation.

Limited sources of incomparability. The relation $\leq_P$ used for frontier reasoning is the reflexive closure of the restriction of this source-induced order to Ω_P , extended only by explicitly modeled partial-order structure. Ordinary distinct-interface source calls are not incomparable merely because they are on different interfaces. A message-operation multi-frontier may arise only from explicit $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$ proof-internal structure such as staged/bundle/join/epoch-gate abstract channels whose elaboration package

declares the relevant frontier items, evaluated boundaries, partial order, and projection/attribution facts. Such elaborated frontier items are part of the selected Sys_ref proof model; they are not an implicit weakening of source order among the ordinary user-written message calls.

For sequential-process signal IO, $\leq_{\text{src}}$ / $\leq_{\text{P}}$ is interpreted through the R2 anchor semantics rather than through the raw lexical statement location of the signal read or write. Thus a signal Read is ordered, for formal frontier and trace-compatibility purposes, at its pred_S anchor, and a signal Write is ordered, for formal frontier and trace-compatibility purposes, at its succ_S anchor. A lexically earlier signal Write whose succ_S anchor is a later synchronization call does not, merely by lexical placement, precede or block intervening message-operation instances in the same source interval; conversely, a lexically later signal Read whose pred_S anchor is an earlier synchronization call does not, merely by lexical placement, wait behind intervening message-operation instances. Signal IO may constrain message IO only through the explicit synchronization anchors and the stated R/E rules, not by raw lexical adjacency inside an interval.

Conceptual Model for a Single Process

For every process P the pre-HLS trace τ_P must satisfy the following *partial-order constraints* over these dynamic operation instances:

R1 (Program order of S).

$$\forall s_1, s_2 \in S : s_1 \leq_{\text{src}} s_2 \Rightarrow \text{clk_pre}(s_1) < \text{clk_pre}(s_2)$$

R2 (Location of R/W for sequential processes).

For a sequential process P, ordinary signal Read/Write events are anchored to synchronization events as follows:

$$\begin{aligned} \forall r \in R_P : \text{clk_pre}(r) &= \text{clk_pre}(\text{pred}_S(r)) \\ \forall w \in W_P : \text{clk_pre}(w) &= \text{clk_pre}(\text{succ}_S(w)) \end{aligned}$$

where $\text{pred}_S(r)$ (resp. $\text{succ}_S(w)$) is the closest dynamic synchronization-call instance that precedes (resp. follows) the signal Read/Write on the dynamic source path of the current execution / witness, after applying the anchoring convention above. This anchoring determines the signal event's formal position for $\leq_P$ / $\leq_P$, Done_P, Remain_P, and NextFront_P reasoning. In particular, for a sequential-process signal Write w, the fact that the write statement appears lexically before a message operation q in the same synchronization interval does not imply $w \leq_P q$ when w is anchored to the succeeding synchronization call; the write's formal observable event is placed at $\text{succ}_S(w)$. Likewise, a signal Read anchored to $\text{pred}_S(r)$ is not delayed by intervening message operations merely because the read statement appears lexically after them.

Every observable signal Read/Write of a sequential process must have a real bounding synchronization anchor on the dynamic path on which it occurs. A process-start synchronization event START_P may serve as the initial predecessor anchor when the modeling convention explicitly includes START_P in S. A terminating process event FINISH_P may serve as the terminal successor anchor when the process actually terminates and FINISH_P occurs. If no real predecessor anchor exists for a Read, or no real successor anchor exists for a Write on the dynamic path being modeled, the sequential-process signal IO

is ill-formed for this formal model or lies outside the finite observable prefix being compared. No observable Read/Write event is assigned clock time ∞ .

R2C (Combinational signal IO at the ϵ -fixed point).

A combinational process P has no process-owned synchronization events and no message-passing events in this formal clause; it may, however, contribute observable signal Read(sig,val) and Write(sig,val) events to Σ through explicitly selected R2C observation components. These events are not anchored by pred_S/succ_S. In every clock cycle t , the global state first reaches the cycle's ϵ -quiescent combinational fixed point after all sequential clock-boundary updates and all internal combinational propagation for that cycle have settled. Let μ_t denote this unique fixed-point valuation of the signal network.

R2C unit-generation convention

Fix an explicitly modeled combinational process or combinational network component C_{comb} and its selected observable slice $\text{Obs}(C_{\text{comb}})$, consisting of the process/signal/direction labels whose fixed-point values are included in that component's R2C observation. The fixed-point valuation μ_t exists every cycle, but a Σ -visible R2C fixed-point signal-observation unit for C_{comb} is emitted only at canonical observation occurrences:

- (i) the first cycle in the compared execution in which C_{comb} 's observable slice is defined and observed; and
- (ii) any later cycle in which the vector of fixed-point values on $\text{Obs}(C_{\text{comb}})$ differs from the vector in the most recent emitted R2C unit for C_{comb} , or in which an explicitly modeled observer/sampler requires a fresh observation unit.

Cycles in which C_{comb} 's observable fixed-point slice is identical to the most recent emitted R2C unit, and in which no explicit observer/sampler requires a fresh unit, are R2C stutter cycles for C_{comb} . They do not emit a new Σ -visible R2C unit. Delta-cycle re-evaluation, intermediate combinational values, redundant re-drive before the fixed point, and such R2C stutter cycles are $\epsilon/\text{stutter}$ for this component and are not separately Σ -visible.

If a combinational process P reads sig in an emitted R2C unit of C_{comb} , the corresponding label is Read(sig, $\mu_t(\text{sig})$) for the cycle t at which that unit is emitted. If P drives sig in an emitted R2C unit of C_{comb} , the corresponding label is Write(sig, $\mu_t(\text{sig})$), where $\mu_t(\text{sig})$ is the final resolved fixed-point value of sig at the chosen observation boundary. All Read/Write labels inside one emitted R2C unit are interpreted at the same ϵ -quiescent fixed point and may not be split.

Combinational-process signal IO is well formed only when the relevant combinational network is deterministic and reaches a unique ϵ -fixed point in each cycle being compared, and when each observable R2C component has a well-defined selected observable slice $\text{Obs}(C_{\text{comb}})$. For a multi-input combinational component whose inputs may be updated by independent latency-insensitive sources, the component is Σ -observable under the stutter-canonicalized R2C rule only if the chosen observation boundary provides a single explicit anchoring domain for the slice, or if an additional component-specific well-formedness proof shows that all admissible interleavings induce the same emitted R2C unit sequence. Otherwise the component's internal combinational propagation must remain ϵ -hidden, or the design must expose the relevant behavior through explicit synchronization, message passing, a cycle-accurate transactor, or a cycle-locked R2C observation boundary. Pure combinational oscillations, ambiguous multiple-driver resolution, hidden stateful behavior, or intentional combinational-loop behavior outside a unique fixed-point interpretation are outside this R2C model unless represented by explicit state or synchronization elsewhere in the formal model.

R3 (Isolation around S).

Let s be a dynamic synchronization-call instance of process P . Let $\text{pref}_S(s)$ be the set of executed dynamic message-call instances $q \in Q_{\text{exec},P}$ in the immediately preceding source interval of P whose source-induced order places q before or at the boundary controlled by s . Let $\text{suff}_S(s)$ be the set of executed dynamic message-call instances $q \in Q_{\text{exec},P}$ in the immediately following source interval of P whose source-induced order places q after s . Then

$\forall q \in \text{pref}_S(s) : \text{issue_pre}(q) \leq \text{clk_pre}(s) \quad \text{and} \quad \forall q \in \text{suff}_S(s) : \text{issue_pre}(q) > \text{clk_pre}(s).$

(For blocking message requests, if the synchronization call commits in the process trace, then any earlier blocking message requests in that dynamic source interval must have committed in some cycle $\leq$ that sync-commit cycle, by blocking-call control-flow semantics. Failed non-blocking polls in $Q_{\text{exec},P}$ satisfy the same issue-side synchronization-boundary rule, but they contribute no Σ -event and do not become Ω_P frontier items merely because they executed.)

R4 (Safe message issue ordering).

For every pair $q_1, q_2 \in Q_{\text{exec},P}$ within the same process and within the compared dynamic execution / witness,

$q_1 <_{\text{src}} q_2 \Rightarrow \text{issue_pre}(q_1) \leq \text{issue_pre}(q_2).$

(For same-channel operations, this states that dynamic calls on a single interface are issued in source-induced program order. For distinct channels, it forbids issuing dynamic message-call instances in the reverse of their source-induced order. This rule does not impose ordering between syntactic operations on untaken branches or between dynamic instances that are not ordered by the source-induced partial order of the selected witness. Failed non-blocking polls are included in this issue-order universe when they are executed, but remain ϵ -steps with no Σ -event.)

Prefix-closed reading of issue order. R4 and E3 are to be read not only as inequalities between already-defined issue timestamps, but also as closure conditions on issue itself. Within a compared dynamic execution / witness, if $q_1 <_{\text{src}} q_2$ and q_2 has issued by cutpoint σ , then q_1 has also issued by σ , and $\text{Issue}(q_1) \leq \text{Issue}(q_2)$ on the same side of the comparison (Issue_pre for R4/source-side prefixes, Issue_post for E3/implementation-side prefixes). Equivalently, in each source interval, the set of issued message-operation instances is downward closed under the source-induced order used by R4/E3. This rule is what excludes the case where a source-later message operation has issued while a required source-earlier message operation in the same interval remains merely reached but unissued.

R5 (Channel capacity semantics; Sys vs. Sys_B).

Appendix G defines the raw rendezvous source model Sys , in which every channel has effective capacity 0. Concretely: for every channel c and any clock cycle t , the number of unmatched committed Push_c actions is zero and the number of unmatched committed Pop_c actions is zero; equivalently, no Push_c shall commit unless a matching Pop_c also commits at t , and no Pop_c shall commit unless a matching Push_c also commits at t .

In Appendices I–K we additionally use the back-annotated source interpretation Sys_B : the same source processes as Sys , but interpreted under the case-split channel semantics of E4 with capacities $B(c)$ matching RTL_B . Thus:

- $B(c)=0$ is interpreted as the rendezvous case of E4: matching $\text{Push}_c(v)$ and $\text{Pop}_c(v)$ endpoint events commit in the same cycle, and no unmatched committed endpoint event may remain after any cycle boundary.
- $B(c)>0$ is interpreted as the cycle-boundary, non-fall-through bounded-FIFO case of E4, using the occupancy predicate $\text{occ}_c(t)$ and the FIFO availability predicates $\text{occ}_c(t) < B(c)$ for Push_c and

$\text{occ_c}(t) > 0$ for Pop_c .

The source conceptual semantics for a process is thus a labeled partial order $(\Sigma, \leq_P)$ generated by R1–R4 plus the applicable E4 channel semantics: raw rendezvous for Sys, or the case-split back-annotated channel semantics of Sys_B / Sys_ref.

Operational interpretation of Sys_ref and source issue policies

The R-rules above are constraints on a selected source-reference transition system, not merely constraints on a finished list of labels. For a fixed design, fixed stimulus, and selected reference-model choice, Sys_ref has the following operational reading.

A Sys_ref state consists of: (1) one local source state per process, including control location, local variables, call-stack/loop state, the current synchronization interval, and the reached/issued/committed status of dynamic message-call instances; (2) one state for each explicit abstract channel of the selected reference model, including $B(c)$, $\text{occ_c}(t)$, FIFO order when $B(c) > 0$, rendezvous endpoint requests when $B(c) = 0$, and any explicit Sys_B^elab staged/bundle/join/epoch-gate channel state; (3) signal and synchronization state at the selected observable anchors; and (4) ϵ -microstate for internal staging, direct-input sampling between anchors, and other proof-hidden activity. In Sys_B^elab, introduced abstract channels are explicit proof-internal boundaries: their commits may be Σ -events for Appendices J–K even when projected away from the outer DUT/testbench-visible alphabet Σ_{DUT} by Π_{elab} .

The transition relation contains the following kinds of steps. Pure source-evaluation ϵ -steps advance ordinary C++/SystemC computation until an IO boundary is reached and allocate dynamic operation instances in dynamic source order. A message-issue step for q may occur only after q has been reached, the endpoint request can be attributed to q , the R3 synchronization-boundary constraints are respected, and the issued set is prefix-closed under $<_{\text{src}}$. Issuing a blocking Push or Pop asserts the endpoint-owned persistent request for q and records $\text{Issue}(q)$. A channel-commit step for a bounded FIFO boundary $B(c) > 0$ may occur when $\text{BoundaryReq}(q, \sigma)$ and $\text{ChannelEnabled}(q, \sigma)$ hold at the selected abstract boundary; it emits the corresponding $\text{Push_c}(v)$ or $\text{Pop_c}(v)$ event at that proof boundary, updates the E4 channel state, and releases the owning blocking call at the process-facing boundary. For a rendezvous boundary $B(c) = 0$, commit is a single atomic two-endpoint transfer step: the matching producer and consumer endpoint requests are both true in the same ϵ -quiescent cycle, and the paired $\text{Push_c}(v)$ / $\text{Pop_c}(v)$ observable unit commits together with one shared payload value. The rendezvous commit is not modeled as two independent single-endpoint commits that can be separated or ordered apart. Synchronization and signal-anchor steps emit wait/Sync and anchored Read/Write events according to R1/R2/R2C. ϵ -settling and drain steps update only proof-hidden or explicitly elaborated internal state and must respect the $K\epsilon$ / B-faithfulness obligations when used by Appendices J–K. For a sequential process, a channel commit in cycle t makes its returned value or status available to dependent process-owned evaluation and continuation only in a strictly later cycle; the commit does not enable a dependent local evaluation step or request assertion at the same cycle Horizon.

Policy L (liberal, witness-relative issue). Policy L is the most permissive source-side issue policy used by the safety witness and by the K.2b dominance/extraction bridge. It may issue a reached source-level message operation whenever the transition-system preconditions above, R3/R4/R5, E4, E5, the selected non-blocking outcome witness, and the source-order prefix-closure requirement are satisfied. Policy L may leave a source-later blocking request issued while a source-earlier same-interval blocking request of the same process remains uncommitted. This is how the reference model can represent loop overlap, RTL-matched eager issue, and other allowed same-cycle/overlapped request timing. Policy L is not a claim that every raw pre-HLS simulator mode can generate every such witness state. Policy L does not override sequential-result availability: it cannot issue an operation in cycle t when that operation

becomes reachable, selects its control path, or obtains any required operand only from a commit in cycle t . The exact meaning of Policy-L legality and Appendix K admissibility, including the cycle-settle boundary and the activation point of Definition R.16, is fixed by Definition R.LAdm below.

Definition R.LAdm (Policy-L legality, admissibility, and cycle-settle convention).

Fix a selected liveness instance I consisting of Sys_ref , the initial/reset state, capacities and elaboration/lowering, the fixed stimulus and reactive environment, witness-selected non-blocking and other ϵ outcomes, arbitration choices, and the selected synchronization, signal-anchor, and ϵ -normalization conventions. A finite or infinite path p is Policy-L-legal for I iff it begins in the selected initial/reset state, every transition is a transition of the operational Sys_ref relation above permitted by Policy L, and every fixed choice in I is respected. R1–R5, E4/E5, dynamic-operation identity, request attribution and persistence, endpoint cardinality, reset-epoch typing, and sequential-result availability are part of this step legality.

Each cycle t of a Policy-L-legal path is interpreted using the following normative phase boundary.

(L0/L1) Cycle entry and pre-settle issue window. Starting from the cycle-entry state after all prior-cycle boundary updates, sequential processes may take a finite selected sequence of pure source-evaluation ϵ -steps and message-issue steps for operations that were already reached at cycle entry or become reached during this phase through evaluation independent of any cycle- t commit, and whose control choice, endpoint, address, payload, status inputs, and other required operands are available independently of any commit in cycle t . These issue steps remain subject to R3–R5 and source-order prefix closure. Thus a source-later independent operation may issue during this window while a source-earlier same-interval blocker remains uncommitted. A result or status first committed in cycle t cannot be used in this window.

(L2) ϵ -settle point. After the selected process-owned pre-settle steps for cycle t , process-owned request assertions are held fixed while the explicit channel network and other relevant combinational/ ϵ structure settle to the first ϵ -quiescent snapshot σ_t^{set} . The phrase “the frontier settles” and every Appendix K test of whether a frontier is fully channel-disabled refer to this snapshot.

(L3) Freeze and boundary action. Front_P and $\text{ChannelEnabled/ChannelDisabled}$ are evaluated at σ_t^{set} . If Front_P is non-empty and every frontier item is disabled there, Definition R.16 activates immediately at σ_t^{set} : no new source-later operation may issue after that snapshot in cycle t or in a later cycle while the same fully disabled frontier persists, although already-issued downstream work may drain as R.16 permits. If the frontier is not fully disabled, the selected E4/rendezvous, synchronization, signal-anchor, arbitration, and endpoint-cardinality rules determine the boundary actions that commit in cycle t .

(L4) Next-cycle result availability. Boundary commits update channel and process-visible state for the next cycle. Process-owned evaluation or issue whose reachability, control, endpoint, address, payload, or required operand depends on a value or status committed in cycle t may begin only in a strictly later cycle.

The L2/L3 freeze is not retroactive. An issue that was legal in the L1 pre-settle window is not invalidated merely because the subsequent settled snapshot exposes an earlier fully disabled frontier. Conversely, once that settled snapshot exists, an operation not already issued before it cannot use the same-cycle pre-settle window to bypass the activated R.16 block.

For Appendix K, a finite Policy-L prefix is admissible under R.LAdm iff it is Policy-L-legal, follows L0–L4, respects nonwithdrawal and $K\epsilon$, and satisfies Definition R.16/K.Drain from every activation point reached in the prefix. Write $\text{Pref_L}^{\text{adm}}(I)$ for these finite prefixes. A complete Policy-L-admissible execution is a finite or infinite maximal such path that additionally satisfies the selected B2/B3/B5 progress and quiescence obligations and issue fairness; write $\text{Exec_L}^{\text{adm}}(I)$ for this set. A5-L’s reachability clause quantifies over $\text{Pref_L}^{\text{adm}}(I)$ and the ϵ -quiescent cutpoints reached by its members.

K.2b.Q’s continuation, stabilization, and limit arguments additionally require a selected member of $\text{Exec_L}^{\text{adm}}(I)$ extending the finite counterexample prefix; that extension is part of the K.2b witness package. Fairness is therefore not decided by a finite prefix, but a finite prefix that has already violated the phase or freeze rules is not admissible.

Normative-use convention. Elsewhere in this document, “Policy-L execution” means a Policy-L-legal path unless the context says otherwise. “Admissible Policy-L execution/prefix” in A5-L, K.1A, K.2b, K.Ser, the K.CE examples, and Appendix K-P means R.LAdm -admissible. K.Drain is therefore not silently part of the basic Policy-L issue rule; it is an explicit qualification of Appendix K admissibility. Policy S uses the same L0–L4 cycle phases, with its stricter serial-blocking issue condition substituted for the Policy-L issue permission in L1.

Policy S (conservative serial-blocking issue). Policy S uses the same Sys_ref state space, channels, values, witness choices, and transition rules as Policy L, but adds one process-side restriction: within a source interval between adjacent ordinary synchronization calls selected into S, a later source-order blocking Push/Pop operation may not issue until every earlier source-order blocking Push/Pop operation in that same interval has committed in a strictly earlier clock cycle. In $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$, the relevant commit for this restriction is the process-facing commit that completes, accepts, or releases the owning source-level blocking operation at its selected boundary; internal staged/bundle/join/epoch-gate transfers do not by themselves satisfy the serial condition unless the elaboration package identifies that transfer as the process-facing commit for the source operation. Policy S serializes only process-side issue of source-level blocking calls. It does not serialize independent peer processes, E4 channel-side drainage, FIFO movement, or ϵ -steps that are otherwise admissible.

Relation to practical pre-HLS simulation modes. A raw serial source simulation mode implements the Policy-S discipline for ordinary unelaborated blocking calls. A Matchlib-style eager or skidbuffered source simulation mode may execute source calls in dynamic program order while issuing requests without consuming a clock cycle until data or space is unavailable; that mode is Policy-L-compatible only to the extent that its request attribution, channel states, and non-blocking outcomes satisfy the transition-system conditions above. Neither mode treats ordinary distinct-interface source calls as unordered. The difference between serial and eager simulation modes is a difference in issue timing and buffering, not a difference in $<_{\text{src}}$.

Trace Compatibility Relation

Let τ_{pre} and τ_{post} be the Σ -traces (finite or infinite) of the same process before and after HLS, where each Σ -event is labeled exactly as in “Common Formal Definitions for Appendices I–K” (e.g., $\text{Push}_c(v)$, $\text{Pop}_c(v)$, $\text{Read}(\text{sig}, \text{val})$, $\text{Write}(\text{sig}, \text{val})$, and synchronization events).

Notation note. We write $\tau_{\text{pre}} \approx \tau_{\text{post}}$ as a named, ordered trace-compatibility predicate. The symbol $\approx$ is local to this document and is not used here to assert a mathematical equivalence relation; in particular, reflexivity, symmetry, and transitivity are not being claimed. Its arguments are ordered: the left trace supplies the pre-HLS/source reference witness, and the right trace supplies the post-HLS implementation trace constrained by E1–E5. In later appendices the same convention applies to $\tau_{\text{ref}} \approx \tau_{\text{post}}$, with τ_{ref} as the prescribed Sys_ref witness.

Convention (S): all references to S, $\text{pred}_S/\text{succ}_S$, $\text{pref}_S/\text{suff}_S$, and $<_{\text{src}}$ in E1–E5 use the dynamic source-induced order defined in R1–R4 for the compared execution / witness. Thus τ_{pre} denotes the Σ -trace of the pre-HLS source over the dynamic operation instances reached under the fixed stimulus / selected witness.

Σ -event matching convention. We use a canonical per-endpoint occurrence matching to make “the same Σ -events” precise. For each channel c , match committed Push_c and Pop_c events by their ordinal occurrence on that channel (e.g., the k -th committed Push on c in τ_{pre} matches the k -th committed Push on c in τ_{post} ; likewise for Pop_c). For each such matched pair, the endpoint (c) and the payload/value label must agree. For the ordinal index k to be well-defined under the per-cycle “set/bucket” trace representation used in these appendices, we assume that for any fixed channel endpoint c , at most one committed Push_c and at most one committed Pop_c may occur in any single clock cycle.

For each observable signal sig of a sequential process, match $\text{Read}(\text{sig}, \cdot)$ and $\text{Write}(\text{sig}, \cdot)$ by their ordinal occurrence on that signal within the process trace, again requiring the value labels to agree.

For sequential processes, we apply the following canonicalization for observable signals: within each anchor interval between consecutive synchronization events in the order S , we record at most one Σ -visible $\text{Read}(\text{sig}, \text{val})$ and at most one Σ -visible $\text{Write}(\text{sig}, \text{val})$ for each (process, sig), with the anchor cycle given by $E2$. Any additional physical sampling of sig by the implementation, or redundant re-driving of sig within the same anchor interval, is treated as an internal ϵ -step and must not change the recorded value label. If a design intentionally relies on intra-interval changes of sig , or on distinguishing multiple reads/writes of sig within the same anchor interval, then sig must be modeled using an explicit synchronized interface rather than as an ordinary sequential-process observable signal.

For combinational processes, the canonical observable unit is the emitted R2C fixed-point signal-observation unit for the relevant combinational process/network component C_{comb} : the set of $\text{Read}(\text{sig}, \text{val})$ and $\text{Write}(\text{sig}, \text{val})$ labels for the selected observable slice $\text{Obs}(C_{\text{comb}})$, recorded at one ϵ -quiescent combinational fixed point under the R2C unit-generation convention. Intermediate delta-cycle reads/writes, repeated re-evaluations before the fixed point, and stutter cycles in which $\text{Obs}(C_{\text{comb}})$ is unchanged and no explicit observer/sampler requires a fresh unit are ϵ /stutter and are not separately Σ -visible.

R2C unit matching/index convention

For each combinational process or explicitly modeled combinational network component C_{comb} , project each trace to the subsequence of emitted R2C fixed-point signal-observation units for C_{comb} . The k -th emitted such unit in Sys_ref is matched with the k -th emitted such unit in RTL_B . This local emitted-occurrence ordinal, together with the component identity C_{comb} , is the correspondence rule for R2C fixed-point units; it is not the global observable-cycle bucket number of the whole-system trace. Thus repeated identical fixed-point observations across stutter cycles do not create additional units, while repeated equal-valued units created by explicit observer/sampler occurrences are distinguished by their local emitted-occurrence ordinal for C_{comb} .

Matched pre-HLS and post-HLS fixed-point units must agree on the included process/signal/direction labels and fixed-point values. The same-cycle agreement required here is local to the matched emitted R2C fixed-point unit: all Read/Write labels inside that unit are interpreted at one ϵ -quiescent fixed point and may not be split. This local atomicity requirement is one of the explicit same-cycle semantic constraints and does not require unrelated Sys_ref and RTL_B events to share the same global bucket decomposition. If a design requires every cycle’s combinational fixed point to be externally observable even when the fixed-point slice is unchanged, then that component must be declared cycle-locked; a

cycle-locked R2C component is matched by its per-cycle emitted occurrences and therefore falls outside the bucket-stutter freedom claimed for ordinary latency-insensitive R2C components.

For synchronization events, match by their per-process occurrence index in the source order (R1; preserved on the post-HLS side by E1 below). Independent Σ -events on different endpoints (including distinct message-passing interfaces) may commute and/or be grouped differently within a clock cycle as permitted by the R-rules and E3. Here “independent” is meant in the Σ -equivalence sense: the pair is not additionally ordered by any explicit Σ -visible ordering/timestamp constraint in E1–E5 (notably E3/E5); it is not a statement about (in)comparability under the Appendix G causal-dependency relation ($\rightarrow$). Accordingly, τ_{pre} and τ_{post} are not required to be identical as a single total order, nor to agree on same-cycle “grouping” of distinct-interface Push/Pop operations, beyond the explicit ordering/timestamp constraints in E1–E5 below.

We say $\tau_{\text{pre}} \approx \tau_{\text{post}}$ iff the two traces match on Σ in this sense, and all the following hold:

E1 (Per-process synchronization-order preservation).

For every process P ,

$$\forall s_1, s_2 \in S_P : s_1 <_P s_2 \Rightarrow \text{clk_post}(s_1) < \text{clk_post}(s_2).$$

Equivalently, synchronization events are matched and ordered by their per-process source occurrence index. E1 does not preserve incidental global clock ordering between synchronization events of different processes unless that ordering is induced by an explicit inter-process synchronization relation already represented in Σ .

E2 (Signal-visibility preservation).

Partition signal Read/Write events by process kind:

- R_{seq} and W_{seq} are the ordinary signal Read/Write events of sequential processes.
- R_{comb} and W_{comb} are the signal Read/Write events of combinational processes, interpreted by R2C.

For sequential-process signal IO:

$$\forall r \in R_{\text{seq}} : \text{clk_post}(r) = \text{clk_post}(\text{pred}_S(r))$$

$$\forall w \in W_{\text{seq}} : \text{clk_post}(w) = \text{clk_post}(\text{succ}_S(w))$$

Equivalently, ordinary signal Reads/Writes of sequential processes are logically timestamped at their synchronization anchors, as in R2. The same anchoring convention is used on the pre-HLS side when forming the matched trace.

For combinational-process signal IO, $\text{pred}_S/\text{succ}_S$ anchoring does not apply. Instead, each R2C fixed-point signal-observation unit is matched by the component-local occurrence ordinal defined above: for each combinational process or explicitly modeled combinational network component C_{comb} , the k -th R2C fixed-point unit of C_{comb} in Sys_ref matches the k -th R2C fixed-point unit of C_{comb} in RTL_B . The matched units must contain the same corresponding combinational Read/Write events and fixed-point values at their respective ϵ -quiescent combinational fixed points, as defined by R2C. Any delta-cycle re-evaluation, intermediate combinational value, or redundant re-drive before the fixed point is an ϵ -step and is not separately Σ -visible. This condition does not require the matched R2C units to occur in the same global observable-cycle bucket number, nor to be grouped with the same unrelated events, in the two executions.

E3 (Safe message issue ordering). (Post-HLS preservation of R4).

For every pair of executed message-call instances $q1, q2 \in Q_{\text{exec}}, P$ of the same process P :

(i) Same-interface source order: if $q1$ and $q2$ access the same message-passing interface and $q1 <_{\text{src}} q2$, then $\text{issue_post}(q1) \leq \text{issue_post}(q2)$. This preserves source order at cycle granularity; any stricter serialization required by the concrete interface is supplied by the channel/interface semantics, not by E3 itself.

(ii) Distinct-interface no-reverse: if $q1$ and $q2$ access distinct message-passing interfaces and appear in sequence in the source ($q1 <_{\text{src}} q2$), then $\text{issue_post}(q1) \leq \text{issue_post}(q2)$ (i.e., they shall not be issued in the reverse sequence).

(iii) Prefix-closed issue obligation: for every cycle-aligned cutpoint σ of the post-HLS execution / witness, if $q1 <_{\text{src}} q2$ and $q2$ has issued by σ , then $q1$ has also issued by σ and $\text{Issue}(q1) \leq \text{Issue}(q2)$. This applies across same-interface and distinct-interface source order. It is an implementation-side obligation on issued sets, not merely an inequality over pairs whose timestamps are already defined.

(Note: HLS internal pipeline staging, dequeue, and hand-off inside the back-annotated process/channel realization are not, by themselves, Σ -visible boundary issue events in Q_{exec}, P nor committed-transfer events in M ; therefore such internal movement does not constitute a counterexample to (ii) or (iii).)

E4 (Per-channel channel semantics: rendezvous and bounded FIFO).

For every observable channel c with capacity $B(c)$, the projection of τ_{post} to events on c is legal for that channel's capacity model. The channel model splits into two cases.

- Rendezvous case, $B(c)=0$. Channel c is a capacity-zero rendezvous channel. A committed transfer on c consists of a matching same-cycle pair $\text{Push}_c(v)$ and $\text{Pop}_c(v)$ with the same payload value v . No unmatched committed Push_c or Pop_c may exist after any cycle boundary. Equivalently, the k -th committed $\text{Push}_c(v)$ and the k -th committed $\text{Pop}_c(v)$ occur in the same clock cycle and carry the same value. A Push_c endpoint can commit in cycle t only when the matching Pop_c endpoint boundary request is also asserted in cycle t , and symmetrically a Pop_c endpoint can commit in cycle t only when the matching Push_c endpoint boundary request is also asserted in cycle t .

- Buffered case, $B(c)>0$. Channel c is a bounded FIFO with cycle-boundary, non-fall-through semantics. The committed $\text{Pop}_c(v)$ events return exactly the FIFO-ordered sequence of values v previously committed by $\text{Push}_c(v)$, with no drops, duplications, or reordering. For every cycle-aligned prefix π_t of the c -projection—i.e., π_t contains exactly the events on c committed in cycles $< t$ —letting $\text{push}(\pi_t)$ and $\text{pop}(\pi_t)$ be the number of Push_c and Pop_c events in π_t , we have

$$0 \leq \text{push}(\pi_t) - \text{pop}(\pi_t) \leq B(c).$$

Equivalently, the abstract occupancy after cycle $t-1$ is $\text{occ}_c(t) = \text{push}(\pi_t) - \text{pop}(\pi_t)$. Availability for commits in cycle t is evaluated against $\text{occ}_c(t)$ at the start of cycle t : Pop_c may commit in cycle t only if $\text{occ}_c(t) > 0$, Push_c may commit in cycle t only if $\text{occ}_c(t) < B(c)$, and simultaneous Push_c and Pop_c commits in the same cycle are permitted iff $0 < \text{occ}_c(t) < B(c)$.

Thus the inequality-based FIFO availability predicates are used only for $B(c)>0$. The $B(c)=0$ case is not interpreted by substituting $B(c)=0$ into the bounded-FIFO inequalities; it is interpreted by the rendezvous rule above.

Note: $\text{occ}_c(t)$ is the logical occupancy of channel c at the chosen Σ boundary, induced solely by the Σ -visible boundary-commit history ($\text{Push}_c/\text{Pop}_c$) and the annotated capacity $B(c)$ in the buffered case $B(c)>0$. For $B(c)=0$, the corresponding channel fact is the same-cycle rendezvous request/commit predicate rather than a nonzero FIFO occupancy predicate.

E5 (Messages cannot cross their immediate synchronization boundary).

For every synchronization call s (in the source order used by $R3 / \text{pref_S} / \text{suff_S}$ over Q_{exec}, P):

$\forall q \in \text{pref_S}(s) : \text{issue_post}(q) \leq \text{clk_post}(s)$

$\forall q \in \text{suff_S}(s) : \text{issue_post}(q) > \text{clk_post}(s)$

(For blocking message requests, if the synchronization call commits in the process trace, then any earlier blocking message requests in that source interval must have committed in some cycle $\leq$ that sync-commit cycle, by blocking-call control-flow semantics. Under the Issue/Commit linkage above, any boundary request assertion that persists while the process is still pending at s reflects only already-issued outstanding operation(s) in $\text{pref_S}(s)$; no operation $q \in \text{suff_S}(s)$ may have $\text{Issue}(q) \leq \text{clk_post}(s)$, and any back-to-back issuance on that endpoint direction may occur only in the first cycle strictly after $\text{clk_post}(s)$. For non-blocking calls, a later executed source-level PushNB/PopNB in $\text{suff_S}(s)$ is a distinct q and cannot be identified with an earlier $\text{pref_S}(s)$ call solely because the endpoint request signal remained asserted.)

See Appendix I – Per-Process Replay and Preparation Proof for the local result used by the system theorem:

For any process P participating in a selected finite RTL_B prefix, the fixed stimulus, WC witness, dynamic-operation matching, and P -local observable-unit history determine the corresponding immediate source replay state. Appendix I proves that, from that state, a finite P -owned ϵ preparation path reaches the exact dynamic source operation for the next selected unit—either as next-frontier or as an already issued persistent request—while preserving E3/E5 and committing no unmatched observable unit. This is a local readiness theorem, not an independent channel-commit or global-trace existence theorem. Appendix J combines these local paths with channel and atomic-interaction certificates to construct the complete Sys_ref witness. The reverse direction remains restricted to RTLConsistentRefPrefix / Appendix L witness-selected executions.

Allowed Transformations and Why They Preserve $\approx$

Transformation permitted by the rules	Formal justification
Loop pipelining (overlaps iterations)	Introduces internal pipeline stages (modeled as ϵ -steps) and overlaps iterations. R1–R5 (and hence E1–E5) are applied to the explicit S set. Loop pipelining may commute independent Σ -actions across iterations (e.g., across distinct channels)—where “independent” here means “not additionally ordered by any explicit Σ -visible constraint in E1–E5 between the pair (notably E3/E5),” rather than “incomparable under Appendix G’s causal-dependency relation ($\rightarrow$)”—but it must still preserve: (i) per-channel FIFO legality (E4), (ii) the required issue discipline (E3) for source-ordered pairs, and (iii) the sync-boundary constraints (E1/E5) with respect to the (explicit + implicit) S-actions.
Overlap of internal dequeue/staging vs. later pipeline work (ϵ)	Permitted because the internal staging/acceptance activity is ϵ -internal within the back-annotated channel realization (as defined in “Appendix B - Pipelined Loops”) and does not

Transformation permitted by the rules	Formal justification
	constitute a Σ -visible boundary message-issue reorder. Σ -visible boundary message issues must still satisfy E3, and per-channel committed-transfer legality is ensured by E4; automatic flush / Appendix K addresses deadlock preservation for overlap timing.
#pragma hls_direct_input (late sampling of static signals)	This pragma imposes a designer/environment stability contract: the signal's value must remain stable after reset (or after its last permitted update) while the receiving process may consume it. The logical signal Read actions r remain anchored exactly as in E2 ($\text{clk_post}(r) = \text{clk_post}(\text{pred_S}(r))$). HLS may implement this by sampling the signal later (instead of inserting internal storage), but because the signal is stable the sampled value equals the value at $\text{pred_S}(r)$; therefore E2 and $\approx$ are preserved.
#pragma hls_direct_input_sync (controlled updates)	This pragma imposes an explicit timing contract on the environment: the controlled direct-input signals may change only on the cycle of the designated synchronization call s^* (i.e., during the sync handshake). With that contract, the logical anchoring required by E2 is preserved: for the receiving process, the relevant Reads are anchored at the closest preceding synchronization call $\text{pred_S}(r) = s^*$, and any environment update Write w_update is aligned with synchronization ($\text{succ_S}(w_update) = s^*$). HLS may still implement late sampling internally, but the value observed is the same as the value at the E2 anchor point, so $\approx$ is preserved without modifying E2. Instrumentation note (logical signal timestamping). In the Σ-traces used for $\approx$ checking, sequential-process signal Read/Write events are timestamped at their E2 anchor points (e.g., $\text{clk_post}(\text{pred_S}(r))$ for Reads), not at any later physical RTL sample cycle that HLS may introduce. Any internal late-sampling micro-steps are treated as ϵ-steps. Combinational-process signal Read/Write labels are handled by R2C rather than by $\text{pred_S}/\text{succ_S}$ anchoring or by global observable-cycle bucket number. A monitor records a combinational fixed-point value only after the simulator/RTL has reached an ϵ-quiescent combinational fixed point, and that value contributes to Σ only when the relevant R2C observation component emits an R2C fixed-point signal-observation unit under the R2C unit-generation convention. Intermediate delta-cycle reads/writes, redundant re-evaluations, transient combinational values before the fixed point, and R2C stutter cycles whose selected observable slice is unchanged are ϵ/stutter and are not separately Σ-visible.

Transformation permitted by the rules	Formal justification
	Therefore, equivalence checking must instrument/record the appropriate logical Read/Write event: the anchored event for sequential-process signal IO, or the emitted R2C fixed-point signal-observation unit for combinational-process signal IO. A wrapper/transactor may be used when needed to expose only those logical events rather than naive physical sample, delta-cycle, or per-cycle stutter events.
Memory-access reordering proven conflict-free	Let $\text{addr}(a)$ be the symbolic address of access a . If the tool proves $\text{addr}(a_1) \neq \text{addr}(a_2)$ for the overlapped window, then the commutation of a_1 and a_2 is observationally silent; no external signal/message depends on the internal order.
Implicit FSM states / added latency	Extra states introduce <i>silent</i> ϵ -steps between observable actions; the partial order on Σ is unchanged, so E1–E5 are unaffected.
Shared-memory arrays with explicit synchronization	When a memory is accessed by multiple processes, the designer explicitly coordinates access with synchronization operations modeled as S-actions, and the externally relevant memory behavior is defined by the array access mapping layer. E1 preserves the order of the synchronization actions that bracket or authorize the shared-memory accesses. The array access mapping layer then defines the mapped memory operations, their commit cycles, and the required serialization/coherence rule for the shared storage, and the pre-HLS and post-HLS traces must agree under that declared memory semantics. E2 is not used here except for ordinary signal IO. E4 is relevant only if the mapping layer represents memory commands/responses as message-passing channels; otherwise memory legality is discharged by the mapping layer’s memory semantics, not by FIFO channel semantics. Under these conditions, the shared-memory transformation preserves the observable behavior required by $\approx$. Scope (J.Mem): the formal theorems of Appendices I–K discharge this entry only when the value-carrying memory traffic is lowered per the J.Mem shared-memory lowering condition (Common Formal Definitions); the non-lowered “declared memory semantics” branch states an agreement obligation that Theorem J.1 as proved does not discharge.
Non-blocking message-passing (PushNB/PopNB) verified by post-HLS snooping	If the latency differences are externally visible to the DUT, a verification wrapper delays the pre-HLS side so that the committed transfer events (successful completions) occur in the same order/timing as observed on the post-HLS channel. This wrapper is itself purely synchronising (S), so it cannot violate R1–R5. Once the wrapper is assumed, τ_{pre} and τ_{post} coincide on the committed message-transfer history recorded in Σ (i.e., the $\text{Push}_c/\text{Pop}_c$ commit events),

Transformation permitted by the rules	Formal justification
	so E3–E5 are preserved. Unsuccessful non-blocking polls remain ϵ -steps and are not required to match. This is not a transformation that inherently preserves $\approx$, but rather a verification technique to enforce equivalence for inherently latency-sensitive operations.
Latency-sensitive <i>global</i> signal IO matched by snooping	If the latency differences are externally visible to the DUT, the same “mirror-and-delay” wrapper used for NB channels is applied to any globally-visible signal whose timing matters. Because the wrapper inserts only S-actions, the partial-order constraints are unchanged. This is not a transformation that inherently preserves $\approx$, but rather a verification technique to enforce equivalence for inherently latency-sensitive operations.
Latency-sensitive <i>local</i> signal IO isolated in cycle-accurate transactors	Local timing-exact protocols are confined to dedicated transactor processes that expose only latency-insensitive M or S operations to the rest of the design. Since the transactor boundary is now the observable interface, R1–R5 apply <i>outside</i> the timing-sensitive region, so system-level $\approx$ still holds.
One-way signal-handshake protocols with run-time assertions	For single-direction vld or rdy signals, an assertion proves that back-pressure can <i>never</i> occur. That assertion establishes a refinement in which the missing handshake is equivalent to a permanent logical '1', so the protocol is observationally identical to the corresponding two-way handshake with the missing side tied true. E2 then applies only to the logical timestamping of the signal Read/Write events, not to the protocol-refinement step itself.
Combinational processes	Combinational processes have no process-owned S actions and no message-passing M actions in this formal clause, but they may have observable signal Read/Write events in Σ through explicitly selected R2C observation components. Their signal IO is interpreted at ϵ -quiescent combinational fixed points as specified by R2C: intermediate delta-cycle propagation is ϵ , and only emitted fixed-point Read/Write labels in the selected observable slice are Σ -visible. Repeated cycles in which the selected fixed-point slice is unchanged are R2C stutter for that component unless an explicitly modeled observer/sampler requires a fresh emitted unit. Under the well-formedness requirement that the combinational network is deterministic, reaches a unique fixed point in each compared cycle, and has a well-defined R2C unit-generation rule for the selected component, the RTL/tool-flow conformance obligation is to preserve the emitted fixed-point signal-observation unit sequence at the chosen observation

Transformation permitted by the rules	Formal justification
	boundary. Thus the required correspondence is not equality of simulator delta-cycle behavior, nor equality of global cycle-bucket numbers, nor an automatic consequence of ordinary combinational synthesis; it is equality of matched emitted R2C fixed-point units by component identity and local emitted-occurrence ordinal. Designs with oscillation, ambiguous multiple-driver resolution, hidden stateful behavior, intentional combinational-loop behavior outside a unique fixed-point interpretation, or multi-input observation slices whose interleavings can change the emitted unit sequence are outside R2C unless represented by explicit state, synchronization, a cycle-accurate transactor, a cycle-locked R2C observation boundary, or another formally modeled boundary.

For the purposes of the formal analysis, non-blocking message-passing is modeled at the level of committed transfers: a successful PushNB/PopNB contributes the same committed Push_c/Pop_c event to Σ as a blocking Push/Pop, while unsuccessful polls are ϵ -steps.

If a design contains latency-sensitive global signals or non-blocking transfers whose timing/ordering is externally visible at the DUT boundary and must be reproduced exactly in both simulations, we take as an axiom that a purely synchronizing snooping wrapper can be applied to supply the same latency choices to the pre-HLS simulation as those observed in the post-HLS RTL (Appendix L). Conceptually, this wrapper is a witness-selection device: it does not enlarge the set of admissible pre-HLS behaviors, but restricts the pre-HLS run to one admissible execution whose Σ -events align with the observed RTL execution. Under this wrapper, the committed Σ -traces of the two simulations agree, and the trace-compatibility rules E1–E5 apply to the wrapped runs.

Appendix L provides detailed guidance to enable this perfect alignment to be achieved in practice.

Proof Structure

The proofs proceed in three stages:

First, Appendix I establishes process-local deterministic replay and finite preparation. For each process participation in a selected RTL_B observable unit, it identifies the exact dynamic source operation, proves the relevant issue/order and witness facts, and constructs a finite process-owned ϵ path that reaches the operation or its persistent issued request without committing an unmatched unit. These facts are packaged by J.PCert. Appendix I deliberately does not assert that the complementary endpoint is present, that a channel transfer is globally enabled, or that the local paths already form one Sys_{ref} execution.

Second, Appendix J combines J.PCert with per-channel J.CCert, atomic-interaction J.ACert, environment/reset certificates, typed construction-action footprints, the generated dependency relation Dep_J, and J.LocalAgree. J.CanonicalRank is derived from that finite dependency graph rather

than supplied as implementation evidence. Lemmas J.Frame through J.UnitExt prove that the local paths lift, that unordered actions commute, that witness-significant non-blocking decisions are evaluated from one common boundary snapshot, and that the next complete observable unit is enabled. Theorem J.GWR-Comp iterates that step to construct J.GWR and one reachable Sys_ref execution; Proposition J.0 then proves system-level observable compatibility. This safety construction does not assume or prove global source liveness or RTL deadlock freedom.

Finally, Appendix K addresses a separate liveness-preservation obligation for internal message-passing deadlock. Appendix K does not discharge the Appendix I/J weak-fairness, finite-depth, channel-progress, realization-correctness, K.Drain, $K\epsilon$, J.KObsConf, or A6–A11 side conditions. Nor does it derive SDet, A5-L, A5-S, K.RespCov, K.RespClean, or any alternate A5-L discharge from the local R-rules. The core Theorem K.1A consumes A5-L directly. The primary user-facing route fixes the actual Policy-S pre-HLS simulator and its selected execution through SDet, supplies maximality/fairness/completeness and complete bounded-response evidence through A5-S/CF-S, and uses Lemma K.2b and Corollary K.2c to discharge A5-L. Structural, invariant, exploration, direct Policy-L, and tool-certificate routes remain alternatives.

Thus the architecture is non-circular. Appendix I supplies only local replay/preparation facts; J.GWR-Comp proves, rather than assumes, their global coexistence and complete-unit extension; Proposition J.0 consumes an already constructed trace pair; and Appendix K separately preserves internal message-passing deadlock freedom under A5-L and its recorded discharge route. The liveness theorem remains conditional on the named fairness, progress, drain, and serial-dominance premises and does not retroactively justify the safety construction.

Causal Dependency Between Processes

To prove system-level trace compatibility, we must distinguish between incidental timing and functionally significant ordering.

Formal Definition of Causal Dependency

To formalize the notion of functionally significant dependency and resolve ambiguity, we define a causal-dependency relation, denoted by $\rightarrow$, on the set of observable IO actions (Σ) across all processes in the system. The relation is causal/information-flow rather than purely temporal: events related by $\rightarrow$ may commit in the same clock cycle, and the direction of $\rightarrow$ indicates which event may be depended on by the other.

Important: $\rightarrow$ is a causal-dependency graph, not by itself the source order used for the Appendix J induction. In particular, because the methodology permits distinct-interface message operations to be issued with timing overlap or in the same cycle while still preserving dynamic source order, and because rendezvous transfers are same-cycle atomic Push/Pop transactions, the unquotiented dependency graph $\rightarrow$ need not be acyclic in every legal execution. A cycle in $\rightarrow$ can represent a legal same-cycle mutually enabling dependency among atomic transactions; it is not, by itself, an observable mismatch. When Appendix J needs a well-founded induction order, it uses the separate required-order relation $<_J$ over observable units. That relation is generated only by the explicit ordering, timestamp, FIFO, atomicity, and synchronization constraints that must be preserved by the trace-compatibility predicate, not by the full causal-dependency graph $\rightarrow$ and not by raw per-process source order on distinct-interface message commits.

Well-formedness use of causal-dependency. The well-formedness rule below uses $\rightarrow$ as a design-intent and source-admissibility relation: if correctness depends on the relative timing, value, availability, or

cross-process observation of two events, that dependence must be represented by an explicit modeled causal mechanism such as message passing, synchronization, signal handshakes/anchors, declared memory serialization, or an Appendix L snooped/witness-selected boundary. This use of $\rightarrow$ does not add proof-preserved observable ordering beyond $\leq_J$, FIFO legality, rendezvous/synchronization atomicity, signal-anchor constraints, synchronization-boundary constraints, and declared memory-serialization constraints.

The causal-dependency relation $\rightarrow$ is the smallest directed relation satisfying the conditions below:

1. **Intra-Process Order:** If actions a and b occur within the same process P and a precedes b in the program's execution trace, then $a \rightarrow b$. This directly reflects the sequential nature of the code within a single thread. **Clarification (non-temporal).** Here “precedes” refers to the order of IO action *instances* in the process's trace/program order (i.e., the order induced by the process's execution), **not** the relative order of their **commit cycles**; distinct-interface message actions may be **issued** in order while **committing** in either order depending on backpressure.
2. **Inter-Process Communication:** The relation is established by the direct exchange of information or synchronization between processes.
 - **Message-passing (committed transfer):** If a is the commit of a send on channel c in process $P1$ (a committed Push_c , including a successful PushNB), and b is the commit of the corresponding receive on c in process $P2$ (a committed Pop_c , including a successful PopNB), for the same logical message instance, then $a \rightarrow b$. Here “corresponding receive” is defined by the channel's FIFO semantics: b is the Pop_c commit that consumes the element produced by a (matching is by FIFO position / transfer instance, not by payload-value equality; duplicate payload values do not introduce ambiguity). Equivalently, if we enumerate committed Pushes on c as $\text{Push}_c^1, \text{Push}_c^2, \dots$ in commit order and committed Pops as $\text{Pop}_c^1, \text{Pop}_c^2, \dots$ in commit order, then $\text{Push}_c^k \rightarrow \text{Pop}_c^k$. For buffered channels with $B(c) > 0$, E4 also imposes the required FIFO legality used by Appendix J's required-order relation $\leq_J$. For rendezvous channels with $B(c) = 0$, the matching Push_c and Pop_c commits occur in the same clock cycle and are treated in Appendix J as one explicitly atomic observable unit. The directed dependency $a \rightarrow b$ records unidirectional information flow — the Pop observes the value supplied by the Push — but it does not make the two rendezvous endpoints separately orderable for the Appendix J induction, and it does not imply an earlier commit cycle. No reverse edge $b \rightarrow a$ is implied unless there is an explicit reverse-direction communication, such as another channel or a signal handshake. Unsuccessful non-blocking polls are ϵ -steps and do not participate in $\rightarrow$.
 - **Signal Handshake:** If a is a signal write action $w(\text{sig})$ in $P1$ and b is a signal read action $r(\text{sig})$ in $P2$ that reads the value written by a as part of an explicit handshake protocol, then $a \rightarrow b$. A complete two-way handshake (e.g., vld/rdy) creates a causal chain, such as $w(\text{vld})@P1 \rightarrow r(\text{vld})@P2 \rightarrow w(\text{rdy})@P2 \rightarrow r(\text{rdy})@P1$.
 - **Explicit Synchronization (two-party SyncChannel / ac_sync):** Let sout be the commit of a SyncChannel sync_out (or equivalent ac_sync call) in process $P1$, and let sin be

the commit of the matching *sync_in* in process P2 for the same synchronization instance. Then this synchronization acts as a two-process barrier:

- Every observable action in P1 that occurs before *sout* (in P1's trace/program order) satisfies $a \rightarrow b$ for every observable action *b* in P2 that occurs after *sin*.
- Symmetrically, every observable action in P2 that occurs before *sin* satisfies $a \rightarrow b$ for every observable action *b* in P1 that occurs after *sout*.
- (The two sync commits *sout* and *sin* are treated as simultaneous; we do not impose $sout \rightarrow sin$ or $sin \rightarrow sout$.)

3. **Transitivity:** The relation is transitive. If $a \rightarrow b$ and $b \rightarrow c$, then $a \rightarrow c$.

Using this relation, we now provide a formal definition for causal dependency between synchronization events, which are the fundamental ordering anchors in the scheduling model.

Definition: Causal Dependency

A synchronization event *s2* in process P2 is **causally dependent** on a synchronization event *s1* in process P1 if and only if $s1 \rightarrow s2$.

If neither $s1 \rightarrow s2$ nor $s2 \rightarrow s1$ holds true, the events *s1* and *s2* are considered **causally independent** (or concurrent). Any change in the observed temporal ordering of causally independent events between the pre-HLS and post-HLS simulations is considered an incidental, functionally insignificant variation in latency. A **well-formed design**, under this methodology, **shall not rely** on a specific ordering of causally independent events for functional correctness.

To be clear, the shall-not-rely requirement is a design rule. To adhere to this design rule, designs must express functionally significant cross-process dependencies through explicit modeled mechanisms such as message passing, SyncChannel/ac_sync operations, signal handshakes/anchors, declared memory-serialization constraints in the array-access mapping layer, or Appendix L snooping/witness-selection boundaries. Designs that violate this design rule are outside the formal guarantees. This rule concerns design well-formedness; it does not convert every causal-dependency edge into a strict proof-order edge.

System-Level Theorem (B1-Specialized Appendix G Statement)

Appendix G gives the high-level system theorem in the same standing-assumption regime used by Appendices J–K: B1 is assumed for RTL_B under the fixed stimulus, so the practical “unique RTL_B trace” reading is available throughout the main theorem stack. The authoritative execution-set theorem, including the exact execution-set quantification and the conditional use of B4/B5 when ϵ -normalization or uniqueness up to finite ϵ -stutter is invoked, is Theorem J.1. Therefore, if this Appendix G statement and Theorem J.1 are read together, Theorem J.1 controls; Appendix G is the high-level summary of the same B1-standing theorem regime.

Fix an initial state and a fixed external stimulus/environment behavior for both the prescribed source reference model Sys_ref and RTL_B, with Sys_ref as defined in Appendix J, Remark 2. (The raw rendezvous model Sys is the special case obtained when Sys_ref = Sys_B and all effective capacities are zero.)

Interpret “fixed stimulus” per Appendix I.2, “Fixed-stimulus interpretation (reactive environments).” Let

Exec_post denote the set of finite execution prefixes of RTL_B that are reachable under this stimulus and that are prefixes of at least one infinite execution under the same stimulus satisfying the stated fairness/progress premises; let Exec_ref denote the corresponding set of finite execution prefixes of Sys_ref. Let Reach_post / Reach_ref denote the corresponding finite reachability sets with no fair-extension qualifier (Definition J.Reach, Appendix J); $\text{Exec_post} \subseteq \text{Reach_post}$ and $\text{Exec_ref} \subseteq \text{Reach_ref}$.

Assume the Appendix I / Appendix L witness machinery and WC are available, together with the local certificate package of Definition J.LocalGWR: J.PCert for every process, J.CCert for every explicit abstract channel, J.ACert for every explicitly atomic unit, the applicable environment/reset certificates, and J.LocalAgree. Also assume the capacities/occupancies/enableness semantics of Sys_ref, finite capacities and B-faithfulness at every explicit abstract boundary, and the standing RTL_B determinism assumption B1 under the fixed stimulus. No B2/B3 premise is used for the finite-prefix construction; use B4/B5 when ϵ -normalization or uniqueness up to finite ϵ -stutter is invoked, and use B2/B3/J.FE only when an infinite fair execution is asserted.

Then the B1-specialized system-level result is:

(Post $\rightarrow$ Ref existence) For every $\tau_{\text{post}} \in \text{Reach_post}$ equipped with a local certificate package satisfying Definition J.LocalGWR, Theorem J.GWR-Comp constructs W with $\text{GlobalWitnessRealizable}(\tau_{\text{post}}, W)$, and there exists $\tau_{\text{ref}} \in \text{Reach_ref}$ such that $\tau_{\text{ref}, \text{system}} \approx_{\text{sys}} \tau_{\text{post}, \text{system}}$ under E1–E5. A directly validated J.GWR package is an alternate core-theorem entry route.

(Ref $\rightarrow$ Post existence, annotated RTL-consistent prefixes only) For every $\tau_{\text{ref}} \in \text{Exec_ref}$ equipped with a selected RTL_B prefix $\tau_{\text{post}}^* \in \text{Exec_post}$ and a compatible witness/annotation package satisfying the annotated RTL-consistency requirement of Theorem J.1 (RTLConsistentRefPrefix), there exists $\tau_{\text{post}} \in \text{Exec_post}$ such that $\tau_{\text{ref}, \text{system}} \approx \tau_{\text{post}, \text{system}}$.

Moreover, because B1 holds in this Appendix G specialization, the matching Σ -label sequence is unique (up to insertion/removal of finite ϵ -steps permitted by B4/B5). That uniqueness is only projection uniqueness; it does not by itself determine μ_Q , failed-poll instances, issue annotations, request attribution, E4 boundary histories, or the corresponding source-side witness prefix/state in Sys_ref.

Proof sketch. Appendix I proves the process-local replay and finite-preparation facts packaged by J.PCert. Theorem J.GWR-Comp combines those facts with J.CCert, J.ACert, environment/reset evidence, and the operational frame/commutation lemmas to construct one reachable Sys_ref witness and J.GWR package. Proposition J.0 then lifts the chosen compatible trace pair to system-level $\approx_{\text{sys}}$, and Theorem J.1 supplies the execution-set statement. Thus the main result is explicitly about sets of executions under fixed stimulus, not merely about a single pre-chosen trace pair. The Ref $\rightarrow$ Post direction is not a symmetric arbitrary-source construction; it applies only to annotated RTL-consistent source prefixes, and under this Appendix G specialization B1 supplies only the unique RTL_B Σ -trace against which the projection component of that consistency is judged. The compatible annotation package remains a separate witness obligation and is not inferred from bare Σ -label matching.

Practical Implication (“No Surprises” Guarantee)

If a verification environment exercises only the alphabet Σ (signals, message ports, synchronization calls) and does not test internal latency, then—under the assumptions of Theorem J.1 in Appendix J—the prescribed source reference model Sys_ref and the post-HLS RTL agree at the chosen observable boundary in the following qualified execution-level sense:

- for every $\tau_{\text{post}} \in \text{Reach_post}$ whose local certificate package satisfies Definition J.LocalGWR, Theorem J.GWR-Comp constructs a J.GWR package and a matching $\tau_{\text{ref}} \in \text{Reach_ref}$; a directly validated J.GWR package may be used instead; and
- in the reverse direction, only those source-side $\tau_{\text{ref}} \in \text{Exec_ref}$ that are annotated RTL-consistent in the sense of Theorem J.1—i.e., equipped with a selected RTL_B prefix and a compatible witness/annotation package satisfying $\text{RTLConsistentRefPrefix}$, not merely a bare Σ -projection match—are guaranteed to have a matching $\tau_{\text{post}} \in \text{Exec_post}$.

Latency-sensitive testbench caveat

A testbench that branches on raw cycle counts, uses timeout watchdogs, checks performance/latency bounds, or otherwise changes its stimulus or pass/fail behavior based on timing not represented in Σ is not covered by the same-stimulus trace-compatibility guarantee unless that timing dependence is itself modeled through explicit Σ -visible causal mechanisms such as synchronization events, handshakes, or message-passing transactions. Such checks may still be useful, but they should be treated as latency-sensitive testbench logic, isolated as described in Appendix D, or performed as post-HLS / RTL-level performance checks rather than as properties transferred automatically from an arbitrary pre-HLS simulation run.

Accordingly, the precise “no surprises” reading is one-sided for arbitrary RTL behavior and restricted on the source side: no Σ -observable behavior can appear in RTL_B under the fixed stimulus without a matching behavior in Sys_ref ; but a source-side pass claim transfers to RTL_B only for the annotated RTL-consistent subset of source-side behaviors covered by Theorem J.1 (or after the Appendix L snooping / witness-selection restriction has been applied where needed).

Thus, for a Σ -only testbench under the same fixed stimulus, any mismatch found on RTL_B corresponds to a matching mismatch on Sys_ref ; however, a source-side pass justifies RTL_B only through the theorem’s restricted reverse direction. Here Sys_ref means Sys_B in the ordinary bounded-FIFO case and $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$ in the elaborated back-annotated cases of Appendix B / Appendix Q. See Appendix J / Theorem J.1 for the full execution-level statement.

Appendix G states the trace-compatibility rules and a B1-specialized high-level implication. Appendix I supplies process-local deterministic replay and finite preparation certificates; Appendix J proves that these local process facts, together with local channel and atomic-interaction certificates, construct a single globally realizable source witness, and then proves the system theorem for the prescribed source reference model. Taken together, these appendices establish the stated execution-level correspondence at the chosen observable interfaces under fixed stimulus and the named local/tool obligations. The unrestricted guarantee is $\text{Post} \rightarrow \text{Ref}$; the reverse direction ranges only over annotated RTL-consistent source-side behaviors covered by Theorem J.1.

Appendix H – Possible Criticisms

This section highlights several potential challenges in the verification approach of Appendix G.

1. Designer-Managed Shared-Memory Synchronization

Appendix G requires that any memory shared between processes use explicit synchronization primitives inserted by the designer. The HLS tool does not perform static verification of those primitives. In practice, we mitigate this risk by encapsulating shared memories within parameterized library classes (for example, see examples `12_ping_pong_mem` and `15_native_ram_fifo`) that are pre-verified for correct memory access coordination in both the pre-HLS and post-HLS models. Typically such classes will be parameterized for aspects such as element type and memory size. Formally, the Appendix I–K theorems cover shared memories only under the J.Mem lowering condition; such library classes should present their value-carrying memory traffic at boundaries satisfying J.Mem, or carry their own separate correctness argument outside the Appendix I–K theorems.

2. Latency-Sensitive Signal Alignment (“Snooping”)

See Appendix L for detailed discussion on snooping.

3. By Default, Matchlib Connections Model a Skidbuffer inside In<> Ports

(Note that this overall document and specifically Appendix G are not intended to be strictly tied to Matchlib. Instead, this document is intended to be applicable to any pre-HLS model written in SystemC using signals, message-passing channels, and synchronization calls.)

Matchlib Connections supports throughput accurate modeling in the pre-HLS simulation. Currently the throughput accurate modeling mechanism relies on the `Pre()` and the `Post()` methods using a 1-place buffer to store transactions that are in flight on `Connections::In<>` ports. This means that by default `In<>` ports function like a skidbuffer. `Connections::Out<>` ports do not introduce any additional storage capacity into the pre-HLS simulation.

By default, Catapult adds skidbuffers on input ports into the post-HLS design, so the formal trace-compatibility relationship described in this document still holds. In other words, the default pre-HLS and post-HLS designs both still model rendezvous semantics, since both explicitly include a structural instantiation of a skidbuffer on input ports. In effect, we define the rendezvous boundary *before* the skidbuffer.

It is possible to remove some or all the skidbuffers during Catapult HLS. Because the abstract rendezvous boundary is defined before the skidbuffer, this choice is orthogonal to the trace-compatibility rules (R1–R5/E1–E5) as long as skidbuffer-internal behavior is not included in Σ . However, to keep the pre-HLS simulation’s port micro-architecture aligned with the RTL configuration, the following compile flag must then be used in this case:

```
-DFORCE_AUTO_PORT=Connections::SYN_PORT
```

This will remove all the skidbuffers from the pre-HLS model. In this case, if some of the skidbuffers are still inserted during HLS, the capacity effects of those specific skidbuffers should be added into `Sys_B` so that the formal trace-compatibility relationship still holds.

In this case the recommended methodology is to use both approaches:

- Use the default throughput accurate mode in Matchlib for most analysis and debug, and for pre-HLS performance verification.
- To keep the pre-HLS simulation's *port micro-architecture* strictly aligned with the RTL configuration, then use `-DFORCE_AUTO_PORT=Connections::SYN_PORT`, and rerun final verification tests.

Common Formal Definitions for Appendices I-K

Throughout Appendices I–K, the formal comparison is between `RTL_B` and `Sys_ref` (Appendix J, Remark 2), i.e., the same source processes interpreted under the channel semantics of E4 with capacities $B(c)$ matching the RTL. The E4 channel semantics are case-split: $B(c)=0$ is interpreted as a capacity-zero rendezvous channel, and $B(c)>0$ is interpreted as a cycle-boundary, non-fall-through bounded FIFO. The rendezvous case is therefore recovered as the $B(c)=0$ case of the channel model, not by applying the $B(c)>0$ FIFO-availability inequalities with $B(c)=0$.

Symbol / Rule	Definition — concise but complete
<code>BoundaryReq(x, σ)</code> (shorthand <code>BoundaryReq(q, σ)</code> only in ordinary unique-boundary case)	For any dynamic source-level message-operation frontier item $x \in \Omega_{\text{msg},P}$ on an explicit abstract channel $c = \text{BoundaryOf_P}(x)$ of <code>Sys_ref</code> , with owning source-level message instance $q = \text{MsgOf_P}(x)$ and $\text{kind}(q) \in \{\text{Push_c}, \text{Pop_c}\}$, <code>BoundaryReq(x,σ)</code> means: at that chosen abstract boundary and ϵ -quiescent cutpoint σ , q 's endpoint-owned boundary request for item x is asserted. Operationally (ready/valid): · for $\text{kind}(q)=\text{Push_c}$: the producer endpoint at <code>BoundaryOf_P(x)</code> asserts <code>vld_c</code>, with stable payload as required; and · for $\text{kind}(q)=\text{Pop_c}$: the consumer endpoint at <code>BoundaryOf_P(x)</code> asserts <code>rdy_c</code>. <code>BoundaryReq</code> is therefore a predicate about the endpoint's boundary-visible request assertion for a specific dynamic operation/frontier item, not about an already-committed Σ -event label. In the ordinary unelaborated case, where q has a unique evaluated boundary and frontier item, <code>BoundaryReq(q,σ)</code> is accepted as shorthand for <code>BoundaryReq(x,σ)</code> . In <code>Sys_B^elab</code> , the frontier-item form is authoritative because one source-level call q may own a chain of proof-internal frontier items at multiple explicit boundaries. Purely combinational realization structure on the channel side may affect only the complementary mirror signal at that boundary (Push: <code>rdy</code> ; Pop: <code>vld</code>) and thus the commit condition after ϵ -settling, but it does not change the endpoint request assertion captured by <code>BoundaryReq(x,σ)</code> . When a cycle-index notation is needed, <code>BoundaryReq(x,t)</code> is shorthand for <code>BoundaryReq(x,σ_t)</code> , where σ_t is the ϵ -quiescent cutpoint for cycle t .
<code>ChannelEnabled(x, σ)</code> (shorthand <code>ChannelEnabled(q, σ)</code> only in ordinary	<code>ChannelEnabled(x,σ)</code> means: <code>BoundaryReq(x,σ)</code> holds, and in the ϵ -quiescent ready/valid fixed point at σ , the channel-side commit-enabling condition for the owning operation $q = \text{MsgOf_P}(x)$ holds at the chosen boundary. Concretely, for bounded-FIFO channels $B(c)>0$, the channel-side condition is

Symbol / Rule	Definition — concise but complete
unique-boundary case)	exactly the E4 availability predicate at that boundary: · for $\text{kind}(q)=\text{Push_c}$: $\text{occ_c}(\sigma) < B(c)$, i.e. space is available; and · for $\text{kind}(q)=\text{Pop_c}$: $\text{occ_c}(\sigma) > 0$, i.e. data is available. For rendezvous channels $B(c)=0$, the channel-side condition is the matching complementary endpoint participation in the same ϵ-quiescent cycle. If the owning operation represented by x commits, it contributes the corresponding committed Σ-event $m(q) \in M$; before it commits, $m(q)$ is absent, but $\text{BoundaryReq}(x,\sigma)$ and $\text{ChannelEnabled}(x,\sigma)$ are still well-defined for the pending frontier item. In the ordinary unique-boundary case, $\text{ChannelEnabled}(q,\sigma)$ is shorthand for $\text{ChannelEnabled}(x,\sigma)$; in $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$, the frontier-item/boundary-specific form $\text{ChannelEnabled}(x,\sigma)$ is authoritative.
$\text{ChannelDisabled}(x, \sigma)$ (shorthand $\text{ChannelDisabled}(q, \sigma)$ only in ordinary unique-boundary case)	$\text{ChannelDisabled}(x,\sigma)$ means: $\text{BoundaryReq}(x,\sigma)$ holds but $\text{ChannelEnabled}(x,\sigma)$ does not. Intuitively: the endpoint is requesting the transfer for dynamic operation instance q, but the transfer is blocked by channel-side conditions, such as empty/full status or the rendezvous partner not simultaneously requesting, as evaluated at the ϵ-quiescent handshake fixed point used throughout the document's enablement tests. In the ordinary unique-boundary case, $\text{ChannelDisabled}(q,\sigma)$ is shorthand; in $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$, the frontier-item/boundary-specific form $\text{ChannelDisabled}(x,\sigma)$ is authoritative.
Σ	Set of observable actions for the equivalence check (committed IO events) at the chosen observable boundary (often the DUT IO boundary for functional equivalence, but optionally expanded—e.g., for Appendix K deadlock reasoning): • channel commit events $\text{Push_c}(v)$ and $\text{Pop_c}(v)$ on channels designated as observable, labeled with the transferred message value (or abstract message identity) v • synchronization events $\text{wait}()$, Sync, START_P, FINISH_P • single-cycle signal actions $\text{Write}(\text{sig}, \text{val})$ and $\text{Read}(\text{sig}, \text{val})$ on signals designated as observable, labeled with the value written/read. Internal-only channels/signals may be excluded from Σ (treated as ϵ-microstate) when they are not part of the chosen observable boundary. If such channels/signals are later brought into the observable boundary (e.g., by snooping for debug or analysis), then they become Σ-events and must match under $\approx$. Deadlock-analysis requirement (Appendix K): for Appendix K, Σ is instantiated to include every message-passing channel whose endpoint transfers at the chosen Sys_ref boundary can contribute a dependency edge in the Appendix K Wait-For Graph, either because the channel is on the declared observable boundary or because it is snooped. The WFG itself is defined over pending blocking message-operation frontier items $x \in Q_{\text{msg},P}$ for the relevant owning process P, with owning dynamic message-call instance $q = \text{MsgOf_P}(x)$, not over already-committed Σ-event labels and not over failed non-blocking polls in $Q_{\text{exec},P}$. Thus, when Appendix K refers to a blocked Push or Pop at a

Symbol / Rule	Definition — concise but complete
	boundary, the relevant frontier object is x, and its owning pending source-level operation instance is q with $\text{kind}(q) \in \{\text{Push_c}, \text{Pop_c}\}$; the edge is determined by $\text{BoundaryReq}(x, \sigma)$ together with $\text{ChannelEnabled}(x, \sigma)/\text{ChannelDisabled}(x, \sigma)$ at the ϵ-quiescent cutpoint σ. Internal micro-interfaces that lie within the back-annotated realization counted in $B(c)$ (e.g., post-HLS RTL pipeline stage implementation) are not treated as separate channels for this requirement: they may be exposed/snooped for debug, but Appendix K's WFG edges are defined using the $\text{ChannelEnabled}/\text{ChannelDisabled}$ status of the corresponding boundary operation instance q via $E4/\text{occ_c}/B(c)$, so such internal points can participate logically in the deadlock argument without being explicitly Σ-observable. Non-blocking message-passing (PushNB/PopNB): A non-blocking call that returns “not completed” produces no Σ-event and is modeled as an internal ϵ-step. When a non-blocking call succeeds (returns “completed”), that success is represented in Σ as the corresponding committed $\text{Push_c}(v)$ or $\text{Pop_c}(v)$ event on that channel, labeled with the same transferred value/message v (i.e., Σ records transfers and their payloads, not failed polls). A non-blocking call is considered issued in the cycle in which it executes (its Issue cycle). A call that returns “completed” commits in that same cycle and therefore yields a committed transfer $m(q) \in M$; a call that returns “not completed” produces no committed transfer event ($m(q)$ undefined / absent) and may be treated as an ϵ-step with respect to Σ-visible message-transfer events. Each executed non-blocking call is still a distinct dynamic source-level message-call instance $q \in Q_{\text{exec}, P}$ for the owning process P. Since failed non-blocking q's have no Σ-label, their cross-trace matching is witness-relative: it is supplied by the chosen μ_Q / WC witness, by NB-CF when failed polls cannot affect the next Σ-visible control flow or frontier, or by Appendix L's snooping / witness-selection mechanism. Continuous assertion of an endpoint request does not by itself identify multiple executed non-blocking calls as one q, and the Σ trace alone is not required to determine how failed non-blocking q's are matched. A successful non-blocking call may also be a member of $Q_{\Omega, P}$ when it contributes a committed $\text{Push_c}(v) / \text{Pop_c}(v)$ event; a failed non-blocking poll remains in $Q_{\text{exec}, P} \setminus Q_{\Omega, P}$.
START_P	First observable action emitted by process P after reset. Marks the moment P begins executing user code. A new START_P is emitted each time P exits reset.
FINISH_P	Last observable action of process P in the current reset epoch. If P executes an unbounded loop within that reset epoch, FINISH_P never occurs for that epoch, and the epoch-local trace is treated as infinite until a later reset boundary, if any. If a later reset affecting P occurs and P exits reset again, a new dynamic START_P begins a fresh reset epoch; any later termination is represented by a distinct dynamic FINISH_P occurrence.

Symbol / Rule	Definition — concise but complete
ϵ -step	An <i>internal</i> , unobservable RTL state transition (pipeline advance, FSM micro-state, etc.).
B(c)	Back-annotated effective capacity of channel c at the chosen explicit abstract Sys_ref boundary used by E4 and Appendix K. In the ordinary non-elaborated case this is the chosen Σ-observable Sys_B boundary; in elaborated cases it is the corresponding explicit abstract channel boundary of Sys_B^elab, which may be proof-internal and later projected away from the outer Σ_DUT trace. Finite, $B(c) \geq 0$. It reflects the total bounded “composite buffer” storage/credit in the RTL realization represented by that explicit abstract channel boundary, including FIFO storage, skid/elastic buffering, HLS-inserted pipeline staging that can hold in-flight messages, and any explicit staged/bundle/join channel capacity introduced by Sys_B^elab. • $B(c)=0 \Rightarrow$ rendezvous (capacity-zero) channel. • $B(c)>0 \Rightarrow$ bounded FIFO (of that effective capacity). B-faithfulness. For the formal results to apply to a concrete RTL_B instance, each back-annotated $B(c)$ must be faithful to the chosen explicit abstract boundary. This means: • Boundary completeness: every RTL storage element, credit, skid/elastic buffer, pipeline stage, or elaborated staged/bundle/join component that can accept, hold, release, or backpressure messages across the abstract boundary c is either included in the effective capacity $B(c)$ for that boundary or represented as a separate explicit Sys_B^elab boundary with its own capacity and E4 semantics. • No hidden capacity or hidden enablement: the RTL realization does not permit a producer-facing accept or consumer-facing delivery at boundary c except in cycles allowed by E4 using the corresponding $occ_c(t)$ and $B(c)$, and any additional enablement restriction that affects boundary behavior is represented by an explicit Sys_B^elab boundary rather than by an unmodeled predicate. • ϵ-opacity of internal movement: movement of an already accepted message within the RTL realization counted by $B(c)$ is internal ϵ-state. Such movement does not create additional Σ-visible Push_c/Pop_c events and does not create, delete, duplicate, reorder, or relabel the Σ-visible boundary transfers. • Evidence obligation: B-faithfulness is a tool/RTL-flow compliance obligation. It may be discharged by a trusted back-annotation algorithm, generated certificate, structural RTL check, interface monitor, formal equivalence/checking flow, or other validation method appropriate to the implementation flow. It is not derived by E4, Proposition J.0, or Theorem J.1. Point-to-point endpoint assumption (single-producer/single-consumer): For every message-passing channel c (including both buffered channels with $B(c)>0$ and rendezvous channels with $B(c)=0$), there is exactly one producer process that may execute Push_c on c, and exactly one consumer process that may execute Pop_c on c. Hence the complementary endpoint relevant to any blocked Push_c/Pop_c on c is unique.

Symbol / Rule	Definition — concise but complete
	Modeling note (shared resources / arbitration): If an implementation conceptually has multiple producers and/or multiple consumers for a logical resource, that sharing must be modeled explicitly (e.g., an arbiter process plus per-client point-to-point channels), rather than as a single multi-endpoint “channel.” This keeps WFG wait dependencies well-defined and unique per edge. Single-transfer-per-cycle endpoint constraint (scalar channel interface): For every message-passing channel c, in any clock cycle t, at most one Push_c may commit and at most one Pop_c may commit. Equivalently, the set of commits on a fixed channel in a single cycle contains ≤ 1 Push and ≤ 1 Pop (it may contain one of each in the same cycle). For rendezvous channels ($B(c)=0$), a committed transfer occurs only as a matching same-cycle $\text{Push}_c(v)$ and $\text{Pop}_c(v)$ pair. For buffered channels ($B(c)>0$), a same-cycle Push_c and Pop_c do not imply fall-through; the channel semantics are cycle-boundary, non-fall-through as stated in E4. Reset-empty FIFO convention: after each reset boundary at which the compared execution begins or restarts, every buffered message-passing channel with $B(c)>0$ has logical FIFO occupancy 0 at the chosen Σ boundary. Equivalently, the reset state contains no preloaded in-flight messages in the abstract channel realization used by Sys_ref / RTL_B. If a design requires preloaded channel contents, those contents must be modeled explicitly as post-reset producer actions or by a separate initialized-state extension outside the present empty-FIFO formal model. Modeling note (multi-lane / burst transfers): If an implementation can transfer $k>1$ messages per cycle on a logical resource, model it as k parallel point-to-point channels (or as a single widened message transferred by one $\text{Push}_c/\text{Pop}_c$ per cycle) so that the Σ-level event model continues to satisfy the scalar constraint above.
occ_c(t)	Abstract FIFO occupancy at the chosen explicit abstract Sys_ref channel boundary: number of items committed by Push_c but not yet committed by Pop_c at that boundary, measured from the most recent reset boundary under the reset-empty FIFO convention. In the ordinary non-elaborated case this is the chosen Sys_B channel boundary; in elaborated cases $\text{Sys_ref} = \text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$, this is the occupancy of the relevant explicit abstract staged/bundle/join channel boundary. Equivalently (E4), $\text{occ}_c(t) = \text{push}(\pi_t) - \text{pop}(\pi_t)$, where π_t is the Σ-visible boundary-commit prefix for that explicit abstract channel strictly before cycle t (i.e., excluding any $\text{Push}_c/\text{Pop}_c$ commits that occur in cycle t), so $\text{occ}_c(t)$ is the abstract occupancy at the beginning of cycle t. For pure-FIFO channels with $B(c)>0$, the FIFO availability predicates (not-full/not-empty) are evaluated against this begin-of-cycle occupancy; hence a Pop_c cannot commit in a cycle that begins empty solely because a Push_c also commits in that same cycle (no fall-through), and likewise a Push_c cannot commit in a cycle that begins full solely because a Pop_c also commits in that same cycle.

Symbol / Rule	Definition — concise but complete
	Clarification (no “second Push/Pop”): movements of an item within the RTL channel realization (e.g., FIFO→staging/skid buffering, staging/skid buffering→pipeline-stage registers, pipeline-stage→pipeline-stage handoff) are internal ϵ-steps; they do not constitute additional Σ-visible committed Push_c/Pop_c events beyond the boundary events counted by push(π_t)/pop(π_t). Derived cutpoint shorthand (used in Appendices K and R): if σ is an ϵ-quiescent cutpoint occurring in cycle t_σ, write $\text{occ}_c(\sigma) \triangleq \text{occ}_c(t_\sigma)$. Likewise, when channel enablement is evaluated at an ϵ-quiescent cutpoint, write $\text{ChannelEnabled}(q, \sigma) \triangleq \text{ChannelEnabled}(q, t_\sigma)$ and $\text{ChannelDisabled}(q, \sigma) \triangleq \text{ChannelDisabled}(q, t_\sigma)$. This is only notational shorthand for cutpoint reasoning; the primary semantic definition of occupancy remains the cycle-boundary quantity $\text{occ}_c(t)$. Note: $\text{occ}_c(t)$ is an abstract analysis quantity derived from Σ-visible boundary commits; in both Sys_B and RTL_B, processes do not directly read $\text{occ}_c(t)$ and instead proceed solely based on the per-channel ready/valid outcome of their own Push/Pop attempts.
P_push(c)	<i>Finite-progress invariant (producer)</i>: this is a persistent-request premise, not a ChannelEnabled premise. In this paragraph, “the producer’s request remains asserted continuously” means that the producer presents a persistent, non-withdrawable Push_c endpoint request from the starting cycle through the matching discharge event, with no deassert-before-commit and with stable payload while asserted. • Buffered case ($B(c) > 0$): If the producer’s Push_c request remains asserted continuously from some cycle t_0 onward while the channel is full ($\text{occ}_c = B(c)$)—with stable payload while asserted—and the complementary endpoint continuously requests the matching Pop_c (persistent request asserted; Pop_c boundary request remains true), then some cycle $t' \geq t_0$ commits a complementary Pop_c (i.e., the full condition is eventually discharged). • Rendezvous case ($B(c) = 0$): If the producer’s Push_c request remains asserted continuously from some cycle t_0 onward (with stable payload while asserted) and the complementary endpoint continuously requests the matching Pop_c (persistent request asserted; Pop_c boundary request remains true), then some cycle $t' \geq t_0$ commits the rendezvous transfer—i.e., a matching Push_c(v) and Pop_c(v) commit in the same cycle.
P_pop(c)	<i>Finite-progress invariant (consumer)</i>: this is a persistent-request premise, not a ChannelEnabled premise. In this paragraph, “the consumer’s request remains asserted continuously” means that the consumer presents a persistent, non-withdrawable Pop_c endpoint request from the starting cycle through the matching discharge event, with no deassert-before-commit. • Buffered case ($B(c) > 0$): If the consumer’s Pop_c request remains asserted continuously from some cycle t_0 onward while the channel is empty ($\text{occ}_c = 0$)—and the complementary endpoint continuously requests the matching

Symbol / Rule	Definition — concise but complete
	Push_c (persistent request asserted with stable payload; Push_c boundary request remains true)—then some cycle $t' \geq t_0$ commits a complementary Push_c (i.e., the empty condition is eventually discharged). • Rendezvous case ($B(c) = 0$): If the consumer's Pop_c request remains asserted continuously from some cycle t_0 onward and the complementary endpoint continuously requests the matching Push_c (persistent request asserted with stable payload; Push_c boundary request remains true), then some cycle $t' \geq t_0$ commits the rendezvous transfer—i.e., a matching Push_c(v) and Pop_c(v) commit in the same cycle.
Trace-compatibility rules (E1–E5)	E1 Synchronization-order preservation: For each process P, the sequence of synchronization events executed by P (wait(), SyncChannel, START_P, FINISH_P) appears in the same source order in the pre-HLS and post-HLS traces. E2 Signal visibility: For each sequential process P, each signal Read in P occurs at the closest preceding synchronization event in P, and each signal Write in P occurs at the closest succeeding synchronization event in P, in both the pre-HLS and post-HLS traces (per R2/E2). For each combinational process or explicitly modeled combinational network component C_comb, observable combinational signal Read/Write labels appear only inside emitted R2C fixed-point signal-observation units for the selected R2C observation component, as defined by R2C. Each emitted R2C unit is evaluated at one ϵ-quiescent combinational fixed point, and all Read/Write labels inside that unit are atomic with respect to that fixed point. Emitted R2C units are matched by component identity and local emitted-occurrence ordinal, not by global observable-cycle bucket number. R2C stutter cycles whose selected observable slice is unchanged do not create separate Σ-visible units unless an explicitly modeled observer/sampler requires a fresh emitted unit. Interpretation (logical timestamping). For sequential processes, the equations in E2 define the logical timestamps of Read/Write Σ-events: the anchor points at which compatibility is checked. An implementation may physically sample a Read later than $\text{pred_S}(r)$, or physically apply a Write earlier than $\text{succ_S}(w)$, provided the value is stable across the anchor interval and the trace emitted for compatibility records the Σ-event at the anchor point. For combinational processes, the logical observation point is the emitted R2C fixed-point signal-observation unit, not a global observable-cycle bucket number; internal delta-cycle propagation before the fixed point and R2C stutter cycles with unchanged selected observable slices are $\epsilon/\text{stutter}$ and are not separately Σ-visible. Direct-input pragmas (e.g., #pragma hls_direct_input and #pragma hls_direct_input_sync) do not change E2 and are not exceptions to E2. For sequential processes, they impose stability/timing contracts that allow later physical sampling, or controlled updates at a synchronization boundary, while the logical Read/Write Σ-events used for $\approx$ checking remain timestamped at

Symbol / Rule	Definition — concise but complete
	the E2 synchronization anchor points and retain the anchored value labels. For combinational processes, ordinary direct-input pragmas do not introduce a separate anchoring rule; any observable combinational signal Read/Write label remains part of an emitted R2C fixed-point signal-observation unit under the R2C unit-generation and matching conventions. Thus the pragma affects only implementation sampling freedom under its stated contract, not the logical Σ observation used for compatibility. E3 (Safe message issue ordering). (Post-HLS preservation of R4). For any two executed message-call instances $q_1, q_2 \in Q_{\text{exec}, P}$ of the same process P: (i) Same-interface order is always preserved: if q_1 and q_2 access the same message-passing interface/channel and $q_1 <_{\text{src}} q_2$, then $\text{issue_post}(q_1) \leq \text{issue_post}(q_2)$. (ii) Distinct-interface no-reverse: if q_1 and q_2 access distinct message-passing interfaces and appear in sequence in the source ($q_1 <_{\text{src}} q_2$), then $\text{issue_post}(q_1) \leq \text{issue_post}(q_2)$ (i.e., they shall not be issued in the reverse sequence). (iii) Prefix-closed issue obligation: at every cycle-aligned cutpoint σ of the post-HLS execution / witness, if $q_1 <_{\text{src}} q_2$ and q_2 has issued by σ, then q_1 has also issued by σ and $\text{Issue}(q_1) \leq \text{Issue}(q_2)$. This is an implementation-side obligation on issued sets, not merely an inequality over pairs whose timestamps are already defined. (Note: any pipelined-loop internal staging/dequeue discussed in “Pipelined Loops” is ε-microstate within the back-annotated channel realization and is not a Σ-visible boundary issue event associated with any $q \in Q_{\text{exec}, P}$ nor a committed-transfer event in M; therefore it does not constitute a counterexample to (ii) or (iii).) E4 FIFO legality: for each channel c, the post-HLS committed ($\text{Push}_c(v)$, $\text{Pop}_c(v)$) history is a legal bounded-capacity execution consistent with Sys_B for that channel (capacity $B(c)$), and reduces to rendezvous consistency when $B(c)=0$. In particular, on each channel, the committed $\text{Pop}_c(v)$ events return exactly the FIFO-ordered sequence of values v previously committed by $\text{Push}_c(v)$, with no drops, duplications, or reordering. E5 (Messages cannot cross their immediate synchronization boundary). For every synchronization call s (in the source order used by R3 / pref_S / suff_S): $\forall q \in \text{pref}_S(s) : \text{issue_post}(q) \leq \text{clk_post}(s)$ $\forall q \in \text{suff}_S(s) : \text{issue_post}(q) > \text{clk_post}(s)$

Frontier-item predicate convention. BoundaryReq , ChannelEnabled , and ChannelDisabled are authoritative in their frontier-item form. For a message-operation frontier item $x \in \Omega_{\text{msg}, P}$, let $q = \text{MsgOf}_P(x)$ and $c = \text{BoundaryOf}_P(x)$. $\text{BoundaryReq}(x, \sigma)$, $\text{ChannelEnabled}(x, \sigma)$, and $\text{ChannelDisabled}(x, \sigma)$ are evaluated at that specific explicit abstract boundary and are undefined for non-message frontier items unless the statement explicitly restricts $x \in \Omega_{\text{msg}, P}$. In the ordinary unelaborated case, where q has a unique frontier item and a unique evaluated boundary, the q -forms

$\text{BoundaryReq}(q, \sigma)$, $\text{ChannelEnabled}(q, \sigma)$, and $\text{ChannelDisabled}(q, \sigma)$ may be used as shorthands for the corresponding x-forms. In $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$, one source-level call q may own several frontier items at different explicit boundaries, so the x-form is authoritative.

No hidden cross-channel disablement. Any cross-channel dependency introduced by combinational couplers must be reflected only at explicit internal staged/bundle/join boundaries introduced by the elaboration, i.e., via $\text{BoundaryReq}/\text{ChannelEnabled}/\text{ChannelDisabled}$ on message-operation frontier items $x \in \Omega_{\text{msg}, P}$, with $\text{MsgOf_P}(x) = q$, at those explicit staged/bundle channels. At the chosen Σ -visible channel endpoints, $\text{BoundaryReq}(x, \sigma)$ and $\text{ChannelEnabled}(x, \sigma)/\text{ChannelDisabled}(x, \sigma)$ for a message-operation frontier item $x \in \Omega_{\text{msg}, P}$ on channel c may not depend on other channels' state beyond the per-channel E4 predicate for c , and no extra hidden predicate may block an otherwise E4-enabled boundary transfer.

K-observation architecture (KObs; normative Appendix J/K cutpoint interface)

The formal development has three explicit layers. First, the operational semantics define process evaluation, Issue/Commit, Policy L/S, channel commits, fairness, and the continuation-level Definition R.16/K.Drain discipline. Second, the safety/replay layer proves process-local preparation in Appendix I, derives J.GWR by the local-to-global Theorem J.GWR-Comp, and then proves Theorem J.1 and Lemma J.HCanon over committed observable units and the fixed witness. Third, the K cutpoint layer combines the canonical replay history H with the current fully attributed residual-offer set O in $\text{KObs} = \langle E, w, H, O \rangle$. Obligation J.KObsConf and Corollary J.1 establish the common record for the selected RTL and reachable Sys_ref cutpoints; Lemmas K.0, K.2, and K.2a and Theorem K.1A consume it through the named reconstruction functions. Appendix K-P uses the same $\text{KObs}/\text{ResOffers}$ interface only at terminal snapshots and retains operational Issue, fairness, nonwithdrawal, and DrainDiscipline for cross-execution and continuation reasoning. No alternate broad state relation or compatibility notation is normative.

(1) Operational Issue is retained. Issue transitions and the Issue/Commit linkage remain part of the operational semantics and continue to govern R4/E3/E5, Policy L, Policy S, Axiom R.1, Definition R.16/K.Drain, the applicable progress and fairness premises including K-O1, Lemmas K.2b.R/K.2b.P/K.2b.Q, and the K.Resp monitor trigger. KObs removes historical issue timestamps only from the cross-model cutpoint-observation and certificate interface; it does not redefine $\text{Issue}(q)$, identify $\text{Issue}(q)$ with $\text{Commit}(q)$, or permit an operational proof to ignore whether work was already issued before a block.

(2) KObs is an observation-layer quotient, not a normalized execution. The factoring theorems prove that K-relevant cutpoint predicates depend only on replay history plus the current attributed residual offers. They do not construct a replacement execution in which committed operations issue in their commit cycles, and no issue-erasure normal form is assumed.

(3) Residual offers are typed over frontier items and explicit boundaries. A residual offer identifies the owning process P , frontier item $x \in \Omega_{\text{msg}, P}$, owning dynamic message-call instance $q = \text{MsgOf_P}(x)$, evaluated explicit abstract boundary $c = \text{BoundaryOf_P}(x)$, endpoint direction, and reset epoch. Its operation kind is the explicitly derived field $\text{kind}(o) := \text{kind}(q)$, with well-typedness requiring producer-valid exactly for a Push instance and consumer-ready exactly for a Pop instance. A bare set of source calls q is insufficient in $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$, where one source-level call may own several proof-internal frontier items at different explicit boundaries.

(4) The full elaboration package E is a parameter of KObs . E includes the selected Sys_ref form, explicit abstract channels, capacities $B(c)$, Π_{elab} , ownership, boundary and projection maps, frontier-item

universes and partial orders, and any bundle/join/epoch-gate structure. KObs is not parameterized by B alone.

(5) Cross-model residual-offer conformance is the bidirectional boundary fact $J.OfferConf$ of Appendix J: every abstract residual offer has its attributed RTL boundary request asserted, and every relevant asserted RTL boundary request is attributed to exactly one stated residual offer. The record enforces at most one attributed outstanding source-level offer per endpoint direction at each explicit abstract boundary. This prevents a proof-internal realization transfer already counted in channel occupancy from also being represented as a second source-level offer.

(6) Residual-offer reachability remains separate from boundary conformance. $J.OfferReach$ establishes that a proposed KObs record is in the image of an admissible reachable Sys_ref cutpoint with the same annotated replay history and witness w . $J.OfferConf$ establishes agreement between the record's residual offers and the RTL requests at the selected cutpoint. $J.KObsConf$ requires both; $OfferConf$ alone cannot manufacture an unreachable source offer set, and replay matching alone cannot determine which uncommitted requests are presently asserted.

(7) Snapshot drain closure is distinct from the transition discipline. $DrainClosedNow(D, KObs)$ means that, at the selected ϵ -quiescent cutpoint, no already-offered non-frontier blocking request owned by a process in D is channel-enabled. It is a function of the cutpoint observation. $DrainDiscipline$ denotes the continuation-level no-new-later-work, non-withdrawal, finite non-replenishing drain, and sync-boundary conditions of Definition R.16/K.Drain; it remains an operational premise.

(8) The minimal K-specific residual-offer abstraction carries no pending Push payload. Payload stability while a blocking Push request is asserted remains required by Axiom R.1 and Appendix C, and the committed payload remains checked by the value-labeled replay/trace results. A proof or checker needing mid-flight data-wire correspondence may add that separate implementation obligation without enlarging the deadlock observation itself.

(9) Elaboration and issue policy remain separate. Pipeline storage, bundle/join structure, and internal stage movement are represented by E and the explicit Sys_B^{elab} channels. Policy L/S governs issue of the actual source-level operation instances and their elaboration-provided frontier items. KObs records current source-attributed offers but does not turn intra-realization movement into additional source calls or double-count capacity already represented by $E4$ occupancy.

(10) KObs-facing waiver classes are observationally closed. For any theorem, certificate, or checker that claims a waiver-parameterized cutpoint predicate is determined by KObs, write $KObsClosed_I, E, w(W)$ for the requirement that, for all reachable ϵ -quiescent cutpoints σ_1 and σ_2 of the same fixed instance, $KObs_E, w(\sigma_1) = KObs_E, w(\sigma_2)$ implies $(\sigma_1 \in W \text{ iff } \sigma_2 \in W)$. $K.Resp$ monitor waivers are a separate complete-run certificate interface: they are keyed by the dynamic process-facing frontier instance and must satisfy $K.RespCov$'s coverage-preservation rule. A waiver class that depends on historical Issue timing, implementation microstate, monitor age, or any other fact not reconstructible from KObs cannot be used in KObs extensionality unless a separate proof establishes $KObsClosed_I, E, w(W)$.

(11) The primary serial route and diagnostic terminal reconstruction are separate instance data. The ambient theorem instance records the $K.Resp$ monitor schema, finite-bound function, reset/end-of-test disposition, and response-waiver policy used by CF-S. Those monitor fields are not part of KObs and are not transferred to RTL as latency claims. Separately, an instance may request diagnostic reconstruction of $WFG+$, $EnvStop$, $DoneStop$, $Dead_KS$, $K.EnvOrd$, or $K.Done$. For $EnvStop$ diagnostics, the instance records either the standard B1-avail, pull-based, consumption-ordered input model with default always-ready outputs, or an explicit $EnvReplayAdequate$ certificate showing that permanent next-interaction availability is a function of H and w . Without one of these environment conditions, KObs still factors the ordinary internal $Dead_K$ predicate but makes no extensionality claim for $EnvStop$ -dependent diagnostic predicates.

(12) The certificate boundary is layered and explicit. A proof-backed application records: (a) one common instance header identifying the selected theorem instance, elaboration, capacities, observation boundaries, fixed stimulus, environment/reset contracts, witness and WC provenance, cutpoint-waiver set, and A5-L discharge route; (b) when Corollary J.1 or Theorem K.1A is used, a KObs cutpoint certificate carrying the canonical replay history H , the fully attributed residual-offer set O , and the evidence for $J.HCanon$, $J.OfferReach$, $J.OfferConf$, $B\text{-faithfulness}/E4$, reset alignment, and finite ε -normalization; and (c) an A5 discharge certificate identifying the Policy-S bounded-response, direct Policy-L, structural, invariant, exploration, or tool-certificate route and its completeness/fairness evidence. Derived Front, WFG, DrainClosedNow, DeadKRec, and optional diagnostic WFGPlusRec/DeadKRec values are checker-reconstructed from KObs and ambient instance data; they are not trusted certificate inputs. $K.RespFail$ is instead reconstructed from the selected Policy-S run plus the separately certified monitor configuration and timer state. The cross-model KObs certificate need not contain a complete historical Issue timeline or response timers. Operational Issue, fairness, request persistence, DrainDiscipline, monitor-trigger, and complete-run response evidence remain required where consumed and may be carried in, or referenced from, the source witness and CF-S payload.

Shared-memory lowering condition (J.Mem). The proof-internal observable alphabet Σ of Appendices I–K contains committed channel transfers, synchronization events, and signal Read/Write actions; it does not contain mapped memory read/write events, and the Theorem J.1 invariant carries per-process replay state and per-channel commit histories but no global shared-memory state. Accordingly, the formal results of Appendices I–K apply to cross-process shared-memory communication only under the following lowering condition, named J.Mem: every shared-memory dependency through which one process’s memory write can affect another process’s control flow, payload/value expressions, or the identity or order of its later operations shall be lowered by the array-access mapping layer onto operations already covered by the proof alphabet — explicit point-to-point message-passing channels governed by $E4$ (memory command/response channels), and/or Σ -visible anchored signal IO governed by $E2$ with the producing Writes observable — so that every memory-carried value is carried by a matched, value-labeled Σ event. Synchronization alone ($E1$) fixes access order but does not, within the present invariant, establish that the two models contain the same memory value; J.Mem closes that gap by making the value flow Σ -visible. Designs that instead rely on the non-lowered “declared memory semantics” branch of the shared-memory transformation entry in Appendix G are outside Theorem J.1, Corollary J.1, and Appendix K as proved here; for them, agreement under the declared memory semantics is a separate verification obligation (see the informative note below). J.Mem is a named entry in the side-condition discharge record. $K.CV$ ’s “declared memory serialization” clause remains a liveness-side premise and does not substitute for J.Mem in the safety proof.

Informative note (direct memory-state extension, not developed here). The alternative repair — adding mapped memory $Read(addr, val)/Write(addr, val)$ events to the proof-internal Σ , extending the required-order relation $<_J$ with the mapping layer’s declared serialization constraints, and adding a global memory-state agreement clause ($I4$) to the Theorem J.1 invariant together with a memory-state component in the enriched replay/KObs reconstruction and the corresponding $J.OfferReach/J.OfferConf$ interface — is compatible with the present proof architecture but is not developed in this document. A flow that requires direct coverage of non-lowered shared memory shall supply that extension and re-verify Lemmas $I.DR/I.DR'$, $J.HCanon$, and $R.21b\text{--}R.21f$, together with Corollary J.1, with the added clause.

Reset-boundary observable unit (RESET) and reset well-formedness (RW1–RW5). When dynamic reset is used, each dynamic reset occurrence is represented in the proof-internal event model as an explicitly atomic observable unit $RESET(S_p, S_c)$: a proof-internal boundary marker whose scope names the set S_p of processes and the set S_c of explicit abstract channels affected by that reset occurrence. RESET units may be projected away from the outer Σ_{DUT} alphabet, like other proof-internal units. The unit is ordered strictly after every observable unit of the ending epoch owned by the affected scope and strictly

before every observable unit of the new epoch of that scope, and the first observable action of each $P \in S_p$ in the new epoch is its fresh dynamic $START_P$. The state-changing reset transition itself — which occurs before the new epoch’s $START_P$ — is exactly what the RESET unit represents, so it receives its own correspondence obligation (Lemma J.RS below) rather than being folded into $START_P$ matching. The following reset well-formedness conditions are implementation-side obligations for designs using dynamic reset:

RW1 (channel-consistent scope). For every explicit abstract channel c , either both endpoint processes of c are in S_p and $c \in S_c$ — in which case c re-initializes to reset-empty occupancy (A10) at the boundary and any in-flight (accepted but not yet delivered) contents are discarded consistently on both sides in both models — or neither endpoint is in S_p and $c \notin S_c$, in which case c ’s state and history are unaffected. A reset that would affect exactly one endpoint of a live channel is permitted only if the design models the cross-epoch disposition explicitly (for example, an explicit flush/abort protocol on that channel); that protocol’s events are ordinary Σ events, and the channel is treated per this clause after the protocol completes.

RW2 (request disposition). Every outstanding endpoint-owned boundary request of a process in S_p is cleared at the RESET unit; its owning dynamic instance does not commit, is not re-attributed across the boundary, and any post-reset re-execution is a fresh dynamic instance in the new epoch’s universe. The Appendix C non-withdrawal discipline is scoped per reset epoch.

RW3 (corresponding reset transitions). At the RESET unit, RTL_B ’s post-reset state at the chosen abstract boundary corresponds to Sys_ref ’s prescribed epoch-initial state: control at epoch-initial locations for every $P \in S_p$, source-visible values at their reset values, reset-empty occupancy on every $c \in S_c$, no stale synchronization state, no unaccounted pending endpoint request, no hidden accepted message absent from the source reference model, and direct-input signals obeying their per-epoch stability or sync-controlled contracts (main text, Direct Inputs).

RW4 (atomic boundary). The reset state transition is not interleaved with same-cycle observable actions of the affected scope. If the implementation asserts reset in a cycle in which affected-scope observable actions also commit, those actions belong to the ending epoch and precede the RESET unit in the required order; the two reset epochs of the affected scope share no observable cycle bucket ambiguity at the boundary.

RW5 (locality). The RESET unit changes no state of processes outside S_p and no history or occupancy of channels outside S_c . Cross-scope effects, if any, must be expressed by ordinary modeled events.

Lemma J.RS (MatchedResetEpochSplice). Assume RW1–RW5 and the fixed-stimulus interpretation. Let H be a matched Theorem J.1 prefix satisfying $Inv(H)$ whose next unit in the selected validated construction-order enumeration is a RESET unit $\gamma_R = RESET(S_p, S_c)$, matched between RTL_B and Sys_ref with the same scope. Then Sys_ref extends from $\sigma_ref[H]$ by its corresponding reset transition, and $Inv(H \cup \{\gamma_R\})$ holds: (I1) holds because γ_R is matched with the same scope and the only required orders at the boundary are the epoch-boundary orders above; (I2) holds because, for every $P \in S_p$, the P -local replay state after γ_R is the deterministic epoch-initial state prescribed by RW3 — identical in both models by the reset-correspondence obligation — while for $P \notin S_p$ the replay state is unchanged by RW5; RW2 guarantees that no request-attribution fact survives the boundary for S_p , so Lemma I.DR’ applies epoch-locally with γ_R delimiting the P -local projection; and (I3) holds because channels in S_c restart with reset-empty histories per RW1 and A10 — the $occ_c(t)$ definition is already measured from the most recent reset boundary — while channels outside S_c retain their histories by RW5. ■

Subsequent induction steps within the new epoch proceed exactly as in the initial epoch; $START_P$ for $P \in S_p$ is matched as the new epoch’s first ordinary unit. Open dispositions that are not covered by RW1–RW5 — for example, an un-modeled partial reset of one endpoint of a live channel, retention of in-flight messages across the boundary, or cross-epoch request re-attribution — place the design outside Theorem J.1, Corollary J.1, and Appendix K until modeled explicitly.

Additional Semantic Assumptions (B-rules)

The following B rules are process assumptions used within the formal proofs. These B rules are in addition to the R rules presented in Appendix G.

ID	Basic-process property (informal statement)	Why it is needed / how it is used
B1 Deterministic Trace Property	For any fixed test stimulus and initial state, the sequence of observable actions emitted by the post-HLS design is unique, including the channel identity and payload/value of each committed Push_c(v)/Pop_c(v) and the value of each Write(sig,val)/Read(sig,val). Internal ϵ-steps may differ between runs, but the externally visible Σ-trace (with labels) cannot. Clarification: B1 is assumed of RTL_B (post-HLS) only. The source-level models Sys/Sys_B may admit multiple ϵ-/latency-different executions with the same Σ-projection. When a single concrete witness execution of Sys_B is required for simulation/debug, Appendix L's snooping wrapper may be used to select one admissible witness whose latency-sensitive events align with the unique RTL Σ-trace. Derived per-process consequence. For every process P, the projection of the unique RTL_B Σ-trace onto the observable units owned by or attributed to P is also unique. This follows from the system-level B1 property; it does not assert that P is deterministic when considered in isolation under arbitrary peer, channel, arbitration, or environment behavior.	Ensures the per-process and system-level trace-compatibility proofs (App. I & J) can match one post-HLS trace to one pre-HLS trace without branching on scheduler nondeterminism.
B2 Weak Fairness of the Scheduler (WF)	If an action's enabling predicate remains continuously true from cycle t onward, the scheduler/arbiter must eventually select that action, and the selected action then commits in the selected cycle, within a finite but unspecified number of cycles. Applies to Push, Pop, and Sync operations. For message-passing operations, "enabled" means ChannelEnabled under E4 at the	Required for all progress arguments, especially the liveness lemmas in Appendix K and the channel-progress corollaries.

ID	Basic-process property (informal statement)	Why it is needed / how it is used
	chosen abstract boundary. Enablement is eligibility for selection; it is not itself a same-cycle commit. Thus B2 is not vacuous: an enabled Push/Pop may be delayed by fair arbitration, but it may not be delayed forever while it remains continuously enabled.	
B3 Channel Progress Invariants	B3 is exactly the following family of per-channel progress obligations. For every explicit abstract channel c with capacity $B(c)$, B3 consists of both $P_push(c)$ and $P_pop(c)$, as defined below. Thus references such as “B3,” “Appendix N’s B3,” and “the P_push/P_pop obligations” name the same channel-progress assumption; $P_push(c)$ and $P_pop(c)$ are not additional assumptions separate from B3. B3 is stated separately from B2 because the proofs often reason from the perspective of a currently stalled request. A blocked $Push_c$ at $occ_c = B(c)$, a blocked Pop_c at $occ_c = 0$, or a rendezvous endpoint waiting for its peer is not itself able to complete until the relevant complementary discharge occurs. B3 packages that discharge fact as a named per-channel progress obligation: under the persistent-request premises below, the full/empty/rendezvous-blocked condition is eventually discharged, after which ordinary E4 availability and B2 can be used for any still-pending enabled transfer. For a single explicit abstract boundary with ordinary E4 buffered or rendezvous semantics, the corresponding B3 discharge is implied by B2 plus E4 once the complementary endpoint request in the B3 premise remains continuously asserted. In the buffered full case, $occ_c = B(c) > 0$ makes the complementary Pop_c continuously $ChannelEnabled$; B2 then	Explicitly assumed in Appendix J to rule out permanent back-pressure loops in which both endpoints continuously request a transfer until the matching discharge event but that transfer never completes, which are logically independent of the cycle-by-cycle R-rules.

ID	Basic-process property (informal statement)	Why it is needed / how it is used
	forces eventual selection and commit of that Pop_c, freeing space. In the buffered empty case, $occ_c = 0 < B(c)$ makes the complementary Push_c continuously ChannelEnabled; B2 then forces eventual selection and commit of that Push_c, providing data. In the rendezvous case, the two persistent endpoint requests make the rendezvous pair continuously ChannelEnabled, so B2 similarly supplies eventual rendezvous selection and commit. B3 is nevertheless retained as an explicit named obligation because Lemma I.2, Appendix K, and the channel-validation methodology consume that modular form directly. It is also the form checked per explicit abstract channel in elaborated Sys_B^{elab} boundary chains. Thus B3 should be read as the modular channel-progress assumption used by the proof and checked against channel realizations, not as a claim that the ordinary single-boundary buffered clauses are logically independent of B2+E4. In the definitions below, “persistent,” “continuously requests,” and “remains true” are interval-scoped. The relevant endpoint request must remain asserted from the starting cycle t_0 through the first matching discharge event, if such a discharge occurs. If no matching discharge occurs, the request must remain asserted for all later cycles. A Push request also keeps its payload stable throughout the outstanding interval. B3 does not require an endpoint request or Push payload to remain asserted forever after the matching transfer has already committed. • $P_push(c)$: If a process P is stalled at a blocking $Push(c)$ with its boundary request true and a persistent request asserted with stable payload while the channel is full ($occ(c) = B(c)$), and the complementary endpoint	

ID	Basic-process property (informal statement)	Why it is needed / how it is used
	process continuously requests the matching Pop_c until the matching discharge event (Pop_c endpoint request asserted; Pop_c boundary request remains true), then the transfer on c must eventually complete. In particular, for $B(c) > 0$, some Pop_c eventually commits, freeing space; for $B(c) = 0$, the rendezvous completion eventually occurs. • $P_{\text{pop}}(c)$: If a process P is stalled at a blocking Pop_c with its boundary request true and a persistent request asserted while the channel is empty ($\text{occ}_c = 0$), and the complementary endpoint process continuously requests the matching Push_c until the matching discharge event (Push_c endpoint request asserted with stable payload; Push_c boundary request remains true), then the transfer on c must eventually complete. In particular, for $B(c) > 0$, some Push_c eventually commits, providing data; for $B(c) = 0$, the rendezvous completion eventually occurs.	
B4 Finite Stutter Bound	Every process P has a finite constant depth D_P such that whenever P is not externally stalled (i.e., P is advancing internal micro-state toward its next observable Σ -action, or its next Σ -action is locally enabled), P can execute at most D_P consecutive ϵ -steps before either (i) executing a Σ -action, or (ii) reaching a stable waiting state in which P has no further ϵ -step available until some external/peer/environment condition changes the enabling predicates.	This guarantees the ϵ -stutter closure needed to construct witness mappings in Appendix I and to bound internal micro-latency (pipeline/FSM bookkeeping) by $\leq D_P$. Unbounded waiting due to back-pressure or missing peer stimulus is governed by WF/B2 and the progress obligations B3, not by B4.
B5 System Quiescence Closure	If, at some cycle t_0 , no observable actions are enabled in any process, and no external or environmental change from t_0 through the closure interval changes the relevant enabling predicates, then within at most $\max_P D_P$ further cycles the system reaches an ϵ -fixed point. Thereafter, while no external or environmental change re-enables observable or internal work, the system executes no additional ϵ -steps.	Needed to finish the starvation-vs-deadlock analysis in Appendix K: ensures an all-disabled state cannot hide behind an infinite tail of unobservable activity.

ID	Basic-process property (informal statement)	Why it is needed / how it is used
B6 Time-Divergence / Idle-Stutter Convention	After the fixed point of B5 is reached — that is, after the system is ϵ -quiescent, no Σ -visible action is enabled, and no further internal ϵ micro-step is enabled under the same stimulus — the global clock continues to advance. We model each subsequent idle clock tick as a stutter step that produces no Σ -event, performs no ϵ -prefix or ϵ -suffix work, and leaves all non-clock state unchanged.	For prefix/trace matching in E1–E5 and for the Exec_post / Exec_ref conventions in Appendix J, these idle ticks are treated as ϵ-stutter. Thus B6 gives a time-divergent infinite extension for any reachable finite execution prefix/state that is already at a B5/global fixed point. B6 is not, by itself, an arbitrary deadlock-cutpoint extension principle. In particular, a partial internal message-passing deadlock cutpoint in Appendix K need not be a global fixed point, because outside-D activity, environment activity, or already-issued non-frontier drain work may still be possible. Such cutpoints are handled by the separate Appendix K fair drain-normalization argument: enabled drain-only transfers may commit as finite drain-only progress under the B2/B3 progress assumptions, while pure idle-stutter is used only once the relevant disabled frontier blockers and drain-closed closed component are preserved in the required execution-scoped continuation.

Side-condition discharge record

Before applying Theorem J.1, Corollary J.1 cutpoint transfer, or the Appendix K liveness-preservation theorem to a concrete design, the verification flow shall maintain an explicit side-condition discharge record. The record need not use one physical file, but every referenced artifact shall be versioned and bound to one selected theorem instance through the common certificate header of Definition K.CertHdr. For each theorem premise identified below, the record shall state whether the premise is inapplicable to the selected theorem scope, satisfied by a simple syntactic/design restriction, discharged by tool/RTL evidence, or discharged by a source/RTL witness construction. A condition required by the selected theorem scope may not be marked inapplicable. The named audit entries are K.CertPkg certificate-package integrity; WC; J.LocalGWR local witness-construction certificates (or optional J.GWR-Direct); Sys_B^elab; B-faithfulness; J.OfferReach residual-offer realizability; J.OfferConf residual-offer boundary conformance; the composite J.KObsConf KObs cutpoint-conformance wrapper; J.Mem shared-memory lowering; J.FE fair extension / environment receptiveness; RW reset well-formedness (RW1-RW5, when dynamic reset is used); K.Drain; K ϵ ; SDet deterministic selected Policy-S simulator; A5-S selected-instance serial liveness; A5-L scheduler-robust liberal liveness; K.CV value determinism; NB-Align witness-selected non-blocking alignment; and L.Dir one-directional alignment / RTL-side non-

interference (required whenever Appendix L snooping / co-simulation is used), as applicable to the selected theorem scope.

K.CertPkg — certificate identity, schema, and trust boundary.

Trigger: Required whenever a generated or manually assembled certificate package is used to discharge Corollary J.1, Theorem K.1A/K.1, A5-S/A5-L, or CF-1 through CF-5.

Discharge: Provide the common K.CertHdr fields: certificate-schema and document/theorem version; a digest or unambiguous identifier for the selected source, Sys_ref/Sys_K, and RTL artifact; E, B_E, explicit boundaries, projections, ownership, and K.Low lowering where applicable; fixed stimulus, environment, reset policy, witness w, and WC provenance; KObs-facing waiver set W and closure evidence; the selected A5-L discharge route; and, for the Policy-S route, the concrete deterministic simulator/scheduler, deterministic arbitration, Policy-S issue semantics, ϵ -normalization identity, SDet evidence, K.Resp monitor schema, finite bounds, cancellation/end-of-test disposition, response waivers, and coverage-preservation evidence; plus the theorem scope, side-condition references, generator/checker versions, and declared trusted base. Every subordinate KObs or A5 certificate shall cite the same header identity.

Derived K-facing predicates and K.Resp outcomes shall be recomputed by the checker from their respective artifacts rather than accepted as authoritative fields.

Evidence examples: A signed or hashed manifest binding source, RTL, elaboration, witness, run/monitor evidence, and proof files; a tool-generated certificate bundle with an independently validated schema; or an equivalent reviewable instance record.

- WC — witness-compatible ϵ choices / non-blocking outcomes.

Trigger: Required when failed non-blocking polls or other ϵ -modeled choices can affect later Σ -visible control flow, frontier membership, request attribution, guard values, payload values, or other later Σ -visible choices.

Discharge: Provide evidence that proves the actual WC premise used by Appendices I–J. The audit entry shall identify the provenance route by which WC was established:

- NB-CF route: show that failed PushNB/PopNB outcomes do not affect later Σ -visible control flow, frontier membership, request attribution, guard values, payload values, or other later Σ -visible choices. Under this route, the failed-poll witness may be the identity or arbitrary selector, subject to the applicable latency-sensitive local-protocol conditions.
- Appendix L snooping route: provide a witness selector W satisfying Lemma L.2. Show that the snooped outcomes cover every ϵ -modeled source choice that can affect later Σ -visible behavior, that the wrapper changes only ϵ -choice selection, and that it does not add, remove, reorder, or relabel Σ -visible events.
- Direct witness-construction route: otherwise construct and prove the μ_Q / WC witness used by Appendix I/J.
- Mixed per-site route: partition the relevant non-blocking or ϵ -choice sites among the applicable NB-CF, snooping, or direct-construction routes, and show that the partition covers every relevant site.

NB-CF and Appendix L snooping are therefore provenance routes for proving WC, not separate theorem premises that replace WC. When useful for review or automation, the WC audit entry may include optional per-site metadata identifying each relevant call site or ϵ -choice site, its selected provenance route, and the corresponding source restriction, tool/RTL evidence, wrapper evidence, or witness construction.

Evidence examples: Source inspection or a static control/dataflow check establishing NB-CF; a generated WC witness or certificate; a wrapper proof or monitor specification satisfying Lemma L.2; a co-simulation/snooping harness, subject to the L.Dir entry below; or a complete per-site coverage report for a mixed discharge.

- **Sys_B^{elab}** — elaborated source reference model.
 Trigger: Required when ordinary Sys_B capacities at the outer abstract boundaries are not sufficient to represent the RTL realization as ordinary E4 bounded-FIFO/rendezvous behavior; examples include multi-input/join couplers, staged/bundle/join channels, and sync-boundary / epoch-gate capacity withdrawal.
 Discharge: Provide a well-formed elaboration package E defining the explicit abstract channels, capacities, projection Π_{elab} , and E4 ChannelEnabled/ChannelDisabled behavior used by Sys_B^{elab}(E).
 Evidence examples: Tool-generated elaboration, structural back-annotation report, Appendix Q-style construction, or manual elaboration justified against the RTL channel structure.
- **B-faithfulness** — faithfulness of each back-annotated capacity B(c) and chosen explicit abstract channel boundary.
 Trigger: Required for every back-annotated explicit abstract channel c whose B(c), occupancy $occ_c(t)$, E4 ChannelEnabled/ChannelDisabled behavior, BoundaryReq facts, or Appendix K blocking/WFG behavior is used by the selected theorem instance. For such a channel, B-faithfulness is a required per-channel obligation and shall not be marked inapplicable.
 Discharge: Show all of the following for the chosen abstract boundary of c:
 Boundary completeness — every Σ -visible transfer of c in RTL_B crosses the chosen abstract boundary as the corresponding committed Push_c or Pop_c, with no hidden side entrance or exit.
 Exact boundary behavior — for every relevant execution state and boundary action, the concrete realization permits the action exactly when the E4 abstract channel permits it. In particular, realized unpoped occupancy is bounded by B(c), and the realization contains no hidden storage or credit beyond the capacity represented by B(c).
 No hidden enablement or disablement — no unmodeled grant, arbitration, throttling, or backpressure condition changes whether a boundary action is permitted. Any such condition that affects boundary behavior shall instead be represented by explicit Sys_B^{elab} boundary structure.
 ϵ -opacity of internal movement — movement of data within the realized channel between chosen boundary commits is internal ϵ -behavior and creates no additional Σ -visible Push/Pop event or Appendix K WFG blocking cause.
 Evidence examples: A trusted back-annotation algorithm; a per-channel capacity and boundary certificate; a structural RTL check; an RTL/interface monitor; a formal refinement check comparing the realized boundary behavior with E4; or equivalent tool/RTL-flow evidence establishing the complete B-faithfulness obligation.
- **J.OfferReach / J.OfferConf / J.KObsConf** — KObs cutpoint correspondence.
 Trigger: Required whenever Corollary J.1 cutpoint correspondence is used, and therefore required for Appendix K / Appendix R uses that transfer Pending_P, BoundaryReq, rendezvous endpoint-request, ChannelEnabled/ChannelDisabled, Front_P, WFG, or derived deadlock facts between RTL_B and Sys_ref. The evidence shall be packaged as, or mapped unambiguously onto, the CF-0 KObs cutpoint certificate of K.4e.
 J.OfferReach discharge: For the same selected Theorem J.1 source witness, witness w, and ϵ -normalization used by the application, exhibit H and O and show that the selected reachable ϵ -

quiescent Sys_ref cutpoint σ_ref satisfies $H = H_E, w(\sigma_ref)$ and $O = \text{ResOffers_E}, w(\sigma_ref)$, with all operational Issue/Commit, E3/E5, reset-epoch, elaboration, and source-transition rules respected. This is an image/realizability obligation; well-typedness of $\langle E, w, H, O \rangle$ alone is insufficient. The complete Issue history may remain in the referenced source witness rather than being duplicated in the CF-0 record.

J.HCanon discharge: Establish the hypotheses of Lemma J.HCanon for the selected source/RTL annotated prefixes and fixed theorem-produced or directly validated J.GWR package; record that both prefixes produce the same canonical enriched replay-history quotient H .

J.OfferConf discharge: At the selected ϵ -quiescent RTL_B cutpoint ρ_post , enumerate every KObs-relevant asserted endpoint-owned request at the explicit boundaries of E and prove bidirectional, unique attribution between that physical request set and O using the operational-attribution component produced by J.GWR-Comp (or supplied by J.GWR-Direct), Appendix C, and I.A0. Record the physical $\text{RelevantReqSet_E}(\rho_post)$, $\text{ReqProjection_E}(O)$, their equality, request-to-offer completeness, no-hidden-request, boundary completeness, issued-summary prefix closure, reset-epoch typing, and endpoint cardinality. A monitor or certificate that reports only requests it can already attribute is insufficient unless it separately proves that no other KObs-relevant asserted request exists.

J.KObsConf discharge: For that same selected tuple $(\rho_post, \tau_ref, \sigma_ref, E, w, H, O)$, additionally establish B-faithful/E4 interpretation at every explicit boundary, reset alignment, and ϵ -opacity of normalization. J.KObsConf is the composite application wrapper; it no longer requires independent proof of a broad source-value/frontier/channel/enableness slice, because those facts are reconstructed from equal KObs by Lemmas R.21b-R.21e.

Audit priority: J.OfferConf is the authoritative RTL request-abstraction boundary. Its completeness and no-hidden-request directions shall receive the same explicit review and certificate coverage previously assigned to the request/pending clauses of the broad J.KObsConf relation.

Evidence examples: A CF-0 tool-generated paired KObs/cutpoint certificate; a source execution log proving OfferReach; an RTL/interface request-attribution monitor plus boundary-completeness proof proving OfferConf; structural back-annotation and B-faithfulness evidence; a co-simulation witness log; a bounded proof over generated RTL; or an equivalent combined certificate.

- K.Drain — drain-only blocked-frontier discipline. Trigger: Required for Appendix K whenever the selected liberal Sys_ref or RTL_B execution may have source-later same-interval blocking work already issued while an earlier minimal blocking frontier remains uncommitted. This includes pipelined-loop overlap, other explicitly modeled eager/overlapped issue under Policy L, and ordinary non-overlapped control when Lemma K.2b or drain normalization relies on the absence of newly launched work past the blocked point. Discharge: Show the full Definition R.16 discipline: blocked-frontier identification, no new later work, no request withdrawal, drain-only downstream progress, finite explicit boundary storage/credit, and any required sync-boundary capacity withdrawal in $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$. Ordinary source operations on distinct interfaces remain source-ordered; any multi-frontier behavior used by Appendix K must be represented by explicit source/elaboration structure rather than by implicit incomparability. Under Definition R.LAdm this discipline is part of Appendix K admissibility once its settled-frontier trigger occurs; it is not part of the basic Policy-L issue rule before that trigger.

- $K\epsilon$ — WFG-inert ϵ / no hidden micro-timing control decisions.

Trigger: Required for Appendix K liveness/deadlock preservation when ϵ -steps occur between Σ -visible cutpoints.

Discharge: Show that ϵ -only steps do not create, remove, or redirect the relevant Appendix K

WFG blocking causes except through the explicit Σ -visible or E4-modeled channel state already represented in Sys_ref.

Evidence examples: RTL structural argument, scheduler proof, bounded pipeline/drain argument, formal check over the WFG abstraction, or tool certificate.

- **SDet** — deterministic selected Policy-S simulator. Trigger: Required for K.2b, K.2c, K.1, K.PSF-1, or CF-S. After fixing Sys_K, capacities/elaboration, initial/reset state, stimulus, environment function, witness-selected ϵ outcomes, deterministic arbitration, concrete SystemC/pre-HLS scheduling, Policy-S issue semantics, and ϵ -normalization, SDet defines a functional Policy-S next-state semantics and selects one run artifact p_S^{det} . For every finite or infinite run artifact p generated from the same initial state under exactly those selected semantics, the committed histories of p and p_S^{det} are prefix-comparable modulo finite WFG-inert ϵ -stutter; equivalently, the selected semantics generate no second incompatible committed history. A finite artifact may therefore be a proper prefix of p_S^{det} without contradicting SDet. WC and deterministic replay give reproducibility relative to the selected history; SDet is the separate global premise fixing every remaining history-affecting choice. Changing any such choice creates a different theorem instance. Discharge by a simulator-semantics proof, deterministic qualification, schedule/arbitration certificate, or mechanized functional-determinism and history-comparability theorem. SDet does not assert that p_S^{det} is maximal, fair, complete, or bounded-response clean. Those facts are separate K.CompleteS and A5-S/CF-S obligations.
- **A5** — primary selected-instance Policy-S bounded-response discharge (A5-S). Trigger: Required whenever Theorem K.1 is invoked; Theorem K.1A instead consumes A5-L. A5-S is a property of the execution p_S^{det} selected by SDet for the selected normalized instance Sys_K, including capacities, elaboration, fixed stimulus, witness choices, deterministic simulator/scheduler and arbitration semantics, environment/reset contracts, K.Low lowering, and the K.Resp configuration. It combines three obligations for that exact run: (1) K.CompleteS evidence establishing maximality, fairness, and completeness; (2) K.RespCov evidence giving a proof disposition for every dynamically reachable instance of every internal process-facing blocking site, together with finite bounds and waiver-preservation, while environment-facing sites are handled by the separate StandardEnv/monitor/exclusion rule; and (3) K.RespClean evidence proving that the complete run contains no non-waived timeout, maximal-finite pending frontier, or pending-frontier cancellation/reset/end-of-test event. Discharge: Supply CF-S identifying p_S^{det} and carrying all three obligations. A finite prefix of a nonterminating execution is supporting evidence only unless accompanied by a complete invariant, model-checking, recurrence/lasso, or equivalent argument that all monitor ages remain bounded. K.Resp evidence is source-side A5-L-discharge evidence; it does not establish an RTL response-time bound.
- **A5-L** — scheduler-robust liberal source liveness. Statement: No finite Policy-L prefix admissible under Definition R.LAdm for the selected Sys_ref instance reaches an ϵ -quiescent cutpoint containing a non-waived internal K.1 deadlock. A5-L is consumed by Theorem K.1A. Discharge: Primarily by an SDet-qualified CF-S certificate and Corollary K.2c showing that A5-S holds for the SDet-selected Policy-S execution; alternatively by K.Str-1/K.Str-2/K.Str-3, direct Policy-L verification, an inductive invariant, exploration, or CF-5. The Policy-S package records the selected normalized instance, capacities, elaboration, lowering, witness, stimulus, environment/reset model, concrete simulator/scheduler, arbitration, Policy-S issue semantics, normalization identity, SDet evidence, K.CompleteS, K.RespCov, K.RespClean, response bounds, monitor waivers, and the trust boundary.
- **K.CV** — design-level value determinism. Trigger: Required for Lemma K.2b, Corollary K.2c, and Theorem K.1 whenever a process can

branch on, compute payloads from, or select later operations based on cross-process observations beyond blocking Pop values — anchored signal reads, direct-input(-sync) reads, shared/external-memory reads through the array-access mapping layer, emitted R2C fixed-point observation units, or synchronization outcomes.

Discharge: Show that every such dependency is carried by an explicitly modeled causal mechanism and that the observed value is a deterministic function of the causal history feeding that mechanism, not of incidental schedule timing — i.e., the design satisfies the causal-dependency well-formedness rule with RULE 1 / RULE 2 anchored signal IO, proper handshakes or direct-input contracts on cross-process signals, mapping-layer discipline on shared memories, and R2C well-formedness; latency-sensitive sites are isolated or witness-aligned per Appendices D and L.

Evidence examples: Source inspection or lint establishing RULE 1 / RULE 2 and handshake conformance; a coverage-justified Appendix L latency-robustness stress-testing result, a refinement argument; an Appendix D isolation argument; or a causal-dependency review showing no reliance on the ordering of causally independent events. Randomized stress testing by itself is supporting evidence, not a complete K.CV discharge, unless accompanied by a coverage/refinement argument showing that the tested executions cover the relevant value/control-dependence cases. This K.CV evidence is necessary but not sufficient for the separate NB-Align condition (next entry), which is discharged independently.

- NB-Align — witness-selected non-blocking alignment. Statement: NB-Align is the scope restriction stated normatively in the Lemma K.2b Statement (Appendix K), which is its authoritative wording: every witness-selected non-NB-CF non-blocking site that can participate in a potential wait cycle must satisfy the Appendix L alignment conditions that convert its selected outcome dependency into an explicitly modeled message/synchronization obstruction. NB-Align is consumed as the applicability condition of the Definition K.Low witness-indexed blocking lowering: an aligned site is lowered to a blocking guard on an explicit point-to-point supplier channel, and a witness schedule containing a non-aligned such site admits no lowering and is outside the Lemma K.2b / Corollary K.2c / Theorem K.1 scope. Theorem K.1A does not consume NB-Align. Trigger: Required whenever Lemma K.2b or Corollary K.2c is invoked (including through Theorem K.1) and the design contains witness-selected non-blocking outcomes that are not NB-CF. Discharge: Show that each witness-selected non-blocking site is NB-CF, is Appendix L-aligned (so that Definition K.Low applies to it), or is structurally excluded from every potential wait cycle of the selected instance. Evidence examples: An NB-CF classification per Appendix L; a per-site Appendix L alignment argument identifying the modeled supplier used by the Definition K.Low guard channel; or a structural argument that no witness-selected site can participate in a wait cycle of the selected instance. NB-Align is distinct from, and not implied by, K.CV.
- K.Low — witness-indexed blocking lowering and cutpoint correspondence. Trigger: Required whenever the serial-reduction route (Lemma K.2b / Corollary K.2c / Theorem K.1) is applied to a design containing explicit synchronization waits or NB-Aligned witness-selected non-blocking sites in potential wait cycles. Discharge: Exhibit the lowered instance $\Lambda_W(\text{Sys_ref})$ of Definition K.Low — epoch-gate representation of synchronization per Definition R.16 clause (7), and a blocking guard channel per aligned site with its modeled supplier as unique producer — and discharge the Lemma K.Low.C correspondence obligations (i)–(iii) for the lowering rules used. The A5 / A5-L premises and the Policy-S check are then evaluated on the lowered instance. Evidence examples: The elaboration record for $\Lambda_W(\text{Sys_ref})$; per-site guard-channel construction tied to the Appendix L alignment; a mechanized or reviewed K.Low.C case proof

per lowering rule. Guard channels carry the corrected default $B(g_s) = 1$ skewed timing, or a declared atomic rendezvous variant, under Definition K.Low.

- K.Resp — validated process-facing bounded-response coverage. Trigger: Required for Lemma K.2b, Corollary K.2c, Theorem K.1, K.PSF-1, and CF-S. K.RespCov is default-total over the selected instance: every dynamically reachable instance of every internal process-facing blocking site shall have one checkable proof disposition, without first requiring the user or checker to decide whether that site can become the blocker produced by Lemma K.2b.Q. A disposition is: (a) a monitor with an unambiguous trigger at the first normalized cycle in which the source operation is the active minimal pending frontier and its persistent boundary request is established, the process-facing commit/return as response, a finite Policy-S-cycle bound, and reset/cancellation/end-of-test handling; (b) a validated static bounded-response proof for that dynamic class; or (c) a proof that the site or dynamic class is unreachable in the selected instance. A production-count argument alone is not an exemption, because the complementary owner may itself be blocked. Under StandardEnv, a source-earlier environment interaction that committed in the liberal witness may be proved incapable of remaining the serial blocker by replay availability and fairness; every other environment-facing site requires monitoring, a specific availability/no-bypass proof, or exclusion from the serial route. K.RespFail is a finite event: bound expiration without response; a maximal finite selected run with the frontier still pending; or reset/cancellation/end-of-test while pending unless that dynamic class is explicitly waived. K.RespClean proves absence of non-waived K.RespFail over the complete p_S^{det} . A successful complete-run proof may use any finite bound; a bound violation under an unproved design-latency bound makes that certificate attempt inconclusive rather than proving a design bug.
- K.EnvOrd / K.Done — optional diagnostic starvation classification. These conditions are no longer part of the soundness-critical Policy-S discharge and cannot substitute for K.RespCov/K.RespClean. They may be used to classify a reported K.RespFail through the historical WFG+/EnvStop/DoneStop owner-walk machinery or to simplify diagnostic reporting from Dead_KS to Dead_K. K.EnvOrd builds the finite may-follow starvation cone and proves the corresponding dynamic no-bypass property. K.Done audits normal completion sufficiently to eliminate DoneStop terminals; the alternative that every process is perpetual eliminates normal completion only and says nothing about live endpoint under-supply. In particular, neither K.Done nor process perpetuity permits omission of a K.Resp monitor. The K.CE-2/K.CE-3/K.CE-4 and H2 examples remain useful diagnostics, but no Corollary K.2c conclusion depends on completeness of this terminal taxonomy.
- W.Env — environment-rescue and response-monitor waiver. Trigger: Optional; used only for a specifically declared cutpoint or dynamic monitor class whose environment/reset/end-of-test behavior is intentional and proved compatible with the theorem scope. For KObs predicates, record the component class, rescuing item, environment contract, and KObs-closure justification. For K.Resp, record the exact dynamic frontier class, the reason timeout/cancellation is permitted, and a coverage-preservation proof that a non-waived Policy-L deadlock component cannot map only to waived serial monitors. A broad end-of-test or reset waiver is insufficient. Waivers are removed explicitly from Dead_K^W and optional diagnostic Dead_KS^W, and from K.RespFail^W, and propagate to Theorems K.1A/K.1. A waiver depending on hidden issue timing or unconstrained future behavior must carry the corresponding operational proof; a label alone does not discharge the obligation.
- L.Dir — one-directional alignment / RTL-side non-interference. Statement: L.Dir is the scope restriction stated normatively in Condition L.Dir (Appendix L), which is its authoritative wording: the source-side snoop sequence selected by W is exactly an

ordinal-preserving consumption of the free-running RTL_B snoop sequence at the chosen boundary — each pre-HLS-side snoop commit consumes the next recorded RTL_B event of the same snoop point with matching kind and payload, no pre-HLS-side snoop commit occurs without such a next recorded RTL_B event, every recorded RTL_B snoop event within the compared run is eventually consumed or reported outstanding per the Requirement W4 bound, and no RTL_B-side signal or event is gated, delayed, or modified. Benign cycle skew is permitted; only order, kind, or payload divergence — non-existence of the WC witness at the chosen boundary — violates the condition. A run violating L.Dir is outside the Appendix I–K theorem scope for that comparison and carries no theorem-backed guarantee.

Trigger: Required whenever WC is discharged through an Appendix L snooping / witness-selector co-simulation harness (Lemma L.2 / Lemma L.5).

Discharge: Provide a per-run monitor per Lemma L.5(iv) — realized by a wrapper conforming to the Appendix L Wrapper Realization Requirements W1–W5 — that aborts loudly on violation, together with the run’s clean-monitor result and a statement of whether the Requirement W4 watchdog bound is proved sufficient for the selected instance (bound-exceeded aborts under an unproved bound are inconclusive witness-realization failures, not proven violations); or a static/structural argument — for example, latency back-annotation or delay padding of the pre-HLS model, or latency-interval analysis at each snoop point in the spirit of the simplified snooping approaches — showing that the post-HLS side cannot run ahead in event order; or a model-checking proof that order divergence is unreachable for the selected instance.

Evidence examples: A harness monitor log showing no L.Dir abort, with cycle-skew statistics reported separately as diagnostics; a static latency analysis at the simplified-snooping end of the Appendix L spectrum; or a wrapper certification against Lemma L.2 together with a watchdog configuration that converts witness non-existence into a reported failure rather than a hang. L.Dir violations are triaged per the Snooping Concerns section of Appendix L: the pre-HLS model is the default suspect in a certified-harness, trusted-tool flow, but harness incompleteness and tool non-compliance must not be excluded a priori.

- J.LocalGWR — local certificates for the compositional J.GWR construction.

Trigger: Required whenever Theorem J.1’s normal Post $\rightarrow$ Ref route, Corollary J.1, Theorem R.21, or any result consuming their witnesses is applied, unless the optional J.GWR-Direct route below is used.

Discharge: For each compared RTL_B prefix, provide the package of Definition J.LocalGWR. The package shall cover every process with J.PCert; every explicit abstract channel with J.CCert and B-faithfulness; every rendezvous, paired synchronization, R2C, anchored synchronization/signal, RESET, and other explicitly atomic unit with J.ACet; and the applicable J.EnvCert and J.ResetCert obligations. It shall also provide the finite typed construction-action inventory, per-action ReadSet/WriteSet, ownership facts, and locally derived epoch/horizon/stage/ordinal metadata for J.FoundationRank, request-snapshot keys for every witness-significant non-blocking call, the locally generated Dep_J edges required by Definition J.DepJ, and J.LocalAgree for every duplicated endpoint, identity, payload, reset-epoch, request-attribution, boundary, footprint, and snapshot field. The package shall prove complete coverage and the premises needed for the case-by-case J.DepRank proof: every relevant process, explicit boundary, construction action, non-blocking decision, and atomic unit in the selected prefix is represented exactly once or by a uniquely identified shared record. J.CanonicalRank is reconstructed from the checked dependency graph and is not a separately supplied certificate field.

The discharge may not contain a renamed global realizability premise. In particular, it may not assume that the local certificates admit a realizable merge, that an arbitrary phase/rank already gives a legal replay order, that the next complete unit has a global extension, or that a matching

Sys_ref execution already exists. Dependency edges must arise only from the enumerated local rules of Definition J.DepJ, and non-commuting action pairs must be covered by Lemma J.DepComplete or by a component-local footprint/commutation certificate. Global well-foundedness, coexistence, and extension are conclusions of Lemma J.DepRank, Lemma J.DepAcyclic, J.PrepareCommute, J.UnitExt, and Theorem J.GWR-Comp.

Evidence examples: per-process schedule/replay scripts with typed action footprints; per-channel boundary, occupancy, same-cycle transfer, and request-snapshot certificates; static or generated atomic-unit identity records; locally justified Dep_J edge records; source/RTL structural checks; component-local footprint/commutation certificates for custom Sys_B^elab elements; a translation-validation package whose individual records map to J.PCert/J.CCcert/J.ACcert; or equivalent independently checkable evidence.

J.GWR-Direct — optional direct global witness-realizability route.

Trigger: Optional alternate route when a flow does not use J.LocalGWR/J.GWR-Comp for a selected prefix.

Discharge: Supply a directly validated package satisfying Definition J.GWR, including the complete reachable Sys_ref witness chain, all operational annotations, and a direct-provenance J.ValidatedConstructionOrder with an independently checked well-founded predecessor relation, complete unit enumeration, required-order refinement, operational-prerequisite coverage, and ideal-prefix proofs. This route may be implemented by translation validation, bounded symbolic replay, a validated global trace certificate, or a previously proved tool-specific theorem. It is not required when J.LocalGWR and Theorem J.GWR-Comp are used, and it may not cite the theorem-derived J.CanonicalRank without also supplying the corresponding LocalGWR package.

Historical Issue timestamps may remain inside either route's operational witness evidence, but they are not fields of KObs and are not independently compared across cutpoints.

- J.Mem — shared-memory lowering.

Trigger: Required whenever the compared design contains a cross-process shared-memory dependency that can affect control flow, payloads, or operation identity/order.

Discharge: Show every such dependency is lowered by the array-access mapping layer onto covered IO operations (explicit point-to-point E4 channels and/or Σ -visible anchored signal IO), or supply the memory-state invariant extension described in the informative note in Common Formal Definitions.

Evidence examples: use of pre-verified shared-memory library classes presenting channel/signal boundaries; mapping-layer configuration review; structural check that no un-lowered cross-process array access exists.

- J.FE — fair extension / environment receptiveness.

Trigger: Required whenever an infinite fair execution is asserted to contain a given finite reachable prefix (Appendix I.5; the embedding step of Theorem K.1).

Discharge: Show the fixed stimulus/environment is receptive — defined on every reachable Σ -causal history — so that Lemma J.FE applies; or discharge the required embedding directly for the flow.

Evidence examples: testbench review showing input-enabled/receptive behavior; environment model with a total transition relation; direct construction of the continuation.

- RW — reset well-formedness (RW1–RW5).

Trigger: Required whenever dynamic reset can occur in the compared executions.

Discharge: Show every dynamic reset occurrence satisfies RW1–RW5 so that Lemma J.RS (MatchedResetEpochSplice) applies at each RESET boundary unit.

Evidence examples: reset-tree/scope review; RTL check that both endpoints of each live channel

reset together or that an explicit modeled flush/abort protocol is used; confirmation that outstanding requests clear and affected channels re-initialize reset-empty.

This record is not an additional semantic assumption beyond the named premises already used in Appendices I–K. It makes the required discharge of WC, J.LocalGWR (or J.GWR-Direct), elaboration, B-faithfulness, J.OfferReach, J.OfferConf, J.KObsConf, J.Mem, J.FE, RW, K.Drain, K ϵ , SDet, A5-L, and the selected A5-L discharge route—including K.CompleteS, K.RespCov, and K.RespClean when the deterministic Policy-S route is used—and K.CV explicit for the selected theorem scope.

Appendix I – Per-Process Replay and Preparation Proof

I.1 Overview

This appendix establishes the process-local replay and preparation results used by Appendix J. Under a fixed initial state, fixed external stimulus/environment behavior, and WC-compatible witness, a selected RTL_B observable-unit prefix determines the corresponding source-local replay state for each process and a finite process-owned ϵ preparation path to the exact dynamic operation participating in the next selected unit. Appendix I does not by itself commit a channel transfer, pair rendezvous or synchronization endpoints, or construct a complete global Sys_ref execution; those composition steps are proved in Appendix J by Lemmas J.Frame–J.UnitExt and Theorem J.GWR-Comp.

Downstream citation discipline. Later appendices may cite Appendix I for Implementation assumption I.A0; Lemmas I.1, I.Obs-Congruence, I.DR, I.DR', and I.3; and the process-local certificate obligations later packaged as J.PCert. Appendix I does not justify an unrestricted per-process or system-level existence theorem in isolation. A complete matching Sys_ref prefix is obtained only after Appendix J combines the process-local paths with the common explicit-channel state, endpoint co-presence, atomic grouping, environment/reset evidence, and interface agreement. The converse direction likewise remains restricted to RTLConsistentRefPrefix / Appendix L witness-selected executions.

I.2 Formal Preconditions

- **Observable alphabet** Σ is as defined in *Common Formal Definitions for Appendices I–K*: it consists of the event schemas {Push_c, Pop_c, Sync, wait, START_P, FINISH_P, Write, Read} instantiated only for channels/signals designated observable at the chosen proof boundary. For Appendices I–K, Σ is the proof-internal observable alphabet of the prescribed Sys_ref / RTL_B comparison. Thus all message-passing channels that can participate in Appendix K deadlock reasoning are designated observable at that proof boundary and hence included in Σ . In elaborated cases Sys_ref = Sys_B^elab, this proof-internal Σ may include introduced staged/bundle/join channels even when the projection Π_{elab} hides those internal events from the outer DUT/testbench-visible alphabet Σ_{DUT} . Such events are therefore Σ -visible for the proof-internal comparison, but may be projected away from the outer observation boundary.
- **Non-blocking message-passing interpretation.** In both RTL_B and Sys_ref, a non-blocking call (PushNB / PopNB) is treated as a poll. A successful poll contributes the same observable event as the corresponding committed Push_c / Pop_c on that channel. An unsuccessful non-blocking call (returns “false” / “not completed”) contributes no Σ -event and is modeled as an ϵ -step. A non-blocking poll may still assert a Σ -visible endpoint request in the cycle of that call. However, each executed non-blocking call is a distinct dynamic source-level instance $q \in Q_{\text{exec},P}$ for its owning process P. Accordingly, continuous assertion of an endpoint request with no intervening commit does not by itself collapse later executed non-blocking call instances into an earlier q. Only a poll that succeeds contributes the corresponding committed transfer $m(q) \in M$ for that

call instance. If a request assertion persists without a new executed source-level call instance being entered, its attribution remains with that same currently outstanding q ; but repeated non-blocking polls in later loop iterations or later source-level call instances create additional $q \in Q_{\text{exec},P}$ even if req does not deassert.

- **Silent step** Any internal RTL microstate transition is written ϵ . In particular, unsuccessful non-blocking polls, arbitration bookkeeping, and pipeline advances are ϵ -steps.
- **Finite-pipeline-depth premise (FPD)** There exists a finite constant $\text{pipe_depth}(P) = D_P < \infty$ such that once P begins internal micro-progress toward its next observable Σ -action (or that next Σ -action is locally enabled), P executes at most D_P cycles of ϵ -steps before either committing a Σ -action or reaching a stable waiting state with no further ϵ -step available until external/peer conditions change. In particular, a process cannot perform an unbounded number of ϵ -only failed non-blocking polls while making no progress toward any Σ -action; designs that can spin indefinitely without reaching either a Σ -action or a stable wait state violate FPD/B4 and are outside the model.
- **Weak-fairness premise (WF)** If a micro-operation remains continuously enabled, the scheduler eventually selects it for progress. For an already-issued blocking message request whose BoundaryReq is asserted and whose ChannelEnabled predicate remains true, this means the enabled transfer is eventually allowed to commit; it does not mean that the same source-level operation is “issued” again. This is an assumption on the execution/scheduling environment (see Appendix N), not an automatic guarantee of “clock-synchronous RTL.” In practice it requires that any arbiters/back-pressure logic that can affect whether an enabled operation is selected or allowed to commit must be fair in the sense of B2/B3.
- **Finite-progress invariants (B3)** For every channel c , assume producer and consumer obligations $P_{\text{push}}(c)$ and $P_{\text{pop}}(c)$ hold, guaranteeing that data (or space) eventually becomes available. This is an assumption on the execution/scheduling environment (e.g., fairness of arbiters/back-pressure; see Appendix N), not a consequence of the cycle-by-cycle R-rules.
- **Channel enablement semantics.** Let $q \in Q_{\text{exec},P}$ be a dynamic source-level message-operation instance of its owning process P on message-passing channel c , and let $\text{kind}(q) \in \{\text{Push}_c, \text{Pop}_c\}$ denote its endpoint direction. If q has issued a persistent blocking request to transfer on c , then $\text{BoundaryReq}(q,\sigma)$ holds at the ϵ -quiescent cutpoint σ : the endpoint-owned boundary request remains asserted, and the payload is stable if q is a Push. The channel-side commit-enabling predicate for q is determined as follows.

Rendezvous case, $B(c)=0$. A Push_c operation instance q is channel-enabled exactly when $\text{BoundaryReq}(q,\sigma)$ holds and the matching Pop_c endpoint boundary request is asserted in the same ϵ -quiescent cycle. A Pop_c operation instance q is channel-enabled exactly when $\text{BoundaryReq}(q,\sigma)$ holds and the matching Push_c endpoint boundary request is asserted in the same ϵ -quiescent cycle. Thus, when both endpoint requests are asserted in that cycle, the matched $\text{Push}_c(v)$ and $\text{Pop}_c(v)$ operation instances are eligible for selection as a rendezvous pair. If the scheduler selects that enabled rendezvous pair in that cycle, the matched $\text{Push}_c(v)$ and $\text{Pop}_c(v)$ commit as a same-cycle rendezvous pair and contribute the corresponding Σ -events. If the pair remains continuously enabled, B2 supplies eventual selection.

Buffered case, $B(c)>0$. The channel-side eligibility predicate for q is exactly the FIFO availability predicate conjoined with $\text{BoundaryReq}(q,\sigma)$:

for $\text{kind}(q)=\text{Push}_c$: $\text{ChannelEnabled}(q,\sigma) \Leftrightarrow \text{BoundaryReq}(q,\sigma) \wedge \text{occ}_c(\sigma) < B(c)$ (“not full”),
and

for $\text{kind}(q)=\text{Pop_c}$: $\text{ChannelEnabled}(q,\sigma) \Leftrightarrow \text{BoundaryReq}(q,\sigma) \wedge \text{occ_c}(\sigma) > 0$ (“not empty”). Here ChannelEnabled means that the abstract channel boundary permits the transfer to be selected; it does not by itself assert that the transfer has already committed in the current cycle.

Modeling note (fall-through / simultaneous empty/full cases). The buffered abstraction for $B(c)>0$ is cycle-boundary, non-fall-through. A Push and a Pop may both be selected and commit in the same cycle when the FIFO begins the cycle neither empty nor full ($0 < \text{occ_c}(t) < B(c)$); in that case both commits are legal and the occupancy is unchanged. The abstraction does not permit a Pop to be selected in a cycle that begins empty solely because a Push is also selected in that same cycle, nor does it permit a Push to be selected in a cycle that begins full solely because a Pop is also selected in that same cycle. If an implementation uses a fall-through FIFO (allowing same-cycle pass-through when empty), model that behavior explicitly (e.g., as an explicit bypass/rendezvous path composed with the bounded FIFO), so that the Σ -level committed-transfer trace matches the intended cycle semantics.

Operational interpretation (availability, selection, and ready/valid): $\text{occ_c}(t)$ is an abstract quantity derived from Σ -visible boundary commits for $B(c)>0$ buffered channels; processes do not read $\text{occ_c}(t)$ directly. For $B(c)=0$ rendezvous channels, the corresponding channel-side availability fact is the matching endpoint request predicate in the same ε -quiescent cycle. In both Sys_ref and RTL_B , $\text{ChannelEnabled}/\text{ChannelDisabled}$ records the settled abstract boundary availability/eligibility predicate. A commit occurs only when an enabled operation, or enabled rendezvous pair, is selected by the scheduler/arbiter for that cycle.

Here Sys_ref denotes the prescribed source reference model at the chosen abstract boundary: Sys_B in the ordinary case, or $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$ in the elaborated back-annotated cases. A concrete realization is correct only if its committed ready/valid transfers are legal with respect to the corresponding rendezvous or buffered availability predicate at that chosen boundary, and if every transfer that remains continuously eligible is eventually selected as required by B2. Thus E4 is a safety/legality condition on which transfers may commit, while B2 is the progress/fairness condition that prevents continuously eligible transfers from starving.

No additional hidden availability predicate is part of the channel semantics. Any cross-channel coordination, arbitration, grant, or back-pressure policy in the realization must be represented either

(1) as scheduler/arbiter selection among already ChannelEnabled actions, governed by B2, or
 (2) as explicit abstract boundary structure in $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$ with its own $B(\cdot)$, $\text{occ_c}(\cdot)$, BoundaryReq , $\text{ChannelEnabled}/\text{ChannelDisabled}$, and B3 obligations. Such coordination must not be encoded as an unmentioned extra conjunct that silently changes the E4 availability predicate at an otherwise ordinary channel boundary.

Therefore, when the boundary request is true and the relevant rendezvous or FIFO availability predicate holds continuously, the transfer is continuously enabled; by weak fairness (B2), the corresponding commit occurs after a finite, though not necessarily bounded, delay.

- **No ill-formed signal IO.** Every observable signal Read/Write has a unique real bounding synchronization operation on each dynamic path on which it occurs; otherwise, the design is ill-formed. START_P may be used as an initial anchor only when it is included as a real synchronization event in S , and FINISH_P may be used as a terminal anchor only when the

process actually terminates. The formal model does not use a virtual synchronization event at ∞ . (From RULE 1 and RULE 2.)

- **Fixed-stimulus interpretation (reactive environments).** If the “same stimulus” includes a reactive testbench and/or peer processes, it is interpreted as the same global Σ -causal behavior (same externally supplied inputs, and the same peer/environment responses to the same prior Σ -visible history), not as a function of P-local history alone. In Appendix I this interpretation is used only as a witness-replay condition: when a next RTL_B event e is already fixed in the chosen post trace prefix, any peer/environment enabling needed for e is part of that same fixed global Σ -causal behavior and is therefore replayed consistently for the matching Sys_ref construction. This is not a standalone assumption that arbitrary Sys_ref continuations are globally live.
- **WC (Witness-compatible non-blocking outcomes).** Because failed polls are modeled as ε (unobservable), all correspondence results in Appendices I–K are stated for witness-compatible comparisons: any ε -modeled non-blocking poll outcome (and any other ε -modeled internal choice that can affect the next Σ -visible control flow / next Σ -visible blocking frontier) is fixed/selected to be consistent with the compared RTL_B execution prefix τ_{post} (e.g., via the Appendix L witness-selection/snooping wrapper). WC also supplies the μ_Q matching for ε -modeled failed non-blocking call instances when E3/E5 or the proof construction refers to $q \in Q_{\text{exec},P}$; those failed q ’s are not inferred from Σ alone.
- **Remark (NB-CF as a sufficient condition).** If a design satisfies the following non-blocking control-flow property—failed PopNB/PushNB polls do not influence the next Σ -visible control flow/frontier—then the witness is trivial and WC holds automatically. Equivalently: between two consecutive Σ -events of a process, inserting/removing any finite sequence of failed PopNB/PushNB polls may change only internal ε -behavior/timing, not which Σ -visible action (Push/Pop/synchronization anchor) is next in program order.

I.3 Auxiliary Lemmas

Implementation assumption I.A0 (RTL message-issue discipline).

The post-HLS RTL_B execution satisfies the full E3 obligation as an implementation-side scheduling obligation: (i) per-interface issue order is preserved for all message operations; (ii) for distinct interfaces, the no-reverse rule holds; and (iii) issue is prefix-closed under source order, so at every compared cutpoint a source-later issued message operation implies that every required source-earlier message operation has also issued, with Issue timestamps ordered accordingly. This condition is not derived inside Appendix I; it is the RTL/tool-compliance obligation corresponding to the scheduling rules stated in the main text and Appendix G. For hand-written RTL or other non-HLS implementations, I.A0 is the corresponding proof/qualification obligation on that implementation.

Lemma I.1 (Bounded ε -chain to Σ -action or stable wait).

Assume the finite-pipeline-depth / finite-internal-stutter premise FPD/B4. From any reachable well-formed cycle-boundary state of P in the Appendix I construction, if P is not already stably waiting on an external/peer enabling condition, then within at most D_P clock cycles of P-local ε -progress, P either:

- (i) commits its next observable Σ -action, or
- (ii) reaches a stable waiting state in which no further P-local ε -step is available until some external, peer, channel, or stimulus condition changes the relevant enabling predicates.

Equivalently, P cannot produce an infinite P-local ε -only execution segment from a reachable well-formed state while remaining internally enabled. Any unbounded delay that remains after the stable-wait point is therefore attributable to external/channel/stimulus enabling and is governed by the WF/B2

and B3 progress premises, not by local ϵ -stutter.

Proof. Direct from FPD/B4, applied only to reachable well-formed states of P in the Appendix I construction. ■

Lemma I.2 (Eventual space / data). Assume P is blocked on either:

- Push_c with $\text{occ}_c = B(c)$, P's Push_c request remains asserted with stable payload for the outstanding transfer, and the complementary endpoint continuously requests the matching Pop_c until the matching discharge event (Pop_c endpoint request asserted; Pop_c boundary request remains true); or
 - Pop_c with $\text{occ}_c = 0$, P's Pop_c request remains asserted for the outstanding transfer, and the complementary endpoint continuously requests the matching Push_c until the matching discharge event (Push_c endpoint request asserted with stable payload; Push_c boundary request remains true).
- Then a complementary Pop_c (respectively Push_c) commits within finite time.

Proof. (By B3 / Appendix N.) In either case, P is stalled at a blocking channel call while its persistent request for that outstanding transfer remains asserted until commit, with stable payload if it is a Push. By the additional premise, the complementary endpoint also continuously requests the matching operation until the corresponding discharge event, with its boundary request remaining true. Therefore the interval-scoped premises of P_push/P_pop (Appendix N) hold, and the corresponding transfer must eventually complete: for Push_c at full, some complementary Pop_c eventually commits, freeing space; for Pop_c at empty, some complementary Push_c eventually commits, providing data. The premise does not require either endpoint request or Push payload to remain asserted after that matching transfer has committed.

■

Definition I.Obs (Σ -relevant source-state slice).

Fix a process P, a fixed external stimulus, and a fixed witness w satisfying WC for the chosen observable boundary. Define $\text{Obs}_{\{\Sigma, P, w\}}(\sigma)$ to be the tuple of P-local source-level facts evaluated at the ϵ -quiescent source state σ that are relevant to future Σ -visible behavior or to the Appendix I–K proof predicates owned by P. This tuple includes: the source control position; source variables and latched values used to evaluate future control predicates Pred_x , payload/value expressions, anchored Write values, and anchored Read labels under the fixed-stimulus interpretation; witness-selected ϵ outcome information that can affect later Σ -visible control flow, frontier membership, or request attribution; $Q_{\text{exec}, P} / Q_{\Omega, P}$ attribution facts needed for E3/E5 or WFG reasoning; Pending_P , NextFront_P , and Front_P membership; and BoundaryReq values for message-operation instances owned by P. Define $\sigma \sim_{\{\Sigma, P, w\}} \sigma'$ iff $\text{Obs}_{\{\Sigma, P, w\}}(\sigma) = \text{Obs}_{\{\Sigma, P, w\}}(\sigma')$. The Σ -relevant source-state slice of σ is its equivalence class $[\sigma]_{\{\Sigma, P, w\}}$.

This quotient intentionally ignores purely internal diagnostic state and ϵ -only micro-timing state that cannot affect any future Σ -visible label, frontier predicate, pending/request-attribution fact, payload/value expression, BoundaryReq predicate, or Appendix K blocking/WFG-facing predicate. $\text{ChannelEnabled} / \text{ChannelDisabled}$ facts are not independently added to this P-local quotient; they are obtained by combining the P-local slice, including BoundaryReq and pending/frontier facts, with the corresponding channel-state facts in the chosen Sys_ref boundary model, such as $B(c)$, $\text{occ}_c(\sigma)$, rendezvous complementary endpoint requests, and any explicit $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$ staged/bundle/join boundary state.

For cadence-sensitive non-blocking polling sites, such as retry/timeout counters whose externally visible behavior depends on the number or cadence of failed polls, this definition is applied only after the site has been handled as an isolated or snoop-aligned latency-sensitive local protocol block under Appendix

D / Appendix L. The ordinary Appendix I source-core proof does not derive retry/timeout behavior from an unconstrained hidden failed-poll cadence.

Lemma I.Obs-Congruence (one-step closure of the Σ -relevant slice).

Fix P , the external stimulus, the chosen observable boundary, and a witness w satisfying WC. Let σ_1 and σ_2 be ε -quiescent source states of P such that $\text{Obs}_{\{\Sigma, P, w\}}(\sigma_1) = \text{Obs}_{\{\Sigma, P, w\}}(\sigma_2)$. Suppose that, from σ_1 and σ_2 , the same next P -local Σ label ℓ is produced under the same witness w and the same fixed-stimulus interpretation, where ℓ includes any committed Push/Pop value, successful non-blocking transfer value, synchronization/wait label, anchored Read value, anchored Write value, START_P/FINISH_P event, or other Σ -visible boundary event. Let σ'_1 and σ'_2 be the resulting ε -quiescent cutpoint states after that same-label step and its following finite ε -closure. Then:

$$\text{Obs}_{\{\Sigma, P, w\}}(\sigma'_1) = \text{Obs}_{\{\Sigma, P, w\}}(\sigma'_2).$$

Proof. By case analysis on the next source construct and on the kind of label ℓ .

For deterministic local computation, equality of the control position and of all variables/latched values feeding future predicates, payloads, anchored writes/reads, guards, and proof predicates implies equality of the updated members of Obs. Updates to variables or diagnostic state not included in Obs cannot affect any later Σ -visible label or Appendix I–K proof predicate by the definition of Obs and the source well-formedness obligations.

For anchored signal reads and writes, the relevant read/write value is either fixed by the common stimulus and anchor or is the common label ℓ ; therefore all future-relevant latched values and anchored-label facts agree after the step.

For blocking Push/Pop and synchronization operations, the common label ℓ , together with equality of the current control position, relevant payload variables, Pending_P, NextFront_P, Front_P, Q_exec,P / Q_Ω,P attribution facts, and BoundaryReq facts, determines the same update to all P-owned frontier, pending, request-attribution, and BoundaryReq components of Obs. ChannelEnabled / ChannelDisabled is not an independent P-local component; any needed enablement fact is obtained from the common P-local request/frontier facts together with the chosen Sys_ref boundary state and E4.

For successful non-blocking PushNB/PopNB, the successful transfer is included in ℓ as the corresponding committed Push_c(v) / Pop_c(v) event. The common label and equal current slice determine the same control, data, attribution, frontier, pending, and BoundaryReq updates.

For failed non-blocking PushNB/PopNB, the failed poll is an ε -step. If NB-CF holds, failed polls cannot affect the next Σ -visible control flow, frontier membership, request attribution, guard values, or payload values, so any difference is outside Obs. If NB-CF does not hold but WC is supplied by Appendix L, the failed-poll outcome is fixed by the witness as part of selecting an admissible source execution at the chosen boundary. If the process computes externally visible behavior from the number or cadence of failed polls, the site must already have been isolated or snoop-aligned as a latency-sensitive local protocol block under Appendix D / Appendix L; otherwise the ordinary Appendix I source-core theorem is not applicable to that process at that boundary.

For any other ε -only implementation choice, WC requires that every outcome capable of affecting later Σ -visible behavior or Appendix I–K proof predicates is selected by w and is causally consistent with the matched prefix. Thus equal current Obs and the same witness-selected outcome produce equal successor Obs. ε -only state not included in Obs is, by the preceding cases and by the construction of Obs, inert with respect to all future labels and proof predicates owned by P .

Therefore equality of Obs is preserved by one same-label cutpoint-to-cutpoint step. ■

Lemma I.DR (Deterministic replay / Σ -relevant source-state determinacy under fixed stimulus + witness).

Fix a process P , a fixed external stimulus, and a fixed witness w satisfying WC for the chosen observable boundary. Consider two executions of the same P source code that start from the same initial source-

level state and are run with that same witness. If their chosen P-local observable-unit replay projections are the same, then for every k , the Σ -relevant source-state slice of P at the ϵ -quiescent cutpoint after the first k P-local observable units is identical in the two executions. Here “P-local observable-unit replay projection” means the sequence obtained from the document’s event-matching / Appendix J observable-unit convention: explicitly atomic same-cycle transactions are grouped as single units; independent same-cycle bucket members are not given an intrinsic order by the bucket itself; and any ordering used for deterministic replay is the selected witness/replay order, together with w and μ_Q for ϵ -modeled failed non-blocking $q \in Q_{\text{exec},P}$ when those instances are needed by E3/E5. Thus Lemma I.DR is not a determinacy theorem from a bare unordered Σ -bucket projection alone.

Proof. At $k = 0$ the executions start from the same initial source-level state, so their $\text{Obs}_{\{\Sigma, P, w\}}$ slices agree. For the induction step, assume the slices agree after k P-local Σ -events. The two executions have the same $(k+1)$ -st P-local Σ label and are run under the same fixed stimulus and witness. By Lemma I.Obs-Congruence, the ϵ -quiescent cutpoint states after that label have equal $\text{Obs}_{\{\Sigma, P, w\}}$ slices. Therefore, by induction on k , the Σ -relevant source-state slice agrees at every ϵ -quiescent cutpoint after the first k P-local Σ -events. ■

Lemma I.DR’ (Immediate post-unit deterministic replay under fixed stimulus + witness). Fix a process P , a fixed external stimulus, and a fixed witness w satisfying WC for the chosen observable boundary. Consider two executions of the same P source code that start from the same initial source-level state and are run with that same witness. Suppose that their chosen P-local observable-unit replay projections through the first k units are the same. Stop each execution at the canonical immediate post-unit semantic state: after the transition, or explicitly atomic transition group, that realizes the k th P-local observable unit, and before any optional following maximal ϵ -normalization. Then the two executions agree on the P-owned source-level replay state at that point, including:

- the source control position;
- all source variables and latched values that can influence future Pred_x predicates, payload/value expressions, or anchored Read/Write values;
- the dynamic-operation and request-attribution facts determined by the replay prefix; and
- the Pending_P , NextFront_P , Front_P , and BoundaryReq facts at that exact semantic point.

This lemma does not assert that the immediate post-unit state is ϵ -quiescent or drain-closed, and it does not identify that state with a later ϵ -normalized cutpoint. Lemma I.DR remains the corresponding theorem for explicitly ϵ -normalized cutpoints.

Proof. By induction on k . The base case follows from equality of the initial source-level state. For the induction step, equality of the prior immediate replay state, together with the same fixed stimulus, witness-selected ϵ outcomes, dynamic-instance attribution, and next observable unit, determines the same finite source transition segment through the transition or explicitly atomic transition group that realizes the next unit. Therefore the two canonical immediate post-unit states agree on every listed P-owned replay fact. No maximal ϵ -closure is invoked. ■

I.4 Local Preparation Construction for Finite Observable-Unit Prefixes (Post $\rightarrow$ Ref support)

Fix a process P , a finite selected RTL_B prefix τ_{post} , and a finite rank-independent required-prefix candidate H as defined by $J.\text{RequiredPrefixCandidate}$ below. Let $\text{Replay}_P(H, w)$ be the deterministic immediate post-unit source replay state obtained from the P-local projection of H under the fixed stimulus, WC witness w , and μ_Q dynamic-instance matching. Let γ be a not-yet-matched observable unit in which P participates, and let $q_P(\gamma)$ denote P ’s matched dynamic source operation, if γ has a process-owned operation. This local construction is indexed without reference to Dep_J , $J.\text{DepAcyclic}$, or $J.\text{CanonicalRank}$; Appendix J later instantiates it at the prefixes selected by the validated construction order.

The process-local input to the construction consists only of P 's source code and state, P -owned endpoint request state, the fixed witness and dynamic identities, and read-only summaries of the incident explicit boundaries named by γ . It does not include a premise that γ is globally enabled or that a complete Sys_ref extension exists.

Lemma I.3 (Finite process-local preparation script with shared-decision holes). Assume I.A0, WC, the source well-formedness conditions, and equality between P 's current source state and $\text{Replay_P}(H, w)$. Assume the P -local certificate identifies $q_P(\gamma)$, the finite dynamic source-control segment leading toward it, and every locally generated Dep_J predecessor required by that segment. Then there exists a finite preparation script $\text{Prep_P}(H, \gamma)$ consisting of alternating finite P -owned ϵ segments and zero or more marked shared-decision holes $\text{NBHole}(q, c, \kappa)$. Each P -owned segment changes only P -local state, P -owned endpoint request/attempt fields, and explicitly named P -local elaboration state; respects E3/E5, synchronization boundaries, same-interface order, issue prefix closure, persistence, and stable payload; and commits no unmatched Σ unit. A hole $\text{NBHole}(q, c, \kappa)$ occurs exactly when the next source step is a witness-significant $\text{PushNB}/\text{PopNB}$ decision whose outcome reads shared state at explicit boundary c . The local script stops immediately before that decision, records the exact dynamic call identity q and snapshot key κ , and does not choose success or failure. For a hole whose WC outcome is failure, the globally evaluated $J.\text{NBDecision}$ is an ϵ action and the script may resume. For a hole whose WC outcome is success, that decision/transfer is a complete observable unit and the script may resume only after that unit has been selected and included in H ; it may not be hidden inside the ϵ preparation for a later γ . Subject to that rule, filling the holes yields a state in which exactly one of the following holds: (i) $q_P(\gamma)$ is the applicable next-frontier operation and may assert its endpoint request; (ii) $q_P(\gamma)$ has already issued, has not committed, remains attributed to the same dynamic instance, and retains stable payload when it is a Push ; or (iii) for a process-local non-message event, the exact source operation for γ is the next enabled local observable action with the certified value/anchor facts. For a sequential process, a preparation segment may not cross a commit-dependent continuation within one Horizon: if a local step consumes a value or status committed in cycle t , every dependent evaluation, control-selection, and request action belongs to a strictly later Horizon.

Proof. Induct over the finite source-control segment certified for $q_P(\gamma)$. Deterministic local statements preserve the replay slice by Lemma I.Obs-Congruence. Anchored signal values are fixed by the common stimulus and anchor. For a blocking message call, I.A0 and the source issue semantics permit the certified source-order prefix of requests to issue without reversal; each outstanding request remains attributed and nonwithdrawable. When a witness-significant non-blocking call is reached, terminate the current local segment and emit $\text{NBHole}(q, c, \kappa)$; Appendix I neither reads a separately reconstructed channel state nor selects the WC outcome at that point. After Appendix J supplies the unique $J.\text{NBDecision}$ result for κ , continue the induction immediately only for a failed ϵ outcome. A successful outcome is the corresponding observable unit; the induction toward a later γ resumes from $\text{Replay_P}(H \cup \{\text{that unit}\}, w)$ after the system construction has committed it. A source step requiring a prior committed observable value is admitted only when the corresponding action is a generated Dep_J predecessor already represented in H or in the executed prefix of the preparation script. When the prerequisite commit belongs to the same sequential process and occurs in cycle t , the dependent source step is assigned a strictly later Horizon and cannot be represented as a same-cycle continuation. FPD/B4 makes the finite script and each local segment finite. Because every local segment has the certified P -owned footprint and no unmatched commit, the script has the stated form. ■

Corollary I.4 (J.PCert construction). Applying Lemma I.3 to every process participation and every applicable finite $J.\text{RequiredPrefixCandidate}$ in the selected finite RTL_B prefix yields the process-local records required by Definition J.PCert: deterministic replay state, exact dynamic-operation identity, finite alternating preparation script, issued/pending attribution, stable-payload facts, marked non-blocking decision holes and snapshot keys, typed per-action read/write footprints, sequential-result-

availability/Horizon facts, and locally generated dependency facts. This corollary remains local; J.CCert and Definition J.NBDecision must evaluate each shared-state poll from the common boundary snapshot, and J.ACert/J.UnitEnable must still establish the complete observable unit.

I.5 Countable Local Replay Chains and Scope

For a process whose selected RTL_B projection contains countably many observable units, repeated application of Lemma I.3 and Lemma I.DR' constructs a countable family of process-local replay/preparation scripts. Each finite record is indexed by a finite rank-independent J.RequiredPrefixCandidate. J.GWR-Comp later instantiates that family only at the candidates that occur as prefixes of the theorem-derived validated construction order. The construction does not independently evaluate shared-boundary non-blocking decisions, select channel commits, or choose an infinite global scheduler.

If P eventually emits no further observable unit, its local replay record simply stabilizes after its last participation; this does not justify appending a global B6 idle suffix. An admissible infinite Sys_ref execution, when one is required, is supplied by the system-level construction and J.FE, then projected onto P. If the complete system reaches a genuine B5 fixed point, B6 may supply global idle stutter. Thus Appendix I proves local replay determinacy and finite local preparation. Appendix J is solely responsible for gluing the local paths into one reachable global execution, validating shared channel and atomic interaction state, and establishing the Post $\rightarrow$ Ref system witness. ■

Appendix J – System-Level Trace Compatibility Proof

Synchronization-pair well-formedness for $\approx$.

For SyncChannel/ac_sync operations with paired endpoints, the compared Sys_ref and RTL_B executions use the same dynamic synchronization-transaction pairing. That is, the two endpoint events of a matched sync_out/sync_in transaction are matched by dynamic sync-instance identity, commit as one two-party barrier transaction, and are treated as simultaneous events in the same observable cycle bucket. This synchronization transaction induces the same cross-process before/after ordering as described in the causal-dependency definition.

Equivalently, E1 preserves the per-process source order of synchronization endpoint events, but E1 does not weaken or replace the paired-barrier semantics of SyncChannel/ac_sync. The system-level trace-compatibility predicate $\tau_{\text{ref}, \text{system}} \approx \tau_{\text{post}, \text{system}}$ is defined only over synchronization-well-formed traces in this sense: if one endpoint of a dynamic SyncChannel/ac_sync transaction appears in the trace, then the matching endpoint appears in the same observable synchronization transaction, with the same dynamic pairing, in both Sys_ref and RTL_B.

Theorem J.1 (Execution-Level / Trace-Set Compositional Compatibility)

Fix an initial state and a fixed external stimulus/environment behavior (e.g., the same testbench-driven inputs) for both the prescribed source reference model Sys_ref and RTL_B, with Sys_ref as defined in Remark 2. The raw rendezvous model Sys is the special case obtained when Sys_ref = Sys_B and all effective capacities are zero.

Clarification (reactive environments). Interpret “fixed stimulus” per Appendix I.2, “Fixed-stimulus interpretation (reactive environments).”

Let Exec_post denote the set of finite execution prefixes of RTL_B that are reachable under this stimulus and that are prefixes of at least one (infinite) execution under the same stimulus that satisfies the

Appendix J fairness/progress premises; and let Exec_ref denote the corresponding set of finite execution prefixes of Sys_ref (defined analogously).

Definition J.Reach (finite reachability sets Reach_post / Reach_ref). Let Reach_post denote the set of all finite execution prefixes of RTL_B reachable under the fixed stimulus, with no fair-extension qualifier; define Reach_ref analogously for Sys_ref . By construction $\text{Exec_post} \subseteq \text{Reach_post}$ and $\text{Exec_ref} \subseteq \text{Reach_ref}$. The finite-prefix safety results of this appendix — the $\text{Post} \rightarrow \text{Ref}$ witness construction of Theorem J.1 and the cutpoint correspondence of Corollary J.1 — are stated over Reach_post / Reach_ref : their finite-ideal inductions never use the existence of a fair infinite extension, so a genuinely bad reachable prefix (for example, one ending at a deadlock cutpoint) is in scope for the state-transfer results regardless of whether a fair infinite extension exists. Exec_post / Exec_ref are used only where an infinite fair execution is itself asserted (Appendix I.5, the B6 convention, and the embedding step of Theorem K.1); Lemma J.FE below relates the two sets.

Lemma J.FE (fair extension / machine closure). Premise (environment receptiveness): the fixed stimulus, interpreted per Appendix I.2 for reactive environments, is defined on every reachable Σ -causal history — the environment/testbench never becomes undefined or refuses to continue after a reachable finite prefix. Claim: under B2–B6 and this premise, every $\tau \in \text{Reach_post}$ (respectively Reach_ref) is a prefix of at least one infinite execution under the same stimulus satisfying the B2/B3 fairness/progress premises; hence $\text{Reach_post} = \text{Exec_post}$ and $\text{Reach_ref} = \text{Exec_ref}$. Proof sketch: construct the continuation greedily. At each reached state, if any Σ -action or ϵ -step is enabled, select among the enabled actions by a fair discipline (for example, oldest-continuously-enabled first); B4 bounds consecutive ϵ -only work, so selection returns to Σ -eligible actions after finitely many steps, and no action remains continuously enabled without eventually being selected, so B2 holds. B3’s interval-scoped channel-progress obligations hold on this schedule because their antecedents keep the relevant transfer continuously ChannelEnabled , and the fair discipline eventually selects it. If no action of any kind is enabled, the state is by definition a B5 global fixed point, and B6 supplies the time-divergent idle-stutter suffix, on which B2/B3 hold vacuously. The construction never blocks: at every reachable state either some action is enabled or B6 applies. ■ Status: J.FE is a named lemma with an explicit environment-receptiveness premise; that premise is an entry in the side-condition discharge record. Flows whose testbench can refuse further input after some reachable history must either restrict $\text{Reach_post}/\text{Reach_ref}$ accordingly or discharge the required embedding directly.

Cycle-bucket and required-prefix convention for this theorem. A system execution may be represented as a sequence of observable cycle buckets $\beta_1 \beta_2 \dots$, where β_i is the finite set of Σ -events committed in one observable clock cycle of that particular execution. Same-cycle events inside a bucket are unordered except for the explicit constraints imposed by E1–E5, the channel semantics, signal-anchor semantics, and explicit synchronization constructs.

The bucket decomposition records the clock timing of one execution; it is not, by itself, part of the cross-model compatibility obligation. The relation $\tau_{\text{ref,system}} \approx \tau_{\text{post,system}}$ does not require Sys_ref and RTL_B to use the same observable cycle-bucket decomposition. Events that are not ordered by the explicit required constraints may be placed in different cycles or grouped into different buckets in the two executions, provided the matched executions preserve all ordering, timestamp, FIFO-legality, and atomicity constraints required by E1–E5 and by the explicitly modeled channel, signal, and synchronization semantics.

The prefix order used by Theorem J.1 is required-prefix order over matched observable units, not RTL_B bucket-prefix order and not the full Appendix G causal-dependency graph $\rightarrow$. An observable unit is either:

- a singleton Σ -event; or
- an explicitly atomic same-cycle transaction that the semantics requires not to be split, including a rendezvous $\text{Push}_c(v)/\text{Pop}_c(v)$ transfer, the two endpoints of a paired $\text{SyncChannel}/\text{ac_sync}$ transaction, an R2C combinational fixed-point signal-observation unit, a proof-internal RESET boundary unit when dynamic reset is used (Common Formal Definitions, reset well-formedness RW1–RW5), and any other same-cycle transaction explicitly identified by the signal/channel semantics.

E2 signal-anchor grouping convention: a synchronization commit together with the sequential-process signal Read/Write events that E2/R2 anchor to it (and therefore require to share its commit cycle) may — and, for mechanization, should — be grouped as one explicitly atomic same-cycle unit. This grouping replaces the same-cycle equality constraint between separately enumerated units by unit-internal atomicity, and is consistent with Corollary J.1(2a), which advances a synchronization-call item together with its anchored signal action items. When anchored signal events are instead enumerated as singleton units, their E2 timestamp equality with the anchor is enforced by the Sys_ref realization semantics (R2) and the within-cycle listing convention, not by the strict order $\prec_J$, which never orders same-cycle-aligned events.

Let $\prec_J$ be the strict required-order relation over observable units generated only by the explicit constraints that must be preserved by $\tau_{\text{ref},\text{system}} \approx \tau_{\text{post},\text{system}}$:

- E1 synchronization source-order constraints within each process;
- E2 signal-anchor timestamp constraints, interpreted as required alignment with the relevant synchronization or R2C fixed-point unit rather than as raw ordering among all source actions;
- E4 channel/FIFO legality for explicit abstract channels, including same-channel FIFO order for $B(c)>0$ and atomic rendezvous grouping for $B(c)=0$;
- E5 immediate synchronization-boundary constraints;
- paired $\text{SyncChannel}/\text{ac_sync}$ barrier semantics; and
- any other explicitly stated signal/channel/synchronization atomicity constraint.

Per-process source order contributes to $\prec_J$ only where it is reflected in one of these explicit required constraints, such as synchronization order, same-endpoint/same-channel order, signal anchoring, or immediate synchronization-boundary legality. E3 contributes issue-order and request-attribution obligations, but it does not by itself create a strict predecessor edge between distinct-interface committed observable units merely because their source calls are lexically ordered. The Appendix G causal-dependency relation $\rightarrow$ is not a generator of $\prec_J$.

A theorem prefix is a finite ideal of observable units under $\prec_J$, i.e. a finite down-closed set H such that $\gamma \in H$ and $\gamma' \prec_J \gamma$ imply $\gamma' \in H$. The proof below proceeds by induction along the finite ideal chain induced by the selected $J.\text{ValidatedConstructionOrder}$. On the normal compositional route, that order is derived from Definition J.DepJ, Lemma J.DepRank, Lemma J.DepAcyclic, and J.CanonicalRank. On the optional direct route, it is supplied with an independently checked well-founded construction order satisfying the same required-predecessor and ideal-prefix obligations. Acyclicity of $\prec_J$ on the fixed execution prefix. For the chosen legal RTL_B execution prefix, assign each observable unit $\gamma \in U(\tau_{\text{post}})$ its RTL_B commit cycle $\text{clk}(\gamma)$. If γ is an explicitly atomic same-cycle unit, such as a rendezvous $\text{Push}_c(v)/\text{Pop}_c(v)$ transfer or a paired $\text{SyncChannel}/\text{ac_sync}$ transaction, $\text{clk}(\gamma)$ is the common commit cycle of the endpoints in that atomic unit.

Every strict generator edge $\gamma_1 \prec_J \gamma_2$ implies a strict cycle inequality $\text{clk}(\gamma_1) < \text{clk}(\gamma_2)$ in that same legal execution prefix:

- E1 synchronization source-order constraints impose strict ordering between the relevant synchronization commits.

- E4 buffered-channel FIFO/order/capacity constraints impose strict commit-cycle ordering through reset-empty FIFO order, bounded occupancy, and non-fall-through cycle-boundary availability. In particular, for $B(c) > 0$, a Pop_c can consume only a value already present at the relevant cycle boundary, and a Push_c that depends on space becoming available after a full condition is enabled only in a later cycle after the required Pop_c effect has occurred.
- E5 immediate synchronization-boundary constraints impose strict separation between a synchronization commit and later suff_S work whose issue/commit is after that synchronization boundary.
- Paired synchronization/barrier before/after constraints impose the corresponding strict before/after cycle relation between distinct observable units when such a relation is explicitly part of the synchronization semantics.
- E2 signal-anchor constraints contribute timestamp equality/alignment to the relevant synchronization or R2C fixed-point unit, or same-cycle atomicity when explicitly specified; they do not by themselves introduce an independent strict edge between distinct observable units.
- Rendezvous Push/Pop endpoints, paired same-cycle synchronization endpoints, and other explicitly atomic same-cycle transactions are represented as single observable units, not as strict internal edges.
- Non-strict issue simultaneity permitted by E3 does not create a strict $\prec_J$ edge.

Therefore any cycle $\gamma_0 \prec_J \gamma_1 \prec_J \dots \prec_J \gamma_0$ over $U(\tau_{\text{post}})$ would imply $\text{clk}(\gamma_0) < \text{clk}(\gamma_1) < \dots < \text{clk}(\gamma_0)$, an impossibility. Hence $\prec_J$ is acyclic on $U(\tau_{\text{post}})$, which is the only acyclicity needed for the finite-ideal induction. For the proof of Theorem J.1, Definition J.DepJ and Lemmas J.DepSound–J.DepAcyclic derive J.CanonicalRank from the chosen RTL_B witness's concrete issue/decision/commit annotations and the local operational footprints. The induced observable-unit enumeration refines commit-cycle order and $\prec_J$. Its prefixes are ideals under $\prec_J$, but stable tie ordering between commuting actions has no semantic significance and must not be read as adding an observable order among independent events. There is no semantic cutpoint after only one endpoint of an explicitly atomic multi-endpoint unit has been taken; such units are split neither in Sys_ref nor in RTL_B .

Scope note (intentional). The finite-prefix $\text{Post} \rightarrow \text{Ref}$ clause of Theorem J.1 and the cutpoint correspondence of Corollary J.1 are stated over Reach_post / Reach_ref and do not require an infinite fair extension. Their finite-ideal construction uses the process-local preparation records and the local channel/atomic certificates of Definition J.LocalGWR, combined by Lemma J.UnitExt and Theorem J.GWR-Comp with the Sys_ref operational transition semantics. Weak fairness B2, channel progress B3, and the time-divergence / idle-stutter convention B6 are used only when an infinite fair execution is itself asserted, such as Appendix I.5, Lemma J.FE, or a later embedding into Exec_post / Exec_ref . B4/B5 remain separate normalization premises when ϵ -quiescent or fixed-point cutpoints are selected.

Assume the Appendix I / Appendix L local replay machinery is available—namely I.A0, WC for ϵ -modeled choices, deterministic replay, and the finite process-local preparation theorem—with NB-CF as a sufficient WC route where applicable. Also assume the capacities/occupancies/enablement semantics of Sys_ref , finite capacities and B-faithful E4 behavior on every explicit abstract channel, the complete local certificate package of Definition J.LocalGWR, and the standing RTL_B determinism assumption B1 under the fixed stimulus. No B2/B3 premise is used by the finite-prefix clause. Use B4/B5 additionally when ϵ -normalization or uniqueness up to finite ϵ -stutter is invoked. When an infinite fair execution is asserted, separately require B2/B3 and the J.FE environment-receptiveness premise. Additionally assume the shared-memory lowering condition J.Mem for every cross-process shared-memory dependency in the compared design and, when dynamic reset is used, the reset well-formedness conditions RW1–RW5

(both in Common Formal Definitions). Then:

Compatibility-relation typing convention. The symbol $\approx$ is an ordered cross-model compatibility predicate, not a mathematical equivalence relation. It is intentionally directed from a Sys_ref execution/projection to an RTL_B execution/projection, and no symmetry or transitivity property is implied. Its carrier is not a bare Σ -label trace alone.

For each process P , the per-process carrier is an annotated observable projection record. Such a record contains the P -local bucketed Σ projection, the relevant observable-unit projection, the dynamic source/witness universe Ω_P and Q_exec,P used for that comparison, the Issue/Commit annotation for dynamic message-call instances, the selected witness w , and the μ_Q matching supplied by WC / Appendix L when ε -modeled failed non-blocking calls or other witness-selected choices are relevant. Forgetting these annotations yields the ordinary P -local observable Σ projection, but E3, E5, BoundaryReq attribution, and the witness construction may depend on the annotations and are not reconstructed from the Σ projection alone.

Accordingly, write

$$\approx_P \subseteq \text{AnnTraces}_{\{\Sigma,P,w\}}(\text{Sys_ref}) \times \text{AnnTraces}_{\{\Sigma,P,w\}}(\text{RTL_B})$$

for the per-process annotated observable-compatibility predicate induced by the P -local R/E obligations: synchronization ordering, signal anchoring or R2C fixed-point agreement, message issue-order constraints, synchronization-boundary issue constraints, and the P -local witness/request-attribution facts needed for those obligations. Here $\text{AnnTraces}_{\{\Sigma,P,w\}}(\cdot)$ denotes the annotated projection records just described, not merely $\text{Traces}_{\{\Sigma,P\}}(\cdot)$.

Similarly, write

$$\approx_sys \subseteq \text{AnnTraces}_{\{\Sigma,w\}}(\text{Sys_ref}) \times \text{AnnTraces}_{\{\Sigma,w\}}(\text{RTL_B})$$

for system-level annotated observable compatibility. A system-level annotated record includes the per-process annotated projections plus the explicit abstract-channel histories and boundary-state facts needed to check E4 at the chosen Sys_ref / RTL_B boundaries.

For system executions $\tau_ref,system$ and $\tau_post,system$, the assertion $\tau_ref,system \approx_sys \tau_post,system$ is therefore an abbreviation: there exist compatible annotation/witness records for the two executions such that every process projection satisfies the corresponding $\tau_ref,P \approx_P \tau_post,P$ obligation and every explicit abstract channel in the chosen Sys_ref / RTL_B comparison satisfies the applicable E4 channel semantics at the agreed abstract boundary. When the annotations are clear from context, the same $\tau_ref \approx \tau_post$ notation may be used for readability; it should not be read as typing $\approx$ over bare Σ -traces alone.

Definition J.RTLConsistentRefPrefix (annotated RTL-consistent source prefix). A source-side prefix $\tau_ref \in \text{Exec_ref}$ is RTL-consistent for the $\text{Ref} \rightarrow \text{Post}$ clause only when it is equipped with a selected RTL_B prefix $\tau_post^* \in \text{Exec_post}$ and a witness/annotation package W such that: (1) τ_post^* is admitted by RTL_B under the same fixed stimulus; (2) the observable-unit projection of τ_ref matches a required-prefix projection of τ_post^* ; (3) W provides compatible annotated projection records for τ_ref and τ_post^* , including the dynamic operation universes Ω_P and Q_exec,P , μ_Q matching, the operational Issue/Commit and E3/E5 annotations needed by the execution-level construction, request-attribution facts (including failed non-blocking poll witnesses where relevant), and the applicable per-channel E4 histories and abstract boundary facts; and (4) whenever Corollary J.1, Appendix K, or any cutpoint transfer uses the selected pair, the same selected witness and normalized source prefix satisfy J.OfferReach, the selected RTL cutpoint satisfies J.OfferConf, and the composite J.KObsConf relation holds for the same H and O . Label-projection matching alone is therefore not sufficient to establish $\text{Ref} \rightarrow \text{Post}$; the compatible annotations and, when needed, the KObs cutpoint package are part of the **RTLConsistentRefPrefix** witness.

Then:

(Post $\rightarrow$ Ref existence, compositional route) For every $\tau_{\text{post}} \in \text{Reach_post}$ together with a local certificate package L satisfying $\text{LocalGWRPackage}(\tau_{\text{post}}, L)$ (Definition J.LocalGWR), there exist a package W and a prefix $\tau_{\text{ref}} \in \text{Reach_ref}$ such that $\text{GlobalWitnessRealizable}(\tau_{\text{post}}, W)$ holds and the annotated system projections satisfy $\tau_{\text{ref}, \text{system}} \approx_{\text{sys}} \tau_{\text{post}, \text{system}}$ under E1–E5. Membership of τ_{post} in Exec_post is not required for this finite-prefix clause.

(Post $\rightarrow$ Ref existence, direct semantic route) The same core conclusion holds when the application directly supplies a validated package W satisfying $\text{GlobalWitnessRealizable}(\tau_{\text{post}}, W)$. The compositional route is the normal theorem path; the direct route permits translation validation, symbolic replay, or another independently checked global certificate to target the stable J.GWR interface.

(Ref $\rightarrow$ Post existence, annotated RTL-consistent prefixes only) For every $\tau_{\text{ref}} \in \text{Exec_ref}$ for which there exist $\tau_{\text{post}}^* \in \text{Exec_post}$ and a witness/annotation package W satisfying $\text{RTLConsistentRefPrefix}(\tau_{\text{ref}}, \tau_{\text{post}}^*, W)$ under the same fixed stimulus, there exists $\tau_{\text{post}} \in \text{Exec_post}$ —namely $\tau_{\text{post}} = \tau_{\text{post}}^*$ —with the compatible witness/annotation package W such that the annotated system projections satisfy $\tau_{\text{ref}, \text{system}} \approx_{\text{sys}} \tau_{\text{post}, \text{system}}$. In Appendix L snooping/witness-selection applications, the selected τ_{post}^* and W are the RTL_B execution prefix and witness package selected by the snooping wrapper/witness.

Moreover, because B1 is a standing assumption in this theorem instance (deterministic Σ -projected RTL_B trace under fixed stimulus), the matching observable Σ projection of a selected RTL_B prefix is unique (up to insertion/removal of finite ε -steps permitted by B4/B5). This uniqueness is only a uniqueness statement about the observable projection; it does not by itself determine μ_Q , failed-poll instances in Q_{exec} , issue annotations, request-attribution facts, the selected package W , or the full stateful Sys_ref witness. The corresponding execution prefix witness τ_{ref} need not be unique as a stateful prefix, since Sys_ref may admit multiple ε -different realizations with the same Σ projection. Sys_ref may also admit executions whose Σ projection does not match RTL_B's Σ trace when latency-sensitive / non-blocking effects are Σ -visible; such executions are outside the scope of (Ref $\rightarrow$ Post) unless constrained by $\text{RTLConsistentRefPrefix}$ / the snooping/witness-selection technique (Appendix L). Proof strategy. Theorem J.1 is not obtained from pairwise composition alone. Appendix I proves the local replay/preparation scripts packaged as J.PCert. Definition J.LocalGWR adds per-channel, atomic-unit, environment/reset, typed footprint, request-snapshot, generated-dependency, and interface-agreement certificates. Lemmas J.DepSound/J.DepComplete/J.DepRank/J.DepAcyclic derive a canonical construction order rather than accepting one as a premise. Theorem J.GWR-Comp constructs one coherent source execution and the theorem-derived J.ValidatedConstructionOrder/J.GWR package from those local facts; J.GWR-Direct instead supplies a direct-validated order and chain. Proposition J.0 below remains only the conditional lifting step for an already selected compatible trace pair. The expanded construction later in this appendix proves J.GWR-Comp and then instantiates Proposition J.0. The restricted Ref $\rightarrow$ Post clause continues to use $\text{RTLConsistentRefPrefix}$ rather than a symmetric source-to-RTL construction.

Definition J.ConstructionAction and operational footprints

Fix a finite RTL_B prefix τ_{post} and a candidate local package L . $\text{Act}_L(\tau_{\text{post}})$ is the finite set of primitive source-construction actions named by the process scripts, channel records, and complete observable units. An action is one of: (A1) a process-owned ε transition; (A2) assertion or retention of an endpoint-owned blocking request, or assertion of a one-cycle non-blocking attempt; (A3) a shared-boundary non-

blocking decision/return, with a successful decision contracted with its corresponding transfer commit; (A4) any other complete explicit-channel or observable atomic-unit commit; (A5) an environment, reset, or explicit $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$ component transition needed by the selected prefix. Endpoints that the semantics requires to be simultaneous are contracted into one A4 action. Every action a has a unique typed identity, owner set $\text{Owner}(a)$, reset epoch $\text{Epoch}(a)$, concrete RTL cycle or commit-horizon annotation $\text{Horizon}(a)$, associated unit $\text{Unit}(a)$, and finite $\text{ReadSet}(a)$ and $\text{WriteSet}(a)$ over the product-state components of Sys_ref . It also carries only the local operational coordinates from which J.FoundationRank is computed: reset-occurrence index, fixed semantic action stage, and an action-kind-specific local ordinal such as a process-script position, request/snapshot position, channel transfer ordinal, environment interaction ordinal, or component-local transition ordinal. These coordinates are determined by the named operational record and are not an arbitrary global replay phase or supplied topological rank. The state-component universe distinguishes process-local state, each endpoint request/attempt field, each explicit abstract-channel/elaboration state, environment state, and reset state. A custom $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$ component is admissible only with a local footprint/commutation certificate identifying its owned state, atomic groups, read/write conflicts, and a well-founded component-local ordinal for its non-commuting transition forms.

Definition J.ReqSnapshot and J.NBDecision

For every witness-significant non-blocking dynamic call q at explicit boundary c , let $\kappa(q)$ be its unique snapshot key. $\text{ReqSnapshot_c}(q)$ is the common source-boundary state immediately before q 's decision, after every Dep_J predecessor of the decision has executed and the selected combinational ε -settling has completed, but before q 's success/failure return and before any channel-state update caused by that decision. The snapshot contains: the reset epoch; the E4 abstract channel state, including occupancy and FIFO head where $B(c) > 0$; every endpoint-owned persistent request and one-cycle attempt present at c , including q 's own attempt, with dynamic attribution and stable Push payload; and every explicitly modeled gate, join, arbitration, or environment-availability field that can affect c . $\text{J.NBDecision}(q, \text{ReqSnapshot_c}(q))$ is the unique result prescribed by the source call semantics and E4 at that snapshot. For $B(c) > 0$, PopNB succeeds exactly when the snapshot is nonempty and PushNB succeeds exactly when it is nonfull. For $B(c) = 0$, success requires the matching complementary attributed request/attempt with value agreement in the same snapshot. A failure is an ε return with no channel commit; a success is the corresponding contracted decision/committed-transfer action and is therefore an observable unit, not a hidden preparation step. WC identifies the implementation-selected dynamic outcome, while J.CC^{ert} proves that it equals this uniquely derived result. A process-local preparation segment may create an attempt or persistent request but may not execute J.NBDecision or read a snapshot whose fields another preparation segment can still change.

Lemma J.BufSameCycle (same-cycle buffered Push/Pop sequentialization)

Let c have $B(c) > 0$, let the pre-cycle logical FIFO contents be Q with $n = |Q|$, and suppose one $\text{Push_c}(v)$ and one $\text{Pop_c}(w)$ both commit in the same RTL cycle under the non-fall-through E4 semantics. Then $0 < n < B(c)$, $w = \text{head}(Q)$, and both source serializations $\text{Push_c}(v); \text{Pop_c}(w)$ and $\text{Pop_c}(w); \text{Push_c}(v)$ are enabled from Q . Both terminate with logical contents $\text{tail}(Q)$ followed by v , occupancy n , the same producer and consumer ordinals, and the same unordered same-cycle observable bucket. The proof may therefore execute the two source transitions in either order while retaining their common RTL-cycle annotation. If $n = 0$, the Pop cannot be enabled by the same-cycle Push; if $n = B(c)$, the Push cannot be enabled by the same-cycle Pop. For $B(c) = 0$ the endpoints remain one indivisible rendezvous action and this lemma does not apply. Proof: direct case analysis on the E4 enablement predicates and FIFO update equations. ■

Definition J.DepJ (generated construction-dependency relation)

After contracting every explicitly atomic action, let $a \prec_D b$ denote a direct generated dependency edge. Dep_J is the finite directed graph on $\text{Act}_L(\tau_{\text{post}})$ whose edges are generated only by the following rules; write $\prec_D^+$ for its transitive closure: (D1) same-process dynamic control, data, source-issue, and synchronization-boundary predecessors; (D2) request/attempt-before-decision edges for every endpoint field read by $\text{ReqSnapshot}_c(q)$, and decision-before-continuation edges for the source branch selected by q ; (D3) per-channel FIFO ordinal/history predecessors, occupancy/head predecessors, and same-boundary update order whenever the actions do not commute under $J.\text{BufSameCycle}$; (D4) reset-epoch, environment-causal, and explicit elaboration-component predecessors prescribed by their operational rules; and (D5) concrete earlier-cycle precedence whenever the selected RTL annotation places a prerequisite action strictly before another action. An edge may not be inserted merely because it is convenient for a proposed replay. Mere source order between distinct-interface blocking commits creates issue-order obligations through D1 but no commit edge when both persistent requests can coexist. For custom elaboration, D4 edges are generated only from its checked local footprint/commutation certificate.

Lemma J.DepSound (every generated edge is an operational prerequisite)

If $a \prec_D b$, then no legal Sys_ref construction segment that realizes both actions from the matched prefix can execute b before a unless the two are first contracted into one explicitly atomic action. Proof: case analysis on D1–D5. D1 follows from the source transition, Issue/Commit, and sequential-result-availability rules; D2 from the definition of the snapshot read and source continuation; D3 from E4/FIFO state dependence except for the commuting case discharged by $J.\text{BufSameCycle}$; D4 from the named reset, environment, or elaboration transition rule; and D5 from the concrete selected-cycle annotation and E1–E5 boundary constraints. ■

Lemma J.DepComplete (all non-commuting construction actions are ordered)

Let a and b be distinct construction actions that are not endpoints of one contracted atomic action. If neither $a \prec_D^+ b$ nor $b \prec_D^+ a$, then either (i) $\text{WriteSet}(a)$ is disjoint from $\text{ReadSet}(b) \cup \text{WriteSet}(b)$ and $\text{WriteSet}(b)$ is disjoint from $\text{ReadSet}(a) \cup \text{WriteSet}(a)$, so the two transitions commute by the product-state operational rules; or (ii) a and b are the dual same-cycle buffered Push/Pop case of $J.\text{BufSameCycle}$ and commute by that lemma. Equivalently, every pair that cannot be swapped while preserving transition legality, observable labels, and resulting semantic state is ordered in at least one direction by $\prec_D^+$. Proof: finite case analysis over A1–A5 and the typed state components. Every overlapping process, request, channel, environment, reset, or elaboration access invokes the applicable D1–D4 rule; nonoverlap gives the standard read/write commutation argument; the only ordinary buffered-channel dual-update exception is $J.\text{BufSameCycle}$. A custom component discharges its cases through its local footprint/commutation certificate. ■

Definition J.FoundationRank (rank independent of graph acyclicity)

For each construction action a , define the semantic foundation rank $\text{FR}(a)$ lexicographically as $\langle \text{EpochIndex}(a), \text{Horizon}(a), \text{SemanticStage}(a), \text{LocalOrdinal}(a), \text{ComponentTie}(a) \rangle$. EpochIndex is the reset-occurrence/epoch number supplied by ResetCert . Horizon is the concrete RTL cycle, decision horizon, or enclosing selected-unit cycle supplied by the operational record; an ϵ action with no separate boundary timestamp inherits the horizon of its certified process or component segment. For process-owned actions, if a continuation, evaluation, control choice, or request consumes a value or status committed by that sequential process in cycle t , its Horizon is strictly greater than t ; an ϵ action may inherit the commit Horizon only when it does not use the newly committed result to advance dependent sequential control. SemanticStage is a fixed finite order determined by the transition form—

reset/environment prerequisites, local evaluation and request/attempt writes, completed request-snapshot formation, shared decision or contracted commit, and selected continuation—with any custom component using reserved locally certified substages. LocalOrdinal is the action-kind-specific source-script, request/snapshot, FIFO/transfer, environment, reset, or component-local ordinal. ComponentTie is used only between actions for which all preceding coordinates are equal and the local certificate proves either commutation or a component-local order. FR is computed from locally checkable operational metadata and does not use Dep_J, a topological sort, Height, or J.CanonicalRank.

Lemma J.DepRank (every generated dependency advances the foundation rank)

For every well-formed LocalGWRPackage and every generated direct edge $a \leq_D b$, $FR(a) < FR(b)$. Proof: by case analysis on D1–D5. D5 strictly increases Horizon. A reset-epoch edge strictly increases EpochIndex. D1 has three relevant cases: within one already-reached process operation or local segment that consumes no newly committed result, it increases the certified process-script/source-action ordinal or moves to a later semantic stage; when a succeeding action depends on a value or status committed by the same sequential process in cycle t , the sequential-result-availability rule strictly increases Horizon; and independently reached overlapped operations do not acquire a commit-to-later-request edge merely from source order, while their actual control, data, and issue-order D1 edges advance the certified ordinal or stage; D2 moves from request/attempt writes to completed snapshot formation, then to the decision/contracted commit, and finally to the selected continuation; D3 increases the applicable channel transfer/history ordinal or the non-commuting channel-state substage, while J.BufSameCycle removes the only ordinary buffered dual update for which neither direction is required; and D4 increases the certified reset, environment, or explicit-component ordinal/substage. Cross-owner request-to-decision edges therefore advance the common stage rather than relying on separate owner-local acyclicity. Every coordinate used in this proof is fixed before Dep_J is analyzed. A custom component’s local certificate must prove the corresponding FR increase for each of its generated non-commuting edges; otherwise the LocalGWR package is invalid. ■

Lemma J.DepAcyclic (well-foundedness of the generated dependency graph)

For every well-formed LocalGWRPackage, the graph Dep_J is acyclic after atomic contraction. Proof. Suppose a directed cycle $a_0 \leq_D a_1 \leq_D \dots \leq_D a_0$ existed. Repeated application of Lemma J.DepRank would give $FR(a_0) < FR(a_1) < \dots < FR(a_0)$, contradicting irreflexivity of the well-founded lexicographic order on the finite rank components. This argument uses one global semantic rank that every D1–D5 edge advances; it does not infer acyclicity from a union of separately acyclic process, channel, request, environment, reset, or component orders. Height and J.CanonicalRank are defined only after this lemma and play no role in proving it. ■

Definition J.CanonicalRank (derived construction order)

Because $Act_L(\tau_post)$ is finite and Dep_J is acyclic by the independent FR argument, define $Height(a)=0$ for actions with no incoming $\leq_D$ edge and $Height(a)=1+\max\{Height(b) \mid b \leq_D a\}$ otherwise. Define $CanonicalRank(a):=\langle FR(a), Height(a), KindKey(a), StableId(a) \rangle$ lexicographically. FR preserves the concrete epoch/horizon and semantic prerequisite structure; Height is a theorem-derived topological depth used only after acyclicity has been established; and KindKey/StableId only totalize otherwise commuting actions and create no observable $\leq_J$ edge. The rank of an observable unit is the rank of its contracted commit action. J.CanonicalRank is reconstructed from checked action identities, local operational coordinates, and Dep_J; no phase or replay rank is supplied by the implementation flow.

Definition J.RequiredPrefixCandidate (rank-independent local-certificate index)

For a finite RTL_B prefix τ_post , $RequiredPrefixCandidate(\tau_post, H)$ means that H is a finite set of complete observable units of τ_post satisfying only order-neutral prefix conditions: (R1) H is down-

closed under the execution-specific required-order relation $\prec_J$; (R2) for every process P , the P -local projection of H is a prefix of the selected P -local observable-unit projection, with no dynamic operation identity used twice and with reset epochs respected; (R3) every explicitly atomic unit is either wholly present or wholly absent; and (R4) each explicit-channel projection is a reset-epoch-consistent prefix of the selected rendezvous or FIFO history. The definition does not mention Dep_J , J.DepAcyclic , J.CanonicalRank , a proposed global replay order, or reachability of a common Sys_ref state. It is only the finite index domain on which Appendix I can compute process-local replay states and preparation scripts. Theorem J.GWR-Comp later selects from this domain the candidates that arise along its derived construction chain.

Definition J.PCert (process-local replay and preparation certificate)

For a process P and finite RTL_B prefix τ_{post} , $\text{PCert_P}(\tau_{\text{post}}, L_P)$ holds when L_P supplies, for every participation of P in a selected complete unit γ and every finite $\text{RequiredPrefixCandidate}(\tau_{\text{post}}, H)$ whose P -local projection ends before γ and contains every $\prec_J$ predecessor needed by P -local replay: (P1) the WC-selected ϵ outcomes, μ_Q matching, reset epoch, and dynamic source-operation identity $q_P(\gamma)$; (P2) the deterministic immediate post-unit replay state $\text{Replay_P}(H, w)$, with all future- Σ -relevant values, guards, payload expressions, control locations, completion facts, and operation ordinals; (P3) the finite alternating preparation script of Lemma I.3, including every marked $\text{NBHole}(q, c, \kappa)$, and identifying whether the final $q_P(\gamma)$ is next-frontier or already issued/pending; (P4) Appendix C/I.A0/E3/E5 issue-order, prefix-closure, persistence, stable-payload, and synchronization-side facts; (P5) for every witness-significant non-blocking call, the exact dynamic call/attempt identity, the desired WC outcome, and its ReqSnapshot key, with no local execution of the decision; (P6) the complete typed construction-action inventory for the script, with $\text{ReadSet}/\text{WriteSet}$, ownership, cycle/horizon annotation, semantic-stage and local-ordinal metadata used by J.FoundationRank , and every $\text{D1}/\text{D2}$ dependency generator; and (P7) proof that each local segment writes only P -local state, P -owned endpoint request/attempt fields, and named P -local elaboration components, and commits no unmatched observable unit. PCert therefore contains no reference to J.CanonicalRank and cannot assume the global order whose existence J.GWR-Comp must prove.

Definition J.CCert (explicit-channel history, request, and enablement certificate)

For every explicit abstract channel c of E , $\text{CCert_c}(\tau_{\text{post}}, L_c)$ holds when L_c supplies: (C1) the exact selected boundary, capacity $B(c)$, endpoint ownership, reset epochs, and B -faithfulness/ ϵ -opacity evidence; (C2) the complete prefix-indexed $E4$ history, FIFO ordinals, payloads, occupancy/head state, and reset-empty restarts; (C3) agreement of producer and consumer records on channel, dynamic transfer identity, payload, ordinal, direction, and epoch; (C4) for every selected commit and every witness-significant non-blocking call q , the complete $\text{ReqSnapshot_c}(q)$ or commit-boundary snapshot, including absent as well as asserted requests/attempts and every explicit gate/join/environment field read by enablement; (C5) proof that the WC outcome for q is exactly $\text{J.NBDecision}(q, \text{ReqSnapshot_c}(q))$, thereby excluding, for example, a failed rendezvous PopNB while a matching persistent Push is present; (C6) the exact local channel-state update produced by each complete unit, with no hidden enablement, disablement, storage, credit, or cross-channel predicate outside explicit $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$ structure; (C7) for every same-cycle buffered Push/Pop pair, the common pre-cycle FIFO state and the facts $0 < \text{occ_c}(t) < B(c)$, value/ordinal agreement, and combined update required by J.BufSameCycle ; and (C8) every $\text{D2}/\text{D3}$ dependency edge, channel-action $\text{ReadSet}/\text{WriteSet}$, horizon/stage, and transfer/local-ordinal field needed by J.DepSound , J.DepComplete , and J.DepRank .

Definition J.ACert, J.EnvCert, and J.ResetCert

ACert_γ identifies the complete participant set, dynamic identities, values, reset epoch, and atomic transition rule for every rendezvous transfer, paired SyncChannel/ac_sync transaction, E2 anchor/signal group, R2C fixed-point unit, RESET unit, and other explicitly atomic unit. It proves that every participant record names the same contracted action and supplies the endpoint requests, values, guards, and component state from which the generic Sys_ref rule can derive enablement; it does not take complete-unit enablement itself as an unexplained certificate field. An endpoint cannot be certified independently of its counterpart. EnvCert proves, for every selected external interaction, that the source and RTL records use the same response of the fixed reactive environment to the same preceding Σ -causal history and supplies the corresponding footprints, horizon/stage/ordinal fields, and dependencies. ResetCert supplies RW1–RW5 for each reset occurrence and scope, including request clearing, reset-empty channel state, source/RTL reset-state correspondence, atomic reset splicing, framing outside the reset scope, and the D4 dependency and J.DepRank coordinate facts.

Definition J.LocalAgree and J.LocalGWR

LocalAgree(L) is the finite conjunction of equality, uniqueness, ownership, and coverage checks on fields duplicated across local records: shared unit/action identity; endpoint pairing; channel and boundary identity; payload/value; transfer ordinal; request/attempt attribution; snapshot key and contents; reset epoch and occurrence index; witness identity; elaboration/projection identity; cycle or commit horizon; semantic stage and action-kind local ordinal used by J.FoundationRank; ReadSet/WriteSet; and generated dependency edge. Every relevant process, explicit boundary, construction action, atomic unit, and witness-significant ε choice in τ_{post} must be covered, and each endpoint-owned request/attempt must have at most one owning dynamic operation. LocalAgree does not assert that a global execution exists, that Dep_J is acyclic, that the canonical order is replayable, or that the next complete unit has a global extension.

Definition J.LocalGWR. LocalGWRPackage(τ_{post} , L) holds when L consists of PCert_P for every process P, CCert_c for every explicit abstract channel c, ACert_γ for every explicitly atomic unit γ, the applicable EnvCert and ResetCert records, the complete Act_L(τ_{post}) inventory and typed footprints, the locally checkable epoch/horizon/stage/ordinal metadata from which J.FoundationRank is computed, the local facts from which Definition J.DepJ generates every dependency edge, any required custom-component footprint/commutation/rank certificates, and LocalAgree(L), all bound to one theorem instance, fixed stimulus, elaboration E, witness w, observation boundary, and RTL_B prefix τ_{post} . J.DepRank, J.DepAcyclic, and J.CanonicalRank are theorem-derived consequences of this package, not additional supplied premises.

Definition J.ConstructionOrderProvenance and J.ValidatedConstructionOrder

For a fixed τ_{post} and global package W, a ValidatedConstructionOrder consists of a complete enumeration $\gamma_1 \dots \gamma_m$ of the indivisible observable units and a finite predecessor relation $\prec_W$ over the construction actions, together with: (V1) well-foundedness of $\prec_W$; (V2) proof that the unit enumeration refines $\prec_J$, reset epochs, atomic grouping, and every strict concrete commit-cycle constraint; (V3) exact coverage and uniqueness of construction actions and complete units; (V4) proof that every process-preparation, request-snapshot, non-blocking-decision, channel, environment, reset, and atomic-commit prerequisite used by the witness chain is a $\prec_W$ predecessor; and (V5) proof that every enumeration prefix is a finite $\prec_J$ ideal and that all $\prec_W$ predecessors needed for its next unit occur earlier. The provenance is exactly one of two forms. The theorem-derived form identifies a LocalGWRPackage L, sets $\prec_W$ to the dependency order generated from Dep_J, and derives the enumeration from J.CanonicalRank using J.DepSound, J.DepComplete, J.DepRank, and J.DepAcyclic. The direct-validated form supplies an independently checked well-founded predecessor relation and

enumeration satisfying V1–V5, without presupposing J.CanonicalRank or a LocalGWR package. Thus both routes use one semantic construction-order interface, while only the normal compositional route derives that interface from local certificates.

Definition J.GWR (GlobalWitnessRealizable(τ_{post}, W))

A selected package W is globally witness-realizable when it contains one coherent global annotation package— WC/μ_Q choices, Issue/Commit and request attribution, explicit-channel E4 histories, atomic groupings, environment/reset identities, dynamic operation identities, request snapshots, and construction-action identities—and there exist: (G1) one J.ValidatedConstructionOrder carrying a finite enumeration $\gamma_1 \dots \gamma_m$ of every complete observable unit of τ_{post} ; (G2) prefixes $H_k = \{\gamma_i \mid i \leq k\}$, each certified as the corresponding finite required-prefix ideal; and (G3) reachable Sys_ref prefixes $\tau_{\text{ref}}[H_k]$ with terminal semantic states $\sigma_{\text{ref}}[H_k]$, beginning at the matched initial/reset state, such that for every $k < m$ there is a finite legal extension $\sigma_{\text{ref}}[H_k] \xrightarrow{\varepsilon} \tilde{\sigma}_{\text{ref}} \xrightarrow{\gamma'_{k+1}} \sigma_{\text{ref}}[H_{k+1}]$, where the ε segment may include only construction actions that precede γ'_{k+1} under the validated predecessor relation, including failed, hence ε , J.NBDecision steps needed to reach the complete matching unit γ'_{k+1} . The chain preserves the required-prefix, deterministic replay, channel-history, witness, dynamic-identity, signal-anchor, synchronization, snapshot, and reset invariants, and its terminal prefix is compatible with τ_{post} under E1–E5. On the theorem-derived route, the validated predecessor relation and enumeration are those produced from LocalGWR, Dep_J, and J.CanonicalRank. On the direct route, they are independently validated as part of W . When cutpoint transfer is requested, W additionally carries the enriched replay-history component H and identities needed by J.OfferReach/J.OfferConf. Historical Issue data remains operational evidence rather than a KObs field. J.GWR is a stable semantic interface. The normal route derives its ValidatedConstructionOrder and the complete witness chain by Theorem J.GWR-Comp from Definition J.LocalGWR. A flow may instead establish the same interface directly through the direct-validated construction-order provenance and a checked reachable chain. No theorem below infers J.GWR from bare Σ -label equality, and the direct route may not refer to J.CanonicalRank unless it also supplies the LocalGWR package and theorem-derived provenance that define that rank.

Lemma J.Frame (local transition framing)

Let a Sys_ref state be decomposed into process-local states, endpoint-owned request/attempt fields, explicit abstract-channel/elaboration states, environment state, and reset state. A transition segment whose certified WriteSet is F changes only the components in F . Therefore every component disjoint from F is equal before and after the segment, and every transition guard whose ReadSet is disjoint from F has the same value. This follows by case analysis on the Sys_ref transition rules and the explicit-boundary/no-hidden-disablement convention.

Lemma J.LocalLift (lifting a certified process-local preparation path)

If the P component of a reachable global state equals the start state of a PCert_P local segment, every incident shared component read by that segment equals the referenced read-only summary, and the segment's typed footprint conditions hold, then that segment lifts to a finite global ε path. The lifted path has the same P -local result and endpoint request/attempt writes, commits no unmatched Σ unit, and frames every unrelated process and channel component. The lifting stops at every NBHole and therefore performs no shared-boundary non-blocking decision. Proof: induction over the finite segment using Lemma J.Frame.

Lemma J.PrepareCommute (commutation of local preparation paths)

Consider the currently executable local preparation segments and other ε construction actions preceding a complete unit γ . If two actions a and b satisfy $\text{WriteSet}(a) \cap (\text{ReadSet}(b) \cup \text{WriteSet}(b)) = \emptyset$ and

$\text{WriteSet}(b) \cap (\text{ReadSet}(a) \cup \text{WriteSet}(a)) = \emptyset$, they commute by Lemma J.Frame and the product-state transition rules. Separately owned endpoint request writes for one interaction may be accumulated when neither segment reads the shared snapshot before both writes are present. A J.NBDecision action is never treated as process-local and never commutes past an action whose write appears in its ReqSnapshot. By Lemma J.DepComplete, every remaining non-commuting pair is ordered by Dep_J^+ ; the sole ordinary buffered dual-update exception is handled by J.BufSameCycle. Consequently any topological execution of the currently required Dep_J actions yields the same prepared state up to framed ϵ -state and same-cycle buffered sequentialization. No fairness premise is used.

Lemma J.NBDecision (globally valid non-blocking decision step)

Suppose the matched construction prefix has executed every Dep_J predecessor of a marked $\text{NBHole}(q, c, \kappa)$, and J.CCert reconstructs $\text{ReqSnapshot_c}(q) = S$ at that point. Then the Sys_ref non-blocking call has exactly one legal decision/return outcome, namely J.NBDecision(q, S). On failure, the corresponding transition is an enabled ϵ action that changes only the caller's local continuation and removes the one-cycle attempt without changing committed channel history; a preparation script may then resume. On success, the decision and transfer commit form the contracted observable action for q . That action may be taken only when it is the selected next complete unit (or has already been included in H); it is not executed inside the ϵ preparation for a later unit. The result agrees with the WC-selected implementation outcome by C5. No process-local script may independently choose or overwrite the result. Proof: case analysis on PushNB/PopNB and $B(c)=0$ versus $B(c)>0$ using the source call rules, the complete snapshot, and E4. ■

Lemma J.UnitEnable (local certificates imply complete-unit enablement)

After all Dep_J predecessor actions and every failed shared-state poll needed to reach γ have been executed as ϵ steps—and, when γ itself is a successful non-blocking transfer, after its ReqSnapshot has been reconstructed for the selected contracted decision/commit—the endpoint request/attempt fields, channel state, and participant states satisfy the premises of the generic Sys_ref transition rule for the complete matching unit. For $B(c)>0$ channels, enablement follows from the common pre-update occupancy/head snapshot and non-fall-through E4; a same-cycle dual Push/Pop may be sequentialized by J.BufSameCycle. For $B(c)=0$ it follows from simultaneous matching endpoint requests/attempts and value agreement. Paired synchronization follows from both named frontiers; anchored signal and R2C units from the certified anchor or unique fixed-point valuation; environment and RESET units from EnvCert/ResetCert. ACert and CCert supply the constituent facts, while this lemma derives complete-unit enablement from the operational rule; neither certificate may simply assert the conclusion.

Lemma J.UnitExt (one complete locally certified unit extends the global prefix)

Assume the matched-prefix invariant at $\sigma_{\text{ref}}[H_k]$, let γ be the least not-yet-matched observable unit under the commit-action J.CanonicalRank, and assume LocalGWRPackage. Consider the finite set of not-yet-executed construction actions in the certified preparation scripts that are Dep_J predecessors of γ . J.DepRank/J.DepAcyclic give a minimal action. Execute process-local segments by J.LocalLift; execute a marked shared-state poll inside the ϵ segment only when J.NBDecision yields failure; if it yields success, its contracted transfer must be γ or an already matched earlier unit; combine unordered actions by J.PrepareCommute; and use J.BufSameCycle when the selected RTL cycle contains a commuting buffered Push/Pop pair. Finiteness of the scripts and repeated removal of a minimal action reach the prepared state for γ . J.UnitEnable then supplies the complete matching Sys_ref transition γ' . The resulting state preserves the replay invariant by Lemma I.DR', updates exactly the certified channel/atomic state, and preserves every framed component. Thus $\sigma_{\text{ref}}[H_k] \xrightarrow{\epsilon^*} \delta_{\text{ref}} \xrightarrow{\gamma'} \sigma_{\text{ref}}[H_k+1]$. The path is finite and uses no B2/B3 fairness.

Theorem J.GWR-Comp (local certificates construct global witness realizability)

Fix a finite reachable RTL_B prefix τ_{post} , the theorem instance, fixed stimulus, elaboration E , observation boundaries, witness w , and reset interpretation. Assume LocalGWRPackage(τ_{post}, L), the Sys_{ref} operational decomposition used by Lemmas J.Frame–J.UnitExt, I.A0/WC, the applicable source well-formedness and RW premises, and B-faithful E4 semantics at every explicit abstract boundary. Then Definition J.DepJ generates a finite relation satisfying J.DepSound and J.DepComplete; Definition J.FoundationRank and Lemma J.DepRank prove J.DepAcyclic; and J.CanonicalRank therefore defines the theorem-derived J.ValidatedConstructionOrder. There exist W and a reachable Sys_{ref} prefix τ_{ref} such that GlobalWitnessRealizable(τ_{post}, W) holds; W is assembled from L , the theorem-derived construction order, and the constructed chain, and τ_{ref} is the terminal prefix of that chain.

Proof. Generate Dep_J and the FR coordinates from the checked local records. Lemmas J.DepSound and J.DepComplete establish that every non-commuting prerequisite is represented and every unordered pair can be swapped. Lemma J.DepRank proves that every generated edge strictly advances one global foundation rank, so J.DepAcyclic follows without appealing to a union of local acyclicity facts; only then is Height defined and J.CanonicalRank derived. Package this rank and predecessor relation as the theorem-derived J.ValidatedConstructionOrder. Order complete units by their commit-action rank, retaining the RTL cycle annotations and using stable keys only between commuting actions. The empty prefix satisfies the initial/reset invariant. For the induction step, J.UnitExt executes the finite predecessor action set—including common-snapshot failed J.NBDecision ϵ steps, while treating a successful decision as its selected observable commit unit—and extends the current reachable global state by the next complete unit. Lemma I.DR' updates every participating replay state; J.CC/Cert/ACert update the common channel/atomic state; J.BufSameCycle justifies either source serialization of a legal same-cycle buffered dual transfer; J.Frame preserves unrelated components; and LocalAgree preserves identity/value/snapshot consistency. Dynamic reset uses ResetCert and Lemma J.RS. Finite induction yields a reachable chain covering every unit. Assemble W from the checked local records, foundation-rank and dependency proofs, validated construction order, snapshots, and the chain; clauses (G1)–(G3) of Definition J.GWR and the required E1–E5 annotations follow by construction. ■

Non-circularity. LocalGWRPackage contains no premise that the local fragments coexist in one source execution and no arbitrary replay phase/rank. J.PCert is indexed by rank-independent RequiredPrefixCandidate records rather than by J.CanonicalRank. The package supplies only typed actions, footprints, locally derived FR coordinates, locally generated dependency facts, snapshots, and interface agreement. J.DepComplete proves that no undeclared non-commuting interaction remains; J.DepRank and J.DepAcyclic prove a global well-founded order; J.NBDecision derives shared-state poll outcomes; and J.PrepareCommute, J.UnitEnable, J.UnitExt, and J.GWR-Comp prove coexistence, endpoint co-presence, common occupancy, absence of incompatible non-blocking outcomes, and finite complete-unit extension.

Proposition J.0 (Pairwise Composition Lemma)

For each process P , let $A_{\text{ref},P}$ and $A_{\text{post},P}$ be the annotated P -local projection records induced by $\tau_{\text{ref},\text{system}}$ and $\tau_{\text{post},\text{system}}$ under the chosen witness/annotation package. Their forgotten observable components are the ordinary projections $\tau_{\text{ref},P}$ and $\tau_{\text{post},P}$, but the records also carry the issue annotations, dynamic message-call universe, μ_Q matching, and request-attribution facts needed by E3/E5 and WC. Assume that for every process P , these annotated projections satisfy the per-process compatibility predicate $A_{\text{ref},P} \approx_P A_{\text{post},P}$. In readable prose below, this may be abbreviated as $\tau_{\text{ref},P} \approx_P \tau_{\text{post},P}$ when the annotation package is fixed by context.

Thus Proposition J.0 is only a conditional composition result for a chosen compatible trace pair. It neither constructs a source execution nor proves J.GWR. Theorem J.GWR-Comp performs the local-to-

global execution construction; Theorem J.1 then instantiates Proposition J.0 with that constructed pair. The restricted reverse clause continues to use the selected pair carried by `RTLConsistentRefPrefix`.

Assume every explicit abstract channel c in the chosen `Sys_ref` / `RTL_B` comparison has finite capacity $B(c) \geq 0$. Also assume, as a per-channel `Sys_ref` / `RTL_B` well-formedness condition, that both chosen traces satisfy the applicable E4 channel semantics at the chosen abstract boundaries. Thus, for $B(c)=0$ channels, committed `Push_c` / `Pop_c` events obey the same-cycle rendezvous semantics; for $B(c)>0$ channels, the committed `Push_c` / `Pop_c` history obeys the reset-empty, cycle-boundary, non-fall-through bounded-FIFO semantics with capacity $B(c)$, including FIFO order, no underflow, no overflow, no duplication, and no loss. Proposition J.0 does not derive these per-channel E4 facts; it assumes them as part of the definition of the compared well-formed `Sys_ref` / `RTL_B` traces.

No weak-fairness or channel-progress premise is needed for this conditional pairwise lifting lemma: Proposition J.0 does not construct a matching trace, but only lifts already-compatible per-process trace projections and already well-formed per-channel communication histories to the aggregate system trace. The finite selected-unit witness-construction premises are used later in Theorem J.1 when proving the finite execution-prefix existence result; weak fairness and channel progress are used only when a corresponding infinite fair execution is asserted. Then the aggregate traces are compatible: $\tau_{\text{ref},\text{system}} \approx_{\text{sys}} \tau_{\text{post},\text{system}}$ under rules E1–E5 (given the R rules and B rules).

Notation: The order relation $<_{\text{src}}$ used below is the dynamic source-induced order from Appendix G / R1–R4: it ranges over dynamic operation instances in the compared execution / witness, not over all syntactic call sites in the source text. Equivalently, when the process must be explicit, write $<_P$. Untaken branches and unexecuted loop iterations are not members of the witness-specific dynamic universe.

Proof

We prove each compatibility property. The per-channel E4 facts are not derived inside this proposition; they are part of the per-channel `Sys_ref` / `RTL_B` well-formedness hypothesis for the chosen traces.

E1 (Synchronization-order preservation):

Fix any process P . By the proposition hypothesis, $\tau_{\text{ref},P} \approx_P \tau_{\text{post},P}$, so the synchronization events of P occur in the same source order in both traces. Since this holds for every P , E1 holds for the system traces $\tau_{\text{ref},\text{system}}$ and $\tau_{\text{post},\text{system}}$.

E2 (Signal-visibility preservation):

Fix any process P . If P is a sequential process, then by the proposition hypothesis (using the E2 anchoring relation embodied in $\tau_{\text{ref},P} \approx_P \tau_{\text{post},P}$), every signal `Read` in P is anchored to P 's closest preceding synchronization event, and every signal `Write` in P is anchored to P 's closest succeeding synchronization event, in both $\tau_{\text{ref},P}$ and $\tau_{\text{post},P}$.

If P is a combinational process, then R2C rather than `pred_S/succ_S` anchoring applies: P 's observable signal `Read/Write` events are represented by the R2C fixed-point signal-observation unit for the relevant combinational process/network component, matched by that component's local R2C occurrence ordinal as specified in the R2C unit matching/index convention. By the combinational well-formedness condition and the compatibility hypothesis for the fixed stimulus / selected witness, the pre-HLS and post-HLS combinational networks reach corresponding unique ϵ -fixed-point valuations for the matched R2C occurrence unit, so the matched `Read/Write` labels agree within that fixed-point unit. This local R2C-unit agreement is an explicit atomicity constraint; it does not require `Sys_ref` and `RTL_B` to use the same global observable cycle-bucket decomposition for unrelated independent events.

Since the appropriate sequential or combinational signal-visibility condition holds for every process P , E2 holds for $\tau_{\text{ref},\text{system}}$ and $\tau_{\text{post},\text{system}}$.

E3 (Safe message issue ordering):

Fix any process P . E3 is the post-side issue-order conjunct of the per-process compatibility relation $\approx_P$, not an additional ordering property derived from the `Sys_ref` trace. Thus what must be checked here is

that P 's post-HLS execution satisfies E3 as stated in Appendix G: for any $q_1, q_2 \in Q_{\text{exec}, P}$ with $q_1 <_{\text{src}} q_2$, including ordinary distinct-interface message calls that appear in dynamic source sequence, $\text{issue_post}(q_1) \leq \text{issue_post}(q_2)$, and the issued set is prefix-closed under that source order. Same-cycle issue is permitted where allowed, and a later operation may be issued before an earlier operation commits under Policy L, but a source-later operation may not be issued before the source-earlier operation has issued. This post-side property is part of the local per-process hypothesis $\tau_{\text{ref}, P} \approx_P \tau_{\text{post}, P}$; in the execution-level use of Proposition J.0 / Theorem J.1, the needed post-side witness/order fact is supplied by Appendix I / Implementation assumption I.A0. Since the E3 post-side conjunct holds for every P , the aggregate system pair satisfies E3.

E4 (Per-channel channel semantics):

E4 holds by the per-channel Sys_ref / RTL_B well-formedness hypothesis of Proposition J.0. That hypothesis states that, for every explicit abstract channel c in the chosen comparison, the Sys_ref and RTL_B traces already satisfy the applicable E4 channel semantics at the chosen abstract boundary: same-cycle rendezvous semantics when $B(c)=0$, and reset-empty, cycle-boundary, non-fall-through bounded-FIFO semantics when $B(c)>0$. Thus Proposition J.0 uses E4 as an assumed channel-realization condition for the chosen traces; it does not attempt to derive E4 from the per-process compatibility relation. Accordingly, Proposition J.0 should be read as a composition theorem under already-established process and channel conformance hypotheses. It does not prove that the implementation realizes the chosen abstract channel boundaries, nor that the back-annotated capacities $B(c)$ satisfy B-faithfulness as defined in the Common Formal Definitions. Those facts are separate RTL/tool-flow compliance obligations required before the theorem is applied to a concrete generated design.

E5 (Messages cannot cross syncs):

For every synchronization call s (in the source order used by $R3$ / pref_S / suff_S over $Q_{\text{exec}, P}$):

$\forall q \in \text{pref_S}(s) : \text{issue_post}(q) \leq \text{clk_post}(s)$

$\forall q \in \text{suff_S}(s) : \text{issue_post}(q) > \text{clk_post}(s)$

(Note: For blocking message transfers, the “no-withdraw”/persistence semantics imply that if a blocking operation is issued in the pre-side interval before s , then it must also commit no later than s (and similarly on the post side), because the process cannot complete s until all earlier-issued blocking requests in that interval have committed. Failed non-blocking polls in $Q_{\text{exec}, P}$ are constrained at the issue level by this rule but contribute no committed Σ -event when they fail.)

This property is guaranteed per-process by the proposition hypothesis on the chosen compatible pair (with Appendix I supplying the witnesses in the execution-level $\text{Post} \rightarrow \text{Ref}$ use case) and requires no inter-process reasoning, so it lifts directly to the system level.

Conclusion:

All five compatibility properties hold at the system level for this chosen compatible trace pair. The composition is valid because:

- intra-process properties are preserved by the per-process compatibility hypothesis;
- inter-process communication respects the applicable E4 channel semantics by the per-channel Sys_ref / RTL_B well-formedness hypothesis; and
- no progress or fairness argument is needed inside Proposition J.0, because the lemma composes already-given traces.

The existence of the source trace used in the normal $\text{Post} \rightarrow \text{Ref}$ application is supplied by Theorem J.GWR-Comp; a J.GWR-Direct package supplies the alternate entry route. Therefore $\tau_{\text{ref}, \text{system}} \approx_{\text{sys}} \tau_{\text{post}, \text{system}}$. $\square$

Remark 1. When $\text{Sys_ref} = \text{Sys_B}$ and all $B(c)=0$, Sys_ref coincides with the rendezvous interpretation of Sys , so Proposition J.0 and Theorem J.1 both specialize to the rendezvous case. In the elaborated cases, the source-side proof target is $\text{Sys_ref} = \text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$.

Remark 2 (Reference-model ladder: raw Sys, abstract Sys_B, and elaborated Sys_B^{elab}).

The Matchlib library provides a capacity back-annotation feature that extracts finite capacities $B(c)$ from the RTL realization of each message-passing channel and makes them available to the source-level model. To avoid ambiguity, this document distinguishes three source-side models:

- Sys: the raw source-level rendezvous interpretation of the user-written processes, i.e., the model obtained when every effective channel capacity is zero and no additional abstract realization structure is introduced.
- Sys_B: the abstract bounded-FIFO source-level interpretation of the same user-written processes under E4, with finite capacities $B(c)$ at the chosen abstract channel boundaries. When all $B(c)=0$ and no additional abstract realization structure is needed, Sys_B coincides with Sys.
- Sys_B^{elab}: the elaborated back-annotated source-level model used in the more complex cases discussed in Appendix B / Appendix Q, in which additional explicit abstract staged/bundle/join channels are introduced so that conjunctive/join dependencies, synchronization-boundary ramp-down / epoch-gating, occupancies, and enablement are represented at explicit abstract boundaries rather than as hidden predicates at the outer Σ -visible endpoints.

Formal proof target. Unless a statement explicitly says otherwise, the formal results of Appendices J–K target the prescribed source reference model Sys_ref, defined as follows:

- (i) Sys_ref = Sys_B in the ordinary case where finite capacities $B(c)$ at the chosen abstract boundaries suffice to capture the RTL realization; and
- (ii) Sys_ref = Sys_B^{elab} in the elaborated cases where additional explicit abstract staged/bundle/join channels or explicit sync-boundary / epoch-gate channels are required.

In particular, if an RTL pipeline with an explicit synchronization boundary ramps down by draining already accepted work and withholding producer-facing availability for capacity usable only after the synchronization call commits, then the prescribed source reference model is Sys_B^{elab}. That withholding shall be represented as ordinary ChannelDisabled behavior at an explicit abstract boundary of Sys_B^{elab}. It shall not be modeled as an extra hidden disablement predicate on an outer bounded channel whose E4 occupancy test would otherwise make the transfer enabled.

For a simple pipelined loop with a single message-passing input and output, Sys_ref is ordinarily just Sys_B: the RTL pipeline’s internal staging capacity is accounted for entirely by the back-annotated effective capacity $B(c)$ at the chosen Sys_B channel boundary. Concretely, Sys_B still has exactly one Σ -visible Push_c(v) at the producer endpoint and one Σ -visible Pop_c(v) at the consumer endpoint. With overlapped iterations, the post-HLS RTL may accept/read-ahead up to $B(c)$ values into internal pipeline staging before older iterations produce their corresponding outputs; these accept/read-ahead transfers are modeled as internal microstate (ϵ) within the concrete realization contributing to $B(c)$. The RTL may realize this staging on either side of a particular module-local “Pop interface” handshake point; that handshake point need not coincide with the chosen Σ -visible Pop endpoint. By construction, the chosen Sys_B boundary encloses all staging counted in $B(c)$ between the Σ -visible endpoints, so movements within that enclosed realization (including stage-to-stage handoff) do not create additional Σ -visible committed Push/Pop events beyond the single boundary Push/Pop events.

In more complex cases such as HW pipelines with multiple message-passing inputs, the back-annotation

mechanism may elaborate the source-side simulation into $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$ by introducing additional explicit abstract realization structure. In those cases the formal target is $\text{Sys_ref} = \text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$, and $B(\cdot)$, $\text{occ_}(t)$, E4, BoundaryReq, ChannelEnabled/ChannelDisabled, and the Appendix K blocking/WFG machinery are interpreted over the explicit abstract channels of that elaborated model. See Appendix B and Appendix Q.

Operational note. In all three cases, Sys_ref is a transition system with explicit process states, explicit abstract channel states, operation-attributive pending requests, and ε -microstate as defined in Appendix G’s operational interpretation of Sys_ref . Sys_B and $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$ differ in the channel/elaboration component of that transition system, not in the ordinary dynamic source order of the user-written process code. Source-level message-call instances that appear in sequence in a process remain ordered by $<_{\text{src}}$; elaboration may introduce additional explicit proof-internal frontier items and abstract channels, but it does not make ordinary source-sequenced calls incomparable.

Note that in all cases the elaborated structure (staged/bundle/join channels, combinational couplers, and the projection map Π_{elab}) introduced for a particular pipelined realization is local to that process’s side of the abstract channels at its boundaries. The complementary endpoint processes see only the abstract Σ -visible channels at the boundary and are unaffected by the elaboration choices.

For Lean-style formalization, the phrase “chosen Sys_ref ” should be read as an explicit theorem parameter: either Sys_B itself, or $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}(E)$ for a well-formed elaboration package E as defined in Appendix Q. Likewise, references to the Appendix I/L witness machinery assume that the actual WC premise has been discharged. The corresponding audit entry records whether WC was proved through NB-CF, an Appendix L snooping / witness-selector construction satisfying Lemma L.2, another direct witness construction, or complete mixed per-site coverage. NB-CF and Appendix L snooping are provenance routes for proving WC, not independent theorem premises alongside WC.

Side-condition audit before theorem application. Applying Theorem J.1, Corollary J.1, or Appendix K to a concrete design requires the side-condition record from the Common Formal Definitions. The normal $\text{Post} \rightarrow \text{Ref}$ route shall identify Sys_ref , discharge WC, and provide Definition J.LocalGWR: complete J.PCert, J.CCert, J.ACet, environment/reset, construction-action inventory, typed footprint, request-snapshot, locally generated Dep_J , LocalAgree, and coverage evidence, together with per-channel B-faithfulness. J.CanonicalRank is derived by the theorem. A flow may instead record J.GWR-Direct together with its direct-provenance J.ValidatedConstructionOrder and independently checked V1–V5 obligations. When Corollary J.1 or Appendix K is used, the application must additionally discharge J.OfferReach, J.OfferConf, and J.KObsConf for the same theorem-produced or directly supplied W , source prefix, RTL prefix, H , O , and cutpoints. Liveness uses the additional K.Drain, $K\varepsilon$, K.CV, A5-L, selected A5-L discharge route, progress, NB-Align, and L.Dir obligations as applicable. Ordinary synthesis does not automatically discharge any of these named conditions.

Remark 3 (Practical rendezvous liveness screening under determinism).

When B1 holds and the design’s control flow does not branch on empty/full observations of non-blocking interfaces (i.e., it depends only on the ordered history of observable Push/Pop/synchronization actions, not on “probe” outcomes (NB-CF, Appendix I.2)), the rendezvous specialization $B(c)=0$ is often an effective practical screen for design-level deadlocks: it exercises the most constrained communication discipline and can expose true cyclic data-dependency deadlocks early. Because rendezvous is strictly more constrained than buffered/elaborated operation, it can also yield false positives: a deadlock observed under $B(c)=0$ may disappear once finite buffering or explicit elaborated staged/bundle/join structure is present. However, bounded buffering can still introduce capacity-

induced deadlocks (FIFO-depth artifacts) when FIFO depths are underestimated; these deadlocks are real for that modeled capacity configuration but may disappear once capacities are increased to the intended design point. Increasing buffer capacity (or applying dynamic buffer-growth strategies) is a standard way to distinguish depth-limited deadlocks from true cyclic dependency deadlocks. Accordingly, the formal results of Appendices J–K deliberately target the prescribed source reference model Sys_ref of Remark 2, with the actual back-annotated capacities and explicit abstract boundaries required by the chosen realization, rather than relying on rendezvous alone.

Remark 4 (When raw Sys may be used instead of the prescribed source reference model for safety-only checks).

If verification is concerned only with safety properties over the chosen DUT-boundary projection Σ (denote it Σ_{DUT}) (and not with deadlock/liveness), the prescribed source reference model Sys_ref of Remark 2 remains the default reference model. This is because Σ_{DUT} includes committed channel-transfer events, and bounded buffering / explicit staged-bundle-join structure generally changes the set/timing of those committed $\text{Push_c}/\text{Pop_c}$ events relative to the raw rendezvous case.

Practical note (early bring-up): Before accurate capacities $B(c)$ are available (or before back-annotation/elaboration can be used), running the rendezvous specialization Sys against the intended testbench is still useful to validate functional intent and catch gross protocol/ordering bugs early; however, it remains a screening check, not a proof about the buffered/elaborated RTL-correspondent model.

Important (soundness): When any channel or explicit abstract staged/bundle/join boundary that can influence Σ_{DUT} -observable behavior has positive effective capacity or nontrivial enablement structure, the raw rendezvous model Sys is often a restriction of Sys_ref / RTL_B at Σ_{DUT} (it can admit fewer Σ_{DUT} behaviors). Therefore, using Sys in place of Sys_ref is generally suitable only as a debug/screening check: a failure can be useful diagnostically, but a pass does not by itself prove Σ_{DUT} -safety of the buffered/elaborated implementation.

Sys may be used as a proof-equivalent substitute for Sys_ref only when Sys and Sys_ref are Σ_{DUT} -equivalent for the chosen Σ_{DUT} (i.e., their Σ_{DUT} -projected trace sets coincide under the intended stimulus). A simple sufficient condition is that every Σ_{DUT} -visible explicit abstract channel/boundary in Sys_ref has effective capacity zero and that buffering/elaboration elsewhere is Σ_{DUT} -opaque (it cannot enable/disable/reorder Σ_{DUT} -events or change when Σ_{DUT} -events occur). In all other cases—i.e., if any Σ_{DUT} -visible explicit abstract boundary has positive effective capacity, or if buffered/elaborated internal channels can affect when Σ_{DUT} -events occur—use the prescribed Sys_ref of Remark 2.

Formal soundness condition. Let $\text{Traces}_{\Sigma_{\text{DUT}}}(\text{M})$ denote the set of Σ_{DUT} -projected traces of model M under the intended fixed stimulus. Sys may replace Sys_ref for proving a universal Σ_{DUT} -safety property ϕ only if $\text{Traces}_{\Sigma_{\text{DUT}}}(\text{Sys}) = \text{Traces}_{\Sigma_{\text{DUT}}}(\text{Sys_ref})$; under that condition, $\text{Sys} \models \phi$ iff $\text{Sys_ref} \models \phi$ (and otherwise Sys is only a diagnostic/screening check as stated above).

Expanded proof of Theorem J.GWR-Comp and Theorem J.1

Post $\rightarrow$ Ref, compositional route. Fix $\tau_{\text{post}} \in \text{Reach_post}$ and L with $\text{LocalGWRPackage}(\tau_{\text{post}}, L)$. Let $U(\tau_{\text{post}})$ be the finite set of complete observable units, with rendezvous, paired synchronization, E2 anchor groups, R2C units, RESET units, and other semantically atomic transactions represented as indivisible units. Generate Act_L and Dep_J from the local records, apply J.DepRank and J.DepAcyclic , and order $U(\tau_{\text{post}})$ by the J.CanonicalRank of its commit actions. The resulting theorem-derived $\text{J.ValidatedConstructionOrder}$ refines RTL commit-cycle order and every generated non-commuting prerequisite; actions with the same cycle and no dependency are ordered only by stable proof keys and may be swapped without changing the construction result.

For $0 \leq k \leq m$, let H_k be the first k ranked units. We construct by induction a reachable Sys_ref prefix $\tau_{\text{ref}}[H_k]$ ending in $\sigma_{\text{ref}}[H_k]$. The invariant is:

- (I1) required-prefix matching: exactly H_k has committed, with matching labels, values, dynamic identities, atomic grouping, and all $\prec_J$ constraints preserved;
- (I2) process replay: every process state agrees with $\text{Replay_P}(H_k, w)$ on all future- Σ -relevant values, control, completion, dynamic-operation, and request-attribution facts;
- (I3) channel/atomic state: every explicit boundary has the CCert-reconstructed E4 history/state for H_k , and every completed atomic transaction has the ACert identity/value interpretation; and
- (I4) certificate coherence: the current global endpoint requests, witness choices, reset epochs, and environment history agree with the local records already consumed.

Base case. Use the matched initial state, reset-empty channel state, empty request inventory, fixed environment history, and LocalAgree. For later dynamic resets, ResetCert and Lemma J.RS re-establish the same invariant per reset epoch while framing components outside the reset scope.

Induction step. Let γ be the next canonical unit. Every construction action that must precede γ is either already represented in H_k or belongs to the finite not-yet-executed Dep_J predecessor set recorded by the preparation scripts. Select a Dep_J -minimal action. A process-local segment is embedded by $J.\text{LocalLift}$. If the action is a marked non-blocking decision, first reconstruct its complete ReqSnapshot and apply $J.\text{NBDecision}$. A failed result is an ϵ action and the local script resumes; a successful result is a contracted observable transfer and therefore must be γ (or already belong to H_k), not an ϵ predecessor hidden before a later unit. $J.\text{PrepareCommute}$ permits any ordering of read/write-independent actions, and $J.\text{DepComplete}$ ensures that every pair not permitted to commute is already ordered. Repeating this finite step reaches the prepared state for γ .

Every witness-significant failed or successful non-blocking call is therefore evaluated at one common incident-boundary snapshot rather than inside an independently replayed process path. The construction cannot choose a failed rendezvous poll while a matching persistent request is present, cannot choose success in an empty/full state that forbids it, and cannot attribute an outcome to a different dynamic call. WC identifies the implementation-selected outcome; $J.\text{CCert}$ and $J.\text{NBDecision}$ prove that it is the unique legal source outcome at the reconstructed snapshot.

$J.\text{UnitEnable}$ now proves the complete matching unit enabled. In the buffered case, the common pre-update history determines occupancy/head and non-fall-through E4 legality. When one Push and one Pop share an RTL cycle and both were independently enabled at that pre-cycle state, $J.\text{BufSameCycle}$ permits either source serialization and proves the same resulting FIFO state; empty and full boundary fall-through remain forbidden. In the rendezvous case, both matching endpoint requests/attempts and payload identity are present simultaneously. Paired synchronization uses both dynamic endpoint identities; E2 anchor groups commit their synchronization and anchored signal events together; R2C uses the unique certified fixed point; environment and reset units use EnvCert/ResetCert. The existential transition relation selects the enabled complete unit, yielding $\sigma_{\text{ref}}[H_k] \xrightarrow{\epsilon^*} \tilde{\sigma}_{\text{ref}} \xrightarrow{\gamma'} \sigma_{\text{ref}}[H_{\{k+1\}}]$.

Lemma I.DR' establishes (I2) for the participants after γ' . $J.\text{CCert}/\text{ACert}$ establish the exact state update for (I3); $J.\text{Frame}$ preserves every nonparticipant; and LocalAgree preserves (I4). Hence the invariant holds for $H_{\{k+1\}}$. The extension is finite by the local certificates/FPD and uses no weak fairness, channel progress, or fair infinite continuation.

At $k=m$, the chain covers every unit of τ_{post} . Assemble W from the local certificates, generated dependency graph, derived canonical enumeration, common request snapshots, and constructed source chain. Definition J.GWR holds by the invariant and extension construction; this proves Theorem J.GWR-Comp. The terminal source prefix $\tau_{\text{ref}} = \tau_{\text{ref}}[H_m]$ and τ_{post} have compatible annotated process projections and well-formed explicit-channel histories, so Proposition J.0 yields $\tau_{\text{ref}, \text{system}} \approx_{\text{sys}} \tau_{\text{post}, \text{system}}$. This proves Theorem J.1's compositional $\text{Post} \rightarrow \text{Ref}$ clause.

Post $\rightarrow$ Ref, direct route. If a validated W satisfying Definition J.GWR is supplied directly, take the reachable terminal source prefix from its chain and apply Proposition J.0 to the annotated pair. This route has the same semantic conclusion but bypasses the local-certificate derivation.

Normalization and cutpoints. Neither route appends a maximal ε -normalization suffix after each matched unit. Corollary J.1 separately applies B4/B5 to the selected terminal prefixes and then requires J.OfferReach, J.OfferConf, and J.KObsConf for the normalized cutpoints. The theorem-produced W is the authoritative source of the operational identities and history used by those obligations.

Ref $\rightarrow$ Post clause. Let $\tau_{\text{ref}} \in \text{Exec_ref}$ and choose $\tau_{\text{post}}^* \in \text{Exec_post}$ and W with $\text{RTLConsistentRefPrefix}(\tau_{\text{ref}}, \tau_{\text{post}}^*, W)$. By definition, the selected pair already carries compatible annotated projections, Issue/Commit and request-attribution evidence, dynamic identities, WC/μ_Q data, and E4 histories. Proposition J.0 therefore gives $\tau_{\text{ref}, \text{system}} \approx_{\text{sys}} \tau_{\text{post}^*, \text{system}}$; take $\tau_{\text{post}} = \tau_{\text{post}}^*$. B1 supplies uniqueness only of the selected RTL Σ projection, not of the annotation package. This is not a construction from an arbitrary source run. $\square$

Lemma J.HCanon (Canonical replay-history quotient agreement)

Fix the same theorem instance I , elaboration E , witness w , reset interpretation, dynamic operation identities, and theorem-produced or directly validated J.GWR annotation package. Let τ_{post} be a finite RTL_B prefix and τ_{ref} the Theorem J.1 source witness prefix selected for τ_{post} . If τ_{ref} and τ_{post} satisfy the annotated observable-unit compatibility relation of Theorem J.1 under that fixed package, then their canonical enriched replay-history quotients are equal:

$$\text{CanonHist}_{E,w}(\tau_{\text{ref}}) = \text{CanonHist}_{E,w}(\tau_{\text{post}}).$$

Proof. The compatibility relation matches the same atomic observable units with the same labels, values, dynamic identities, and reset scopes. The fixed witness w and μ_Q/WC package identify the same witness-selected failed non-blocking, arbitration, signal, and ε -choice outcomes used by replay. Theorem J.1 preserves each process-local required order, each per-channel committed-transfer ordinal/FIFO order, every explicit atomic rendezvous or paired-synchronization grouping, every RESET marker, and every predecessor required by $<_J$. CanonHist retains exactly those fields. It discards only incidental source-versus-RTL clock-bucket placement and ordering among units that are independent under the retained constraints. Therefore both annotated prefixes map to the same typed quotient H . This lemma asserts equality of the canonical replay quotient, not equality of concrete cycle buckets or historical Issue timestamps. $\blacksquare$

Definition J.OfferReach (reachable source realization of a KObs record)

Fix the theorem instance I , elaboration package E , witness w , enriched replay history H , attributed residual-offer set O , and the particular Sys_ref witness prefix selected for the current Theorem J.1 / Corollary J.1 application. Write $\text{OfferReach}_{I,E,w}(H,O; \tau_{\text{ref}}, \sigma_{\text{ref}})$ when all of the following hold: τ_{ref} is a finite reachable Sys_ref prefix under the same fixed stimulus; after the selected finite B4/B5 ε -normalization it ends in the ε -quiescent cutpoint σ_{ref} ; $H = H_{E,w}(\sigma_{\text{ref}})$; $O = \text{ResOffers}_{E,w}(\sigma_{\text{ref}})$; and the prefix and cutpoint satisfy the operational Issue/Commit, E3/E5, Axiom R.1, reset-epoch, elaboration, and explicit-boundary rules of the selected Sys_ref instance. For an Appendix K application, the selected prefix/cutpoint package shall additionally be recorded as admissible under Policy L; this is the source-policy reachability fact consumed by Theorem K.1A.

OfferReach is an image/realizability predicate. It is not implied by type-correctness, source-prefix closure, or endpoint cardinality of an arbitrary tuple $\langle E, w, H, O \rangle$. In Corollary J.1 it is discharged for the same normalized source witness selected from Theorem J.1, not for an unrelated existential source state. A source execution log, mechanized reachability proof, or tool/witness certificate may discharge it.

Historical Issue cycles may be used internally to prove that τ_{ref} is admissible and that O is its current residual-offer set, but they are not fields of $K\text{Obs}$ and are not compared with RTL issue cycles. OfferReach records only the surviving attributed offers at the selected cutpoint.

Definition J.RelevantReq (KObs-relevant RTL endpoint request)

At an ϵ -quiescent RTL_B cutpoint p_{post} , an asserted request level r is $K\text{Obs}$ -relevant for elaboration E when: (i) r is endpoint-owned and lies at an explicit abstract boundary selected by E ; and (ii) the presence or absence of r can affect the reconstruction of BoundaryReq, a rendezvous endpoint-request/co-presence fact, ChannelEnabled/ChannelDisabled, Front, WFG, WFG+, or a derived Dead_K/Dead_KS diagnostic predicate. Relevance is determined from the selected physical/abstract boundary and the reconstructed cutpoint interface, not from whether the flow happened to supply an attribution. Thus an asserted boundary request with missing attribution remains relevant and causes J.OfferConf to fail; it cannot be dropped from the abstraction by calling it unrecognized. K.Resp timers are not $K\text{Obs}$ fields and are validated separately by CF-S.

The dynamic operation/frontier/epoch attribution used below is supplied by the operational request-attribution component constructed by J.GWR-Comp or supplied by J.GWR-Direct, constrained by Appendix C's Issue/Commit linkage and Implementation Assumption I.A0. It is not inferred from the ready/valid wire level alone. A post-cycle request level proved by those annotations to belong only to an operation that committed in the selected cycle, with no next dynamic operation owning the continuing level, is not a residual offer. For a back-to-back continuing assertion, the annotation shall identify the next owning dynamic operation.

Obligation J.OfferConf (bidirectional RTL residual-offer conformance)

For an ϵ -quiescent RTL_B cutpoint p_{post} , fixed E and w , and candidate residual-offer set O , OfferConf_I,E,w(p_{post} , O) holds only if the following boundary conditions are satisfied at every explicit abstract boundary used by the theorem instance. All references to attribution use the theorem-produced or directly supplied operational package, Appendix C, and I.A0 as specified by Definition J.RelevantReq; no attribution is inferred solely from an asserted wire level.

- (1) Offer-to-request completeness. For every $o = (P, x, q, c, \text{dir}, e) \in O$, the corresponding endpoint-owned RTL request at c and direction dir is asserted at p_{post} , is $K\text{Obs}$ -relevant, and is attributed by the selected J.GWR-Comp-produced operational package (or J.GWR-Direct package) to that same frontier item x and source operation q in reset epoch e , with the operation kind derived from q .
- (2) Request-to-offer completeness and uniqueness. Every $K\text{Obs}$ -relevant endpoint-owned RTL request asserted at the selected post-cycle ϵ -quiescent cutpoint is attributed by the selected J.GWR-Comp-produced operational package (or J.GWR-Direct package), Appendix C, and I.A0 to exactly one member of O , unless that package proves that the level belongs only to an operation that committed in the selected cycle and no next operation owns the continuing assertion. If the level remains high for a back-to-back operation, the attribution shall identify that next dynamic operation and the corresponding member of O . No relevant asserted request may be hidden, left unattributed, or omitted from O . At most one attributed outstanding source-level offer exists per explicit boundary and endpoint direction.
- (3) Snapshot issue-order consistency. The issued-summary represented by the committed/replay history H , the WC witness information, and the current residual offers O is prefix-closed under the applicable dynamic source order and is consistent with $E3$, $E5$, reset epochs, and the selected elaboration. This is a cutpoint set invariant; OfferConf does not compare historical first-issue timestamps across models.
- (4) Boundary and reset typing. Every x , q , c , direction, kind, owner, and epoch in O is supplied by E and agrees with the live RTL boundary attribution. Reset clears ending-epoch offers as required by RW2.

Internal movement already represented as E4 occupancy is not also exposed as a second source-level offer.

(5) Payload scope. O need not contain pending Push payload values. Stable request payload is still required by Appendix C/Axiom R.1, and committed payload equality is checked by the value-labeled replay history. A flow that needs mid-flight data-wire correspondence may add it as a separate implementation obligation.

Audit-critical status of J.OfferConf(2). J.OfferConf is the authoritative RTL request-abstraction boundary for the KObs cutpoint result. In particular, request-to-offer completeness, no-hidden-request, explicit-boundary completeness, and attribution uniqueness are load-bearing obligations: omitting any asserted request that is KObs-relevant can remove a reconstructed wait-for edge or rendezvous-enablement fact and invalidates J.OfferConf, J.KObsConf, and the equal-KObs conclusion. B-faithfulness/E4 and canonical-history agreement remain separate independent obligations; satisfying them does not compensate for an incomplete request abstraction.

Obligation J.KObsConf (composite KObs cutpoint conformance)

For every reachable ϵ -quiescent RTL_B cutpoint used by Corollary J.1 or Appendix K, the flow shall select one exact package $(\tau_{\text{ref}}, \sigma_{\text{ref}}, \rho_{\text{post}}, l, E, w, H, O)$ such that: (a) the selected source and RTL prefixes use the same fixed instance, elaboration, witness, stimulus, reset-epoch interpretation, and observation boundaries; (b) Lemma J.HCanon yields H as their common canonical replay-history quotient, without requiring equal incidental cycle bucketings; (c) J.OfferReach_I,E,w(H,O; $\tau_{\text{ref}}, \sigma_{\text{ref}}$) holds and therefore realizes O at the reachable source cutpoint; (d) J.OfferConf_I,E,w(ρ_{post}, O) holds and therefore identifies O bidirectionally and uniquely with the complete KObs-relevant RTL request inventory; and (e) the selected RTL abstract boundaries satisfy E4, B-faithfulness, reset correspondence, and ϵ -opacity of the finite normalization. J.KObsConf is tied to the particular source witness chosen by Theorem J.1; an unrelated existential source cutpoint or an unrealizable residual-offer record does not discharge it. Define the J-facing RTL observation certified by that package as $\text{KObsPost}_J(\rho_{\text{post}}; E, w, H, O) := \langle E, w, H, O \rangle$. J.OfferReach and Definition R.18c give $\text{KObs}_{E,w}(\sigma_{\text{ref}}) = \langle E, w, H, O \rangle$. Hence J.KObsConf entails $\text{KObsPost}_J(\rho_{\text{post}}; E, w, H, O) = \text{KObs}_{E,w}(\sigma_{\text{ref}})$. This typed equality is the sole cutpoint-level correspondence used by Appendix K. It is not equality of arbitrary RTL and source microstates, and it creates no independent clause-based state relation.

Corollary J.1 (K-observation Correspondence at the End of a Matched Observable Prefix)

Purpose.

This corollary is the bridge between execution-level trace compatibility and the K-facing cutpoint observation used directly by Appendix K. Its primary and authoritative cutpoint conclusion is equality of the compact KObs record, not equality of arbitrary source and RTL state. K-relevant frontier, request, channel, enablement, WFG, drain, and deadlock facts are derived from that equality by the named reconstruction functions; no clause expansion is required by the Appendix K transfer layer.

Statement. Assume the hypotheses of Theorem J.1 for Sys_ref versus RTL_B under the fixed stimulus, including B1 for the RTL_B Σ projection, and use B4/B5 to choose finite ϵ -normalized cutpoints. Let $\tau_{\text{post}} \in \text{Reach}_{\text{post}}$ carry the J.GWR package constructed by J.GWR-Comp or supplied by J.GWR-Direct. Choose an ϵ -quiescent RTL_B representative ρ_{post} by a maximal finite ϵ -extension of τ_{post} . Select the

matching Theorem J.1 source witness prefix and the finite source ϵ -normalization recorded by $J.\text{OfferReach}$, ending in the reachable ϵ -quiescent cutpoint σ_{ref} . Fix the same I , E , w , H , and O throughout, and assume $J.\text{KObsConf}$ for this exact package, namely: canonical-history agreement H from Lemma J.HCanon, $J.\text{OfferReach}_{I,E,w}(H,O;\tau_{\text{ref}},\sigma_{\text{ref}})$, $J.\text{OfferConf}_{I,E,w}(\rho_{\text{post}},O)$, B-faithful/E4 interpretation at E 's explicit boundaries, reset correspondence, and ϵ -opacity. Then:

(1) $\tau_{\text{ref},\text{system}} \approx \tau_{\text{post},\text{system}}$ under $E1\text{--}E5$; and

(2) $\text{KObsPost}_J(\rho_{\text{post}};E,w,H,O) = \text{KObs}_E,w(\sigma_{\text{ref}})$.

Derived K-facing consequence. Let K denote the common record in conclusion (2). Every typed reconstruction function in Definitions R.18d–R.18e has the same value on the selected post and source views. In particular, ProcRec , ChanRec , NextFrontRec , PendingRec , BoundaryReqRec , FrontRec , $\text{ChannelEnabledRec}/\text{ChannelDisabledRec}$, WFGRec , and DrainClosedNowRec agree. Under the explicit premises stated in Definition R.18c-1 and Lemma R.21f, the corresponding waiver- and environment-dependent Dead_K^W and optional diagnostic Dead_{KS}^W reconstructions also agree. These are functional consequences of conclusion (2), not additional implementation-side state-equality assumptions. $K.\text{RespFail}$ is not transferred by this consequence.

Proof of Corollary J.1

Step 0 (Choose the normalized cutpoints). Extend the selected RTL prefix by one maximal finite ϵ suffix to the chosen ϵ -quiescent ρ_{post} ; B4 makes the suffix finite and B5 supplies the quiescent/fixed-point interpretation. Use the source normalization recorded by $J.\text{OfferReach}$ to obtain the ϵ -quiescent σ_{ref} . Neither side requires uniqueness of maximal ϵ extensions; all conclusions are relative to the selected package.

Step 1 (Obtain the matched replay history). Apply Theorem J.1 to the selected RTL prefix and its theorem-produced or directly supplied $J.\text{GWR}$ package to obtain the matching Sys_{ref} witness prefix under the same stimulus. Lemma J.HCanon then gives

$\text{CanonHist}_{E,w}(\tau_{\text{ref}}) = \text{CanonHist}_{E,w}(\tau_{\text{post}}) = H$.

Thus conclusion (1) holds, and the replay-history field of the two KObs records is equal even when their concrete cycle-bucket decompositions differ. The retained fields and the erased incidental ordering are exactly those stated in Lemma J.HCanon.

Step 2 (Establish the common residual offers). $J.\text{OfferReach}$ identifies O exactly with $\text{ResOffers}_{E,w}(\sigma_{\text{ref}})$ at the selected reachable source cutpoint. $J.\text{OfferConf}$ identifies that same O bidirectionally and uniquely with the relevant asserted endpoint-owned RTL requests at ρ_{post} . The reset-epoch, source-prefix-closure, boundary-cardinality, and no-hidden-request conditions ensure that O is a well-typed residual-offer component for both sides.

Step 3 (Conclude equal KObs). Both records have the same elaboration E , witness w , replay history H , and residual-offer set O . Therefore $\text{KObsPost}_J(\rho_{\text{post}};E,w,H,O) = \langle E,w,H,O \rangle = \text{KObs}_{E,w}(\sigma_{\text{ref}})$, proving conclusion (2). B-faithfulness and E4 ensure that the post-side interpretation of the committed history at each explicit boundary is the same abstract channel interpretation used by ChanRec ; finite normalization is ϵ -opaque by $J.\text{KObsConf}$.

Step 4 (Derive the K-facing facts). Lemmas R.21b–R.21e reconstruct the process slice, explicit abstract channel state, NextFront , residual endpoint requests, $\text{Pending}/\text{BoundaryReq}$ attribution, enablement, Front , WFG , and DrainClosedNow from the common record K . Lemma R.21f supplies the ordinary Dead_K factoring and, under its stated waiver-closure and environment-terminal premises, the corresponding Dead_K^W and optional diagnostic Dead_{KS}^W factoring. These conclusions follow by functional extensionality of the named reconstruction functions; no broad state correspondence is assumed. The Policy-S $K.\text{Resp}$ discharge is separately checked over $\rho_{\text{S}}^{\text{det}}$ and is not a KObs cross-model predicate. $\square$

J.3 Causal Dependency and What System-Level Compatibility Guarantees (Informative)

The system-level result of Appendix J establishes compatibility of the aggregate observable behavior, i.e. $\tau_{\text{ref,system}} \approx \tau_{\text{post,system}}$ over the alphabet Σ of channel operations, synchronization events, and signal Read/Write actions.

This compatibility is intentionally *observational*: it constrains what an external environment can distinguish at Σ , not internal RTL micro-timing.

As a consequence, Appendix J should be read as preserving explicitly required observable ordering, atomicity, and FIFO/synchronization semantics, not incidental latency. The causal-dependency relation ($\rightarrow$) defined in the “Causal Dependency Between Processes” section remains useful for explaining information flow and for documenting which interactions a designer intends to be functionally significant. However, $\rightarrow$ is not itself the strict induction order for Theorem J.1, and the theorem does not require the unquotiented dependency graph $\rightarrow$ to be acyclic. The proof order is the required-order relation $<_J$ over observable units.

Accordingly, the system-level theorem implies the following required-order preservation principle:

- If two observable units γ_1 and γ_2 are ordered by the required-order relation $\gamma_1 <_J \gamma_2$, then the matched Sys_ref and RTL_B executions preserve that required order. This follows because each elementary $<_J$ generator is preserved by the corresponding rule: synchronization source order by E1; signal-anchor timestamping by E2; issue-side and request-attribution obligations by E3; channel FIFO legality and rendezvous atomicity by E4; immediate synchronization-boundary constraints by E5; and paired-barrier semantics by the explicit synchronization well-formedness conditions. In particular, for each explicit abstract channel c , the matched executions preserve the committed Push_c/Pop_c history: for $B(c)=0$, a committed transfer is one explicitly atomic rendezvous Push_c(v)/Pop_c(v) unit; for $B(c)>0$, the k -th committed Pop_c observes the k -th earlier unmatched Push_c according to reset-empty, FIFO-order, no-underflow/no-overflow, and non-fall-through E4 semantics.
- If two observable units are not ordered by $<_J$ and are not members of the same explicitly atomic unit, then their relative cycle placement or interleaving is not constrained by the methodology, and differences are treated as incidental latency variation. A designer who needs a particular cross-process ordering to be preserved must express it through an explicit Σ -visible mechanism such as message-passing FIFO order, a rendezvous/handshake atomic unit, explicit synchronization, or signal-anchor semantics.

This perspective is what makes the “single testbench / no surprises” implication precise: for the fixed-stimulus execution sets covered by Theorem J.1, any testbench that observes only Σ and encodes its expectations through causal dependencies (channels, barriers, or explicit handshakes) cannot distinguish the matched Sys_ref / RTL_B execution pairs provided by the theorem.

Equivalently, RTL_B introduces no new Σ -observable behavior relative to Sys_ref under that fixed stimulus, and source-to-RTL transfer is asserted only for the annotated RTL-consistent source prefixes covered by Theorem J.1. (Here Sys_ref is as fixed in Remark 2. The rendezvous specialization Sys with $B(c)=0$ is covered only under the explicit conditions of Remark 4.)

Appendix K – Preservation of Internal Wait-Cycle Freedom (Reachable-Cutpoint Deadlock-Freedom) for the Prescribed Source Reference Model

K.1 Scope, Notation, and Definition of Internal Message-Passing Deadlock

Terminology alignment

Throughout Appendix K, when evaluating predicates at an ε -quiescent cutpoint σ , let t_σ denote the cycle of that cutpoint and use the cutpoint shorthand $\text{occ}_c(\sigma) \triangleq \text{occ}_c(t_\sigma)$. For any frontier item x on an explicit abstract channel $c = \text{BoundaryOf_P}(x)$ of Sys_ref , with owning dynamic source-level message instance $q = \text{MsgOf_P}(x)$, use $\text{BoundaryReq}(x, \sigma)$, $\text{ChannelEnabled}(x, \sigma)$, and $\text{ChannelDisabled}(x, \sigma)$ for the endpoint-owned request, enablement, and disabledness facts at that specific evaluated boundary. In the ordinary unelaborated case, where q has a unique evaluated boundary and a unique frontier item, $\text{BoundaryReq}(q, \sigma)$, $\text{ChannelEnabled}(q, \sigma)$, and $\text{ChannelDisabled}(q, \sigma)$ may be used as shorthands. In $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$, however, the frontier-item form is authoritative because one source-level operation may own multiple proof-internal frontier items at different explicit boundaries. Thus “boundary request is asserted” means $\text{BoundaryReq}(x, \sigma)$, “channel-enabled” means $\text{ChannelEnabled}(x, \sigma)$, and “channel-disabled” means $\text{ChannelDisabled}(x, \sigma)$, all evaluated at the ε -quiescent ready/valid fixed point of the cutpoint cycle and read through $q = \text{MsgOf_P}(x)$ and $\text{BoundaryOf_P}(x)$. These predicates are not applied to already-committed Σ -event labels except through the operation/frontier item that contributes $m(q)$ when it commits.

We work with a fixed design:

System Sys_ref : The collection of pre-HLS processes obeying the R-rules and B-rules, interpreted under the prescribed source reference model of Appendix J, Remark 2. In this appendix, capacities/occupancies/enablement predicates are interpreted at the chosen abstract boundaries of Sys_ref ; in elaborated cases, this means the explicit abstract staged/bundle/join channels of that model. Each explicit abstract channel c of Sys_ref has finite capacity $B(c) \geq 0$, chosen to match the corresponding RTL realization at that abstract boundary.

Post-HLS implementation RTL_B : The hardware implementation of the same processes in which each chosen abstract channel c is realized with finite capacity $B(c) \geq 0$. In this appendix, we compare Sys_ref (the prescribed source-side proof target) to RTL_B (the micro-architectural realization). The proof does not require mapping buffered RTL states to a distinct raw rendezvous ($B(c)=0$) state.

Witness-selection and post-view convention. Corollary J.1 supplies a selected reachable Sys_ref cutpoint σ_{ref} and a common record K with $\text{KObs_E}, w(\sigma_{\text{ref}}) = \text{KObsPost_J}(p_{\text{post}}; E, w, H, O)$ for the selected ε -normalized RTL cutpoint p_{post} . Appendix K does not compare arbitrary RTL microstate with source state. Define the K -facing post abstract view by applying the reconstruction functions of Definitions R.18d–R.18e to KObsPost_J . Unless a raw RTL signal is expressly named as part of J.OfferConf , every post-side occurrence of NextFront , Pending , BoundaryReq , channel state, $\text{ChannelEnabled/ChannelDisabled}$, Front , WFG , DrainClosedNow , or Dead_K in Appendix K denotes that reconstructed view. If a reproducible source witness is desired for debugging, the Appendix L snooping

wrapper may select one aligned to the RTL latency-sensitive events; uniqueness is not required by the theorem.

A global state σ of either system consists of:

1. For each process P : a control location (program point) and local state.
2. For each explicit abstract channel c of Sys_ref : its abstract FIFO state at the chosen Sys_ref boundary—its current occupancy $\text{occ_c}(t)$ and (for buffered channels) its ordered contents. Here $\text{occ_c}(t)$ counts all items that have been committed by Push_c but have not yet been committed by Pop_c at that chosen abstract boundary. In RTL_B , this count includes items residing anywhere in the concrete sub-realization that contributes to that particular abstract channel's back-annotated capacity $B(c)$. Thus internal movement within the concrete realization of one abstract channel c is ϵ and does not create additional committed $\text{Push_c}/\text{Pop_c}$ Σ -events beyond the boundary events counted by occ_c ; however, transfers between distinct explicit abstract channels introduced in $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$ are represented in Sys_ref by those channels themselves and are not collapsed back into one outer Sys_B boundary.
3. Any additional architectural state not representing buffered messages on any channel (e.g., computation pipeline registers, arbitration state, bookkeeping, etc.).

We adopt the usual Wait-For Graph (WFG) abstraction, restricted to internal message-passing channels. Internal means: the producer and consumer of channel c are both processes of Sys_ref / RTL_B (i.e., both endpoints are in the modeled system). Channels whose complementary endpoint is the external environment/testbench (DUT boundary) are excluded from the WFG and from the deadlock definition in Appendix K. We write WFG_ref for the wait-for graph of Sys_ref and WFG_post for that of RTL_B .

- **Vertices:** Processes.
- **Edges:** There is a directed edge $P \rightarrow Q$ via channel c in state σ if there exists some frontier item $x \in \text{Front_P}(\sigma)$ on channel c , with owning message instance $q = \text{MsgOf_P}(x)$, such that x is channel-disabled (i.e., $\text{ChannelDisabled}(x, \sigma)$ holds), and Q is the unique process that is the complementary endpoint for q (producer/consumer partner for c). This edge definition applies uniformly for both buffered channels ($B(c) > 0$, enable is space/data availability via occ_c) and rendezvous channels ($B(c) = 0$, enable requires the complementary endpoint's boundary request to be true in the same cycle), hence WFGs may contain a mix of edges via both kinds of channels. Here $\text{Front_P}(\sigma)$ is the set of $\leq_P$ -minimal pending blocking message-operation frontier items $x \in \Omega_{\text{msg}, P}$ whose owning message instances $q = \text{MsgOf_P}(x)$ have $\text{kind}(q) \in \{\text{Push_c}, \text{Pop_c}\}$, have issued, and have not yet committed. Under ordinary source-sequenced message order, $\text{Front_P}(\sigma)$ has at most one ordinary source-level message item for a process. Multiple message-operation frontier items may appear only when $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$ explicitly introduces proof-internal staged/bundle/join/epoch-gate frontier items and declares them incomparable in the elaboration package. P is “blocked on message passing” in σ as defined in Definition (Blocked on message passing) (K.1). Note: WFG edges may exist even when P is not blocked (e.g., one frontier item is channel-disabled while another explicitly incomparable frontier item is channel-enabled); however, internal message-passing deadlock (K.1) considers only sets D in which every $P \in D$ is blocked, so all WFG edges relevant to deadlock reasoning originate from blocked processes with no channel-enabled frontier item. When $\text{Front_P}(\sigma)$ has multiple members, P may have multiple outgoing WFG edges (one per blocked frontier item).
(No deassert-before-commit assumption.) Blocking $\text{Push_c}/\text{Pop_c}$ requests are non-withdrawable: once the request corresponding to a frontier item $x \in \Omega_{\text{msg}, P}$ is asserted through its owning message instance $q = \text{MsgOf_P}(x)$, it is not deasserted before q commits (and Push_c payload remains stable while asserted). This rules out “try-and-withdraw” behavior for blocking transfers within the WFG abstraction.

All WFG reasoning is over ϵ -quiescent (ϵ -normalized) global states: internal pipeline/arbitration micro-steps are treated as ϵ and are not represented as separate WFG blocking points. Here, “ ϵ -quiescent” includes the fixed point of purely combinational ready/valid propagation, so K.1 enablement is evaluated only on those settled ready/valid values.

(WFG-inert ϵ premise.) Appendix K uses ϵ -steps only after the WFG-relevant boundary-request / attribution cutpoint has been fixed. More precisely, consider an ϵ -path $\sigma \xrightarrow{\epsilon^*} \sigma'$ that contains no Σ -visible committed Push_c/Pop_c event, no synchronization event, no signal Read/Write event, and no source-level issue/attribution transition that creates, removes, or reassigns a pending blocking boundary request. Such ϵ -steps are observationally silent with respect to the WFG abstraction: they do not change (i) the potentially-blocking frontier $\text{Front_P}(\sigma)$ for any process P (i.e., which guarded blocking Push/Pop frontier items are minimal and pending), nor (ii) the truth or attribution of any boundary requests relevant to those frontier items, nor (iii) the channel-side enabling status (as defined in K.1) of any $x \in \text{Front_P}(\sigma)$, read through $q = \text{MsgOf_P}(x)$. Equivalently, these WFG-inert ϵ -steps do not change the channel state relevant to K.1 enabling (e.g., $\text{occ_c}(t)$ for $B(c) > 0$ buffered channels), and they do not create/remove rendezvous enablement for a frontier transfer except via Σ -visible committed Push_c/Pop_c events.

This premise does not say that every non- Σ microstep is WFG-inert. In particular, an ϵ -normalization segment may include source-level issue/attribution steps that establish a persistent blocking request, such as moving from a cutpoint before a Pop has issued to a cutpoint where the Pop request is pending and BoundaryReq is true. Those steps may change Front_P , BoundaryReq, or request attribution, and are therefore not the ϵ -steps quantified over by the WFG-inert premise. Appendix K’s WFG construction is applied only at the resulting ϵ -quiescent cutpoints, after such request/attribution state has been fixed.

In particular (pipelined loops / overlapped iterations): when HLS introduces overlap that may initiate later-iteration message reads “early,” we assume the design obeys the Automatic flush (drain-only blocking discipline) defined in Appendix B. Under that discipline, once the process has reached a stable blocked frontier, overlapped execution does not introduce any later-iteration blocking Push/Pop frontier item into $\text{Front_P}(\sigma)$, so transient internal pipeline activity that merely moves already-accepted work inside the concrete realization remains WFG-inert ϵ and does not contribute wait-for edges. Overlapped execution in pipelined loops is modeled only as a potential retiming of ordinary Σ -visible boundary commits (Push_c/Pop_c) relative to the unpipelined source, and is accounted for by the back-annotated semantics at the chosen abstract boundary of Sys_ref (E4). In particular, the channel facts relevant to K.1 enabling/WFG edges—e.g., $\text{occ_c}(t)$ for $B(c) > 0$, and rendezvous enablement for $B(c) = 0$ —change only on Σ -visible committed Push_c/Pop_c events at that boundary, or on explicit source-level issue/attribution steps before the WFG cutpoint is formed; internal movement within the concrete realization of a single abstract channel after that cutpoint is WFG-inert ϵ and does not affect K.1 enablement or introduce/remove WFG edges.

Precondition ($K\epsilon$: WFG-inert ϵ / no hidden micro-timing control decisions). All results in Appendix K are stated under the precondition $K\epsilon$ that the narrowed WFG-inert ϵ premise above holds for the design at the ϵ -quiescent cutpoints used for WFG reasoning. If an implementation intentionally uses internal micro-timing after such a cutpoint to change Front_P membership, boundary-request attribution, or ChannelEnabled/ChannelDisabled facts without a corresponding Σ -visible event or explicit source-level issue/attribution transition, then $K\epsilon$ is violated unless that behavior is made Σ -observable (e.g., via explicit modeling/snooping) or is witness-selected under the Appendix I.2 framework.

A common instance is branching on the success/failure of a non-blocking poll in a way that changes the next Σ -visible candidate frontier **NextFront_P(σ)** (Definition R.6; see Lemma R.21b and Corollary J.1); in that case, either NB-CF must hold (Appendix I.2), or the poll outcomes must be witness-selected as stated there.

Non-blocking polling attempts and other purely internal actions do not contribute edges to the WFG; they are modeled as internal ϵ -steps. When a non-blocking call succeeds, that success is already represented at the Σ level as the corresponding committed Push_c/Pop_c event, but it does not itself add a wait-for edge because it is not a blocking operation.

SyncChannels and barrier well-formedness.

SyncChannel (barrier) operations are treated as pure synchronization events and are omitted from the Wait-For Graph, which tracks only blocking Push/Pop dependencies. We therefore interpret “deadlock” in this appendix as **internal message-passing deadlock** (i.e., a deadlocked set in which all processes are blocked on some internal Push/Pop dependency captured by the WFG). Any global stall at a barrier caused by mismatched or conditional participation (e.g., a process can permanently bypass the barrier or reach it a different number of times) is a specification-level error already present in the pre-HLS model; such stalls are not created by the HLS transformation and are excluded by an explicit barrier well-formedness assumption (A8 below), not by the internal message-passing deadlock premise. Under this assumption, omitting SyncChannels from the WFG is sound: a post-HLS deadlock implies the existence of a Push/Pop wait-cycle as characterized below.

Definition (Blocked on message passing). Using $\text{Front_P}(\sigma)$ as defined above, we say that P is blocked on message passing in state σ iff $\text{Front_P}(\sigma)$ is non-empty and, for every frontier item $x \in \text{Front_P}(\sigma)$, $\text{BoundaryReq}(x, \sigma)$ holds and $\text{ChannelDisabled}(x, \sigma)$ holds (equivalently, $\text{BoundaryReq}(x, \sigma) \wedge \neg \text{ChannelEnabled}(x, \sigma)$), read operation-attributively through the owning message instance $q = \text{MsgOf_P}(x)$. Note ($\text{ALL disabled} \Rightarrow \text{stall}$). If any frontier item $x \in \text{Front_P}(\sigma)$ is channel-enabled at the chosen Σ -visible boundary, then P is not “blocked on message passing” for WFG purposes. Consequently, an implementation may not be physically stalled at the chosen Σ boundary by a cross-channel “join” predicate while some frontier item $x \in \text{Front_P}(\sigma)$ at that boundary remains channel-enabled; any such conjunctive/join dependency must be represented as an explicit staged/bundle/join boundary channel so that, when the process is physically stalled, the relevant frontier items on that explicit boundary are all channel-disabled.

Definition (Drain-closed cutpoint for deadlock extraction). Let D be a non-empty set of processes. An ϵ -quiescent state σ is drain-closed for D iff no already-issued non-frontier blocking Push/Pop request of any process $P \in D$ is channel-enabled at σ . Equivalently, after the frontier members $\text{Front_P}(\sigma)$ are all disabled, there is no remaining already-issued downstream transfer of any process in D that can still commit as drain-only progress.

Here “already-issued downstream transfer” means an already-issued non-frontier blocking message-operation frontier item $x \in \text{Pending_P}(\sigma) \setminus \text{Front_P}(\sigma)$, with owning message instance $q = \text{MsgOf_P}(x)$, interpreted at the chosen abstract $\text{Sys_ref} / \text{RTL_B}$ boundary and within the current source interval, i.e., the interval between the adjacent synchronization calls that bracket σ in P ’s current execution; hidden internal pipeline staging or later-iteration prefetch absorbed into $B(c)$ is not a separate source-level operation for this definition unless it has been made an explicit abstract channel in $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$.

If such a non-frontier drain transfer is enabled, σ is not yet a stable deadlock cutpoint for D ; either that drain transfer must be allowed to commit finitely often until a drain-closed cutpoint is reached, or the resulting commit changes the WFG-relevant channel facts so that some frontier operation becomes enabled and the candidate deadlock disappears.

Finite drain note. At a blocked frontier satisfying the applicable drain-only blocked-frontier discipline, no new later blocking message-operation frontier item may be issued. Therefore the only downstream work that can still drain is work already accepted before the blocked condition. Because every explicit abstract channel has finite capacity $B(c)$, every process has finite ϵ -depth D_P when not externally stalled, and no new work may cross the blocked frontier, the number of D -owned downstream drain commits before reaching a drain-closed ϵ -quiescent cutpoint is finite. A coarse bound may be taken as a function of the sum of the relevant in-flight occupancies on explicit abstract channels plus the finite per-process ϵ -depths D_P ; the exact numeric bound is not used by Theorem K.1, only finiteness.

An internal message-passing deadlock is a reachable ϵ -quiescent state σ in which there exists a non-empty set of processes D such that σ is drain-closed for D and:

- Every process P in D is blocked on message passing, and in particular there exists at least one frontier item $x \in \text{Front}_P(\sigma)$ on an internal message-passing channel c (i.e., a channel included in the WFG), with owning message instance $q = \text{MsgOf}_P(x)$, such that $\text{BoundaryReq}(x, \sigma)$ holds and $\text{ChannelDisabled}(x, \sigma)$ holds.
- The vertices in D , together with the internal channels they access, form a strongly connected component in the WFG that has no outgoing edges (a closed cycle): processes in D can only wait on each other through internal WFG channels. (Members of D may additionally hold environment-facing frontier items, which are excluded from the WFG; see the Terminology note below.)

Intuitively, D is a set of processes that are waiting only on each other (via internal message-passing channels tracked by the WFG), with no remaining enabled drain-only transfer of any process in D that could change the WFG-relevant channel facts. Thus D cannot be unblocked by internal modeled message-passing progress represented in the closed WFG component, nor by already-issued downstream drain from within D . This is a reachable-state predicate, not a permanence claim: a member of D may also hold environment-facing frontier items (excluded from the WFG), and later environment/testbench activity under the fixed stimulus may dissolve such a state; the Appendix K results and the A5 premise quantify over reachability of these states, not over their permanence. A process that is blocked solely on channels whose complementary endpoint is the external environment/testbench (excluded from the WFG) does not witness an internal message-passing deadlock in this appendix.

Terminated-process convention. For purposes of Appendix K, termination is interpreted per reset epoch. After a process P emits FINISH_P for a given reset epoch, the infinite execution is padded only by process-local idle stutter for P for the remainder of that epoch. This padding creates no new P -owned Σ -events, no new BoundaryReq , no new Front_P or NextFront_P item, and no new outgoing WFG edge from P . This epoch-local padding does not preclude a later reset boundary affecting P . If such a reset occurs and P later exits reset, the subsequent START_P is a new dynamic occurrence that begins a fresh reset epoch, and the earlier FINISH_P has no ordering, anchoring, or WFG force across that reset boundary. Any later termination of P is represented by a distinct dynamic FINISH_P occurrence. Thus a process blocked waiting for a complementary Push/Pop from a peer that has terminated in the current reset epoch is not, by itself, an internal message-passing deadlock in the K.1 sense. It is instead outside the K.1 deadlock notion unless the design includes an explicit modeled termination protocol that makes such waiting part of the internal channel protocol being analyzed.

Terminology (adopted reading: reachable closed internal wait-cycle cutpoint). The predicate just defined is, precisely, a reachable, drain-closed, closed internal wait-cycle cutpoint. It is deliberately weaker than a conventional (permanent) deadlock: a member of D may hold environment-facing

frontier items excluded from the WFG, and — in a declared timed or reactive environment outside the B1-avail convention — a fair continuation in which the environment later enables such an item can leave the state. (Under the default B1-avail pull-based stimulus convention, an environment-facing input item that is disabled at a cutpoint is stimulus-exhausted and remains disabled forever, per Lemma K.EnvX-Auto in K.4b; the later-enablement possibility, and with it the input-side W.Env rescue class, arises only for declared timed/reactive environments.) Three consequences are adopted normatively throughout this appendix. (1) The property preserved by Theorem K.1 — absence of reachable states satisfying this predicate — is an invariance (safety-style) reachability property over admissible executions, not a temporal liveness property in the eventually/always sense; the historical word “liveness” is retained in titles for continuity but shall be read with this meaning. (2) The phrase “processes in D can only wait on each other” means, wherever it appears, “only wait on each other through internal WFG channels”; it does not exclude coexisting environment-facing waits. (3) The A5 premise is correspondingly conservative: it can be violated by a transient internal wait-cycle cutpoint even in a design whose fixed environment is guaranteed to release an environment-facing frontier item so that the system always progresses; such a report is a true positive for the defined predicate and a deliberate conservatism with respect to permanent deadlock. Designs for which this conservatism is unacceptable may instead be assessed against the stronger persistent-deadlock predicate — every blocking frontier item of every member of D internal, with its complementary owner in D, and the state a trap under all admissible continuations — but the theorems of this appendix neither require nor establish results for that stronger predicate; adopting it would require re-proving Lemmas K.1a–K.2b and Theorem K.1 with an added permanence argument.

Scope warning. This exclusion is only a scope convention for Theorem K.1. It does not imply that waiting forever for a terminated peer is benign or acceptable design behavior. If termination, EOF, done, cancellation, or end-of-stream behavior is part of the intended protocol, that behavior must be modeled explicitly in Sys_ref and RTL_B, or verified separately outside the Appendix K internal message-passing-deadlock theorem.

Our notion of the preserved property (historically labeled “liveness”) in this appendix is: no reachable internal message-passing-deadlock state (reachable closed internal wait-cycle cutpoint) as defined above, under the fixed stimulus and fair scheduling. Formally this is an invariance (safety-style) reachability property over admissible executions — see the Terminology note above — and it does not assert that a reached deadlock state is permanent when environment-facing frontier items are present. (Starvation of a single process in an otherwise live system is ruled out separately by weak fairness.)

Implication note (relation to persistent deadlock). The reachable-cutpoint predicate implies absence of persistent internal communication deadlock: a K.1 component is internally closed, so no internal continuation can dissolve it, and escape requires environment action on a co-frontier item excluded from the WFG. The preserved property is therefore at least as strong as the operational guarantee that the design never hangs permanently on internal communication. The stronger reachability form is retained as the normative predicate deliberately: it is safety-shaped — an invariance over reachable states — which is what makes it checkable by inductive invariants (K.4e) and preservable through finite-prefix correspondence (Definition J.Reach, Corollary J.1). A persistence-only predicate would be liveness-shaped: its preservation would require continuation and fairness correspondence between RTL_B and Sys_ref, and its per-design certification would require co-reachability rather than reachability arguments. Weakening the predicate would make both the theorem and its discharge harder, not easier, while yielding a weaker guarantee that the present predicate already implies. Designs with intentional environment-rescued wait cycles are handled by the Waiver W.Env mechanism (K.2), not by weakening the predicate.

K.2 Assumptions and Imported Results

K.2.1 Standing Assumptions We assume throughout Appendix K:

A1. R-rules and B-rules. The prescribed source reference model Sys_ref and the post-HLS implementation RTL_B satisfy the process- and channel-level semantic rules defined earlier (R-rules and B-rules).

A2. Finite Pipeline Depth (FPD) / B4 finite ϵ -stutter. For each process P there is a finite bound D_P such that, along any consecutive ϵ -only evolution in which P is internally advancing toward its next observable Σ -action or its next Σ -action is locally enabled, and P is not externally stalled by a peer/environment/back-pressure condition, P executes at most D_P consecutive ϵ -steps before either (i) executing a Σ -action, or (ii) reaching a stable waiting state in which no further ϵ -step is available until some external/peer/environment condition changes the relevant enabling predicates. This is not a bound on time spent waiting for external stimulus, peer action, or back-pressure relief; such waiting is governed by WF/B2 and the channel-progress obligations B3. The system-level all-disabled quiescence bound used later in Appendix K is supplied by B5, with bound $\max_P D_P$.

A3. Weak Fairness (WF) (B2). If an action remains continuously enabled (its guard remains true), the scheduler eventually selects it.

A4. Channel Progress (B3 (Additional Semantic Assumptions (B-rules)); Appendix N). For each channel c with capacity $B(c)$, assume the progress invariants of Appendix N hold. This is an obligation on the scheduler/environment (e.g., fairness of arbiters/back-pressure) and is not implied by the local R-rules alone.

A5. Primary selected-instance Policy-S bounded-response premise (A5-S). For the selected Sys_K instance, let p_S^{det} be the deterministic Policy-S execution selected by SDet after fixing capacities, elaboration, initial/reset state, stimulus, witness choices, environment behavior, arbitration, concrete pre-HLS scheduling semantics, Policy-S issue semantics, ϵ -normalization, and K.Low lowering. A5-S requires: (i) K.CompleteS evidence that p_S^{det} is maximal, fair, and complete; (ii) K.RespCov evidence giving a checkable proof disposition and finite bound for every dynamically reachable instance of every internal process-facing blocking site, with coverage-preserving waivers and the separate environment-site rule; and (iii) K.RespClean evidence that the complete run contains no non-waived K.RespFail event. K.RespFail means finite bound expiration without process-facing commit/return, a maximal finite run with the monitored frontier still pending, or reset/cancellation/end-of-test while it remains pending without an explicit waiver.

For A5, Policy S is the conservative serial-blocking interpretation of Appendix G. Within each source interval, a process does not issue a source-later blocking operation until every source-earlier blocking operation required by the serial discipline has committed in a strictly earlier cycle. The condition is process-facing: proof-internal staged/bundle/join/epoch-gate transfers do not satisfy it unless the elaboration identifies them as the commit that releases the source-level call. Channel-side E4 movement, FIFO drainage, independent-process execution, and explicit elaborated transfers remain concurrent.

Maximality, completeness, and fairness of p_S^{det} are part of A5-S/ K.CompleteS , not SDet . K.RespCov and K.RespClean are additional obligations checked over that complete artifact, not definitions of completeness itself. A finite simulation discharges A5-S only when it reaches a declared maximal terminal state and has no pending covered frontier, or when a complete proof establishes the required monitor result. A finite prefix of a still-running system is insufficient. For a nonterminating design, the selected run requires an invariant, sound model checking, recurrence/lasso evidence, or another complete argument that every covered response occurs within its finite bound and no cancellation failure occurs.

Instance dependence. A5-S and SDet are not properties of the raw SystemC text and are not discharged by an arbitrary simulation. They are re-established whenever capacities, boundaries, elaboration, lowering, stimulus, witness assignment, environment/reset contract, arbitration rule, concrete simulator scheduling semantics, Policy-S implementation, or normalization changes. Such a change defines a different selected theorem instance.

Practical discharge route (Corollary K.2c). Under SDet there is one selected Policy-S execution p_S^{det} for the selected instance, with a committed history unique modulo finite WFG-inert ϵ -stutter. A5-S/CF-S separately supply K.CompleteS, K.RespCov, and K.RespClean evidence. Lemma K.2b shows that any internal deadlock reached by a finite Policy-L prefix admissible under Definition R.LAdm forces that same selected execution to produce a finite non-waived K.RespFail witness. Therefore a complete clean bounded-response certificate for p_S^{det} is sufficient. No alternate Policy-S schedulers or interleavings exist within the selected instance, and no confluence theorem is relevant.

A source region whose liveness depends on favorable same-cycle or overlapped issue of multiple blocking operations does not pass the Policy-S route merely because a particular Policy-L or RTL schedule is live. It must pass the applicable Policy-S bad-state check, be rewritten or buffered, be placed under explicit protocol structure, or use a direct A5-L certificate outside the serial reduction.

A5 and Appendix K do not assert freedom from specification-level barrier errors, reset stalls, or external-environment stalls that do not contain the internal wait structure represented by the operative predicate.

A6. Point-to-point channels (single-producer/single-consumer). For each message-passing channel c (including buffered channels with $B(c)>0$ and rendezvous channels with $B(c)=0$), exactly one process performs all Push _{c} operations on c (the producer) and exactly one process performs all Pop _{c} operations on c (the consumer). Hence the complementary endpoint for any blocked Push _{c} /Pop _{c} is unique, and WFG edges are well-defined even for mixed WFGs that include both buffered and rendezvous channels.

If a design has a shared resource that would violate this uniqueness, it must be modeled via an explicit arbiter process plus point-to-point channels (as noted in “Common Formal Definitions” B(c)).

A7 (RTL determinism / witness selection / equal-KObs correspondence). Assume B1 for RTL_B, so its Σ -labeled execution under the fixed stimulus is unique up to finite ϵ -stutter. Theorem J.GWR-Comp/Theorem J.1 and Corollary J.1 supply one selected Policy-L-legal Sys_{ref} witness and equal KObs for the compared cutpoints. When Appendix K uses that finite witness prefix, the separate K.Drain, nonwithdrawal, $K\epsilon$, and fixed-instance premises qualify it as admissible under Definition R.LAdm; Appendix K does not require all Sys_{ref} executions to be unique. J.OfferReach, J.OfferConf, and J.KObsConf must refer to the same RTL cutpoint, source cutpoint, H, O, E, and witness w . Policy-S determinism is supplied separately by SDet, not by B1.

When a deterministic, reproducible Sys_{ref} witness is desired for simulation/debug, apply the Appendix L snooping wrapper to select a particular witness aligned with the latency-sensitive ϵ -choices. B4 and B5 justify the selected ϵ -normalized endpoints required by Corollary J.1. Every Appendix K transfer of a reconstructed frontier, request, channel, enablement, WFG, drain, or deadlock predicate uses the same equal-KObs package. A discharge for an unrelated source cutpoint, different witness, different O, or noncanonical unmatched history is insufficient.

Premise SDet (deterministic selected Policy-S simulator). Fix the selected Sys_K, initial/reset state, capacities/elaboration, stimulus and reactive environment, witness-selected ϵ outcomes, deterministic arbitration, concrete SystemC/pre-HLS scheduler, Policy-S issue rule, and ϵ -normalization. These define a functional Policy-S next-state semantics and select one run artifact p_S^{det} . Every finite or infinite artifact generated from the same initial state by those exact semantics has a committed history prefix-comparable with that of p_S^{det} modulo finite WFG-inert ϵ -stutter; hence no two incompatible committed histories arise from the selected instance. WC and I.DR/I.DR' determine replay state/actions

relative to the selected history; SDet excludes multiplicity caused by an unfixed scheduler, arbiter, environment, witness, issue, or normalization choice. SDet does not by itself assert maximality, fairness, completeness, response coverage, or response cleanliness, and a shorter finite artifact may be a proper prefix of the selected history. K.CompleteS and A5-S/CF-S separately establish maximality/fairness/completeness and K.RespCov/K.RespClean for p_S^{det} . Changing any listed choice defines a different selected instance.

A8. Barrier well-formedness (SyncChannels). For each SyncChannel instance, the set of designated participant processes reaches the barrier the same number of times under the fixed stimulus/initial state; equivalently, no participant can permanently bypass a barrier call while another participant is waiting at that barrier. (Barrier stalls are therefore outside the behaviors considered in Appendix K's internal message-passing deadlock analysis.)

A9. Single-transfer-per-cycle endpoint constraint (scalar channel interface). For every message-passing channel c , in any clock cycle t , at most one Push_ c commit and at most one Pop_ c commit may occur on c . Multi-lane/burst resources must be modeled explicitly.

A10. Reset-empty FIFO assumption. After each reset boundary, every buffered channel has logical occupancy 0 at the chosen Σ boundary.

A11. WFG-inert ϵ ($K\epsilon$). The design satisfies $K\epsilon$.

No further numbered A-assumption is introduced beyond A1–A11; SDet is a separately named selected-simulator premise. A5-S is part of the selected-instance liveness obligation, not a conclusion derived from the local R-rules, WC alone, or the no-reverse rule.

Drain-only blocked-frontier discharge for Appendix K (K.Drain). The K.2b dominance/extraction bridge and K.1 drain-normalization arguments require the complete seven-clause discipline of Definition R.16 for every interval in which Policy L can leave source-later same-interval work outstanding behind a disabled earlier frontier. Pipelined or otherwise overlapped control discharges this through Appendix B automatic flush. Ordinary non-overlapped control may discharge it through a structural proof of the same discipline. In every case, the discharge must establish the blocked point, no new source-later dynamic-operation launch, request non-withdrawal, exclusion of non-frontier requests as WFG sources, drain-only downstream progress, finite non-replenishing B-faithful boundary storage or credit, and explicit sync-boundary / epoch-gate treatment for any withheld producer-facing capacity. This is the K.Drain application-specific discharge of the existing scheduling and channel assumptions, not an additional numbered A-assumption.

Premise A5-L (scheduler-robust liberal source liveness). For every $p_L \in \text{Pref_L}^{\text{adm}}(I)$ of the selected Sys_ref instance, under the fixed stimulus, capacities B(c), elaboration, and fixed witness-selected outcomes, no ϵ -quiescent cutpoint reached by p_L satisfies Dead_ K^W . Theorem K.1A consumes A5-L directly. Where synchronization waits or witness-selected non-NB-CF sites can participate in a potential wait cycle, the serial route uses the normalized blocking instance Sys_K defined in K.4b. Policy-S-primary architecture. SDet fixes one concrete deterministic Policy-S execution p_S^{det} . Lemma K.2b compares a liberal counterexample with that execution and proves that a Policy-L internal deadlock forces a finite K.RespFail witness on p_S^{det} . Corollary K.2c therefore reduces A5-L to the single complete A5-S check consisting of K.CompleteS, total K.RespCov, and K.RespClean. There is no family of Policy-S scheduler interleavings inside one selected instance and no confluence question. Dead_KS, EnvStop, DoneStop, K.EnvOrd, and K.Done are optional diagnostic classifications only. Normative organization of Appendix K. The spine is: the K.1 predicate; K.0 frontier reconstruction; K.2 WFG extensionality; K.2a DrainClosedNow extensionality; K.1A from A5-L; Sys_K and the SDet-selected p_S^{det} ; deterministic serial-dominance K.2b; Corollary K.2c; A5-S on p_S^{det} ; and Theorem K.1.

Appendix K-P contains the operational companion proof. Structural and direct certificates remain alternate A5-L routes.

Waiver $W.\text{Env}$ (declared environment-rescued cutpoints). The side-condition record may exclude a precisely identified cutpoint class when a declared environment-facing co-frontier is intended and proved to rescue it. The record shall identify the component class, rescuing item, environment assumption, and design justification. A waiver does not alter the default predicates and does not excuse an Example K.CE-style bypass without an accompanying no-bypass or equivalent argument.

Definition K.DeadW and response waivers. Let W be the union of declared KObs-facing waived cutpoint classes. $\text{Dead_K}^W(\sigma)$ means $\text{Dead_K}(\sigma)$ and $\sigma \notin W$; optional diagnostic Dead_KS^W is defined analogously. KObs-facing waiver closure requires $\text{KObsClosed_I,E,w}(W)$ whenever W is non-empty. Separately, let W_{resp} be the declared dynamic K.Resp monitor-waiver classes. RespFail^W means a K.RespFail whose monitor instance is not in W_{resp} . K.RespCov requires coverage-preserving waiver closure: for every non-waived liberal Dead_K component admitted to the K.2b premise, at least one permanently pending serial monitor extracted by K.2b.Q is outside W_{resp} . A response waiver depending on hidden issue timing, reset disposition, or future environment behavior must carry the corresponding operational proof. Neither W nor W_{resp} may be used as a broad label to hide an unclassified deadlock or end-of-test hang.

Scope of the preservation theorem. Theorem K.1A transfers an RTL deadlock to a Policy-L Sys_ref deadlock through equal KObs and contradicts A5-L; it consumes neither SDet nor the serial-route premises. Theorem K.1 adds SDet, K.CV, NB-Align/K.Low where applicable, K.Resp, and the remaining serial conditions, and obtains A5-L from A5-S for the SDet-selected execution p_S^{det} via Corollary K.2c. Within Lemma K.2b, K.CompleteS supplies maximality/fairness/completeness, K.RespCov supplies total finite-bound coverage, and K.RespClean is the contradiction used by K.2c.

The no-reverse rule is not by itself a liveness theorem. Its practical force is captured by the deterministic Policy-S reduction: the selected simulator withholds source-later requests and serves as the conservative deadlock-stress execution. K.2b does not claim that p_S^{det} reproduces the Policy-L trace or the same component; it states that any Policy-L internal deadlock forces a permanent covered process-facing serial frontier and therefore a finite K.RespFail witness.

Example: blocking rendezvous operations whose liveness depends on same-cycle/eager issue. Consider two rendezvous channels a and b with $B(a)=B(b)=0$ and two processes:

```
P1: b.Pop(); a.Push(v)
P2: a.Pop(); b.Push(w)
```

Under Policy S's conservative serial-blocking issue discipline, each process issues only its first source-order blocking operation: P1 waits on Pop_b and P2 waits on Pop_a ; neither process reaches the complementary Push, so the system has a closed internal rendezvous WFG deadlock. If, instead, each process uses an admissible eager Policy-L issue schedule that has both distinct-interface blocking requests asserted by the same cycle while preserving source order, then both rendezvous transfers can commit in that cycle. The Policy-S/A5-S discharge route therefore cannot establish the Appendix K guarantee for this example unless it is rewritten, buffered, explicitly synchronized, or otherwise made to pass the route-selected $\text{Dead_KS}/\text{Dead_K}$ check. A direct Policy-L proof, structural proof, or another recorded alternate A5-L discharge could still be used. The example also illustrates the role of K.2b: the Sys_ref cutpoint obtained from the RTL_B witness may contain overlapped pending requests, whereas A5-S is checked on the SDet-selected Policy-S execution p_S^{det} with separate K.CompleteS evidence.

The Front/NextFront bridge used later in Appendix K is the source-local reconstruction result of Lemma K.0. Cross-model frontier, raw rendezvous-request, enablement, and WFG agreement are obtained by

applying the same reconstruction functions to the equal KObs record of Corollary J.1. No asserted rendezvous request is identified with frontier membership merely because it is present in O.

K.2.2 Lemma K.0 — Frontier Reconstruction from KObs

Purpose. Appendix K forms WFG edges from the minimal pending blocking frontier. The KObs layer already separates the candidate source frontier reconstructed from H from the currently asserted attributed offers reconstructed from O. This lemma identifies the operational source frontier with the corresponding pure reconstruction and states the cross-model consequence by equal-KObs extensionality.

Statement. Fix I , E , w and a reachable ε -quiescent Sys_ref cutpoint σ , and let $K = \text{KObs_E,w}(\sigma)$. For process P define

$\text{BlockingMsgNextFrontRec_P}(K) := \{ x \in \text{NextFrontRec_P}(K) \mid x \in \Omega_msg,P \text{ and } \text{MsgOf_P}(x) \text{ is a blocking Push or Pop instance} \}.$

Then

$\text{Front_P}(\sigma) = \text{FrontRec_P}(K) = \{ x \in \text{BlockingMsgNextFrontRec_P}(K) \mid \text{BoundaryReqRec}(x,K) \}.$

Here NextFrontRec is witness-relative over the fixed Ω_P and $\leq_P$ supplied by E ; it is a candidate frontier, while BoundaryReqRec selects the currently outstanding blocking offers.

Cross-model consequence. Let $K_post = \text{KObsPost_J}(\rho_post; E, w, H, O)$ and $K_ref = \text{KObs_E,w}(\sigma_ref)$ be the exact records selected by Corollary J.1. If $K_post = K_ref$, then for every process P , $\text{FrontRec_P}(K_post) = \text{FrontRec_P}(K_ref)$, and $\text{BoundaryReqRec}(x, K_post) = \text{BoundaryReqRec}(x, K_ref)$ for every typed blocking message-operation frontier item x . Thus the reconstructed post frontier is exactly the operational source frontier at σ_ref . This consequence uses only the common record; it does not compare historical Issue times or raw RTL control state.

Mixed blocking/non-blocking clarification. Successful non-blocking transfers may contribute committed Push/Pop events to H , and failed polls may contribute WC-selected ε outcomes, but neither creates a pending blocking frontier member. A blocking endpoint may nevertheless wait on a complementary process whose source endpoint uses a non-blocking call; the non-blocking side can change occupancy or complete the complementary transfer, but does not itself become a WFG source unless it also owns a separate pending blocking frontier.

Proof. For a reachable source cutpoint, Lemma R.21d identifies Pending and BoundaryReq with PendingRec and BoundaryReqRec and therefore identifies Front_P with FrontRec_P . The displayed $\text{BlockingMsgNextFrontRec}$ characterization is the Definitions R.14–R.15 classification of the $\leq_P$ -minimal pending blocking items; source-prefix issue order, synchronization anchoring, and the exclusion of failed polls ensure that no earlier unrealized nonblocking, signal, or synchronization item invalidates the candidate-frontier characterization. The cross-model conclusion follows by substituting $K_post = K_ref$ into the pure reconstruction functions. $\square$

Corollary K.0a (Rendezvous endpoint-request extensionality). For a point-to-point rendezvous channel c with $B(c)=0$, define $\text{ReqProdRec_c}(K)$ and $\text{ReqConsRec_c}(K)$ as the producer-direction and consumer-direction projections of O . If $K_post = K_ref$ as above, then $\text{ReqProdRec_c}(K_post) = \text{ReqProdRec_c}(K_ref)$ and $\text{ReqConsRec_c}(K_post) = \text{ReqConsRec_c}(K_ref)$. This raw endpoint-request equality is independent of frontier membership: an already-asserted non-frontier blocking offer remains represented in O and can participate in rendezvous enablement.

K.2.3 Example K.0b — Front_P vs. $\text{BlockingMsgNextFront_P}$ Example

The following example illustrates the distinction between Front_P and $\text{BlockingMsgNextFront_P}$. In this example all message-operation items under discussion are blocking Push/Pop operations, so $\text{BlockingMsgNextFront_P}$ is the relevant WFG-facing slice of the source-level NextFront_P frontier over

Ω_P . The broader notation MsgNextFront_P , when used elsewhere, denotes the general message-operation-item slice and may also include successful non-blocking transfer items; it is not the object used by the Front/NextFront bridge for WFG construction.

```
void P() {
  while (1) {
    wait();           // sync point
    int x = in.Pop(); // blocking Pop
    out.Push(x + 1);  // blocking Push
  }
}
```

Consider two ε -quiescent cutpoints for this same process:

Cutpoint σ_0 : just after $\text{wait}()$ has committed, before $\text{in.Pop}()$ has issued

- $\text{BlockingMsgNextFront_P}(\sigma_0) = \{ \text{Pop_in} \}$
- $\text{BoundaryReq}(\text{Pop_in}, \sigma_0) = \text{false}$
- $\text{Front_P}(\sigma_0) = \emptyset$

Cutpoint σ_1 : $\text{in.Pop}()$ has issued, rdy is asserted, but no data has arrived yet

- $\text{BlockingMsgNextFront_P}(\sigma_1) = \{ \text{Pop_in} \}$
- $\text{BoundaryReq}(\text{Pop_in}, \sigma_1) = \text{true}$
- $\text{Front_P}(\sigma_1) = \{ \text{Pop_in} \}$

So the difference is:

- $\text{BlockingMsgNextFront_P}$ says which blocking message-operation items are next candidates in the source-level frontier over Ω_P for WFG/frontier classification.
- Front_P says which of those next blocking message-operation items are actually outstanding pending blockers right now.

K.3 Lemma K.1a — Characterization of Internal Message-Passing Deadlock (Buffered and Rendezvous Cases)

Elaboration prerequisite. The channel boundary c used in this lemma is the chosen abstract boundary of the prescribed $\text{Sys_ref} / \text{RTL_B}$ comparison after applying any required elaboration from Appendix J, Remark 2. In particular, synchronization-boundary ramp-down / epoch-gating is not treated as a hidden exception to E4 on an otherwise ordinary buffered channel. If such gating can withhold producer-facing availability while outer projected capacity would otherwise appear available, the relevant blocking point is represented by an explicit abstract channel of $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$.

Statement: Let σ_{post} be a reachable ε -quiescent global state of the post-HLS system RTL_B (equivalently, the ε -normalization of some reachable state, which exists as a finite extension by B4/B5). Suppose there is a non-empty set of processes D that is internally message-passing deadlocked (as defined in K.1). Then:

Every process P in D is blocked on a blocking channel operation (Push or Pop), not on an internal step.

Buffered-channel case ($B(c) > 0$):

- If P is blocked on a frontier item $x \in \text{Front_P}(\sigma_{\text{post}})$, with owning message instance $q = \text{MsgOf_P}(x)$, $\text{kind}(q) = \text{Push_c}$, and $B(c) > 0$, then $\text{occ_c}(\sigma_{\text{post}}) = B(c)$ (channel is full at that cutpoint).
- If P is blocked on a frontier item $x \in \text{Front_P}(\sigma_{\text{post}})$, with owning message instance $q = \text{MsgOf_P}(x)$, $\text{kind}(q) = \text{Pop_c}$, and $B(c) > 0$, then $\text{occ_c}(\sigma_{\text{post}}) = 0$ (channel is empty at that cutpoint).

Rendezvous case ($B(c) = 0$):

- If P is blocked on a frontier item $x \in \text{Front_P}(\sigma_{\text{post}})$, with owning message instance $q = \text{MsgOf_P}(x)$,

kind(q)=Push_c, and B(c)=0, then the complementary endpoint is not simultaneously requesting the matching Pop_c in σ_{post} (i.e., the complementary Pop_c endpoint request is not true in that cycle, so rendezvous enabling for x is false).

- If P is blocked on a frontier item $x \in \text{Front_P}(\sigma_{\text{post}})$, with owning message instance $q = \text{MsgOf_P}(x)$, kind(q)=Pop_c, and B(c)=0, then the complementary endpoint is not simultaneously requesting the matching Push_c in σ_{post} .

The processes in D form a closed strongly connected component in the WFG.

Proof:

Internal Steps: Because σ_{post} is ϵ -quiescent (i.e., an ϵ -normalized endpoint that exists as a finite extension by B4/B5), no process has any enabled internal ϵ -step in σ_{post} . In particular, if some process had an internal step whose guard is true in σ_{post} , then σ_{post} would not be ϵ -quiescent: the ϵ -normalization could be extended by at least one additional ϵ -step. Therefore, no process in D is blocked on an internal step with a true guard; since each $P \in D$ is blocked on message passing (K.1), the blocking operation must be a blocking channel operation (Push or Pop).

Blocked Push: By the definition of “blocked on message passing” in K.1, if P is blocked due to a frontier item $x \in \text{Front_P}(\sigma_{\text{post}})$, with owning message instance $q = \text{MsgOf_P}(x)$ and kind(q)=Push_c, then $\text{BoundaryReq}(x, \sigma_{\text{post}})$ is true and $\text{ChannelEnabled}(x, \sigma_{\text{post}})$ is false.

- If B(c)>0, the channel-side enabling condition for x is space availability, i.e., $\text{occ_c}(\sigma_{\text{post}}) < B(c)$.

Hence, if P is blocked on such a Push_c frontier item x in σ_{post} , necessarily $\text{occ_c}(\sigma_{\text{post}}) = B(c)$ (channel is full).

- If B(c)=0 (rendezvous), the channel-side enabling condition for x is that the complementary Pop_c endpoint request is true in the same cycle. Since P is blocked, this rendezvous enabling condition is false; equivalently, the complementary endpoint is not simultaneously requesting Pop_c in σ_{post} .

Blocked Pop: Symmetric. By the definition of “blocked on message passing,” if P is blocked due to a frontier item $x \in \text{Front_P}(\sigma_{\text{post}})$, with owning message instance $q = \text{MsgOf_P}(x)$ and kind(q)=Pop_c, then $\text{BoundaryReq}(x, \sigma_{\text{post}})$ is true and $\text{ChannelEnabled}(x, \sigma_{\text{post}})$ is false.

- If B(c)>0, the channel-side enabling condition for x is data availability, i.e., $\text{occ_c}(\sigma_{\text{post}}) > 0$. Hence $\text{occ_c}(\sigma_{\text{post}}) = 0$ (channel is empty).

- If B(c)=0 (rendezvous), the channel-side enabling condition for x is that the complementary Push_c endpoint request is true in the same cycle. Since P is blocked, this rendezvous enabling condition is false; equivalently, the complementary endpoint is not simultaneously requesting Push_c in σ_{post} .

Closed WFG cycle: By the definition of internal message-passing deadlock, every WFG edge from a process in D points to a process in D. Hence no process in D waits, through the literal WFG edge relation, on a complementary endpoint owner outside D.

K.4 Lemma K.2 — WFG Extensionality under Equal KObs

Statement. Let ρ_{post} and σ_{ref} be the selected ϵ -quiescent RTL_B and Sys_ref cutpoints of one Corollary J.1 application, and write

$K_{\text{post}} := \text{KObsPost_J}(\rho_{\text{post}}; E, w, H, O),$

$K_{\text{ref}} := \text{KObs_E}, w(\sigma_{\text{ref}}).$

If $K_{\text{post}} = K_{\text{ref}}$, then

$\text{WFGRec}(K_{\text{post}}) = \text{WFGRec}(K_{\text{ref}}).$

Equivalently, the K-facing reconstructed post wait-for graph and the operational source wait-for graph have exactly the same vertices and directed edges. The statement applies uniformly to buffered and rendezvous boundaries and to Sys_B^elab explicit staged, bundle, join, and epoch-gate boundaries supplied by E.

Proof. WFGRec is a typed pure function of K. FrontRec and BoundaryReqRec are reconstructed from O by Lemma K.0/R.21d; buffered channel state is reconstructed from H and E by Lemma R.21c; rendezvous complementary requests are direction projections of O by Corollary K.0a; ChannelEnabledRec/ChannelDisabledRec and the edge relation are then reconstructed by Lemma R.21e. Substitution of $K_post = K_ref$ therefore gives graph equality by functional congruence. No separate case split over full, empty, or rendezvous channels and no clause-by-clause state correspondence is required. Lemma K.1a remains the local semantic characterization of what a disabled frontier means at a concrete boundary, but is not needed to transfer the graph. $\square$

K.4a Lemma K.2a — DrainClosedNow Extensionality under Equal KObs

Statement. Let K_post and K_ref be the equal records of Lemma K.2, and let D be a non-empty process set. Then

$DrainClosedNowRec(D, K_post) = DrainClosedNowRec(D, K_ref)$.

Consequently, if the reconstructed post cutpoint is drain-closed for D in the K.1 snapshot sense, the selected operational source cutpoint σ_ref is drain-closed for D; the converse snapshot implication also holds.

Proof. $DrainClosedNowRec(D, K)$ is the pure predicate that no residual offer owned by D and lying outside FrontRec is ChannelEnabledRec. All of its arguments are fields or reconstruction functions of K, so equality follows by functional congruence from $K_post = K_ref$ and Lemmas R.21d–R.21f. This lemma transfers only the cutpoint predicate. It does not transfer, erase, or reconstruct the continuation-level Definition R.16/K.Drain discipline, which remains an operational premise for the executions used by Appendix K and Appendix K-P. $\square$

K.4b Deterministic Serial-Source Dominance and the Primary Policy-S Route

Organization. The serial route normalizes the selected instance, applies SDet to select the Policy-S run artifact p_S^{det} and to exclude any incompatible committed history under the same selected functional semantics, and uses separately supplied K.CompleteS evidence to establish that this artifact is maximal, fair, and complete. K.RespCov assigns every possible persistent process-facing serial blocker a finite response obligation, and K.RespClean proves that the complete selected run violates none of those obligations. Lemma K.2b proves that a Policy-L internal deadlock would force a finite K.RespFail event on p_S^{det} . The historical Dead_KS/K.EnvOrd/K.Done owner-walk remains below only as diagnostic machinery and is not needed for Corollary K.2c.

Definition K.BF (blocking-only fragment). Every wait relevant to the WFG is a persistent blocking Push/Pop at an explicit point-to-point boundary with finite B-faithful capacity; control, payloads, and later operation identities are deterministic functions of committed causal history, fixed stimulus, and fixed witness choices under K.CV; shared arbitration is remodeled as explicit point-to-point subchannels through an arbiter whose choices are deterministic or witness-fixed. Bounded local progress: computation between message operations terminates, so at every point each process either normally completes, reaches its next message operation, or is blocked at one; a process that diverges in pure computation is outside the fragment. Lemma K.2b.Q uses this assumption to identify a permanently non-advancing process with a persistent process-facing frontier that K.RespCov must cover. No missing-supply owner trichotomy is assumed.

Definition K.Low and normalized instance Sys_K. Let $\Lambda_W(Sys_ref)$ be the witness-indexed lowering that represents synchronization by explicit epoch-gate channels and every aligned non-NB-CF non-blocking dependency by a fresh blocking guard channel. The default guard has $B(g)=1$ with ordinary non-fall-through E4 timing; the finite skew after supplier commit is WFG-inert and cannot remain at a drain-

closed cutpoint. Define $\text{Sys_K} \triangleq \Lambda_W(\text{Sys_ref})$ where lowering is needed, and $\text{Sys_K} \triangleq \text{Sys_ref}$ otherwise. All serial-route predicates below are evaluated on Sys_K .

Lemma K.Low.C (normalization correspondence) — statement. Projection erasing guard/epoch transitions maps executions of Sys_K to executions of the original selected instance with the same external Σ history; witness-consistent executions lift to Sys_K ; and internal wait cutpoints correspond to literal blocking wait cutpoints of Sys_K . The local proof obligations are per lowering rule and are collected in Appendix K-P.

Example K.CE (why ordinary Policy-S Dead_K avoidance is not a sufficient serial check). Let P execute Pop_e ; $\text{Push_c}(v0)$, where e is an exhausted environment input and Push_c is independent of Pop_e . Let downstream processes use c and then form an internal wait cycle. Policy L may issue Push_c while Pop_e remains pending and reach the downstream internal cycle. Policy S withholds Push_c and instead leaves covered process-facing frontiers pending along a chain ending at exhausted e. Thus absence of a Policy-S internal cycle alone does not imply A5-L; K.Resp detects the unanswered serial frontier without requiring a closed Policy-S WFG component.

Definition K.StimX. Under convention B1-avail, the next fixed input item is available as soon as earlier items on that environment channel have been consumed. An environment-facing Pop is stimulus-exhausted exactly when no item remains; an environment-facing Push is exhausted only under a declared permanent-stop contract, and never under the default always-ready output environment.

Definition K.RespMon (process-facing bounded-response monitor). For a dynamic blocking source-operation instance q of process P in reset epoch e, let x be its E-typed process-facing frontier item or certified joint-frontier representative. The monitor triggers at the first selected Policy-S normalized cycle t in which q is the active source-minimal pending blocking frontier, its persistent request attribution is established, and q has not process-facing committed. The response is the commit/return that releases q from P's source execution; proof-internal channel movement does not count unless E identifies it as that process-facing commit. The monitor carries a finite bound $B_resp(P, q, e, \text{state-class})$ measured in selected Policy-S clock cycles. Its age advances with the selected clock even while unrelated processes commit. For a certified multi-frontier source operation, the monitor is attached to operation return and the K-O2 composition lemma proves that permanent joint blockage leaves the monitor pending.

Definition K.RespFail, K.RespCov, and K.RespClean. RespFail occurs at a finite Policy-S prefix when one of the following holds for a non-waived covered monitor: (i) timeout—the response has not occurred by $t + B_resp$; (ii) maximal-pending—the selected execution is maximal finite while the monitor remains pending, even if its numerical deadline would lie later; or (iii) cancelled-pending—a reset, cancellation, abort, or declared end-of-test clears or abandons q before response. Because A5-L forbids reachability of the liberal deadlock cutpoint even if a later reset or environment action would rescue it, cancellation is a failure unless the exact dynamic class is explicitly waived with the K.Resp coverage-preservation proof. K.RespCov is default-total over internal sites: every dynamically reachable instance of every internal process-facing blocking site in the selected instance shall have one checkable proof disposition. The disposition may be a literal monitor, a validated static bounded-response proof, or a proof that the site or dynamic class is unreachable. This definition does not ask the user or checker first to decide whether a site can become the persistent serial blocker; that fact is motivation for the coverage rule, not its quantification domain. A production-count argument alone is not an exemption. K.RespClean states that the complete p_S^{det} contains no non-waived RespFail.

Environment and waiver rule for K.RespCov. Every internal process-facing blocking site is covered by default. For StandardEnv/B1-avail, a source-earlier environment operation that committed in the frozen liberal prefix has the same consumption ordinal available to Policy S and, under persistent request, B2/B3, and issue fairness, cannot be the permanent serial blocker; that theorem may discharge coverage for the corresponding dynamic instance. An environment operation not covered by that argument—including timed/reactive delivery, permanent exhaustion, output back-pressure under a

nondefault contract, or an end-of-test wait—must itself be monitored, proved unable to feed a liberal internal cycle by an explicit no-bypass argument, or placed outside the serial route. A response waiver is valid only if every non-waived liberal K.1 component extracted by K.2b maps to at least one non-waived covered serial monitor.

Complete-run and bound rule. K.CompleteS remains the semantic proof that p_S^{det} is the complete selected artifact. K.RespClean is a separate property checked over it. For a terminating artifact, the checker validates every monitor through the maximal terminal state. For an infinite artifact, a finite trace is insufficient: an invariant, exhaustive model check, recurrence/lasso proof, or equivalent certificate must establish that monitor ages never exceed their bounds. For theorem soundness, the bound need only be finite and compliance must be proved over the complete run; a separately justified worst-case-latency proof is required only to classify a timeout as a design-specification violation rather than as a failed certificate attempt. No K.Resp bound is transferred to RTL by Theorem K.1.

Diagnostic Definition K.WFG+ and K.DeadKS. For debugging and failure triage only, extend the ordinary wait-for graph with two terminal-node classes. For each environment-facing boundary c whose next required interaction is permanently unavailable under Definition K.StimX, create EnvStop_ c and add $P \rightarrow \text{EnvStop}_c$ when blocked P has the corresponding disabled frontier. For each internal point-to-point boundary c whose unique complementary owner has normally completed before the demanded ordinal, create DoneStop_ c and add $P \rightarrow \text{DoneStop}_c$. Ordinary internal dependencies remain process-to-process edges $P \rightarrow Q$. At a reachable ε -quiescent, drain-closed Policy-S cutpoint, Dead_KS holds when the extended graph contains a nonempty closed blocked component containing at least one process-to-process edge; Dead_K is the terminal-free special case. These predicates remain KObs-reconstructible under their stated environment and waiver premises, but they are not complete for live endpoint under-supply and are not used to prove Corollary K.2c. They may classify why a K.Resp monitor fired and support familiar diagnostic reports for Examples K.CE through K.CE-4.

Diagnostic Definition K.Cone, Condition K.EnvOrd, and Condition K.Done. K.Cone and its may-follow closure may be used to explain environment-rooted or completion-rooted response failures and to prove that particular eager bypasses are impossible. K.EnvOrd retains the transitive, loop-aware dynamic no-bypass meaning described below. K.Done remains only a normal-completion audit: it can prove DoneStop unreachable by showing that every normally terminating endpoint produces or consumes enough operations before FINISH, or by proving that no process normally completes. The latter does not establish continuing service on every endpoint and does not address the H2 perpetual-under-supply case. Consequently K.EnvOrd/K.Done may simplify diagnostic Dead_KS reports but never permit omission of K.Resp coverage and never discharge A5-L by themselves.

Example K.CE-2 (transitive starvation—diagnostic value and uniform K.Resp detection). Let e be an environment input channel with empty stimulus, and let c_E, c_V, a, b be internal point-to-point channels. E : Pop_ e ; Push_ cE . W : Pop_ cE ; Push_ $cV(v0)$, with $v0$ independent of the Pop_ cE payload. V : Pop_ cV ; Push_ a ; Pop_ b . $P2$: Push_ b ; Pop_ a . An admissible Policy-L schedule can use the L1 pre-settle window to feed the downstream internal cycle $\{V, P2\}$, so A5-L fails. Policy S withholds the feeding operations and leaves the relevant downstream/internal serial frontiers pending. Total K.RespCov therefore produces a finite timeout or maximal-pending failure without needing to walk the chain to EnvStop. K.Cone/K.EnvOrd may still diagnose the transitive environment root and explain which bypass admitted the liberal cycle, but that diagnosis is not part of the soundness proof.

Example K.CE-3 (loop-carried bypass—diagnostic value and uniform K.Resp detection). Let e and c_E be as in Example K.CE-2, with E : Pop_ e ; Push_ $cE(f(e))$ fully dependent, and let W be the pipelined loop W : loop { Push_ $cV(v0)$; Pop_ cE }, with $v0$ independent of the Pop_ cE payload. Policy L can issue iteration $i+1$'s Push_ cV while iteration i 's Pop_ cE remains pending and feed the downstream cycle; Policy S withholds the crossing and leaves a covered process-facing serial frontier unanswered. K.Resp therefore rejects the selected run by a finite response failure. The may-follow form of K.EnvOrd remains useful

diagnostically because it identifies the loop-carried crossing that a merely textual source-later analysis misses.

Example K.CE-4 (completed-producer starvation—diagnostic value and uniform K.Resp detection). Let Z: Push_c(w); end produce exactly one item on internal channel c and normally complete, and let Y: Pop_c; Pop_c; Push_d(v0) demand two, with v0 independent; V: Pop_d; Push_a; Pop_b and P2: Push_b; Pop_a. Policy L may issue Push_d before Y's second Pop_c settles and thereby reach the downstream internal cycle. Under Policy S, Push_d is withheld and Y's second Pop_c remains unanswered after Z completes. K.RespCov monitors that process-facing Pop and therefore yields a finite timeout or maximal-pending failure. The diagnostic WFG+ may classify the cause as DoneStop_c, but K.2b no longer depends on completion being an exhaustive owner-walk case.

Example K.CE-5 / H2 (perpetual under-supplying owner). Let Z: Push_c(1); while (1) { Push_d1(0); Pop_d2; }, W: while (1) { Pop_d1; Push_d2(0); }, X: Pop_c; Pop_c; Push_g(v0) with v0 independent of the Pops, V: Pop_g; Push_a; Pop_b, and P2: Push_b; Pop_a. Policy L may issue Push_g before Pop_c#2 settles and then reach the internal cycle {V,P2}. Under Policy S, Push_g is withheld; Z and W may continue their d1/d2 ping-pong forever while X and the downstream chain remain permanently unanswered. No closed Dead_KS component need exist because the owner Z stays live. K.RespCov nevertheless monitors the process-facing serial blockers, and their finite bounds are violated on the complete run. This example is the reason the owner trichotomy and terminal taxonomy are not soundness-critical in the revised route.

Lemma K.EnvX-Auto (environment co-frontiers). Under B1-avail and the default always-ready output environment, every environment-facing frontier item held by a blocked member of a K.1 component is stimulus-exhausted. Proof. Blockedness requires every frontier item to be channel-disabled. A remaining input item or ready output environment would enable the environment-facing item. Hence no separate K.EnvX premise is needed. Nonstandard timed/reactive environments require a recorded substitute argument or direct A5-L verification. Scope emphasis (normative): B1-avail is a genuine environment-model restriction, not a bookkeeping convention — it asserts that stimulus availability is consumption-ordered and untimed. A testbench that delivers stimulus at declared clock times (for example, a configuration token released at a fixed cycle) is outside B1-avail: under timed delivery an environment-facing item can be disabled now and enabled later, this lemma does not apply, and the instance shall either declare the timed channels and supply a substitute exhaustion argument or discharge A5-L by a non-serial route.

Lemma K.2b.E (fair complete frozen extension). Let $p_L \in \text{Pref}_L^{\text{adm}}(I)$ end at an ε -quiescent drain-closed cutpoint σ_L containing a non-waived K.1 component D, and let f_P be the component frontier operation selected for each $P \in D$. Under Definition R.LAdm, R.16/K.Drain, B2/B3/B5, issue fairness, nonwithdrawal, $K\varepsilon$, K.BF, point-to-point ownership, and the same fixed stimulus, witness, environment, reset, arbitration, and normalization choices, there exists a finite maximal or infinite fair complete continuation $\bar{p}_L \in \text{Exec}_L^{\text{adm}}(I)$ extending p_L in which every f_P remains pending. The continuation may schedule all enabled work outside the frozen component and may drain already-issued downstream work, but closure and DrainDiscipline prevent any newly issued source-later request from releasing the frozen frontiers. Disabled frozen requests impose no fairness obligation to commit. This lemma supplies the continuation required by the dominance comparison; it is not an unnamed witness-package assumption.

Lemma K.2b (deterministic serial-source dominance with bounded-response extraction). Fix Sys_K, stimulus, capacities, elaboration, environment, witness, concrete Policy-S simulator/scheduler and arbitration semantics, Policy-S issue semantics, ε -normalization, and K.Resp. Assume SDet, A1-A4 with issue fairness, A6-A11, K.CV, point-to-point ownership, nonwithdrawal, $K\varepsilon$, K.Drain, K.RespCov, Lemma K.2b.E, and the applicable K.Low correspondence. Let $p_{S^{\text{det}}}$ be the Policy-S execution selected by

SDet, and assume separate $K.CompleteS$ evidence establishing that it is maximal, fair, and complete. If some $p_L \in Pref_L^{adm}(I)$ reaches a drain-closed cutpoint σ_L whose K_L satisfies $DeadKRec^W$, then Lemma K.2b.E supplies the fair complete $R.LAdm$ -admissible frozen continuation consumed by the dominance comparison, and p_S^{det} has a finite prefix containing a non-waived $K.RespFail$ witness. The finite liberal counterexample uses the $R.LAdm$ reachability clause; the complete continuation is theorem-derived rather than assumed in a witness package; and the finite response failure uses the complete selected Policy-S artifact plus the certified finite bound. The proof remains operational with respect to Issue, Commit, the L1/L2 settle boundary, fairness, DrainDiscipline, monitor trigger, and timer progression.

Proof status. Appendix K-P gives the identity-aware frozen-extension, progress-dominance, and bounded-response extraction proof. The remaining mechanization obligations are the local $K.Low.C$ rules, K.2b.P1 determinacy, the explicit serial-prefix request-reachability lemma used uniformly for buffered and rendezvous transfers, issue fairness K-O1, the separate multi-frontier joint-freeze/monitor-trigger composition lemma K-O2, the default-total $K.Resp$ coverage and waiver-preservation theorem K-O5, the finite timeout/maximal-pending/cancellation extraction theorem K-O6, and the fair complete frozen-extension theorem K-O7. The former missing-supply-owner trichotomy, owner-walk closure, $K.EnvOrd/K.Done$ collapse, and $KObs$ drain-bag descent are not part of the primary soundness stack; they may be retained as diagnostic or auxiliary lemmas.

K.4c Corollary K.2c — The Deterministic Policy-S Execution Suffices

Definition $K.RespSafe$. For the selected p_S^{det} and certified $K.Resp$ configuration, $RespSafe_S^W$ means that $K.RespCov$ holds and no finite prefix of the complete run contains a non-waived $K.RespFail$. This is an operational complete-run property, not a $KObs$ cutpoint predicate and not an RTL latency statement.

Premise A5-S (primary Policy-S check). Let p_S^{det} be the Policy-S execution selected by SDet. A5-S requires $K.CompleteS$ evidence establishing maximality, fairness, and completeness of that run, $K.RespCov$ establishing total finite-bound monitor coverage, and $K.RespClean$ establishing $RespSafe_S^W$. CF-S records these separate layers of the discharge.

Corollary K.2c (deterministic Policy S is a sufficient bounded-response check). Under SDet and Lemma K.2b's remaining premises, including Lemma K.2b.E, A5-S implies A5-L. If A5-L were false, its finite $R.LAdm$ -admissible counterexample prefix would satisfy Lemma K.2b.E, which supplies the fair complete frozen continuation required by K.2b. Lemma K.2b would then force the complete selected p_S^{det} to contain a finite non-waived $K.RespFail$ witness, contradicting $K.RespClean$. $\square$

Definition $K.CompleteS$ and practical completeness rule. The SDet-selected p_S^{det} is complete when it is maximal and fair for the selected deterministic simulator semantics. A terminating run must reach a declared maximal terminal state; a nonterminating run requires invariant, model-checking, recurrence/lasso, or equivalent completeness evidence. $K.CompleteS$ identifies the entire artifact over which $K.RespClean$ is checked; it does not itself imply any response bound. Changing capacities, elaboration, witness, stimulus, environment/reset contract, arbitration, simulator scheduler, Policy-S implementation, response-monitor configuration, waiver set, or normalization creates a different selected instance.

Determinism and bound note. Corollary K.2c concerns the selected artifact p_S^{det} generated by the concrete Policy-S simulator semantics and certified complete by $K.CompleteS$. It neither assumes nor proves confluence among multiple Policy-S histories. A successful proof may use any finite response bounds if it proves complete-run compliance; increasing an unproved bound after a timeout changes the certificate attempt but not the functional design instance. A separately justified bound is needed to call the timeout a functional performance violation. WC and deterministic replay support reproducibility

relative to the selected history; SDet fixes the remaining global choices that could change that history or the monitor outcomes.

K.4d Structural Sufficient Conditions for A5-L

The theorems of this subsection are alternate direct discharges of A5-L. They do not use Policy S, Lemma K.2b, or Corollary K.2c. They remain useful for nonterminating systems, designs outside the serial fragment, or flows that prefer a compact structural certificate.

Definition K.Dep (full static dependency graph). G_dep is the directed graph over the processes of the selected instance with an edge $P \rightarrow Q$ for every way P can, at some reachable cutpoint, hold a disabled blocking frontier item whose actual unique complement owner is Q : a data edge from the consumer to the producer of every internal channel; a capacity (back-pressure) edge from the producer to the consumer of every finite-capacity internal channel; both edges for every rendezvous channel; both directions between synchronization partners through their epoch-gate channels; and, for every arbiter process, edges in both directions between the arbiter and each client along the remodeled point-to-point sub-channels. Caution (normative): G_dep shall be computed on this full relation. The data-flow topology alone is insufficient: a feed-forward data graph with finite capacities, synchronization, or arbitration can still contain dependency cycles through capacity, epoch-gate, or arbiter edges.

Theorem K.Str-1 (acyclic dependency). If G_dep is acyclic, then A5-L holds for the selected instance.

Proof. At every reachable ε -quiescent cutpoint under every admissible issue policy, every literal K.1 WFG edge is an instance of a G_dep edge, by the E4 evaluation of ChannelDisabled at point-to-point boundaries and the K.1 edge definition; a WFG cycle would therefore yield a G_dep cycle. ■

Theorem K.Str-2 (ranked dependency). If there is a function r from processes (or from process–boundary pairs) to a well-ordered set such that every G_dep edge realizable as a WFG edge at a reachable cutpoint strictly decreases r , then A5-L holds, since a WFG cycle would yield an infinite descent in r . Edges provably unrealizable at reachable cutpoints may be excluded from the obligation, with each exclusion proved as an invariant of the selected instance and recorded in the side-condition discharge record. ■

Theorem K.Str-3 (credit / initial-token invariant). If every cycle of G_dep contains at least one edge that is unrealizable as a WFG edge at any reachable cutpoint — for instance, an edge of a channel with a proved occupancy invariant $0 < occ_c < B(c)$ whenever both endpoints are pending, as arranged by an initial token or a credit protocol — then A5-L holds. ■ Each such invariant is itself a proof obligation over the selected instance, including its capacities and elaboration, and shall be recorded in the side-condition discharge record.

K.4e Certificate and Discharge Formats (Normative)

A concrete theorem application uses one versioned certificate package. It may contain CF-0 cutpoint certificates and contains one A5-L discharge payload: the primary SDet-qualified CF-S bounded-response route, a direct Policy-L proof, or CF-1 through CF-5. Policy-S certificates target K.RespClean through Corollary K.2c. No scheduler-confluence or alternate-interleaving reduction is assumed.

Definition K.CertHdr (common certificate header). The header binds every artifact to one theorem instance and records schema/model versions; source, Sys_ref/Sys_K, and RTL identities; elaboration, capacities, projections, ownership, and lowering; fixed stimulus, environment, reset, witness/WC provenance; and, for the Policy-S route, the concrete deterministic simulator/scheduler, deterministic arbitration, Policy-S issue semantics, ε -normalization identity, SDet evidence, K.Resp monitor schema, finite-bound function, reset/end-of-test disposition, and response-waiver policy. It also records cutpoint waivers, route, side-condition references, generator/checker versions, and the trusted computing base. Different header identities denote different selected instances.

CF-0 — KObs cutpoint correspondence certificate. This certificate supports Corollary J.1 and Theorem K.1A; by itself it does not discharge A5-L. It records or reproducibly commits to: (1) the K.CertHdr identity; (2) the selected source and RTL prefixes/cutpoints and the finite ϵ -normalization evidence; (3) the canonical history H, including committed dynamic identities, values, per-channel ordinals, reset markers, atomic observable units, required-order information, and WC-selected outcomes retained by CanonHist; (4) the fully typed residual-offer set O with owner, frontier item, operation identity/kind, explicit boundary, direction, and reset epoch; (5) J.HCanon and J.OfferReach evidence; (6) the complete physical RelevantReqSet_E(ρ_{post}), ReqProjection_E(O), their equality, unique attribution, endpoint-cardinality, prefix-closure, and no-hidden-request evidence required by J.OfferConf; and (7) B-faithfulness/E4, reset-alignment, and ϵ -opacity evidence required by J.KObsConf. H or large logs may be stored by digest only when the checker can retrieve and replay the committed artifact. Derived process slices, Front, BoundaryReq, enablement, WFG, DrainClosedNow, DeadKRec, and optional diagnostic WFGPlusRec/DeadKRec are recomputed by the checker. A complete historical Issue timeline and K.Resp timer state are not required CF-0 fields; the operational source witness and CF-S monitor artifact must nevertheless contain enough evidence to validate reachability, E3/E5, persistence, triggered K.Drain, and response timing.

CF-S — Primary deterministic Policy-S bounded-response certificate. The payload records the header; the functional Policy-S simulator semantics, initial state, fixed witness/stimulus/environment, deterministic scheduler and arbitration, capacities, elaboration, lowering, normalization, and response-waiver policy; the selected run artifact $\rho_{\text{S}}^{\text{det}}$ or symbolic representation; SDet evidence that no incompatible committed history exists; fairness/maximality and B2/B3/B5/K.Drain/K ϵ /nonwithdrawal evidence; and completeness evidence under K.CompleteS. It additionally records the K.Resp monitor configuration, the finite bound associated with each static site or certified dynamic class, the proof that every K.2b-relevant dynamic serial frontier is covered, monitor trigger/response attribution, timer or symbolic age evidence, maximum observed/certified response age where useful, reset/cancellation disposition, and a complete-run proof that no non-waived timeout, maximal-pending, or cancelled-pending event occurs. For an infinite run, the lasso/invariant/model-checking artifact must close the monitor-age obligations. The checker validates the monitor facts from the selected operational run; it does not trust a logged clean Boolean and does not reconstruct them from CF-0 KObs alone. A valid CF-S discharges SDet and A5-S and, through K.2c, A5-L.

Definition K.A5Cert (A5-L discharge package). The package consists of K.CertHdr plus exactly one declared route payload: CF-S; a proof reference for K.Str-1; CF-1; CF-2; CF-3; CF-4; CF-5; or a direct Policy-L invariant/exploration/proof artifact. The package records the route and target property and shall expose enough data for an independent checker to validate the route without trusting a tool-emitted conclusion string. Policy-S route packages target K.RespClean and include dominance, coverage, finite-bound, waiver-preservation, and complete-run evidence; direct Policy-L packages target Dead_K^W. Optional diagnostic environment-terminal records do not substitute for the response payload.

CF-1 — Rank certificate. A function r from processes (or process–boundary pairs) of the selected instance to a declared well-ordered set, together with the Definition K.Dep edge enumeration, such that every realizable edge strictly decreases r (Theorem K.Str-2). Checker obligations: the edge enumeration covers data, capacity back-pressure, rendezvous, epoch-gate, and arbiter edges of the selected instance including its elaboration and lowering; every non-excluded edge strictly decreases r ; every excluded edge carries a recorded invariant proof of unrealizability.

CF-2 — Credit / cycle-breaking certificate. For each cycle of the full dependency graph G_{dep} , provide an invariant—such as token presence, occupancy bounds, or a circulating-credit invariant—establishing that at least one edge of the cycle is unrealizable as a WFG edge at any reachable cutpoint (Theorem K.Str-3). Checker obligations: the dependency-cycle enumeration is complete; each invariant is inductive

over the selected instance; and the proved edge exclusion applies at the explicit capacities and elaborated boundaries. Petri-net or siphon analyses may be used by a tool as one way to generate this certificate, but no Petri-net equivalence theorem is part of normative Appendix K.

CF-3 — Inductive-invariant certificate. Supply an abstraction map α from the selected operational transition system into a finite abstraction A. For direct Policy-L verification, the observation component shall be KObs, or an explicitly proved quotient sufficient to reconstruct DeadKRec^W . For the Policy-S response route, A shall additionally carry the monitor activation, dynamic attribution, age, bound-class, cancellation, and maximality state needed to reconstruct K.RespFail; KObs alone is intentionally insufficient. Supply an invariant Inv such that $\alpha(\text{Init})$ is contained in Inv, Post_A(Inv) is contained in Inv, and Inv excludes the route's bad event. Checker obligations: α and Post_A soundly overapproximate the selected operational relation; every cutpoint or monitor fact is reconstructed from the appropriate observation/monitor components and ambient instance data; reset/environment/waiver distinctions are represented; witness-selected non-blocking outcomes are source-describable through NB-CF or K.Low; and all invariant inclusions are mechanically validated. Equality of KObs records alone shall not be treated as transition equivalence or as proof of future Issue legality, fairness, DrainDiscipline, or response timing.

CF-4 — Exploration certificate. Record an exhaustive or soundly bounded model-checking result over the selected Policy-L relation establishing unreachability of DeadKRec^W , or over the selected Policy-S relation establishing absence of K.RespFail, with K.CertHdr, the explored transition-system identity, abstraction map, cutpoint normalization rule, monitor semantics, tool/version, bound or completeness justification, fairness interpretation, and coverage argument. The checker shall recompute Dead_K from KObs for the direct route and shall recompute monitor outcomes from the augmented Policy-S state for the response route. A finite exploration depth or simulation prefix without a proof of completeness is supporting evidence only.

CF-5 — Tool-emitted certificate. Any CF-S or CF-1 through CF-4 emitted by the HLS tool or a companion tool over the selected instance may exploit the tool's knowledge of the scheduled control graph, stage allocation, actual FIFO and skid-buffer capacities, request ownership, join and arbitration structure, automatic-flush implementation, and hidden storage or credits. It shall use K.CertHdr and the applicable CF-0/A5 payload schema and be validated by an independent checker whose trusted base is recorded. The checker shall validate structure, evidence references, and reconstructed K-facing predicates, not merely the certificate generator's final claim. Labeling rule (normative): a certificate stated over the generated RTL itself, rather than over the selected Sys_ref instance, is admissible evidence of deadlock-freedom for that design but bypasses the Appendix K preservation architecture — it is output verification, not a discharge of A5-L — and shall be labeled as such in the record.

Soundness restriction (normative). An arbitrary eventuality claim—such as ‘the arbiter eventually grants’—does not by itself discharge A5-L, because A5-L prohibits reaching the closed wait-cycle cutpoint. The K.Resp route is different: Lemma K.2b proves that any such liberal cutpoint forces a permanent covered serial frontier and therefore a finite timeout/maximal-pending/cancellation event under a certified finite bound. Only response properties satisfying K.RespCov, the K.2b trigger mapping, complete-run checking, and waiver preservation may be used in Corollary K.2c. An unproved timeout threshold or a finite clean simulation is not a certificate.

K.4f The Policy-S Standard Fragment (K.PSF)

Definition K.PSF (Policy-S standard applicability fragment). A selected instance is in K.PSF when it is in Sys_K form; channels are point-to-point with finite B-faithful capacities; SDet holds for the concrete Policy-S simulator; K.CV holds and arbiters are deterministic and part of that simulator semantics; the single-frontier or certified multi-frontier condition holds; requests are nonwithdrawable; $\text{K}\epsilon/\text{K.Drain}$

hold; and a finite-bound $K.Resp$ configuration with total $K.RespCov$ is supplied. Completeness, fairness, and $K.RespClean$ of p_S^{det} belong to $A5-S/CF-S$.

Theorem K.PSF-1. For a $K.PSF$ instance, the $SDet$ -selected $Policy-S$ execution p_S^{det} establishes $A5-L$ when $CF-S$ supplies $K.CompleteS$ and $K.RespClean$ for the totally covered finite-bound monitor set.

Proof: Lemma K.2b and Corollary K.2c. $\square$

Intent. $K.PSF$ is the recommended standardized applicability target for new latency-insensitive designs. The general user-facing evidence is the conservative $Policy-S$ execution checked by complete process-facing bounded-response obligations. For finite transactions and bounded hardware protocols, these are ordinary timeout/service assertions and are expected to be highly automatable. A correct design with fair but genuinely unbounded response gaps lies outside this serial fragment and must use a structural, direct $Policy-L$, invariant, exploration, or tool-certificate route. $Dead_KS/K.EnvOrd/K.Done$ remain optional diagnostic aids rather than primary proof premises.

K.5 Theorems K.1A and K.1 — Reachable-Cutpoint Deadlock-Freedom Preservation (“Liveness Preservation”)

Theorem K.1A (core preservation from the scheduler-robust premise). Statement:

Assume $A1-A4$ and $A6-A11$, the Appendix I/J correspondence prerequisites including WC , the exact $J.OfferReach/J.OfferConf/J.KObsConf$ package yielding equal $KObs$ for the compared cutpoints, the Definition R.LAdm admissibility qualification, including the $K.Drain$ discharge of Definition R.16 from its $L2$ settled-frontier trigger, point-to-point evaluated boundaries, and $K\epsilon$. If W is non-empty, also assume $KObsClosed_I,E,w(W)$. If the scheduler-robust premise $A5-L$ holds for the selected Sys_ref , then RTL_B cannot reach an internal message-passing-deadlock cutpoint classified as non-waived by the $KObs$ -facing waiver predicate of the selected theorem instance. With $W = \emptyset$, RTL_B is internally message-passing-deadlock-free. The theorem consumes neither $K.CV$, $NB-Align$, nor Lemma K.2b; those attach only to the serial-reduction route of Theorem K.1.

Proof (by contradiction).

1. Assume RTL_B reaches a finite ϵ -quiescent cutpoint p_post whose K -facing reconstructed observation K_post satisfies $DeadKRec^W(K_post, I, W)$. By Definition K.Dead and the reconstruction interface, this includes a non-empty blocked closed WFG component and $DrainClosedNow$ for that component. The asserted RTL requests and channel facts used in this observation are covered by $J.OfferConf$ and B -faithfulness/ $E4$; no unrecorded raw RTL request may be omitted.
2. Apply Corollary J.1 to this same finite prefix and certificate package. It supplies a reachable ϵ -quiescent Sys_ref cutpoint σ_ref and $K_ref = KObs_E,w(\sigma_ref)$ such that $K_post = K_ref$. $J.OfferReach$ ensures that σ_ref is the endpoint of the selected admissible source witness rather than an arbitrary or unrealizable record.
3. By Lemma K.0, Lemma K.2, and Lemma K.2a — equivalently, by functional extensionality of the reconstruction functions — $DeadKRec^W(K_ref, I, W)$ has the same truth value as $DeadKRec^W(K_post, I, W)$. When W is non-empty, $KObsClosed_I,E,w(W)$ makes the waiver predicate well-defined on the common observation, and Lemma R.21f identifies the reconstructed source predicate with $Dead_K^W(\sigma_ref)$. Hence $Dead_K^W(\sigma_ref)$ holds.
4. The source witness selected by Corollary J.1/ $J.OfferReach$ is $Policy-L$ -legal for the fixed stimulus, elaboration, and witness choices. The theorem-instance nonwithdrawal, $K\epsilon$, and $K.Drain$ premises establish the additional Definition R.LAdm finite-prefix admissibility conditions: $Policy L$ permits the source-order-respecting outstanding-offer pattern represented by O ; all issue steps occur in the $L1$ pre-settle window or otherwise obey the operational phase rules; and every fully disabled frontier activates R.16 at the $L2$ settled snapshot. Thus σ_ref is a reachable R.LAdm-admissible $Policy-L$ cutpoint prohibited by $A5-L$.

5. This contradicts A5-L. Therefore RTL_B cannot reach a non-waived internal K.1 deadlock cutpoint. $\square$

Mechanization note. The proof core is now the finite-prefix Corollary J.1 construction, equality of two typed KObs records, pure reconstruction of Dead_K^W, and the Policy-L reachability supplied by J.OfferReach. No separate graph-edge case split, broad state relation, or clause-by-clause transfer of frontier, request, occupancy, and drain facts remains in Theorem K.1A. The continuation-level K.Drain premise is retained and is not derived from KObs.

Theorem K.1 (user-facing deterministic Policy-S preservation). Assume Theorem K.1A's premises and SDet, K.CV, NB-Align/K.Low where applicable, point-to-point boundaries, nonwithdrawal, K ϵ , K.Drain, and K.RespCov. If A5-S holds for the SDet-selected execution $\rho_{S^{\text{det}}}$ —supplying K.CompleteS and K.RespClean—then RTL_B cannot reach a non-waived internal K.1 deadlock. Proof: K.2c gives A5-L; apply K.1A. $\square$ The result retains proposed-reduction status until K-P is mechanized.

Discharge routes for A5-L (normative summary). Primary: an SDet-qualified CF-S certificate and K.2c from A5-S for the SDet-selected $\rho_{S^{\text{det}}}$, including K.CompleteS, K.RespCov, and K.RespClean.

Alternatives are structural, invariant, exploration, CF-5, or direct Policy-L artifacts. The header records the selected normalized instance and, when Policy S is used, the deterministic simulator/scheduler, arbitration, Policy-S issue semantics, normalization identity, SDet, response-monitor schema and finite bounds, completeness/fairness, waivers, and trust boundary.

Appendix K-P – Proofs Companion for the Serial-Reduction Route

Status. This companion collects the deterministic serial-reduction proof. SDet fixes the selected functional Policy-S semantics and one run artifact ρ_S^{det} at the outset; K.CompleteS separately establishes that this artifact is maximal, fair, and complete. Below write $\rho_S := \rho_S^{\text{det}}$. The soundness-critical proof retains K.Low.C, identity/dataflow lemmas, serial-prefix reachability, progress dominance, joint frontier freeze, and finite bounded-response extraction. The former missing-supply owner trichotomy, stuck-owner walk, EnvStop/DoneStop closure, and K.EnvOrd/K.Done collapse are retired from the trusted route and remain at most diagnostic. Optional serial replay is unchanged.

K-P KObs interface convention. For every reachable ε -quiescent source cutpoint σ used below, write $K_\sigma := \text{KObs_E,w}(\sigma) = \langle E, w, H_\sigma, O_\sigma \rangle$, where $O_\sigma = \text{ResOffers_E,w}(\sigma)$. For $K = \langle E, w, H, O \rangle$, use $\text{owner}(o)$, $\text{item}(o)$, $\text{op}(o)$, $\text{boundary}(o)$, $\text{dir}(o)$, and $\text{epoch}(o)$ for the projections of the attributed residual-offer tuple $o = (P, x, q, c, \text{dir}, e)$ of Definition R.18b. Write $\text{Proc}(I)$ for the finite process set of the selected instance. For a process set D define $\text{Offers_D}(K) := \{o \in O \mid \text{owner}(o) \in D\}$; $\text{FrontOffers_D}(K) := \{o \in \text{Offers_D}(K) \mid \text{item}(o) \in \text{FrontRec_owner}(o)(K)\}$; and $\text{DrainBag_D}(K)$ as the finite multiset of offers $o \in \text{Offers_D}(K)$ whose item lies outside $\text{FrontRec_owner}(o)(K)$. $\text{DrainCandidates_D}(K)$ is the submultiset of $\text{DrainBag_D}(K)$ whose item is ChannelEnabledRec at K . $\text{CmtRec_P}(K)$, $\text{PushOrdRec_c}(K)$, and $\text{PopOrdRec_c}(K)$ denote the committed-identity and per-endpoint ordinal projections of H . These names are pure snapshot selectors; at an operational cutpoint K_σ they agree with the corresponding source facts by Lemmas R.21b-R.21f.

Operational and elaboration boundary. The graph and residual-offer arguments in this appendix range over the full E-typed frontier items and tuples, including explicit $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$ staged, bundle, join, guard, and epoch-gate boundaries. When the proof uses an operation symbol f_P , g_P , or q , it abbreviates $\text{MsgOf_P}(x)$ only after the corresponding typed item x and boundary have been fixed; the item identity, boundary, direction, epoch, and owner remain part of the formal object. KObs deliberately omits historical Issue times and does not determine future issue legality. Definition R.16/K.Drain remains the continuation-level DrainDiscipline used to forbid replenishment past a blocked frontier.

DrainClosedNowRec and DrainCandidates are only cutpoint predicates. Channel-side E4 movement inside the selected elaboration is handled by B4/B5 ε -normalization and is not duplicated as a source residual offer.

Lemma K.Low.C (normalization correspondence) — restated with proof. For the same fixed stimulus and witness choices: (i) every admissible execution of $\Lambda_W(\text{Sys_ref})$ projects, by erasing guard-channel and epoch-gate transitions, to an admissible execution of Sys_ref with the same issue-policy class (S or L), the same committed message/synchronization/observation history, and the same Σ projection; (ii) every admissible execution of Sys_ref in which each witness-selected site takes its W-selected outcome lifts to an admissible execution of $\Lambda_W(\text{Sys_ref})$ in which each guard Pop commits within a finite WFG-inert ε -delay of the commit of its modeled obstruction — in the default $B(g_s) = 1$ form, in the cycle after that commit once the guard request is asserted; exactly at that commit only in a declared atomic rendezvous variant; (iii) a reachable ε -quiescent cutpoint of $\Lambda_W(\text{Sys_ref})$ contains an internal K.1 deadlock if and only if its projection is a reachable ε -quiescent cutpoint of Sys_ref containing a closed internal wait cycle in the extended sense — a non-empty process set closed under waiting through internal message frontiers, infeasible NB-aligned selected outcomes, and pending explicit synchronizations. Proof. Parts (i) and (ii) are per-rule stuttering simulations: the added transitions touch only the fresh channels; by NB-Align and K.CV, W's selected outcome at each lowered site is a deterministic function of the commit of its modeled obstruction, so the guarded process's post-guard behavior is identical in both models; clause (7) already requires synchronization refusal to be represented as ChannelDisabled at an explicit boundary, so the synchronization/epoch-gate lowering rule is representational rather than semantic; point-to-point ownership and E3 prefix closure identify

the unique g_s producer; $K\epsilon$ keeps the added microsteps WFG-inert. The guard skew of the default $B(g_s) = 1$ form is absorbed by the same stuttering simulations: during the skew the guard Pop is channel-enabled with its unique producer already committed, so it is WFG-inert and is a drain candidate, and therefore no ϵ -quiescent drain-closed cutpoint analyzed by part (iii) contains a half-completed guard; an exactly-at reading would be inconsistent with the non-fall-through E4 semantics for positive-capacity channels. For (iii), left to right: a member blocked at a guard or epoch-gate frontier projects to a process whose W-selected outcome or synchronization is infeasible, and the unique complement owner of that frontier projects to the modeled supplier, so a lowered literal WFG cycle projects to a closed wait cycle in the extended sense; right to left: each frozen or waiting node of an extended cycle is, in the lowered instance, message-blocked at its guard or epoch-gate frontier with its complement owner the image of its modeled supplier, so the extended cycle is a literal all-message-blocked K.1 cycle in $\Lambda_W(\text{Sys_ref})$. ■ Mechanization note. Lemma K.Low.C is the single successor to the former obstruction-pointer conversion obligation. It shall be discharged per lowering rule — one case lemma for the epoch-gate rule and one for the guard rule — as a local correspondence at each lowered site, not as a global argument over terminal cutpoints. Part (iii) is the load-bearing claim; a development that mechanizes only the blocking-only Lemma K.2b without K.Low.C(iii) covers only designs natively in the blocking-only fragment.

Definition K.Id (committed-identity state and serial frontier). For an execution prefix p and process P , $\text{Cmt_P}(p)$ is the set of dynamic source-operation identities of P that have process-facing committed in p , and $\text{Push_c}(p)$, $\text{Pop_c}(p)$ are the per-endpoint commit ordinals at channel c . At a terminal cutpoint σ with $K_\sigma = \langle E, w, H_\sigma, O_\sigma \rangle$, write $\text{CmtRec_P}(K_\sigma)$, $\text{PushOrdRec_c}(K_\sigma)$, and $\text{PopOrdRec_c}(K_\sigma)$ for the same facts reconstructed from H_σ . Because operations on a single message-passing interface issue and commit in source order (R4/E3 with FIFO transfer order and point-to-point ownership), the per-channel per-endpoint commit ordinal of any fixed dynamic operation is the same in every admissible execution in which it commits; per-channel counts therefore identify committed transfers by identity through Lemma K.2b.P1. Across distinct interfaces, however, Policy L may commit a source-later operation while a source-earlier operation remains uncommitted, so $\text{Cmt_P}(p_L)$ need not be a source-order prefix, and a scalar commit count identifies neither the committed set nor the frontier under Policy L. Under Policy S, $\text{Cmt_P}(p_S)$ is always a source-order prefix of P 's dynamic operation sequence; in the blocking-only fragment every commit advances the frontier, and $\text{SerFront_P}(p_S)$ — P 's serial frontier — is its source-minimal uncommitted blocking operation, with every source-earlier operation committed. All cross-policy progress comparisons remain statements over operational prefixes, committed-identity sets, and per-channel ordinals; the reconstructed KObs projections are used only when a terminal cutpoint is named. Scalar counts are consumed only as inequalities (Lemma K.2b.P). The earlier identification of a process's liberal frontier as operation $\text{prog_P} + 1$ was unsound and remains retired.

Lemma K.2b.P1 (dataflow determinacy) — restated with proof. In the blocking-only fragment, for the fixed instance, stimulus, and witness choices: for every channel c and ordinal n , the payload of the n -th committed transfer at c , and for every process P and index k , the identity of P 's k -th dynamic source operation, are the same in every admissible execution — of either policy — in which they occur. Proof. By strong induction on the causal order of commits. By K.CV, P 's k -th operation identity and its payload expressions are deterministic functions of the values P observed at its committed operations of index below k , the fixed stimulus, and the fixed witness choices. The value observed at P 's j -th pop of c is the payload of the transfer of a fixed ordinal at c , by FIFO order and point-to-point ownership; that payload is, by the induction hypothesis, the same in every execution in which it occurs. Environment payloads are fixed by B1, and arbiter selections are deterministic or witness-fixed by Definition K.BF. ■ This is the Kahn-determinacy fact for the fragment, and it is the instance of K.CV actually consumed below. At any named terminal cutpoint, the determined committed identities, payload ordinals, and process-local

replay facts are exactly the corresponding projections of H in its $KObs$ record; this observation does not replace the operational induction.

Lemma K.2b.R (serial-prefix request reachability). Immediately before a first alleged Policy-S overtake of a liberal comparison execution, every source operation committed before the current Policy-S operation has also committed, by dynamic identity, in the liberal execution. $K.CV$ therefore places the liberal owner at or beyond the same dynamic operation. Because Policy L permits every issue allowed by Policy S, issue fairness eventually asserts the corresponding endpoint request, and nonwithdrawal keeps it asserted until commit. This lemma supplies the owner-side request fact used uniformly in the buffered-Pop, buffered-Push, and rendezvous cases of Lemma K.2b.P.

Lemma K.2b.P (deterministic serial progress dominance) — restated with proof. Fix a Policy-L prefix and a complete continuation $\bar{p}_L$ supplied by Lemma K.2b.E (finite maximal or infinite fair), and let p_S^{det} be the Policy-S execution selected by $SDet$, with separate $K.CompleteS$ evidence establishing maximality, fairness, and completeness. Every endpoint transfer identity/payload committed in p_S^{det} also occurs in $\bar{p}_L$. A first-violation proof uses K.2b.R, K.2b.P1/K.CV, buffered count or rendezvous counterpart invariants, issue fairness, nonwithdrawal, B2/B3, and bounded local progress. The comparison is between this one selected serial execution and the theorem-derived liberal continuation; there is no alternate Policy-S interleaving quantifier.

Lemma K.2b.E (fair complete frozen extension)—Proof. Start from the finite $R.LAdm$ -admissible prefix p_L and its drain-closed component D . Retain the persistent requests f_P already present at σ_L . By component closure and Definition R.16/K.Drain, a complementary request whose new issue could release a frozen f_P is source-later than some frozen frontier and is therefore not legal to introduce after settling; already-issued source-later work is finite at the cutpoint, may drain under B2/B3/B5 and $K\epsilon$, and cannot replenish the frozen set. Construct the continuation by repeatedly scheduling all continuously enabled nonfrozen process and channel actions using a standard fair dovetailing enumeration, normalizing each cycle under B4/B5, and retaining every disabled frozen request by nonwithdrawal. A frozen disabled request is not continuously enabled and therefore creates no fairness obligation to commit. If the construction reaches a state with no enabled transition, the resulting continuation is finite maximal; otherwise dependent choice yields an infinite fair continuation. In both cases the continuation belongs to $Exec_L^{adm}(I)$, extends p_L , and preserves every f_P pending. The construction uses the same fixed stimulus, witness, environment/reset contract, arbitration, and normalization choices as the prefix. $\square$

Lemma K.2b.Q (deterministic bounded-response extraction)—Statement. Assume $SDet$, separate $K.CompleteS$ evidence for p_S^{det} , $K.RespCov$, Lemma K.2b.E, and K.2b's remaining premises. Let a Policy-L prefix reach σ_L with $DeadKRec^W(K_L)$. Then the $SDet$ -selected execution p_S^{det} has a finite prefix containing a non-waived $K.RespFail$ witness. No conclusion about $Dead_KS$, an owner terminal, or a closed serial WFG component is required.

Proof, Step 1 (joint frontier freeze and permanent serial blockage). Let D be the non-waived $K.1$ component at K_L . In the single-frontier case, for each $P \in D$ let x_P^L be its unique internal item in $FrontRec_P(K_L)$ and $f_P := MsgOf_P(x_P^L)$. Exact residual offers and source-prefix closure show that every operation source-earlier than f_P committed by σ_L . Invoke Lemma K.2b.E to obtain a finite maximal or infinite fair complete $R.LAdm$ continuation in which all f_P remain pending. The closure and drain-closed hypotheses, point-to-point ownership, and Definition R.16/K.Drain make this a joint freeze: complementary requests needed to release one f_P are source-later than another frozen frontier and cannot be newly asserted, while already-issued downstream offers may only drain finitely and cannot replenish the frozen set. Lemmas K.2b.R and K.2b.P then prevent p_S from overtaking this continuation. Hence each $P \in D$ eventually becomes permanently non-advancing at a process-facing Policy-S serial frontier x_P^S with operation $g_P \leq_{src} f_P$, and that frontier never process-facing commits. $K.BF$ excludes an intervening pure-computation divergence. The certified multi-frontier case applies the

freeze itemwise and uses K-O2 to obtain one permanently pending operation-return monitor per blocked process.

Proof, Step 2 (coverage and non-waiver). By the default-total definition of K.RespCov, every dynamically reachable internal x_P^S produced by Step 1 already has a checkable proof disposition; no modal selection argument about whether its static site can become a serial blocker is permitted. A validated unreachability disposition cannot apply to the reached dynamic instance, and a validated static bounded-response disposition supplies the same finite-response fact as a literal monitor. If x_P^S is environment-facing and the instance uses StandardEnv/B1-avail, then $g_P <_{src} f_P$ committed in the liberal prefix; its fixed consumption ordinal is therefore available in Policy S, and persistent request plus issue fairness and B2/B3 would force its commit, contradicting permanent blockage. Thus such an environment frontier cannot be the Step 1 blocker. For a timed/reactive or nondefault environment, K.RespCov requires an explicit monitor or substitute availability/no-bypass proof. Coverage-preserving waiver closure ensures that the original non-waived component D cannot map solely to waived dispositions. Therefore at least one non-waived covered response obligation triggers at a finite Policy-S cycle t and remains unsatisfied thereafter unless a cancellation event occurs.

Proof, Step 3 (finite response-failure witness). Let B be the finite bound of the monitor selected in Step 2. If p_S continues through cycle $t+B$ without response, the prefix ending there witnesses timeout. If p_S is maximal finite before that cycle while the monitor remains pending, the terminal prefix witnesses maximal-pending. If reset, cancellation, abort, or end-of-test clears the pending operation first, the prefix witnesses cancelled-pending unless that exact class is waived; Step 2's non-waiver property excludes such a waiver for every mapped monitor. These cases exhaust the complete artifact supplied by K.CompleteS, so p_S contains a finite non-waived K.RespFail. $\square$

Diagnostic note. The retired owner walk may still be run after K.RespFail to classify a likely root as an internal cycle, EnvStop, DoneStop, or another owner-chain condition. Example K.CE-5/H2 shows why that taxonomy cannot be used as an exhaustive proof premise: a complementary owner can remain live forever on unrelated channels while permanently under-supplying the demanded endpoint. Failure to classify a response failure affects diagnostics only, not Corollary K.2c.

Proof of Lemma K.2b. Apply K.Low.C if lowering is needed. By Lemma K.2b.E, extend the finite liberal counterexample prefix to the required fair complete frozen R.LAdm execution. By SDet, fix the selected Policy-S execution p_S^{det} under the selected stimulus, witness, environment, arbitration, simulator scheduling, Policy-S issue, normalization, and K.Resp semantics; use the separately supplied K.CompleteS evidence for maximality, fairness, and completeness. K.2b.Q Step 1 uses the theorem-derived continuation to freeze the liberal component, and K.2b.R/P establish permanent serial non-advancement. Step 2 maps that blocker to a non-waived covered process-facing response obligation. Step 3 uses its finite bound and the complete-run trichotomy—infinite/long-enough continuation, maximal finite termination, or cancellation—to construct a finite K.RespFail witness. This conclusion is consumed by K.2c. KObs exposes the liberal terminal snapshot; response triggers and timer state remain operational CF-S evidence. No alternate Policy-S scheduler exploration, owner-terminal completeness theorem, or confluence theorem is used. $\square$

Lemma K.Ser (conditional serial trace replay). Statement. Fix the selected instance Sys_K , the fixed stimulus, and the fixed witness choices, and let p_L be a finite Policy-L prefix admissible under Definition R.LAdm ending at an ϵ -quiescent cutpoint σ_L with $K_L = \langle E, w, H_L, O_L \rangle$. Suppose: (a) commit-prefix condition — for every process P , $CmtRec_P(K_L)$ is a source-order prefix of P 's dynamic operation sequence; (b) serial-precedence acyclicity — the union of the causal dependencies of p_L (per-channel transfer order and capacity dependencies, rendezvous atomic pairing, epoch-gate and guard dependencies, and process-local source order) with the Policy-S precedence constraints, requiring each source-earlier blocking operation of a process to commit strictly before a source-later one issues, is acyclic; and (c) terminal offer admissibility — every $o \in O_L$ is attributed to its owner's source-minimal

uncommitted blocking item, equivalently $\text{DrainBag_Proc}(I)(K_L)$ is empty, so σ_L contains no source-later asserted request that Policy S would have withheld. Then there exists a finite admissible Policy-S execution of the same instance, stimulus, and witness with the same per-channel committed transfer sequences and payloads ordinal for ordinal, the same committed-identity sets and canonical process-local replay history H_L , and therefore the same ProcRec, ChanRec, NextFrontRec, and source-relevant terminal values as K_L . If a separate terminal-offer replay check also establishes the same residual-offer set O_L , the two terminal cutpoints have equal KObs; equal O is not inferred from the committed history alone. Proof sketch. Linearize the finite acyclic combined precedence relation and replay commits in that order, inserting idle cycles to satisfy the strictly-earlier-cycle serial condition. The induction invariant — equal per-channel counts and payloads, equal process-local committed histories, equal channel state — is preserved at each step: source-earlier blockers have committed by the added precedence constraints, so each issue is Policy-S-legal; channel enabling conditions transfer by the equal-channel-state invariant; Lemma K.2b.P1 supplies operation-identity and payload agreement; and I.DR supplies per-process state agreement from equal replay histories. The optional equal-O conclusion requires one additional finite check that the terminal serial requests are asserted at the same typed boundaries and epochs. Mechanization note: a finite structural induction with no fairness or limit reasoning; mechanization is required before the lemma is cited as certified.

Engineering note (serial replay of recorded traces; scope of Lemma K.Ser). Lemma K.Ser characterizes when a recorded liberal or RTL-matched execution can be replayed under the conservative serial scheduler with identical committed histories — and, with the additional terminal-offer replay check, identical KObs. KObs alone is not a sufficient replay certificate. The recorded artifact must additionally contain the historical dynamic operation identities, Issue events, persistent-request intervals and attribution, failed non-blocking outcomes as witness selections, elaborated-boundary transfers, and arbiter selections needed to justify the acyclic operational replay; a committed-event history determines neither those issuance obligations nor the intermediate enablement facts. O_L records only requests still outstanding at the terminal cutpoint. Conditions (a) and (c) fail exactly where the recorded run exploited eager issue; Examples K.CE and K.CE-2 are minimal failures, and their liberal histories are reproducible by no Policy-S execution. Lemma K.Ser is therefore deliberately not a substitute for Lemma K.2b: the non-serializable case is where the dominance content of the serial-reduction route resides. Mechanization obligations. K-O1: formalize issue fairness for a reached source operation whose issue preconditions remain satisfied. K-O2: prove multi-frontier joint-freeze and process-facing monitor-trigger composition for elaborated joins and bundles over the full attributed item type; the primary certified theorem may initially be K.2b-SF for single-frontier processes. K-O4: mechanize Lemma K.2b.R uniformly across buffered and rendezvous cases. K-O5: mechanize default-total K.RespCov completeness by enumerating every internal blocking site and its dynamically reachable classes, assigning each class a literal monitor, validated static bounded-response proof, or selected-instance unreachability proof, and proving process-facing attribution, the StandardEnv rule, and waiver closure. K-O6: extract a finite response failure from every permanently pending covered obligation, including timeout, maximal-finite pending, and reset/cancellation/end-of-test. K-O7: mechanize Lemma K.2b.E by constructing from each finite R.LAdm-admissible liberal deadlock prefix a finite-maximal or infinite-fair R.LAdm continuation that preserves the frozen requests and the required fairness, B2/B3/B5, and DrainDiscipline obligations. K-O8 is needed only for the optional diagnostic drain-normalization/Dead_KS construction, not K.2b or K.2c. K.Low.C preserves projected history modulo permitted positive-capacity guard-channel stutter; identical cycle timing is not required. These operational results shall be proved from R.16, Appendix C Issue/Commit linkage, nonwithdrawal, K_ϵ , K.CV, B1-B5, issue fairness, K.BF, point-to-point E4 ownership, and K.Resp—not from finite state-space reasoning. KObs selector facts do not replace operational monitor premises.

Appendix L – Snooping Introduction, Implementation and Concerns

Snooping Introduction

If designs are completely latency insensitive, verification of the pre-HLS versus post-HLS models is straightforward. However, if the design contains some components such as arbiters which have latency-sensitive behavior, and if that latency-sensitive behavior is in some cases externally visible to the DUT, then verification becomes somewhat more complex. Techniques can be applied to simplify verification.

Consider a design which has an arbiter like Matchlib toolkit example 09*. The arbiter uses non-blocking PopNB() on its inputs, and blocking Push() on its output to emit the winner of the arbitration. Since the latency between the pre-HLS and post-HLS designs will differ, the order of transactions presented to the arbiter in the two scenarios will differ, and thus the order of the winners will differ. This may result in verification mismatches between the two models if the order of the winners is externally visible to the DUT.

To force the pre-HLS and post-HLS simulations to match, we can run the two designs side-by-side. We can snoop the inputs to the arbiter in the post-HLS model, and only allow the inputs to the pre-HLS arbiter to proceed when the corresponding inputs are seen in the post-HLS model. This will force the order of the inputs to be equivalent between the pre-HLS and post-HLS models, and thus both arbiters will pick the same winners. When this technique is used, the pre-HLS simulation will be throttled by the post-HLS simulation, but the overall verification will still work properly.

Another related example involves interrupt request signals feeding into an interrupt controller within a CPU model. Typically, each interrupt request signal is a single bit `sc_signal<>`, indicating that an interrupt request is pending. If the requests originate from accelerator blocks that are being synthesized through HLS, then because of the latency differences between the pre-HLS and post-HLS models, the order of interrupt requests arriving at the interrupt controller will differ between the two models, and this will likely result in verification mismatches if the differences are externally visible to the DUT. To force the order of the requests to match, we snoop the requests arriving at the controller in the post-HLS model, and only then allow the requests to be seen in the pre-HLS model.

Simplified Snooping Approaches

In the snooping example directly above in which the arbiter is snooped, the entire post-HLS RTL DUT is simulated alongside the pre-HLS model to force the arbiter requests to be aligned in time. This is the most general case and assumes the input delays to the arbiter are difficult to determine via analysis.

Sometimes there are simpler cases where the input delays to the arbiter in the RTL DUT are easier to determine. For example, each input to the arbiter might arrive a fixed number of clock cycles after one of the primary inputs to the RTL DUT is pushed by the testbench. In this case, a much simpler model can be used to align the pre-HLS model with the post-HLS model. We can simply monitor the primary inputs to the pre-HLS model and then apply the fixed cycle delays to the pre-HLS arbiter inputs.

The two cases above illustrate two ends of a spectrum of possible approaches for extracting the delays from the RTL DUT. Between these two points there exist other possible approaches.

Snooping Implementation

To enable perfect matching between the pre-HLS and post-HLS system simulations, latency-sensitive global signals and latency-sensitive non-blocking message-passing operations need to be synchronized between the two simulations if their latency differences are externally visible to the DUT.

As explained earlier in this appendix, in the general case the entire post-HLS DUT RTL must be run alongside the pre-HLS system to achieve alignment. Examples of signals that need to be synchronized include global interrupt request signals (as discussed earlier in this appendix) and rdy/vld signal pairs for non-blocking operations on message-passing channels. All such synchronization signals and their corresponding handshake signals must be level-stable:

- A latency-sensitive signal s is **level-stable** if, once s becomes 1 in cycle t , it must remain 1 until the corresponding handshake signal h is 1 in some cycle $t' \geq t$.

Once the set of signals that need to be aligned between the two simulations is identified, the general rule to implement snooping is simple:

- For each polarity-normalized Boolean commit-enabling snoop signal (for example, the vld/rdy handshake signals of snooped non-blocking operations, or level-stable request lines), make all readers in the pre-HLS simulation see the logical AND of the value driven in the pre-HLS simulation and the recorded post-HLS observation of the same dynamic instance ordinal — captured at the post-HLS-side event and retired at the pre-HLS-side handshake of that ordinal, per Wrapper Realization Requirements W1–W4 below. Payload/data values are never ANDed or substituted; they are checked for equality at the matched ordinal (Requirement W4). The post-HLS simulation runs free: its readers see only its own driven values, and the wrapper observes but never gates, delays, or modifies any post-HLS-side signal.

Often the post-HLS side will not run ahead of the pre-HLS side at the snoop points, because HLS typically only adds (rather than subtracts) latency within each process. This tendency is a heuristic, not an invariant: HLS can also subtract latency, for example by removing conservative waits present in the source, by improving loop initiation intervals, or by realizing channels with fall-through timing. The one-sided rule above is therefore normative, and a symmetric variant — driving the logical AND of the two simulations' nets into the readers on both sides, so that the pre-HLS side can gate the post-HLS side — must not be used, even as a fallback when the post-HLS side runs ahead. Under B1 the post-HLS Σ -trace under fixed stimulus is unique, so there is no post-HLS nondeterminism for a wrapper to select among: gating a post-HLS-side reader (in particular an internal net such as an arbiter input or an interrupt request line) does not select an admissible RTL_B behavior; it produces a different circuit RTL_B' with different internal latencies, and any result obtained about RTL_B' does not transfer to the RTL_B that ships. Gating the pre-HLS side, by contrast, is witness selection over an intentionally under-specified specification (see Snooping Concerns below) and is always permitted.

Two situations must be distinguished when the post-HLS side does run ahead at a snoop point. (a) Benign cycle skew: the RTL asserts a snooped level-stable signal some cycles before the pre-HLS side does, but the order of Σ -visible events at the snoop points is unchanged. Because the compatibility

results of Appendices G–K are stated over Σ -event order and values, with finite ϵ -stutter tolerated (B4/B5), a matching pre-HLS witness still exists. The wrapper handles this case by recording the RTL assertion (level-stability makes the capture clean; the recorded assertion is held until the pre-HLS-side handshake of the same ordinal, per Requirement W1 below) and letting the pre-HLS side catch up, arbitrarily behind in host time. Cycle skew is not an error, and a cycle-locked per-cycle “perfect match” comparison must not be used as a validity gate, since it would misclassify a mere HLS speedup as a failure. (b) Divergence: no admissible pre-HLS execution can consume or produce the RTL’s event sequence — its ordinal order, kinds, and payloads — at the chosen boundary; the witness required by WC does not exist. This is the genuine failure mode; it violates Condition L.Dir below, must cause the wrapper to abort loudly, and is triaged as described under Snooping Concerns. Comparison of the pre-HLS-side AND against the value driven on the post-HLS side remains a mandatory monitor (Requirement W4 below), but its role is diagnostic: a per-cycle mismatch reports skew, while the L.Dir violation itself is defined at the event level — ordinal order, kind, and payload — and is detected by an order/kind/payload check together with a watchdog/timeout that converts witness non-existence, or an inconclusive failure to realize the witness within an unproved bound (Requirement W4), into a reported failure rather than a silent gate or an indefinite hang.

Wrapper Realization Requirements (Recorded-Observation AND)

The AND rule above is stated over a recorded observation, not over the live post-HLS net. A naive realization in which the pre-HLS reader sees the AND of the two currently driven values is a cycle-window mechanism: it delivers a snooped event to the pre-HLS side only if the post-HLS assertion is still asserted when the pre-HLS side is ready to commit. Because the post-HLS side runs free, its assertion window ends at its own handshake, which is unrelated to whether the pre-HLS side has caught up; level-stability guarantees that the signal remains asserted until the post-HLS-side handshake, not until the pre-HLS-side handshake. The live-AND realization is therefore faithful exactly when, for every dynamic instance ordinal k at every snoop point, the pre-HLS-side commit of instance k falls inside the post-HLS-side assertion window of instance k . This per-ordinal window-overlap condition is strictly stronger than Condition L.Dir, and it is an empirical per-run property: it shall be checked, not assumed.

Where the window-overlap condition fails — including on runs that are L.Dir-clean, i.e., runs exhibiting only benign cycle skew — the live AND fails in three ways. First, it drops events: the post-HLS assertion retires before the pre-HLS side arrives, the AND never rises for the pre-HLS side, and the event is silently lost (for example, a lost interrupt downstream, or a pre-HLS process waiting forever on a request that never becomes visible), converting an L.Dir-clean run into an apparent failure or value divergence — precisely the misclassification this appendix forbids. Second, it aliases ordinals: if the post-HLS side runs two or more transactions ahead on the same signal, the pre-HLS side’s k -th commit can be enabled by the post-HLS side’s $(k+1)$ -th assertion, and pulse-type signals held across two post-HLS instances can merge into one pre-HLS observation, or drop. Dropped and aliased events violate the no-add/remove/reorder premise of Lemma L.2 and break the per-instance μ_Q matching supplied by WC: the harness is then sampling a wire, not replaying the witness. Third, it detects nothing: genuine order divergence (a real L.Dir violation) manifests as a hang indistinguishable from a dropped-event hang, so the triage of Snooping Concerns cannot begin; moreover, the harness-induced infinite wait appears as a wait-for dependency in any Appendix K analysis — a phantom deadlock manufactured by the harness rather than by the design, and outside the finite-delay tolerance that B2 fairness extends to the wrapper on L.Dir-clean runs.

W1 (Recorded per-ordinal observation). For each snoop point, the wrapper shall capture each post-HLS snooped event — the committed transfer for message-passing snoop points, the assertion edge for level-stable global signals such as interrupt request lines — indexed by its dynamic instance ordinal, and shall hold the captured observation for the pre-HLS side until the pre-HLS-side handshake of the same ordinal, at which point the observation is retired. For a single-outstanding interface this reduces to one sticky flop, set by the post-HLS event and cleared by the pre-HLS-side handshake; in the general case it is a small per-snoop-point event FIFO. The AND shall consume the captured observation, never the raw net; level-stability is what makes the capture clean, and pulse-like signals shall be queued as distinct edge events so that dynamic instances are neither merged nor dropped.

W2 (Gate only the commit-enabling mirror signal). Per operation kind, the wrapper shall gate only the mirror signal that enables the pre-HLS-side commit: the observed vld for a pre-HLS-side Pop, and the observed rdy for a pre-HLS-side Push. The endpoint-owned request driven by the pre-HLS side itself is never modified, consistent with the Appendix C non-withdrawal discipline.

W3 (Registered sampling point). In a shared-clock co-simulation, the post-HLS observation shall be registered by at least one cycle before it enters the AND, so that delta-cycle ordering races between the two simulations cannot affect the observed value. This is safe by construction: it adds only pre-HLS-side latency, which is witness selection.

W4 (Monitor and watchdog; Lemma L.5(iv)). At each pre-HLS-side commit at a snoop point, the wrapper shall compare the committed event against the recorded post-HLS event of the same ordinal, in order, kind, and payload. Payloads must match (K.CV); the wrapper shall never substitute a post-HLS payload into the pre-HLS side, since substitution relabels Σ -events and masks value divergence. A pre-HLS-side snoop commit with no recorded post-HLS counterpart, or an order/kind/payload mismatch at a matched ordinal, shall abort loudly as an L.Dir violation. A recorded event outstanding beyond a configured watchdog bound, or a pre-HLS-side request that remains unmatched beyond that bound, shall likewise abort loudly, but as an L.Dir/WC discharge failure: if the bound has been proved sufficient for the selected instance, the abort may be classified as an L.Dir violation; otherwise it shall be triaged as an inconclusive witness-realization failure — the compared run remains outside the discharged theorem scope, but the abort shall not be converted into a claimed design deadlock or a claimed proven violation. In all cases the abort converts witness non-existence, or failure to realize the witness within the bound, into a reported failure rather than a silent gate or an indefinite hang. Per-cycle skew shall be logged separately as diagnostics and shall not be treated as a failure.

W5 (Coverage remains a separate obligation). Requirements W1–W4 concern the fidelity of the replay mechanism at each snoop point; they do not discharge the first premise of Lemma L.2. If the snooped set misses an ϵ -modeled choice that can affect Σ -visible control flow, frontier membership, request attribution, guard values, or payload values, the replayed witness is underdetermined regardless of the recording discipline, and the resulting failure shall be triaged as harness incompleteness under Snooping Concerns.

Remark (relation to the naive live AND). The live-AND and recorded-observation realizations coincide on single-outstanding snoop points at which the pre-HLS consumer commits within every post-HLS assertion window — for example, a non-blocking polling consumer that polls every cycle while the pre-HLS side remains at-or-ahead in cycle time at that snoop point throughout the run. Because W4 requires the W1 recording in any case as its comparison reference, gating with the live net offers no economy;

the recorded observation is therefore the normative gating term, and the live net may be used only as an additional diagnostic tap.

Shared reactive testbenches. Once the pre-HLS side is permitted to lag by more than a cycle, a single shared reactive testbench instance is problematic: its reactions are driven by whichever model it is wired to, so the two models no longer receive the same stimulus, contrary to the fixed-stimulus setting of the formal results. The flow shall therefore either replicate the stimulus/testbench per model, or structure the shared testbench as a function of the DUT-visible trace so that the wrapper’s recorder can replay its reactions to the lagging side under the same recorded-observation discipline of W1–W4.

Definition L.1 (Witness selector / Snooping).

Fix an initial state, fixed external stimulus, and an RTL_B execution prefix τ_{post} . A witness selector W for a source process P is a partial strategy that, at each ϵ -quiescent source cutpoint σ_{ref} and each source-level choice point whose outcome is ϵ -modeled but may affect later Σ -visible behavior, returns the outcome selected by the matched RTL_B execution.

Such choice points include failed/successful outcomes of non-blocking PushNB/PopNB calls when the outcome affects later control flow, frontier membership, request attribution, or payload/guard values; and any other ϵ -only implementation choice that can affect the next Σ -visible frontier.

Cadence-sensitive non-blocking polling. If a source process computes externally visible behavior from the number or cadence of failed PushNB/PopNB polls — for example, retry counters, timeout counters, or arbitration policies whose winner depends on how long an input remained empty/full — then that polling logic is latency-sensitive in the sense of Appendix D. Such a process is not covered by the ordinary Appendix I/J latency-insensitive source-core argument merely by treating the failed polls as hidden ϵ -steps. To bring such a design into scope, the cadence-sensitive polling logic shall be isolated as a latency-sensitive local protocol block, or shall be aligned by an Appendix L snooping/witness construction that makes the selected source execution an admissible execution of the same isolated protocol behavior observed in RTL_B. The observable interface to the rest of the system shall then be the chosen boundary of the isolated block, not the internal failed-poll cadence itself.

The selected outcome must be causally available from the matched RTL_B prefix and the fixed global Σ -causal history. W is not allowed to depend on future RTL_B events beyond the matched prefix needed to identify the current source choice. For cadence-sensitive polling logic, the witness must select an admissible execution of the isolated latency-sensitive block; it may not manufacture a retry/timeout outcome that is inconsistent with the RTL_B behavior being used as the witness, the fixed stimulus, or the chosen observable boundary of that block.

Lemma L.2 (Snooping establishes WC).

Let τ_{post} be an RTL_B execution under fixed stimulus, and let W be the witness selector induced by the Appendix L snooping wrapper for the corresponding source execution. Assume:

1. the snooped signals / outcomes include every ϵ -modeled source choice whose result can affect the next Σ -visible control flow, frontier, request-attribution, guard value, or payload value;
2. the snooping wrapper does not add, remove, reorder, or relabel any Σ -visible event except by selecting ϵ -only source outcomes at the chosen observable boundary;
3. each selected ϵ -only outcome is consistent with the matched RTL_B prefix and the fixed global Σ -causal history;
4. failed non-blocking polls remain ϵ -events and successful non-blocking transfers produce exactly the corresponding committed Push_c / Pop_c Σ -event; and

5. if the source contains cadence-sensitive non-blocking polling whose externally visible behavior depends on the number or cadence of failed polls, that polling logic has been isolated or snoop-aligned as a latency-sensitive local protocol block as described in Appendix D and Definition L.1. The WC witness is then applied to the chosen observable boundary of that block, not to an unconstrained hidden failed-poll cadence inside the ordinary latency-insensitive source core.

Then the source execution selected by W satisfies the witness-compatibility premise WC used in Appendix I.2 and Appendix J.

Corollary L.3 (NB-CF identity witness).

If NB-CF holds for process P , then failed non-blocking poll outcomes do not affect the next Σ -visible control flow, frontier membership, request attribution, guard values, or payload values. Therefore the witness selector W may be taken to be the identity / arbitrary selector on failed non-blocking outcomes, and WC holds without additional snooping for those polls.

Corollary L.4 (Cadence-sensitive polling is handled by isolation).

If NB-CF does not hold because the source observes the number or cadence of failed PushNB/PopNB polls — for example, retry counters, timeout counters, or arbitration policies whose later Σ -visible behavior depends on how long a channel remained empty/full — then the design is latency-sensitive at that polling site. Such a site must be isolated or snoop-aligned under Appendix D / Appendix L before applying the ordinary Appendix I/J source-core proof. If no such isolation, snooping, or equivalent explicit timing model is supplied, the process is outside the scope of the Appendix I/J trace-compatibility theorem for the chosen observable boundary.

Condition L.Dir (One-directional alignment / RTL-side non-interference).

Fix the free-running RTL_B execution τ_{post} under the fixed stimulus (B1) and the Appendix L wrapper for a chosen set of snoop points. L.Dir holds for a compared run iff the source-side snoop sequence selected by the witness selector W of Definition L.1 is exactly an ordinal-preserving consumption of the free-running RTL_B snoop sequence at the chosen boundary: (i) each pre-HLS-side snoop commit consumes the next recorded RTL_B event of the same snoop point, with matching kind and payload; (ii) no pre-HLS-side snoop commit occurs without such a next recorded RTL_B event; and (iii) every recorded RTL_B snoop event within the compared run is eventually either consumed by the source witness or reported outstanding according to the proved or declared comparison bound of Requirement W4 above. Throughout, the alignment never gates, delays, or modifies any RTL_B-side signal or event (RTL-side non-interference): the wrapper never drives a post-HLS-side reader with a value different from the value the free-running RTL_B drives. Cycle-level lag of the pre-HLS side (benign skew) is permitted under L.Dir provided the ordinal-preserving consumption above is maintained via recorded/buffered replay of the level-stable assertions; only order, kind, or payload divergence — non-existence of the WC witness at the chosen boundary — violates L.Dir. L.Dir is a named side condition with its own entry in the side-condition discharge record (Common Formal Definitions). A run that violates L.Dir provides no theorem-backed guarantee. The harness shall abort loudly on any detected divergence and on any exceeded Requirement W4 watchdog bound, with the classification of bound-exceeded aborts governed by Requirement W4, and every abort shall be triaged as described under Snooping Concerns below.

Lemma L.5 (Online realization of W / harness soundness).

The equivalence and liveness results of Appendices I–K are stated over the free-running RTL_B execution τ_{post} under fixed stimulus (B1), together with the source-side witness selector W of Definition L.1. This statement is one-directional by construction: no premise of those results requires RTL_B to be stallable by the source, and τ_{post} is a fixed object rather than a participant that can be gated. Separately, suppose the co-simulation wrapper (i) observes but never gates, delays, or modifies any post-HLS-side

signal or event; (ii) records snooped level-stable assertions and replays them to the pre-HLS side in RTL order, permitting arbitrary finite host-time skew (Wrapper Realization Requirements W1–W3); (iii) satisfies the premises of Lemma L.2 (see Requirement W5); and (iv) monitors Condition L.Dir and aborts loudly upon violation (Requirement W4). Then on every run on which the wrapper does not abort, the wrapper computes W online, the selected source execution satisfies the WC premise used by Appendices I–J (by Lemma L.2), and the results proved over free-running $RTL_B + W$ apply to that run. Bidirectional stalling therefore never enters any theorem whose conclusion is transferred to the shipping RTL: the post-stalls-pre direction is witness selection over the intentionally under-specified source, and the pre-stalls-post direction is excluded by the monitored Condition L.Dir rather than assumed, endorsed, or repaired by gating the RTL.

Snooping Concerns

The snooping technique is used to align pre-HLS and post-HLS latency-sensitive global signals and latency-sensitive non-blocking message-passing operations in cases where their latency differences are externally visible at the DUT boundary. This includes cadence-sensitive polling blocks, such as retry/timeout or polling-arbiter logic, when their externally visible behavior depends on the number or cadence of failed non-blocking polls. When such a wrapper is applied, the pre-HLS model is throttled to follow the latency choices made by the post-HLS RTL, and the resulting traces at the observable interfaces are forced to agree. Snooping does not make failed polls into committed message-transfer events; failed polls remain ϵ -steps. Rather, snooping selects an admissible execution of the latency-sensitive local protocol block, while the rest of the system is compared at the block’s chosen observable boundary.

Readers with a formal background may be concerned by this technique, because it appears to use the post-HLS RTL implementation to modify the behavior of the pre-HLS specification. From a formal point of view, the important observation is that the pre-HLS model is intentionally under-specified with respect to micro-timing/latency: subject to the R-rules, B-rules, weak fairness, and the explicit Σ -visible ordering, FIFO, signal-anchor, synchronization, and atomicity constraints used by $\approx$, it can admit multiple ϵ -/latency-different executions that respect the same required-order constraints over the chosen observable units. This is compatible with B1, which asserts that the post-HLS Σ -projected trace is unique under a fixed stimulus; the pre-HLS side may still have multiple admissible realizations that (when projected to Σ) match that unique RTL Σ -trace.

Snooping does not change what executions are allowed by the pre-HLS specification. Instead, it selects—purely for verification purposes—one admissible pre-HLS execution whose latency-sensitive events align with those observed in the RTL. In other words, the implementation is used to pick a witness execution of the specification, not to redefine the specification.

Triage of L.Dir violations. A violation of Condition L.Dir (order, kind, or payload divergence at a snoop point, including a pre-HLS-side snoop commit with no recorded RTL_B counterpart) is a relational failure: the compared run is outside the discharged theorem scope, and no theorem-backed claim attaches to it. It shall not be defined a priori as a bug in the pre-HLS model, because witness non-existence has three possible root causes, and defining the event as a model bug by fiat forecloses detection of the third: (1) an ill-formed pre-HLS model — for example, reliance on the ordering of causally independent events, cadence-sensitive polling that was not isolated per Corollary L.4, or a snooped signal that is not level-

stable — in which case the failure is of the same character as a standalone pre-HLS test failure and the model is outside the well-formedness envelope of the stress-testing section below; (2) an incomplete snooping harness — the snooped set misses an ε -modeled choice covered by the first premise of Lemma L.2, so the replayed witness is underdetermined; or (3) a non-compliant tool/RTL — the RTL exhibits behavior outside the admissible envelope (for example, an R/B-rule or B-faithfulness violation), in which case the Post $\rightarrow$ Ref result itself fails and the divergence is evidence of a synthesis defect. In a flow in which the harness has been certified against Lemma L.2 and the tool is trusted, the pre-HLS model is the default suspect and the failure should be filed against it first; the formal status of the run, however, is “L.Dir/WC undischarged — outside theorem scope,” not “pre-HLS model incorrect,” until triage assigns the root cause. A watchdog abort under a bound that has not been proved sufficient for the selected instance is triaged in the same way but is recorded as an inconclusive witness-realization failure per Requirement W4, not as a proven L.Dir violation. Benign cycle skew (unchanged Σ -event order with the RTL merely earlier in cycle time) is not an L.Dir violation and shall not be classified as a model defect. Experienced SoC architects tend to view this slightly differently, in terms of design tradeoffs and verification cost.

First, it is usually possible at the architectural level to avoid latency-sensitive behaviors entirely, for example by insisting that all communication be latency-insensitive and fully synchronized. However, the quality-of-results (QOR) costs of such designs may be unacceptable. Introducing latency-sensitive behavior—non-blocking arbiters, latency-sensitive global interrupt signals, and so on—is a deliberate choice made by the designer to meet performance, power, or area goals.

Second, in many practical systems, latency-sensitive behavior is not functionally observable at the DUT boundary under the trace-compatibility predicate $\approx$ with Σ instantiated to include only the DUT-boundary observables (Appendix G; Common Formal Definitions above). As an example, consider a DUT that contains a single-port RAM used to exchange data between two internal processes. An arbiter is required to control access to that RAM port, and the arbiter uses latency-sensitive non-blocking Pop operations on its request channels. During HLS, internal latencies will change, so the order in which the arbiter sees pending requests and chooses winners may differ between the pre-HLS and post-HLS models.

In this example:

- The individual RAM read/write operations and the internal arbitration decisions are not directly visible at the DUT interface.
- Only the higher-level IO of the two processes (for example, their message-passing interfaces to the rest of the system) is externally visible.

One might initially conclude that it is necessary to snoop the arbiter’s inputs to make the pre-HLS and post-HLS traces match. However, the modeling rules impose two additional constraints:

1. **Weak fairness for the arbiter.** The arbiter must satisfy the weak fairness assumptions, so that any request that remains pending is eventually granted in both the pre-HLS and post-HLS models.
2. **Causal-dependency discipline on shared memory.** The system must make any functionally significant shared-memory dependence explicit, either through synchronization that orders the relevant accesses or through declared array-access mapping / memory-serialization semantics. This discipline ensures that sufficient synchronization or declared serialization exists between the processes so that there are no read/write races through the RAM in either model.

Under these conditions, the different arbitration orders merely change the relative timing of internal operations and of externally visible actions that are not ordered by the explicit required Σ -constraints. They do not change the FIFO, synchronization, signal-anchor, atomicity, or other required ordering constraints at the DUT boundary. In the terminology of Appendices G and J, the differences are incidental variations in latency rather than changes to the required-order relation $\leq_J$ over the chosen observable units, and therefore they are not considered observable differences in behavior at the DUT boundary. **In such cases, snooping is not required.** (See also Note 1 below).

(More precisely: the trace-compatibility predicate $\approx$ is parameterized by the chosen observable alphabet Σ . If internal functionality (such as the above RAM arbiter) uses channels/signals that are not designated observable in the chosen instantiation of Σ (see Common Formal Definitions), then mismatches on those internal actions are outside $\approx$ by construction: they are not in Σ . If those internal channels/signals are designated observable (e.g., by snooping for debug, or by expanding Σ for Appendix K deadlock analysis), then they are Σ -events and must match under $\approx$. In addition, even when B1 holds (unique post-HLS Σ -trace under fixed stimulus), the pre-HLS model may still admit multiple ε -/latency-different executions consistent with the same required Σ -ordering, FIFO, signal-anchor, synchronization, and atomicity constraints; Theorem J.1 captures the intended quantification (“existence of a matching witness execution prefix”) rather than requiring a single pre-chosen trace.)

Experienced SoC architects therefore try to avoid designs in which latency-sensitive internal behaviors leak directly into the observable behavior of the system under test, since this both complicates verification and makes RTL behavior less predictable. When they do introduce such behaviors—examples include non-blocking arbiters whose winners affect externally visible ordering, global interrupt request signals at the DUT boundary—they typically know exactly where those latency-sensitive interfaces are and can isolate them.

A useful analogy is a subsystem whose clock frequency is adjusted dynamically based on on-die temperature. As temperature changes, the externally visible behavior of the SoC can change (for example, in terms of throughput or timing of events), and designers may choose such a temperature-dependent scheme to meet overall system requirements. To verify such a system, we may wish to compare a concrete RTL trace captured at a specific temperature profile with a higher-level reference model. To do so, the reference model must be driven with the **same** temperature evolution as the RTL saw. If that temperature profile is not otherwise under direct control, the simplest way to obtain it is to “snoop” the temperature as observed in the RTL trace and replay it into the reference model. In this analogy, temperature is an external parameter of the environment rather than a fundamental part of the functional specification, but it still influences observable behavior. Snooping simply provides a mechanism to recover that parameter from the implementation when it cannot be easily prescribed a priori. Similarly, snooping of latency-sensitive IO provides a mechanism to supply implementation-specific latency choices — subject to the fairness assumptions and the explicit required Σ -ordering, FIFO, signal-anchor, synchronization, and atomicity constraints — back to the pre-HLS specification so that the two models can be compared under a common environment.

Note 1 (Unobservable non-blocking micro-timing).

Safety / functional equivalence. The trace-compatibility predicate $\approx$ is parameterized by the chosen observable alphabet Σ (Appendix G). If, for safety-only checking, we instantiate Σ to include only DUT-boundary observables (Σ_{DUT}) and we assume that any latency-sensitive internal behavior is not visible at that boundary under $\approx$ —i.e., it may change only internal micro-timing, but it does not change the values or presence of Σ_{DUT} events, and does not change the ordering of causally *dependent* Σ_{DUT}

events—then snooping of those internal latency-sensitive interfaces is not required for proving Σ_{DUT} -safety. Any mismatches on actions outside Σ_{DUT} are outside $\approx$ by construction.

Liveness / deadlock analysis. For message-passing deadlock analysis (Appendix K WFG), any latency-sensitive interface whose ε -level choices can affect whether a blocking Push/Pop is enabled, or can create/remove a wait-for dependency without an intervening committed Σ -event, must be accounted for. Practically, the default is to snoop and replay every such latency-sensitive (typically non-blocking) arbitration/probe interface in the DUT. Snooping can be avoided only if the design is certified “WFG-inert” with respect to that interface: it cannot change WFG edges except via committed Push_c/Pop_c (or explicit synchronization) events.

Stress Testing Pre-HLS Models for Latency Robustness

The formal trace-compatibility results in Appendices G–K establish that, under the scheduling rules and fairness assumptions, the post-HLS RTL is trace-compatible with the pre-HLS/source-reference model at all observable interfaces.

These results implicitly assume that the pre-HLS specification is *well-formed*: it must not rely on incidental, implementation-specific timing alignments for functional correctness. Designs that do rely on such incidental alignments fall outside the formal guarantees.

Designs that use non-blocking message-passing operations (e.g., PushNB/PopNB, ac_channel nb_read/nb_write) or latency-sensitive global signals are particularly vulnerable to this kind of fragility. For such designs, it is strongly recommended to subject the pre-HLS model to aggressive *latency stress tests* in which message and handshake latencies are varied across executions. The intent is to validate that the design behaves correctly across the range of weakly fair schedules permitted by the modeling rules, not just under one convenient execution order.

More concretely, verification should check that:

- **Causal dependencies are explicit.** All functionally significant causal-dependency relationships are enforced via message-passing, SyncChannel/ac_sync operations, explicit signal handshakes/anchors, declared memory-serialization constraints, or Appendix L snooping/witness-selection boundaries, rather than by relying on the incidental execution order of concurrent processes. In the terminology of Appendix G, the design shall not depend on the ordering of causally independent events for correctness.
- **Weak fairness does not hide latent deadlocks or starvation.** The design continues to make progress under adversarial but *weakly fair* scheduling—i.e., enabled actions may be delayed arbitrarily long but not forever—consistent with the B2/B3 obligations on the scheduler and environment summarized in Appendix N.

If the pre-HLS model fails under such randomized-latency stress scenarios, then the specification itself is outside the formal model of this document: it violates the design rule that well-formed systems must not rely on the relative ordering of causally independent events. In that situation, the trace-compatibility theorems still apply to well-formed traces, but they no longer guarantee that the “golden” specification is robust under the full range of latency variations allowed by the environment.

The Matchlib library provides practical mechanisms to automate these stress tests in pre-HLS simulation, including:

- **Random stall injection on message-passing channels**, to simulate variable communication delays while preserving rendezvous semantics.
- **Latency and capacity back-annotation**, to model specific per-channel buffer depths and delays, including the capacities $B(c)$ chosen during HLS.

Worked examples of this methodology are provided in Catapult Matchlib examples 60* and 72*, which illustrate how to configure randomized stalls and back-annotated latencies when validating that a design remains well-formed and latency-robust.

Appendix M – Document Abstract

This document defines a precise user-level scheduling model for high-level synthesis (HLS) that enables system-level verification and debug to be carried out primarily on the pre-HLS SystemC model, while still permitting aggressive RTL optimizations in the synthesized design. It introduces a small set of uniform rules governing three classes of I/O operations — message-passing channels, signal I/O, and explicit synchronization — and organizes them into a “basic conceptual model” that preserves source-order synchronization, anchors signal reads and writes to their nearest synchronization points, and constrains the reordering of message-passing operations so that HLS cannot introduce new deadlocks merely by reversing source-order message calls. Deadlock behavior can still depend on bounded-capacity effects, overlapped execution, and progress assumptions; the full liveness/deadlock-preservation result is therefore stated separately and remains conditional on the Appendix K and Appendix N assumptions.

These rules are extended to pipelined loops, shared and external memories through an explicit array-access mapping layer and conflict-free reordering discipline, and direct-input pragmas that allow stable or explicitly synchronized signals to avoid unnecessary internal storage while preserving the intended Σ -visible correspondence under the stated stability and synchronization contracts.

The methodology is latency-insensitive by construction but accommodates latency-sensitive islands such as cycle-accurate transactors, non-blocking arbiters, and one-way handshake protocols through encapsulation, explicit synchronization, and the Appendix L snooping / witness-selection mechanism when needed. The document also provides concrete modeling guidelines, including rules for placing signal reads and writes around wait statements, coding rolled loops with signal I/O, and using Matchlib Connections and SyncChannel, so that digital verification engineers can write a single verification intent in SystemVerilog UVM or SystemC/C++ and reuse it across pre-HLS and post-HLS models with “no surprises,” subject to the stated well-formedness and side-condition obligations.

A major contribution is the formalization, in Appendix G and subsequent appendices, of an ordered observable trace-compatibility predicate between the prescribed source reference model Sys_ref and RTL_B , expressed as partial-order constraints on observable I/O actions and encapsulated in E1–E5. The unrestricted safety direction is $Post \rightarrow Ref$. Appendix I proves process-local replay and finite preparation scripts; Definition J.LocalGWR packages local process, channel, atomic-interaction, environment, reset, action-footprint, request-snapshot, generated-dependency, and agreement certificates; and Theorem J.GWR-Comp proves that these local facts construct a single globally witness-realizable source execution. The converse use remains restricted to annotated RTL-consistent source prefixes or Appendix L witness-selected executions.

For channels whose RTL implementations introduce finite buffering or staged realization structure, the correspondence is stated against the chosen source reference model Sys_ref : in ordinary bounded-FIFO cases, $\text{Sys_ref} = \text{Sys_B}$ with capacities $B(c)$ faithful to the selected abstract boundaries; in elaborated cases, $\text{Sys_ref} = \text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$ with explicit staged, bundled, join, or epoch-gate abstract channels. The raw rendezvous case is recovered as the special case $B(c)=0$ at the relevant ordinary boundaries.

The trace-compatibility proofs are compositional in a strong local sense: each process is checked against local replay, issue, action-footprint, and endpoint obligations; each explicit channel boundary is checked against E4, B-faithfulness, same-cycle buffered updates, complete request snapshots, and outcome consistency; and each atomic interaction is checked only across its named participants. The generic J.GWR-Comp theorem generates and proves acyclic a complete dependency graph, lifts and commutes the local preparation segments, globally evaluates shared-state non-blocking decisions, and proves a complete source unit enabled at the common channel state. Proposition J.0 then composes the selected trace pair. The conclusion is global, but no design-specific global replay order or replay premise remains in the normal theorem path.

The liveness/deadlock result is more conditional. Corollary J.1/J.KObsConf gives a common KObs for the certified RTL cutpoint and a reachable source cutpoint. Theorem K.1A consumes A5-L. The primary discharge fixes the actual deterministic Policy-S simulator and selected execution through SDet; A5-S/CF-S separately provide K.CompleteS, total K.RespCov, and complete-run K.RespClean evidence. K.2b shows that a liberal deadlock forces that SDet-selected $\rho_{\text{S}}^{\text{det}}$ to produce a finite bounded-response failure. Structural, direct Policy-L, invariant, exploration, and tool-certificate routes remain alternatives. Dead_KS/K.EnvOrd/K.Done are retained only as optional diagnostic classifications.

This trace-compositional methodology covers key HLS transformations including loop pipelining, added FSM states, memory-access reordering, direct-input late sampling under explicit contracts, and configurable channel buffering. It also explains why the methodology is not inherently limited to HLS-generated RTL: hand-written or otherwise generated RTL can use the same proof framework when its processes, channel realizations, selected abstract boundaries, and tool/RTL evidence satisfy the same implementation-side obligations. The proofs do not by themselves certify any particular HLS tool invocation or RTL instance; those obligations must be discharged by tool documentation, generated certificates, static checks, RTL/interface checks, or another validation method appropriate to the flow. Collectively, the scheduling rules, coding guidelines, and formal guarantees provide a tool-agnostic, Catapult-compatible foundation for industrial HLS use, a scalable verification methodology for RTL design more generally, and a concrete starting point for standardization efforts within bodies such as the Accellera Synthesis Working Group.

Keywords: High-level synthesis (HLS); SystemC; scheduling rules; latency-insensitive design; message-passing channels; ready/valid protocols; signal I/O; loop pipelining; direct input pragmas; shared memory; Sys_ref ; RTL_B; trace compatibility; witness selection; formal verification; bounded FIFOs; B-faithfulness; liveness preservation; deadlock preservation; fairness; Catapult HLS; Matchlib; Accellera Synthesis Working Group.

Appendix N – Scheduler and Environment Fairness Assumptions

The formal results in Appendices I–K rely on several semantic assumptions about the post-HLS scheduler and its environment. The B-rule table in “Common Formal Definitions for Appendices I–K” gives the proof-level names B1–B6. This appendix restates the fairness/progress rules in operational ready/valid form. In particular, Appendix N’s “B3 Channel Progress Invariants” are exactly the $P_push(c)$ and $P_pop(c)$ obligations for each explicit abstract channel c ; they are not additional assumptions beyond B3.

- **B2 (Weak fairness of the scheduler).** If the enabling predicate for an action (Push, Pop, Sync) remains continuously true from some cycle onward, the scheduler must eventually select that action within a finite, but unspecified, number of cycles.
- **B3 Channel Progress Invariants (ready/valid form).**
For every channel c with capacity $B(c)$, interpret “continuously enabled” in terms of continuous endpoint request, not as an immediate commit.
(No deassert-before-commit assumption.) For blocking $Push_c/Pop_c$ transfers, these requests are non-withdrawable during the outstanding transfer attempt: once asserted for a transfer attempt, they are not deasserted before the corresponding commit, and $Push_c$ payload remains stable while vld_c is asserted for that outstanding transfer. After the corresponding commit, the endpoint may deassert or may present a different request/payload for a later transfer.

Let vld_c denote the producer’s persistent request to transfer (e.g., $valid=1$ with a stable payload for a $Push_c$), and let rdy_c denote the consumer’s persistent request to transfer (e.g., $ready=1$ for a Pop_c). In the definitions below, “remains asserted continuously” is scoped to the outstanding interval from t_0 until the first matching discharge event. If the matching discharge never occurs, then the request must remain asserted for all later cycles.

- **$P_push(c)$:** If vld_c is asserted at cycle t_0 while the channel is full ($occ_c = B(c)$), and both endpoint requests continue until the matching discharge event — i.e., vld_c remains asserted with stable payload and the complementary Pop_c endpoint request remains asserted with $BoundaryReq(Pop_c, t)$ true until the first Pop_c commit on c — then some Pop_c commit must eventually occur, discharging the full condition. Equivalently: when both endpoints continuously request the matching transfer until discharge, the system cannot remain stuck forever in the full state without a Pop_c commit.

- **$P_pop(c)$:** If rdy_c is asserted at cycle t_0 while the channel is empty ($occ_c = 0$), and both endpoint requests continue until the matching discharge event — i.e., rdy_c remains asserted and the complementary $Push_c$ endpoint request remains asserted with stable payload and $BoundaryReq(Push_c, t)$ true until the first $Push_c$ commit on c — then some $Push_c$ commit must eventually occur, discharging the empty condition. Equivalently: when both endpoints continuously request the matching transfer until discharge, the system cannot remain stuck forever in the empty state without a $Push_c$ commit.

For $B(c)=0$ rendezvous channels: if both endpoint requests are asserted at cycle t_0 and both remain asserted until the matching rendezvous discharge event, then the rendezvous completion eventually occurs. If no rendezvous completion occurs, both requests must remain asserted for all later cycles.

These obligations rule out “permanent back-pressure loops” that are logically independent of the local R-rules. They do not require an endpoint request or Push payload to remain asserted forever after the matching transfer has already committed.

- **B5 (System quiescence closure).** If at some cycle no observable actions are enabled in any process, and no external or environmental change during the closure interval changes the

relevant enabling predicates, then within a bounded number of cycles the system reaches an ϵ -fixed point. Thereafter, while no external or environmental change re-enables observable or internal work, the system executes no additional ϵ -steps. This prevents a dead, all-disabled state from being hidden behind an infinite tail of internal activity, without requiring the system to remain quiescent after a later reset, input change, externally supplied message, or other environmental event re-enables work.

These B-rules are **assumptions on the execution environment**, not guarantees automatically provided by the HLS tool. In practice they place concrete requirements on arbiters, back-pressure, and external masters that interact with the post-HLS RTL.

Priority arbiter example: fair vs unfair priority

Consider a simple two-input priority arbiter inside the post-HLS RTL. Each input is driven by a message-passing channel; the arbiter issues Pop operations to select which request to serve in each cycle.

- Input 0: high-priority channel `c_high`
- Input 1: low-priority channel `c_low`

Both channels may have pending requests at the same time.

1. Fair priority arbiter (satisfies B2 / B3).

A fair implementation might still give `c_high` strict priority in *individual* decisions, but it ensures that a continuously pending `c_low` request cannot starve. In RTL terms, this can be realized by, for example:

- A **round-robin or rotating-priority** arbiter that periodically moves the “highest” priority to the next requester, or
- A **bounded-burst priority** scheme in which `c_high` may win at most N consecutive cycles while `c_low` is requesting; after that, the next grant is forced to `c_low`.

Under these implementations:

- If `Pop_low`’s `ChannelEnabled` predicate remains true indefinitely (the low-priority channel has a pending request and the relevant abstract boundary availability predicate holds), the scheduler/arbiter must eventually select `Pop_low`. The selected `Pop_low` then commits in the selected cycle. This satisfies B2 for that action.
- If the low-priority FIFO is full and keeps requesting service, the system ensures that some complementary `Pop_low` eventually commits, discharging data and freeing space. This is consistent with `P_push/P_pop` in B3; it is a channel-progress obligation that may be needed before a blocked producer’s Push becomes `ChannelEnabled`.

Intuitively, the arbiter is still “priority-based,” but its micro-architecture ensures that every continuously enabled requester is eventually selected, and that full/empty channel states covered by B3 cannot persist forever under the stated persistent-request premises.

2. Unfair priority arbiter (violates B2 / B3).

A more naive design might implement:

```
if (req_high) grant_high();
else if (req_low) grant_low();
```

combined with an environment in which `req_high` can remain asserted indefinitely. In this case, even if `req_low` is also continuously asserted:

- `Pop_low`’s `ChannelEnabled` predicate may be true forever, but `Pop_low` is never selected by the scheduler/arbiter.
- Low-priority requests can starve indefinitely, even though they are continuously eligible for selection.

This behavior violates B2, because B2 requires eventual selection of any continuously enabled action. If `c_low`'s FIFO is full and the only way to make space is to service it, permanent starvation can also violate B3's progress expectations for that channel, because the full condition may never be discharged under the stated persistent-request premises.

In such a design, the safety properties E1–E5 may still hold (trace-compatibility on actions that do occur), but the liveness/results that depend on B2/B3—especially the starvation-vs-deadlock arguments in Appendix K—no longer apply.

Patterns that typically satisfy the fairness assumptions

The following design patterns normally satisfy B2 and are compatible with B3/B5, provided the rest of the system is well-behaved:

- **Round-robin or rotating-priority arbiters.** Any requester that remains enabled will eventually be at the front of the rotation and will be granted.
- **Age-based or credit-based arbiters.** Requesters accumulate age or credits while waiting; the arbiter prefers older or more-starved requests, guaranteeing that long-pending actions eventually win.
- **Bounded-burst fixed priority.** Fixed priority is combined with a counter that limits how long a higher-priority requester can dominate while lower-priority requesters are pending. After the burst limit is reached, lower-priority requests are forced to win until the system is “caught up.”
- **Back-pressure with bounded stall.** When ready/valid or similar handshake signals are used, the design (or its environment) must enforce that ready cannot remain low forever while valid remains high, and vice versa. For example:
 - Downstream consumers are required (by specification) to service queues at least once every *N* cycles when data is present.
 - External bus masters are configured such that they cannot indefinitely defer reading from full DUT FIFOs that are logically part of the interface contract.
- **Clock-gating and power-management schemes that respect B5.** Once no observable actions are enabled, the design either:
 - Quietly stabilizes (no further internal toggling), or
 - Explicitly enters a low-power state from which it only wakes when some observable action again becomes enabled.

In each case, the intent is the same: continuous `ChannelEnabled` status implies eventual scheduler/arbiter selection and commit under B2; persistent full/empty/rendezvous-blocked request premises imply eventual discharge under B3; and once nothing is enabled, the system converges rather than oscillating internally.

Patterns that tend to violate the fairness assumptions

Conversely, the following patterns are likely to **break B2/B3/B5** and therefore fall outside the scope of the liveness arguments in this document:

- **Pure fixed-priority arbitration with unbounded high-priority traffic.** A static priority tree with no rotation or aging, combined with workloads in which a high-priority master can keep its request asserted indefinitely, can starve lower-priority channels forever.
- **“Best-effort” external masters with no progress guarantee.** For example:
 - A software driver that reads from a DUT output FIFO only when it happens to poll, and that may be pre-empted indefinitely by higher-priority threads.

- An external bus or DMA engine that is architecturally allowed to ignore some requesters forever if higher-priority traffic remains heavy.
Such environments can violate **P_push/P_pop** by allowing FIFOs to remain full or empty indefinitely while the DUT is continuously requesting progress.
- **Circular back-pressure loops with no escape.** Two or more processes form a cycle in which each is waiting for the other's channel to change state, and no other process can break the cycle. Without an explicit design-level guarantee that some process in the loop will eventually act (for example, by dropping priority or issuing a compensating Pop/Push), **B3** is not satisfied.
- **Internal oscillation without quiescence.** A scheduler or control FSM that can toggle internal ϵ -level state forever, even after all observable actions are disabled, violates **B5**. While such designs are uncommon in practice, patterns involving mis-configured clock gating, asynchronous feedback, or "keep-alive" timers that never expire can have this effect.

In all these cases, the trace-compatibility theorems **still describe what happens when actions do occur**, but the liveness claims that depend on B2/B3/B5 (for example, "a continuously enabled channel will not starve") are no longer guaranteed. Designers and verification engineers should therefore either:

- Architect their arbiters and environments to satisfy these B-rules, or
- Treat the liveness guarantees in Appendix K as *out of scope* for those particular interfaces, and rely only on the safety-oriented parts of the model.

Appendix O – Support for Multiple Clock Domains (Informative Sketch)

This appendix is an informative sketch of how the single-clock formalism of Appendices G–K could be organized in a multi-clock design. The formal results of Appendices G–K are stated for a single global clock unless an explicit multi-clock semantic layer is added.

Within a single clock domain d , one may treat that domain as a synchronous island with a local cycle counter clk_d and apply the existing R- and E-rules to processes wholly inside that domain, interpreting $\text{clk}(\cdot)$ as $\text{clk}_d(\cdot)$ for local synchronization, signal I/O, and message-passing events. Inter-domain communication should be represented by explicit clock-domain-crossing components, such as CDC FIFOs, whose source-side and destination-side commit semantics are specified at their respective clock-domain boundaries.

A full formal lift requires additional definitions not supplied by Appendices G–K themselves: a global event order or partial order relating local-domain cycles, precise CDC commit semantics, occupancy sampling rules across source and destination clocks, synchronizer fairness/metastability abstraction assumptions, and progress obligations for CDC components. Once those additional definitions are supplied, the intended proof strategy is to treat each synchronous island using the existing single-domain rules and to treat each CDC component as an explicit channel/refinement boundary with its own stated E4-style legality and progress obligations. Without those additional definitions, Appendix O should not be read as claiming that the single-clock proofs apply unchanged to arbitrary multi-clock systems.

Appendix P – AI Discussion of Alternative Formal Frameworks

The following links provide an AI discussion of alternative formal frameworks compared to the one presented in this document:

https://drive.google.com/file/d/1ccU-eRW7H2ggh-AZyKnCOzO-KLPejob_/view?usp=sharing

<https://chatgpt.com/share/69457119-ec30-8006-8684-9a2a8b19f96f>

<https://drive.google.com/file/d/1R3-46DtZLsBn1hdTbLEXyCOFVB50Gymz/view?usp=sharing>

Appendix Q – Multiple Input Pipelines Back-Annotation

Appendix J Remark 2 discusses back-annotation of pipelined loops with a single message passing input. In more complex cases such as HW pipelines with multiple message-passing inputs, the back-annotation mechanism may elaborate the Sys_B (source-level) simulation by introducing additional internal realization structure. In this document, we adopt the following simplified modeling discipline:

1. Terminology (elaboration and channel accounting). In an elaborated realization, the quantities $B(\cdot)$, $occ_{\cdot}(t)$, and the E4 availability predicate are interpreted over the explicit abstract channels present in the elaborated model (including any introduced staged/bundle channels). When we continue to write a source-level channel name c at the outer DUT/testbench observation boundary, we mean the chosen outer abstract boundary channel associated with c in that elaboration; downstream staging that is reachable only through a join (and therefore may be withheld when “join not met”) is represented by distinct internal channels with their own $B(\cdot)$ and $occ_{\cdot}(t)$, rather than as independent “slack” for c in isolation.
2. All buffering / capacity effects are represented explicitly as finite-capacity message channels (annotated with bounded capacity) that may appear upstream and/or downstream of any internal glue logic; and
3. Any internal “coupler” used to enforce mutual-stall between multiple inputs is purely combinational (stateless) handshake logic.

Observation-boundary convention for Appendix Q. In elaborated cases, distinguish the outer projected observation boundary from the proof-internal abstract boundaries. The outer Σ_{DUT} / testbench projection records only the chosen outer Push_c / Pop_c history after applying Π_{elab} . By contrast, Appendix K WFG reasoning is carried out over the explicit abstract channels of $Sys_{ref} = Sys_B^{elab}$, including introduced staged/bundle/join channels. Thus an introduced internal channel may be hidden by Π_{elab} from the outer DUT-visible trace while still being an explicit proof-internal boundary with its own $B(\cdot)$, $occ_{\cdot}(t)$, BoundaryReq, ChannelEnabled/ChannelDisabled, Front_P, and WFG facts.

Concretely, a combinational coupler is a stateless component that (a) reads the upstream channels’ valid and data signals and computes/drives the downstream channels’ valid and data signals, and (b) reads downstream ready signals and upstream valid signals and then computes/drives upstream ready signals. The coupler contains no internal state and has no separate credit/capacity state; any shared pipeline capacity, per-input staging, skid/elastic buffering, or credit-like effects are modeled only by the explicit finite-capacity channels inserted by the back-annotation realization.

Example (two inputs, staged Pops, $II=1$, latency=4):

Consider a 4-stage RTL pipeline that (i) performs `Pop_c1` in stage 1, (ii) performs `Pop_c2` in stage 2, and (iii) performs `Push_cout` in stage 4, with $II=1$. To model the pipeline's internal staging and the stage-2 input coupling in the source-level `Sys_B^elab` simulation while keeping the same outer projected Σ boundary, the back-annotation elaboration may introduce the following internal realization structure:

- An explicit bounded **channel F1 of capacity 1** on the c1 path to represent stage-1 in-flight storage of values that have been accepted from c1 but have not yet reached the stage-2 join point.
- An explicit internal **rendezvous channel F2** on the c2 path at the stage-2 join boundary, with $B(F2)=0$. F2 represents the c2-side handoff into the stage-2 join. It is not additional c2-side buffering or slack, and it does not permit a c2 value to be accepted independently before the join is ready. Its purpose is to make the c2-side join blocking point an explicit proof-internal abstract boundary of `Sys_B^elab`, so that any mutual-stall condition involving c1/F1 and c2/F2 is represented as ordinary `BoundaryReq` / `ChannelEnabled` / `ChannelDisabled` facts on explicit internal channels rather than as a hidden cross-channel disablement predicate on the outer projected c2 boundary.
- A **purely combinational coupler/join** at the stage-2 boundary that enforces mutual stall: it allows the joined transfer to proceed only when (a) a token is available from F1, (b) the c2-side rendezvous over F2 is requested/enabled, and (c) downstream staging has space; it then presents the paired value(s) to the downstream staging. The join's possible refusal to proceed is therefore visible to Appendix K through the explicit internal boundaries F1, F2, and F34, even though those internal events are projected away from the outer DUT/testbench-visible Σ_{DUT} trace by Π_{elab} .
- An explicit bounded **channel F34 of capacity 2** after the coupler to represent the in-flight capacity of stages 3–4 for the joined/paired work.

This example illustrates why multi-input pipelines cannot always be captured by a single per-channel capacity number in isolation: c1 and c2 do not have independent “slack” because acceptance across the stage-2 join boundary is coupled. In this particular example, the c1 side has one stored stage-1 token available through F1, the c2 side has no independent pre-join storage and is therefore modeled by the rendezvous channel F2 with $B(F2)=0$, and the joined/paired work has two downstream storage slots through F34.

All storage-bearing buffering/capacity resides in the explicit bounded channels F1 and F34, and in any additional positive-capacity stages the realization uses. The explicit rendezvous channel F2 has $B(F2)=0$ and contributes no storage; it is an explicit proof-internal join boundary used to type the mutual-stall condition. The coupler itself remains stateless combinational handshake logic.

This elaboration is an implementation/refinement of the abstract bounded-FIFO channels at the chosen outer DUT/testbench observation boundary; it does not change the outer interface Σ_{DUT} or E4's per-channel FIFO meaning at that outer boundary. It may, however, introduce additional proof-internal Σ boundaries in `Sys_ref = Sys_B^elab` for Appendix K blocking/WFG reasoning. Concretely, any back-annotation elaboration (including extra FIFO stages and/or combinational couplers) must satisfy:

- No new outer DUT-boundary observables: It introduces no new Σ_{DUT} -observable actions at the chosen DUT/testbench boundary, and it does not change the labeling of existing outer Σ_{DUT} events (`Push_c(v)`, `Pop_c(v)`, etc.).
- Boundary/E4 preservation at the outer projection: At the chosen outer DUT/testbench boundary, each outer Σ_{DUT} -visible committed `Push_c/Pop_c` event still denotes a committed transfer on the same abstract channel `c`, with per-channel FIFO order and the same E4 capacity/enablement interpretation

under the annotated $B(c)$ and $occ_c(t)$. Any additional internal channels introduced by the elaboration (e.g., staged/bundle/join channels) are separate proof-internal abstract channels in Sys_B^{elab} with their own $B(\cdot)$, $occ_c(t)$, and E4 availability predicates; if they participate in Appendix K, their committed transfers are proof-internal Σ -events even when Π_elab hides them from Σ_DUT .

- No double-counting of internal staging: internal transfers within the concrete realization of a single explicit abstract channel that contributes to that channel's effective capacity (extra FIFO stages, skid/elastic buffering, FIFO $\rightarrow$ pipeline-stage handoffs, and value propagation through purely combinational couplers that does not cross an explicit abstract channel boundary) are ϵ -steps and do not create additional committed Push_c/Pop_c events at that abstract boundary. By contrast, a transfer across an explicit staged/bundle/join channel introduced in Sys_B^{elab} is a committed Push/Pop event at that proof-internal abstract boundary. Such an event may be projected away from the outer DUT/testbench-visible Σ_DUT trace by Π_elab , but it is not ϵ for the Appendix K proof-internal WFG boundary.

- Conservation / projection of internal staging (normative): For each outer Σ_DUT -visible abstract channel c at the chosen DUT/testbench boundary, the elaborated realization shall admit a fixed projection/accounting map from the occupancies of the explicit internal channels introduced by the elaboration (including staged/bundle/join channels, as applicable) to the outer boundary occupancy $occ_c(t)$. This projection/accounting map is part of the realization and witnesses that the proof-internal occupancy bookkeeping is only a refinement of the outer boundary model: (i) every ϵ -step internal transfer and every committed transfer across an introduced proof-internal abstract channel preserves the projected outer boundary occupancy for each outer Σ_DUT -visible channel, except when it corresponds under Π_elab to an outer boundary commit, and (ii) each outer Σ_DUT -visible committed Push_c/Pop_c updates the projected outer boundary occupancy exactly as required by E4 (equivalently, exactly as the outer boundary $occ_c(t)$ defined from Σ_DUT -visible boundary commits). For bundled/joined work items, the projection may assign one proof-internal token to multiple outer Σ_DUT -visible channels as specified by the realization. Therefore, the internal capacities/occupancies $B(\cdot)$, $occ_c(t)$ do not introduce an additional independent outer Σ_DUT -visible state; they refine the same bounded-FIFO accounting already represented at the chosen outer boundary, while still serving as proof-internal Σ state for Appendix K when those internal channels are explicit abstract boundaries.

- **Multi-input pipelines / combinational couplers (mutual stall + explicit capacity):**

To preserve per-channel E4 at the Σ boundary, any downstream staging that is reachable only through a join (and therefore may be withheld when “join not met”) shall be modeled as distinct internal finite-capacity channels with their own $B(\cdot)$ and $occ_c(t)$, rather than being treated as additional independent “slack” for an upstream Σ -visible channel in isolation; the back-annotation elaboration may use combinational couplers to enforce the intended mutual-stall behavior when some required inputs are unavailable. Any “shared capacity” or “distributed staging” effects needed for such a pipeline shall be represented only by explicit finite-capacity channels in the realization (e.g., bounded staging FIFOs, bounded slot/credit channels, bounded bundle channels), not by coupler state. The coupler itself remains stateless combinational handshake logic and does not redefine the per-channel E4 capacity/availability predicates at the chosen observable boundary.

Projection/accounting invariant for Sys_B^{elab} (normative). Any elaborated reference model Sys_B^{elab} used for multi-input / coupler cases shall come with a projection map Π_elab from the explicit staged/bundle/join channels of the elaboration back to the chosen outer Σ -visible channel boundaries. This projection map has these roles:

- Observable-boundary preservation. When the internal staged/bundle/join events introduced by elaboration are hidden or projected away, the remaining outer-boundary Push_c(v) / Pop_c(v) history is

the same boundary history that the non-elaborated model would expose at the chosen Σ -visible endpoints. Elaboration may add explicit internal abstract channels for proof and WFG purposes, but it may not create extra outer-boundary Push_c / Pop_c events, drop outer-boundary events, duplicate them, or change their payload labels.

- **Capacity/occupancy accounting.** For each outer channel c represented by an elaborated subnetwork, the outer-boundary availability facts used by E4 are preserved by the aggregate accounting of the explicit internal channels in the preimage/fiber $\Pi_{\text{elab}}^{-1}(c) = \{d : \Pi_{\text{elab}}(d) = c\}$. Internal staged/bundle/join occupancies may refine where storage and blocking occur, but after projection they must implement the same externally visible capacity/acceptance behavior at the chosen boundary. Conversely, any cross-channel dependency or join condition that can block progress must appear as ordinary BoundaryReq / ChannelEnabled / ChannelDisabled facts on some explicit internal abstract channel of $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$, not as a hidden extra predicate on an otherwise E4-enabled outer-boundary operation.

All examples and constraints in Appendix Q are to be read relative to this projection/accounting invariant.

Explicit join boundary requirement (normative): The mutual-stall point shall be an explicit staged/bundle/join boundary inside the elaborated realization (i.e., the endpoint of an explicit finite-capacity message channel). “Join not met” shall therefore be expressed as ordinary ChannelDisabled at that explicit internal boundary (because that boundary’s own E4 availability predicate fails in the ϵ -quiescent handshake fixed point). The realization must not force a Σ -visible operation on an abstract channel c at the chosen boundary to be ChannelDisabled solely due to the state of some other channel; any cross-channel dependency shall be expressed only via the explicit staged/bundle channels introduced by the elaboration. Operationally, the coupler is invisible at the outer DUT/testbench observation boundary: it only propagates ready/valid between the explicit staged/bundle channels inside the elaborated realization, and it does not change the projected outer $\text{occ}_c(t)$, which is defined solely by projected outer-boundary commits under Π_{elab} . This invisibility is only with respect to the outer projection; it does not hide any explicit staged/bundle/join channel from Appendix K’s proof-internal WFG boundary.

- **WFG compatibility (Appendix K):** The realization must not introduce a new blocking point that is invisible to the proof-internal abstract boundary of $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$. In particular, if the consuming process cannot advance the pending blocking frontier $\text{Front_P}(\sigma)$ (Appendix K.1), then at least one blocking frontier operation (Push/Pop) at either the chosen outer boundary or an introduced explicit staged/bundle/join boundary is asserted with a true boundary request and is channel-disabled by the K.1 enablement test; the process is therefore “blocked on message passing” exactly as defined in K.1. Because couplers are purely combinational, they have no internal state transitions; any changes in readiness/validity induced by the coupler are purely a function of (i) downstream readiness and (ii) the same channel occupancies / Σ -visible committed transfers already accounted for by E4/K.1, with “downstream readiness” interpreted in the ϵ -quiescent (ϵ -normalized) state used for WFG evaluation.

Pure internal data movements that do not change any proof-internal BoundaryReq, ChannelEnabled/ChannelDisabled, Pending_P, or Front_P fact are ϵ -steps and are WFG-inert under the same pending-blocking-frontier / $\text{Front_P}(\sigma)$ discipline used elsewhere in Appendix K. By contrast, a staged/bundle/join channel boundary that can block progress is not hidden from Appendix K; it is part of

the explicit $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$ proof boundary, even if it is projected away from the outer Σ_{DUT} trace by Π_{elab} .

- **Combinational well-formedness:** The network of combinational couplers and ready/valid connections shall be combinational acyclic (no pure combinational ready/valid loops). Any required feedback that would otherwise create a combinational loop must pass through an explicit finite-capacity channel stage (and is therefore represented in the back-annotated realization and its effective capacities).

Accordingly, the formal development need not depend on the particular back-annotation construction, provided it yields an explicit source-side reference model $\text{Sys_ref} = \text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$ (Appendix J, Remark 2) equipped with a projection/accounting map Π_{elab} satisfying the invariant above. The elaborated model must respect E4, BoundaryReq, ChannelEnabled/ChannelDisabled, and the Appendix K blocking/WFG semantics at its explicit proof-internal abstract boundaries, while its projection back to the chosen outer Σ_{DUT} -visible boundaries must preserve the externally visible Push_c / Pop_c history and aggregate capacity/occupancy behavior. In these cases the proofs do not target the raw outer-boundary Sys or the non-elaborated outer-boundary Sys_B directly; they target the proof-internal explicit abstract channels of $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$ together with their Π_{elab} projection back to the outer DUT/testbench-visible boundary.

Lean-oriented clarification / proof-parameter convention

The formal theorems do not require a unique algorithm that constructs $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$ from RTL_B . Instead, the chosen comparison boundary Sys_ref is part of the theorem instance. For ordinary bounded-FIFO cases, Sys_ref may be Sys_B . For cases involving proof-relevant internal staging, multi-input joins, combinational couplers, sync-boundary epoch gates, or shared-capacity effects, Sys_ref shall be supplied as $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}(E)$ for some well-formed elaboration package E .

Thus elaboration is not an extra semantic freedom inside the proof. It is an explicit input to the proof instance, and all Appendix I–K definitions are interpreted over that chosen Sys_ref .

Definition Q.1 (Elaboration package for $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$).

For a chosen outer source reference boundary Sys_B and outer observable alphabet Σ_{DUT} , an elaboration package E consists of:

1. an elaborated source reference model $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}(E)$;
2. a finite set of explicit abstract channels $\text{Chan_elab}(E)$, each with finite capacity $B_E(d) \geq 0$ and cycle-boundary occupancy $\text{occ}_d(t)$;
3. a distinguished subset of outer-boundary channels Chan_outer and a projection/accounting map

$$\Pi_{\text{elab}} : \text{Chan_elab}(E) \rightarrow \text{Chan_outer} \cup \{\perp\};$$

4. a trace projection map $\pi_{\Sigma,E}$ from proof-internal Σ_{elab} traces to outer Σ_{DUT} traces; and
5. a state-accounting map A_E that computes each outer $\text{occ}_c(t)$ from the occupancies and token/accounting state of the elaborated channels in $\Pi_{\text{elab}}^{-1}(c)$.

The package is well formed only if the following obligations hold:

- (a) Outer-trace preservation. $\pi_{\Sigma,E}$ neither creates, drops, duplicates, nor relabels any outer-boundary

Push_c(v) / Pop_c(v) event.

(b) Occupancy preservation. For every outer channel c and every ε -quiescent cycle-boundary state σ at time t ,

$$\text{occ}_c(\sigma) = A_E(c, \sigma),$$

and projected Push_c / Pop_c commits update A_E exactly as required by E4 for the outer channel c .

(c) Internal refinement. Any internal staged/bundle/join transfer either is projected away by $\pi_{\Sigma, E}$ or projects to a unique corresponding outer-boundary commit. Projected-away internal transfers preserve all outer occupancies $A_E(c, \sigma)$.

(d) No hidden cross-channel disablement. If progress can be blocked by a join, mutual-stall condition, sync-boundary gate, or shared-capacity condition, then that blocking condition appears as ordinary BoundaryReq / ChannelEnabled / ChannelDisabled status at some explicit abstract channel $d \in \text{Chan_elab}(E)$. It is not an additional hidden predicate on an otherwise E4-enabled outer-boundary operation.

(e) WFG visibility. Every proof-relevant blocking point introduced by the elaboration is represented at an explicit abstract boundary of $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}(E)$, and therefore may be used by Appendix K's Front_P, ChannelDisabled, and WFG definitions, even if its events are projected away from the outer Σ_{DUT} trace.

(f) Combinational well-formedness. Any combinational coupler logic in the elaboration is stateless and acyclic after ε -settling; any feedback or storage needed for correctness is represented by an explicit finite-capacity abstract channel.

(g) Point-to-point elaborated channels. Every explicit abstract channel in $\text{Chan_elab}(E)$ at which BoundaryReq, ChannelEnabled/ChannelDisabled, Front_P, or Appendix K WFG facts are evaluated has exactly one producer process and exactly one consumer process at that boundary of evaluation. A join, bundle, or shared-capacity structure that would multiplex several producers or several consumers at an evaluated boundary shall be remodeled with explicit per-endpoint point-to-point sub-channels (for example, via an explicit arbiter process), as required by the point-to-point premise of Lemma K.2b.

(h) Frontier-item declaration and boundary attribution. The elaboration package declares every proof-internal frontier item introduced by $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}(E)$, including its owning process, its membership in Ω_P / $\Omega_{\text{msg}, P}$ when applicable, its owning source-level message instance $\text{MsgOf}_P(x)$, its evaluated abstract boundary $\text{BoundaryOf}_P(x) \in \text{Chan_elab}(E)$, where P is the owning process of x , and the partial order $\leq_P$ among ordinary source items and introduced elaborated frontier items. For ordinary unelaborated message calls there is a unique frontier item and a unique evaluated boundary. For elaborated calls, one source-level message instance q may own multiple frontier items at different explicit abstract boundaries; in that case BoundaryReq, ChannelEnabled, ChannelDisabled, Pending_P, and Front_P are interpreted for the pair $(q, \text{BoundaryOf}_P(x))$ represented by the frontier item x , not for q alone. Thus BoundaryReq(q, σ) remains only a shorthand for the ordinary unique-boundary case, while BoundaryReq(x, σ) means the endpoint-owned request for $\text{MsgOf}_P(x)$ at $\text{BoundaryOf}_P(x)$. The package also states how these introduced items project through $\pi_{\Sigma, E}$ / Π_{elab} back to outer Σ_{DUT} events and occupancy accounting.

When $\text{Sys_ref} = \text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}(E)$, all references to $B(\cdot)$, $\text{occ}_\cdot$, BoundaryReq , $\text{ChannelEnabled/ChannelDisabled}$, Front_P , and the Appendix K WFG are interpreted over the explicit channels of $\text{Chan_elab}(E)$, with outer observations recovered only through $\pi_{\Sigma, E}$ and Π_{elab} .

Locality of elaboration

The elaboration package E is constructed locally, per process and per channel boundary. Each elaboration pattern in this appendix (multi-input pipelined-loop staging, sync-boundary epoch gating, R2C combinational coupler, etc.) is determined by the local channel structure of the process at the boundary in question — its number of input channels, its sync-boundary discipline, its pipelining configuration — and does not depend on the structure or elaboration of any other process. Independently chosen per-process elaborations compose into a system-level $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}(E)$ without further global modeling. Π_{elab} then projects the introduced internal channels back to the outer Σ_{DUT} alphabet on a per-channel basis. In this sense, the elaboration step preserves the per-process compositionality stated in the introduction: it refines each process's abstract boundary, it does not introduce cross-process modeling obligations.

Appendix R – Compact Formal Core for Appendices B–K

R.1 Purpose and scope

Numbering convention. Definitions in this appendix use the numbers R.1–R.20, with letter suffixes (for example, Definition R.1a) for attached definitions. Theorems, lemmas, and corollaries use the numbers R.21 onward, continuing the same sequence, so that every type-plus-number pair in this appendix is unique; a letter suffix such as Corollary R.21a denotes attachment to the same-numbered parent item (here, Theorem R.21). Axiom R.1 and the Remarks retain their per-type numbering.

This appendix packages the common formal core already used by Appendices B, C, J, and K into a compact definition/lemma/theorem form. Its purpose is only to factor out the shared semantic skeleton and finite-prefix cutpoint view of the formal story. All terminology, assumptions, and proof targets remain those of the main document. In particular, the prescribed source-side semantic target remains exactly the Appendix J, Remark 2 target: $\text{Sys_ref} = \text{Sys_B}$ in the ordinary abstract back-annotated presentation using the case-split channel semantics of E4 ($B(c)=0$ as rendezvous, $B(c)>0$ as cycle-boundary non-fall-through bounded FIFO), and $\text{Sys_ref} = \text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$ in the elaborated/back-annotated / coupler cases. Thus the proofs here do not introduce any proof target separate from the Appendix J target family.

Definition R.1a (Elaboration projection/accounting map Π_{elab}).

In the elaborated case $\text{Sys_ref} = \text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$, Π_{elab} denotes the fixed projection/accounting map associated with the chosen elaboration. It maps proof-internal executions, events, and channel-occupancy state of $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$ to the chosen outer DUT/testbench-visible boundary view. Π_{elab} has the following roles:

- (1) Trace projection. Π_{elab} preserves the labels and order of the chosen outer Σ_{DUT} -visible boundary events, such as outer $\text{Push_c}(v)$ and $\text{Pop_c}(v)$, and hides or projects away introduced proof-internal staged/bundle/join channel events that are not part of the chosen outer observation boundary.
- (2) Occupancy projection. For each chosen outer Σ_{DUT} -visible abstract channel c , Π_{elab} maps the occupancies of the explicit internal channels introduced by the elaboration to the outer occupancy $\text{occ}_c(\sigma)$ used for the outer E4 interpretation.

(3) Conservation/accounting. Internal ϵ -steps and committed transfers across introduced proof-internal abstract channels preserve the projected outer boundary history and projected outer occupancy, except when the elaboration designates such a transfer as corresponding to an outer boundary commit under Π_{elab} . Each projected outer Push_c/Pop_c commit updates the projected outer occ_c exactly as required by E4. For bundled or joined work items, Π_{elab} may assign one proof-internal token to one or more outer channels as specified by the elaboration.

(4) WFG visibility. Projection by Π_{elab} does not make an introduced proof-internal blocking boundary invisible to Appendix K. Any staged/bundle/join channel used for proof-internal blocking, BoundaryReq, ChannelEnabled/ChannelDisabled, Pending_P, Front_P, or WFG reasoning remains an explicit abstract channel of $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$, even if its committed events are projected away from the outer Σ_{DUT} trace.

Thus Π_{elab} witnesses that $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$ is a refinement of the chosen outer boundary model: it may expose additional proof-internal abstract channels for Appendix K, but it does not add independent outer DUT-visible behavior or alter the projected outer Push/Pop history and E4 occupancy accounting.

This appendix should therefore be read as a compact companion to the existing appendices, not as a replacement for the full modeling assumptions, witness constructions, fairness/progress premises, or elaboration conventions already stated there.

Appendix B continues to supply the general drain-only blocked-frontier discipline, with automatic flush as its pipelined or otherwise overlapped implementation-side instance and a structural no-new-dynamic-operation-launch argument as the ordinary non-overlapped discharge. Appendix C supplies the Issue/Commit linkage and non-withdrawal discipline, Appendix I the witness construction machinery, Appendix J the full execution-level / cutpoint-correspondence results, Appendix L the witness-selection / snooping wrapper where needed, Appendix N the cited progress premises, and Appendix K the wait-for-graph and deadlock-preservation layer.

Corollary J.1 is the authoritative equal-KObs cutpoint theorem used by Appendices J–K. Appendix R introduces no alternate clause relation or compatibility symbol: cross-model arguments cite the common KObs record and the named reconstruction functions directly. Whenever abbreviated wording in this appendix about Issue, BoundaryReq attribution, or channel state appears less precise than Appendices C, J, or K, the authoritative definition in those appendices governs.

R.2 Prescribed reference model

Definition R.1 (Prescribed source reference model Sys_ref).

For a fixed design and fixed external stimulus, let Sys_ref be exactly the prescribed source reference model of Appendix J, Remark 2:

- $\text{Sys_ref} = \text{Sys_B}$ in the ordinary abstract back-annotated presentation using the case-split channel semantics of E4: $B(c)=0$ is rendezvous, and $B(c)>0$ is cycle-boundary non-fall-through bounded FIFO.
- $\text{Sys_ref} = \text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$ in the elaborated/back-annotated case.

All source-side semantic notions used below are interpreted with respect to this prescribed source reference model.

Remark R.1 (Interpretation at explicit abstract channels).

Whenever $\text{Sys_ref} = \text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$, the quantities $B(\cdot)$, $\text{occ_}\cdot(t)$, E4, BoundaryReq, ChannelEnabled, ChannelDisabled, and the Appendix K blocking / wait-for-graph machinery are interpreted per explicit abstract channel, including any staged, bundle, or join channels introduced by elaboration. Any conjunctive/join dependency shall therefore be represented only via such explicit abstract channels, not as cross-channel disablement at the outer Σ -visible endpoints.

Remark R.1a (Operational Sys_ref transition system and issue policies).

Sys_ref is the selected source-reference transition system described in Appendix G. Its states contain process-local control/variable state, reached/issued/committed dynamic message-call instances, explicit abstract channel state for every Sys_B or Sys_B^elab boundary, operation-attributive pending endpoint requests, synchronization/signal-anchor state, and ϵ -microstate. Its steps are pure source-evaluation ϵ -steps, message issue steps, E4 channel-commit steps, synchronization/signal-anchor steps, and admissible ϵ -settling/drain steps. Policy L and Policy S are two issue policies over this same transition system. Policy L permits source-later blocking requests to be issued before source-earlier same-interval blockers process-facing commit, subject to source-order prefix closure and all R/E/E4/E5 obligations. Policy S adds the conservative serial-blocking restriction: a later source-order blocking Push/Pop may issue only after every earlier source-order blocking Push/Pop in that interval has process-facing committed in a strictly earlier cycle. In Sys_B^elab, process-facing commit is the commit that releases the owning source-level operation at its selected boundary, not an arbitrary internal staged/bundle/join transfer. The authoritative definition of Policy-L legality, finite-prefix admissibility, complete admissible executions, and the pre-settle/settled-frontier phase boundary is Definition R.LAdm in the Common Formal Definitions; this remark introduces no alternate admissibility relation.

R.3 Observable alphabet and executions

Definition R.2 (Observable alphabet Σ).

Let Σ be the observable event alphabet consisting of:

- (1) committed message-transfer events Push_c(v) and Pop_c(v),
- (2) synchronization events selected into S, and
- (3) signal events Read(sig, v) and Write(sig, v), interpreted as anchored signal events for sequential processes under R2 and as ϵ -fixed-point cycle-bucket events for combinational processes under R2C. Under the pipelined-loop body no-wait condition, an HLS-pipelined loop body contributes no additional in-body wait/synchronization events to S or Σ .

Definition R.3 (ϵ -steps and compact trace notation).

Let ϵ denote internal micro-steps that are not observable at the proof-internal alphabet Σ , including internal staging/hand-off within the concrete realization of a single explicit abstract channel, late direct-input sampling between anchors, and failed non-blocking polls. In elaborated cases Sys_ref = Sys_B^elab, transfers across introduced staged/bundle/join channels are not ϵ merely because Π_{elab} hides them from the outer DUT/testbench-visible alphabet Σ_{DUT} ; if such a channel is an explicit abstract boundary used by Appendix K, its committed Push/Pop transfers are Σ -events for the proof-internal comparison.

A finite execution prefix τ is understood in the same sense as in Appendix J: it carries the inherited cycle partition / per-cycle observable buckets of the execution, together with any ϵ -steps between successive Σ -visible cutpoints. For compact notation one may write a linearization over $(\Sigma \cup \{\epsilon\})$, but only modulo permutation of Σ -events that occur in the same cycle and are not additionally ordered by the document's explicit Σ -visible constraints. Accordingly, $\tau \upharpoonright \Sigma$ denotes the observable projection together with that inherited cycle partition; same-cycle observable events are not assigned any extra order merely by this compact notation.

Definition R.4 (ϵ -quiescent cutpoint).

A state σ is ϵ -quiescent if no further ϵ -step is enabled from σ . For any finite prefix τ , let $\bar{\tau}$ denote a maximal finite ϵ -extension to an ϵ -quiescent endpoint, preserving the same observable cycle partition /

bucket structure on $\tau|\Sigma$. The Appendix J / K state-comparison reasoning is always performed at such ϵ -quiescent cutpoints.

R.4 Source order and source-level frontier items

Definition R.5 (Per-process execution-call universe, frontier-item universe, observable projection, and source order).

For each process P , let Q_exec, P denote its execution-level set of dynamic source-level message-call instances for the particular execution / witness under the fixed external stimulus being analyzed. Q_exec, P includes blocking Push/Pop calls, successful non-blocking PushNB/PopNB calls, and failed non-blocking PushNB/PopNB polls.

Let Ω_P denote P 's local dynamic source-level frontier-item universe for that same execution / witness. Thus Ω_P is stimulus-dependent: it contains exactly the local synchronization-call items, signal-action items, and message-operation frontier items that belong to the realized execution being compared, and excludes items on untaken control-flow branches, unentered cases, and unexecuted loop iterations. For sequential processes, signal-action items are positioned by the R2 anchoring rule; for combinational processes, signal-action items are positioned in the observable cycle bucket determined by the R2C ϵ -fixed-point rule. Message-operation frontier items include reached blocking Push/Pop instances, whether pending or committed, and successful non-blocking PushNB/PopNB instances that contribute committed Push_c(v) / Pop_c(v) events. Failed non-blocking polls are ϵ -steps: they are members of Q_exec, P when executed, but they are not members of Ω_P merely because they executed.

Because Q_exec, P is a universe of dynamic message-call instances while Ω_P is a universe of source-level frontier items, their message-operation overlap is not a literal set intersection. Let $MsgOf_P(x)$ be the partial projection from a frontier item $x \in \Omega_P$ to its owning dynamic message-call instance, defined exactly for message-operation frontier items and undefined for pure synchronization or signal-anchor items. Define the message-frontier slice

$$\Omega_msg, P := \{ x \in \Omega_P \mid \exists q \in Q_exec, P : MsgOf_P(x) = q \}.$$

For any message-operation frontier item $x \in \Omega_msg, P$, let $BoundaryOf_P(x)$ denote the explicit abstract channel boundary at which x is evaluated for `BoundaryReq`, `ChannelEnabled`, `ChannelDisabled`, `Front\_P`, and Appendix K WFG reasoning. In the ordinary unelaborated case, each source-level message-call instance q has a unique corresponding frontier item x and a unique evaluated boundary. In Sys_B^{elab} , $MsgOf_P$ need not be injective: one owning source-level message-call instance q may project to a chain or bundle of proof-internal frontier items x at several explicit abstract boundaries. The elaboration package must then provide $BoundaryOf_P(x)$, $MsgOf_P(x)$, and the partial order $\leq_P$ for each introduced item.

Define the corresponding message-instance slice induced by Ω_P as

$$Q_Q, P := \{ q \in Q_exec, P \mid \exists x \in \Omega_msg, P : MsgOf_P(x) = q \}.$$

Let Σ_P denote the corresponding observable event/label projection: synchronization and signal items contribute their Σ labels when observed, and a message-operation frontier item $x \in \Omega_msg, P$ with $MsgOf_P(x)=q$ contributes the committed Σ -event $m(q)$ only if q commits. Pending blocking message-operation frontier items may therefore be in Ω_P and Ω_msg, P , and their owning message-call instances

may be in $Q_{\Omega,P}$, without yet contributing any committed Σ -event. Let $\leq_P$ denote the source order on Ω_P , i.e. the order generated by the document's scheduling rules for synchronization calls, signal actions as positioned by R2 or R2C, message-operation frontier items, and any explicit partial-order structure declared by the selected Sys_ref elaboration. The execution-level order constraints E3/E5 use the corresponding source-induced order on $Q_{\text{exec},P}$.

Definition R.6 (Done_P , Remain_P , and NextFront_P relative to the fixed witness).

Fix the particular execution / witness under analysis, hence the associated $Q_{\text{exec},P}$, Ω_P , $\Omega_{\text{msg},P}$, $Q_{\Omega,P}$, Σ_P , and $\leq_P$ from Definition R.5. For a state σ occurring as a cutpoint of that compared execution, let

$\text{Done}_P(\sigma) \subseteq \Omega_P$

be the set of local frontier items already realized by σ . For synchronization and signal items, “realized” means that the corresponding Σ -event has occurred. For a message-operation frontier item $x \in \Omega_{\text{msg},P}$ with $\text{MsgOf}_P(x)=q$, “realized” means that q has committed and its committed Σ -event $m(q)$ has occurred. A pending issued-but-uncommitted blocking message-operation frontier item x is therefore not in $\text{Done}_P(\sigma)$, even though $\text{BoundaryReq}(x,\sigma)$, $\text{ChannelEnabled}(x,\sigma)$, and $\text{ChannelDisabled}(x,\sigma)$ may be defined at σ , read operation-attributively through $q = \text{MsgOf}_P(x)$. A failed non-blocking poll $q \in Q_{\text{exec},P}$ that induces no frontier item in $\Omega_{\text{msg},P}$ is not considered by Done_P , Remain_P , or NextFront_P , because it is an ϵ -step with no frontier item and no committed Σ -event.

Let

$\text{Remain}_P(\sigma) := \Omega_P \setminus \text{Done}_P(\sigma)$.

Then define the next source-level frontier-item set by

$\text{NextFront}_P(\sigma) := \min_{\leq_P}(\text{Remain}_P(\sigma))$.

This is the Appendix J next-frontier notion used by Theorem J.1 and reconstructed from KObs by Lemma R.21b, interpreted relative to the fixed witness universe Ω_P . It may contain synchronization-call items, signal-anchored action items, and message-operation items. It is a frontier of source-level items, not a set of already-committed Σ -event labels.

Definition R.7 (Message-operation slice of the next frontier).

For the same fixed compared execution / witness, define

$\text{MsgNextFront}_P(\sigma) := \{ x \in \text{NextFront}_P(\sigma) \mid x \in \Omega_{\text{msg},P} \text{ and, for } q = \text{MsgOf}_P(x), q \text{ is defined and } \text{kind}(q) \in \{\text{Push}_c, \text{Pop}_c\} \text{ for some channel } c \}$.

This is only the message-operation frontier-item slice of the candidate next frontier; it is not yet the pending blocking frontier of Appendix B / K.

Clarification R.5a (ordinary source order versus elaborated partial order). For ordinary user-written sequential source code, dynamic message-call instances that appear in sequence in one process are ordered by dynamic program order, including distinct-interface calls, repeated loop iterations, and unrolled instances whose selected source expansion is ordered. Same-cycle issue, same-cycle commit, or issue before an earlier operation commits is a timing/issue-policy property, not incomparability. A message-operation multi-frontier exists only when an explicit $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$ elaboration package introduces incomparable proof-internal frontier items and supplies the corresponding projection, boundary, order, and attribution facts. Ordinary distinct-interface source calls are not made incomparable merely because they access different channels.

R.5 Commit, issue, and boundary requests

Definition R.8 (Commit).

For a message transfer at a chosen Σ -visible boundary endpoint, $\text{Commit}(q)$ is the cycle in which an external clocked observer sees both valid and ready high simultaneously at that endpoint. The committed payload is the value seen in that same cycle.

Definition R.9 (Issue).

For a source-level message operation instance q at a chosen Σ -visible boundary endpoint, $\text{Issue}(q)$ is the first cycle in which the calling process begins requesting the transfer corresponding to q at that endpoint. $\text{Issue}(q)$ is an auxiliary scheduler/witness timestamp used for rules such as R4, E3, and E5.

Definition R.10 (Endpoint-owned boundary request).

Fix a Σ -visible endpoint direction at an explicit abstract boundary. For any message-operation frontier item $x \in \Omega_{\text{msg},P}$ with owning source-level message instance $q = \text{MsgOf_P}(x)$ and evaluated boundary $c = \text{BoundaryOf_P}(x)$, let $\text{req_x}(t)$ denote the endpoint-owned boundary request signal for that endpoint in cycle t , namely valid for a Push endpoint and ready for a Pop endpoint. The predicate $\text{BoundaryReq}(x, \sigma)$ records that this endpoint-owned request is asserted for frontier item x at state σ . $\text{BoundaryReq}(x, \sigma)$ is operation- and boundary-attributive: it is true only when the asserted endpoint-owned request at σ is attributed to the specific frontier item x , its owning source-level operation q , and its evaluated boundary $\text{BoundaryOf_P}(x)$. In particular, if $\text{Issue}(q)$ has not yet occurred at σ , then $\text{BoundaryReq}(x, \sigma)$ is false. In the ordinary unelaborated case, where q has a unique frontier item and a unique evaluated boundary, $\text{BoundaryReq}(q, \sigma)$ may be used as shorthand for $\text{BoundaryReq}(x, \sigma)$. In $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$, the x -form is authoritative.

Axiom R.1 (Issue/Commit linkage).

Fix a Σ -visible endpoint direction. For source-level message operation instances on that endpoint direction, the following all hold:

(1) Boundary-request soundness / non-withdrawal.

If q is blocking, then once issued its endpoint-owned request remains asserted until q commits, with stable payload while asserted for Push.

(2) Stable attribution while the same source-level request remains outstanding.

If the request remains asserted across a cycle in which no transfer commits on that endpoint direction, then the continued assertion is attributed to the same outstanding q only so long as the requesting source-level operation remains that same outstanding instance. For blocking Push/Pop, this is the mandatory non-withdrawable case. For non-blocking PushNB/PopNB, continuous assertion of the endpoint request signal does not collapse later executed non-blocking call instances into the same q ; each later executed source-level poll is a distinct $q' \in Q_{\text{exec},P}$ unless the witness explicitly identifies the same still-outstanding source-level request instance.

(3) Back-to-back issuance.

If q_0 and q_1 are same-direction source-level message operation instances, q_0 commits in cycle t , and q_1 is the next such operation issued back-to-back within the same source interval, then $\text{Issue}(q_1) = t + 1$, even if the request signal does not deassert between commits.

(4) Sync-boundary discipline.

If q_0 and q_1 are same-direction source-level message operation instances and $q_0 \in \text{pref_S}(s)$ and $q_1 \in \text{suff_S}(s)$ for a synchronization call s , then $\text{Issue}(q_1)$ occurs strictly after the commit of s . Any request assertion that persists while the process is still pending at s is attributed to the outstanding operation(s) in $\text{pref_S}(s)$, not to issuance of any operation in $\text{suff_S}(s)$.

Remark R.2 (Non-blocking polls).

For non-blocking message passing, a failed poll produces no Σ event and is modeled as an ϵ -step, while a successful poll contributes the corresponding committed $\text{Push}_c(v)$ or $\text{Pop}_c(v)$ event. Each executed $\text{PushNB}/\text{PopNB}$ call is nevertheless a distinct dynamic source-level instance $q \in Q_{\text{exec}}, P$ for its owning process P ; thus repeated failed polls in later loop iterations are distinct q 's even if the endpoint request remains continuously asserted. The ϵ -modeling concerns observability in Σ , not the dynamic-instance identity of the underlying source-level calls.

R.6 Channel enablement

Definition R.11 (ChannelEnabled / ChannelDisabled).

Let x be a message-operation frontier item on channel $c = \text{BoundaryOf}_P(x)$, and write $q = \text{MsgOf}_P(x)$ with $\text{kind}(q) \in \{\text{Push}_c, \text{Pop}_c\}$ for its endpoint direction. At an ϵ -quiescent cutpoint σ , let t_σ denote the cycle of that cutpoint. Define:

$\text{ChannelEnabled}(x, \sigma)$ to mean that $\text{BoundaryReq}(x, \sigma)$ holds and that the channel-side condition required for x 's owning operation q to commit at $\text{BoundaryOf}_P(x)$ is satisfied after combinational settling at that cutpoint, and

$\text{ChannelDisabled}(x, \sigma)$ to mean that $\text{BoundaryReq}(x, \sigma)$ holds but $\text{ChannelEnabled}(x, \sigma)$ does not.

In the ordinary unique-boundary case, $\text{ChannelEnabled}(q, \sigma)$ and $\text{ChannelDisabled}(q, \sigma)$ may be used as shorthand for the corresponding x -form.

Definition R.12 (Buffered channels).

If $B(c) > 0$ and x is a source-level or elaborated message-operation frontier item on channel $c = \text{BoundaryOf}_P(x)$, with $q = \text{MsgOf}_P(x)$, then the buffered-channel enabling condition is:

- $\text{ChannelEnabled}(x, \sigma) \Leftrightarrow \text{BoundaryReq}(x, \sigma) \wedge \text{occ}_c(\sigma) < B(c)$, when $\text{kind}(q) = \text{Push}_c$
- $\text{ChannelEnabled}(x, \sigma) \Leftrightarrow \text{BoundaryReq}(x, \sigma) \wedge \text{occ}_c(\sigma) > 0$, when $\text{kind}(q) = \text{Pop}_c$

Thus, if x is a buffered Push_c frontier item that is channel-disabled, then $\text{BoundaryReq}(x, \sigma)$ holds and $\text{occ}_c(\sigma) = B(c)$; and if x is a buffered Pop_c frontier item that is channel-disabled, then $\text{BoundaryReq}(x, \sigma)$ holds and $\text{occ}_c(\sigma) = 0$.

Definition R.13 (Rendezvous channels).

If $B(c) = 0$ and x is a source-level or elaborated message-operation frontier item on channel $c = \text{BoundaryOf}_P(x)$, with $q = \text{MsgOf}_P(x)$, then the rendezvous enabling condition is:

$\text{ChannelEnabled}(x, \sigma) \Leftrightarrow \text{BoundaryReq}(x, \sigma) \wedge$ (the complementary endpoint request on c is asserted at σ).

Equivalently:

- if $\text{kind}(q) = \text{Push}_c$, then

$\text{ChannelEnabled}(x, \sigma) \Leftrightarrow \text{BoundaryReq}(x, \sigma) \wedge$ (the complementary Pop_c endpoint request is asserted at σ)

- if $\text{kind}(q) = \text{Pop}_c$, then

$\text{ChannelEnabled}(x, \sigma) \Leftrightarrow \text{BoundaryReq}(x, \sigma) \wedge$ (the complementary Push_c endpoint request is asserted at σ)

Hence, if a rendezvous frontier item x is channel-disabled, its own BoundaryReq holds but the complementary endpoint is not simultaneously requesting the matching partner action at that cutpoint. In the ordinary unique-boundary case, the equivalent q -form may be used as shorthand.

R.7 Pending blocking frontier

Definition R.14 (Pending blocking operations).

Fix an ϵ -quiescent state σ of process P within the current interval $I_P(\sigma)$ between the adjacent synchronization calls that bracket σ in P 's current execution. Define $\text{Pending}_P(\sigma) := \{x \mid x \in \Omega_{\text{msg},P} \text{ is a blocking source-level message-operation frontier item in that same interval } I_P(\sigma), \text{ and for } q = \text{MsgOf}_P(x), q \text{ is defined, Issue}(q) \text{ has occurred, and Commit}(q) \text{ has not yet occurred in } \sigma\}$.

By Appendix C's Issue/Commit linkage together with the definition of BoundaryReq, each member x of $\text{Pending}_P(\sigma)$ has its endpoint-owned request asserted at the cutpoint, read operation-attributively through its owning dynamic message-call instance $q = \text{MsgOf}_P(x)$.

Definition R.15 (Pending blocking frontier $\text{Front}_P(\sigma)$).

Define

$\text{Front}_P(\sigma) := \min_{\leq P}(\text{Pending}_P(\sigma))$

If several $\leq_P$ -minimal pending blocking message-operation frontier items are simultaneously outstanding, they form a frontier. This is the Appendix B / K notion of the pending blocking frontier (or minimal pending blocking frontier). It is distinct from $\text{NextFront}_P(\sigma)$, which is the broader source-level frontier-item set over Ω_P .

R.8 Drain-only blocked-frontier discipline and automatic flush

Definition R.16 (Drain-only blocked-frontier discipline).

A source interval satisfies the drain-only blocked-frontier discipline if, at the L2 ϵ -settle point σ_t^{set} of Definition R.LAdm, $\text{Front}_P(\sigma_t^{\text{set}})$ is non-empty and every frontier item $x \in \text{Front}_P(\sigma_t^{\text{set}})$ is channel-disabled. The discipline activates at that first settled snapshot. It does not retroactively invalidate source-later operations legally issued during the preceding L1 pre-settle window, but it forbids any new such issue after σ_t^{set} in that cycle and while the same fully disabled frontier persists. Set $\sigma := \sigma_t^{\text{set}}$ at activation. Once activated, the following all hold:

(1) Block point.

P is blocked on message passing at $\text{Front}_P(\sigma)$.

(2) No new later work.

While $\text{Front}_P(\sigma)$ remains non-empty and fully disabled, no new later blocking message-operation frontier item $y \in \Omega_{\text{msg},P}$ is issued, where "later" means that, for some $x \in \text{Front}_P(\sigma)$, $x \leq_P y$ and $x \neq y$, with issue understood through the owning message instance $q_y = \text{MsgOf}_P(y)$. More generally, no new source-later dynamic operation is launched past the blocked point.

(3) No withdrawal.

Already-asserted blocking requests are not withdrawn before the owning message instances commit.

(4) Frontier-minimality.

An already-asserted blocking request whose frontier item is not in $\text{Front}_P(\sigma)$ is not treated as a wait-for source unless and until that frontier item later becomes frontier-minimal.

(5) Drain-only downstream progress.

Work already past the blocked frontier may drain and commit when channel-enabled, but no new work advances past the blocked frontier while that frontier remains fully disabled.

(6) Finite non-replenishing drain.

Every selected explicit abstract boundary that can hold or credit drainable work has finite B-faithful

storage or credit, directly or through a finite $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$ boundary chain. Together with clause (2), this makes the drain set finite and non-replenishing.

(7) Sync-boundary capacity withdrawal — elaborated-boundary interpretation.

While a process is pending at an explicit synchronization call s , producer-facing availability for any back-annotated capacity belonging only to $\text{suff_S}(s)$ is withheld until s commits; work already accepted before s may still drain. For the Sys_ref proof model, this withdrawal is not an additional hidden enablement predicate on an otherwise ordinary E4 channel. It is represented only by choosing $\text{Sys_ref} = \text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$ with explicit sync-boundary / epoch-gate abstract channels, or equivalent explicit staged realization structure, so that the refusal appears as ordinary `ChannelDisabled` behavior at an explicit abstract boundary.

For a pipelined or otherwise overlapped implementation, Appendix B’s automatic-flush rules are the implementation-side construction that supplies Definition R.16. For ordinary non-overlapped control, the same definition may be discharged by a structural proof that no new source-later dynamic operation can be launched after the blocked point is reached. Thus the K.2b dominance/extraction premise ranges over every liberal interval that can contain eager issue, not only loop pipelines. In particular, eager issue permitted by Policy L must occur in R.LAdm’s L1 pre-settle window; the no-new-launch obligation begins at the L2 settled snapshot, not at the earlier issue of the frontier request.

Remark R.3 (ALL disabled $\Rightarrow$ stall).

The document’s intended policy is exactly the “ALL disabled $\Rightarrow$ stall” interpretation: the process stalls only when none of the frontier items in $\text{Front_P}(\sigma)$ is channel-enabled. Downstream drain is compatible with that stall provided no new later work is issued past the blocked frontier.

R.9 Observable compatibility and cutpoint correspondence

Definition R.17 (System-level observable compatibility).

For a witness prefix τ_{ref} of Sys_ref and a post-HLS prefix τ_{post} of RTL_B , define

$$\tau_{\text{ref}} \approx \tau_{\text{post}} : \Leftrightarrow E1 \wedge E2 \wedge E3 \wedge E4 \wedge E5$$

This is an ordered compatibility predicate, not a mathematical equivalence relation. The left argument supplies the Sys_ref witness prefix, and the right argument supplies the RTL_B post-HLS prefix constrained by E1–E5. This appendix treats E1–E5 as primitive named conjuncts, exactly as used by Appendix J.

Definition R.18 (Cross-model KObs correspondence).

For the exact selected package of Corollary J.1, cross-model cutpoint correspondence means only the typed equality $\text{KObs_E}, w(\sigma_{\text{ref}}) = \text{KObsPost_J}(\rho_{\text{post}}; E, w, H, O)$ established by J.KObsConf . This definition introduces no additional notation and no independent state clauses. All process, channel, frontier, request, enablement, WFG, drain, terminal, and deadlock facts are obtained by applying Definitions R.18d–R.18e to the common record.

R.9a K-observation quotient and residual-offer layer

Status of this subsection. Definitions R.18a–R.18e and Lemmas R.21b–R.21g provide the source-side KObs record and its reconstruction theory. Appendix J now constructs the corresponding J-facing RTL record and uses $\text{J.OfferReach}/\text{J.OfferConf}/\text{J.KObsConf}$ to prove equal KObs at matched cutpoints. The subsection still does not characterize the image of arbitrary well-typed records beyond the explicit J.OfferReach predicate, and it does not alter the operational Issue, Policy-L/Policy-S, or DrainDiscipline semantics.

Definition R.18a (Enriched replay history H).

Fix a theorem instance I consisting of the design, fixed stimulus, declared environment model, reset policy, chosen observation boundaries, and KObs-facing waiver set W . For the Policy-S A5-L discharge, I may additionally reference a K.Resp monitor schema, finite-bound function, reset/end-of-test disposition, and response-waiver policy; those are operational CF-S data and are not fields of KObs. I also records an environment-reconstruction mode for optional diagnostic terminals: either StandardEnv, meaning the normative B1-avail pull-based, consumption-ordered input model with default always-ready outputs, or EnvReplayAdequate, meaning a certificate that supplies a typed reconstructed environment state $\text{EnvStateRec}_I(H, w)$ and proves that Definition K.StimX permanent next-interaction availability is determined by H , w , and that reconstructed state. Fix the full elaboration package E and witness w . For a reachable ϵ -quiescent cutpoint σ of Sys_ref , let $H_{E, w}(\sigma)$ be the finite canonical annotated replay history through σ . It contains the observable units and annotations needed by Theorem J.1 and I.DR/I.DR': committed $\text{Push}_c(v)/\text{Pop}_c(v)$ events with dynamic identities and per-channel ordinals; synchronization and wait units; anchored Read/Write units; START_P , FINISH_P , and $\text{RESET}(S_p, S_c)$ units where applicable; and the WC/witness-selected non-blocking, arbitration, signal, and ϵ -choice outcomes required to replay the selected execution. H retains explicitly atomic unit grouping, per-process replay order, per-channel FIFO order, reset-epoch structure, and the required-prefix constraints used by $\prec_J$. It quotients away incidental model-specific clock-bucket placement and ordering among independent units not required by those constraints. Raw source or RTL cycle buckets may be retained as certificate metadata, but they are not fields compared by KObs equality. $H_{E, w}(\sigma)$ contains no historical $\text{Issue}(q)$ timestamps merely because requests were asserted before commit.

Definition R.18b (Attributed residual offer and residual-offer set).

At a reachable ϵ -quiescent Sys_ref cutpoint σ , an attributed residual offer is a tuple $o = (P, x, q, c, \text{dir}, e)$ satisfying all of the following: P owns x ; $x \in \Omega_{\text{msg}, P}$; $q = \text{MsgOf}_P(x)$; $c = \text{BoundaryOf}_P(x)$; q is a blocking Push or Pop instance that has issued but not committed in reset epoch e ; dir identifies the endpoint-owned producer-valid or consumer-ready direction; and $\text{BoundaryReq}(x, \sigma)$ is asserted and attributed to that same x , q , c , direction, and epoch. Define the derived operation-kind projection $\text{kind}(o) := \text{kind}(q)$, with the typing invariant $\text{dir} = \text{producer-valid}$ iff $\text{kind}(q) = \text{Push}$ and $\text{dir} = \text{consumer-ready}$ iff $\text{kind}(q) = \text{Pop}$. Let $\text{ResOffers}_{E, w}(\sigma)$ be exactly the set of such tuples.

$\text{ResOffers}_{E, w}(\sigma)$ is well typed and issue-prefix consistent under the existing E3/Axiom R.1 semantics. In particular: (a) its item and boundary fields are supplied by E ; (b) if a source-later residual offer exists while an earlier blocking item in the applicable source prefix is also issued, uncommitted, and still requesting at an evaluated boundary, that earlier offer is also represented; (c) reset clears all offers in the ending epoch under RW2; and (d) for each explicit abstract boundary and endpoint direction there is at most one attributed outstanding source-level offer. A concrete token or transfer already accounted for as explicit channel occupancy is not additionally represented as an independent source-level residual offer unless E declares a distinct source-attributed frontier item at that boundary.

Definition R.18c (K-observation KObs).

For the fixed instance I , elaboration E , witness w , and reachable ϵ -quiescent Sys_ref cutpoint σ , define the K-observation record by

$$\text{KObs}_{E, w}(\sigma) := \langle E, w, H_{E, w}(\sigma), \text{ResOffers}_{E, w}(\sigma) \rangle.$$

The fixed stimulus, environment model and reconstruction mode, reset policy, observation-boundary selection, and KObs-facing waiver set W are ambient parameters of the theorem instance I rather than duplicated in every record. K.Resp configuration and monitor ages are likewise ambient or CF-S operational data, not KObs fields. Equality of KObs records means typed equality of E and w and equality of the canonical replay-history quotient and residual-offer components. It does not require equality of

the source and RTL clock-bucket decompositions permitted to differ by Theorem J.1. It is not equality of arbitrary process, scheduler, channel-realization, environment, response-monitor, or RTL microstate.

Definition R.18c-1 (Observational waiver closure and environment replay adequacy).

For fixed I, E, w , define $KObsClosed_I, E, w(W)$ to mean: for all reachable ε -quiescent Sys_ref cutpoints σ_1 and σ_2 of the same fixed instance, $KObs_E, w(\sigma_1) = KObs_E, w(\sigma_2)$ implies $(\sigma_1 \in W \text{ iff } \sigma_2 \in W)$. Define $EnvTerminalAdequate(I)$ to hold when I records either $StandardEnv$ or an $EnvReplayAdequate$ certificate. Under $StandardEnv$, $EnvStop$ reconstruction uses Definition K.StimX together with Lemma K.EnvX-Auto and the default output-readiness assumption; under $EnvReplayAdequate$, it uses $EnvStateRec_I(H, w)$ and the certificate's permanent-availability theorem. These are extensionality premises, not claims that every well-typed $KObs$ record is reachable.

Definition R.18d (Process and channel reconstruction from KObs).

For $K = \langle E, w, H, O \rangle$, define $ProcRec_P(K)$ to be the source-relevant process slice reconstructed by deterministic replay of P 's projection of H under w : the source control location and reset epoch, source-visible local values needed by the next frontier, branch/guard outcomes, operation identities and per-channel ordinals, and the source-level completion status. Define $ChanRec_c(K)$ for every explicit abstract channel c declared by E to be the $E4$ abstract state reconstructed from its reset/initial state and the committed Push/Pop history in H : for $B(c) > 0$, occupancy, empty/full status, and logical ordered contents/head information; for $B(c) = 0$, capacity-zero occupancy together with endpoint-request information supplied separately by O . For an outer channel represented by Sys_B^{elab} , projected outer occupancy is obtained through Π_elab , while every proof-internal boundary used by Appendix K retains its own explicit $ChanRec$ state.

Definition R.18e (K-relevant derived functions).

For $K = \langle E, w, H, O \rangle$ define the following typed functions. $DoneRec_P(K)$, $RemainRec_P(K)$, and $NextFrontRec_P(K)$ are computed from $\Omega_P / \leq_P$ supplied by E and the realized-item history reconstructed from H . $PendingRec_P(K)$ is the set of frontier items x appearing in O for P , and $BoundaryReqRec(x, K)$ holds exactly when O contains the attributed offer for x . $FrontRec_P(K) := \min_P(PendingRec_P(K))$. $ChannelEnabledRec(x, K)$ and $ChannelDisabledRec(x, K)$ are computed at $BoundaryOf_P(x)$ from $ChanRec$ and the complementary endpoint offers in O using Definitions R.11–R.13. $WFGRec(K)$ is Definition R.20 applied to $FrontRec$ and $ChannelDisabledRec$. $DrainClosedNowRec(D, K)$ holds exactly when no already-offered non-frontier blocking item owned by a process $P \in D$ is $ChannelEnabledRec$ at the cutpoint.

For optional diagnostics, define $DoneStopRec_c(K, I)$, $EnvStopRec_c(K, I)$, $WFGPlusRec(K, I)$, $DeadKRec(K, I)$, and their $KObs$ -closed waiver variants exactly as in the diagnostic Definition K.WFG+. Define $DeadKRec(K)$ and $DeadKRec^W(K, I, W)$ by the ordinary K.1 predicate. No $BadSRec$ or $K.RespFail$ reconstruction is defined from K alone: response monitor activation and age depend on operational history and the CF-S monitor artifact. At this stage all functions are interpreted on records extracted from reachable source cutpoints; no image characterization is asserted.

Historical issue-time quotient. The record deliberately retains whether an operation survives as a current attributed offer, but not the earlier cycle in which that request first became asserted. Therefore two reachable source cutpoints with the same E, w, H , and O have the same $KObs$ even if their operational executions used different legal historical issue times. This is only an observation equivalence at the selected cutpoint; it does not assert that the two executions have the same admissible continuations or satisfy the same transition-level $DrainDiscipline$ for reasons independent of the common cutpoint.

R.10 Prefix-matching theorem

Theorem R.21 (Finite-prefix witness consequence of Theorem J.1)

Fix a finite post-HLS execution prefix $\tau_{\text{post}} \in \text{Reach_post}$ of RTL_B under a fixed external stimulus, where Reach_post is the Appendix J finite-reachability scope (Definition J.Reach) under the same local-certificate/J.GWR premises used there (Definition J.LocalGWR and Theorem J.GWR-Comp, or J.GWR-Direct); no fair-extension qualifier is required for this finite-prefix result. Then there exists a finite execution prefix τ_{ref} of Sys_ref under that same stimulus such that $\tau_{\text{ref}} \approx \tau_{\text{post}}$

This theorem is a compact finite-prefix consequence of Appendix J's full execution-level result, not a replacement for that full execution-level statement. In particular, the controlling hypotheses are exactly Appendix J's execution-set scope conditions together with the relevant Appendix I / Appendix L witness machinery and the cited fairness/progress premises. Appendix K uses only the existence of such a matching source-side witness at the compared cutpoint, not uniqueness of that witness.

Corollary R.21a (Equal-KObs cutpoint correspondence; compact finite-prefix form of Corollary J.1).

This corollary is the compact finite-prefix restatement of Corollary J.1. Under the same selected normalized cutpoints and the same J.OfferReach/J.OfferConf/J.KObsConf package, there exist H and O such that

$$\text{KObsPost_J}(\rho_{\text{post}}; E, w, H, O) = \text{KObs_E, w}(\sigma_{\text{ref}}).$$

No second correspondence relation or derived clause package is introduced.

Let $\tau_{\text{post}} \in \text{Reach_post}$ be as in Theorem R.21, let ρ_{post} be its selected ε -quiescent RTL cutpoint, and let σ_{ref} be the selected reachable ε -quiescent source cutpoint. If the same package satisfies J.OfferReach, J.OfferConf, and J.KObsConf, equal KObs follows. Every K-facing fact listed in Definition R.18e is then obtained by applying the same pure function to the common record.

In particular, the compact form yields equal reconstructed NextFront, process replay facts, explicit abstract channel state, residual endpoint requests, Pending/BoundaryReq attribution, enablement, Front, WFG, and DrainClosedNow. Under the premises of Lemma R.21f it also yields the corresponding Dead_K^W and optional diagnostic Dead_KS^W equality. K.RespFail is deliberately outside this cross-model cutpoint conclusion.

R.10a K-observation reconstruction lemmas

The lemmas in this subsection are source-side reconstruction and factoring results. Corollary J.1 now consumes them after J.OfferReach/J.OfferConf establish a common KObs record across the selected RTL_B and Sys_ref cutpoints. They remain functions over a source-realizable record and do not by themselves prove RTL boundary conformance.

Lemma R.21b (Process replay reconstruction).

Let σ be a reachable ε -quiescent Sys_ref cutpoint under I, E, w and let $K = \text{KObs_E, w}(\sigma)$. For every process P, $\text{ProcRec_P}(K)$ equals the source-relevant process slice of σ used by Lemmas I.DR/I.DR' and the Appendix J finite-ideal construction. Consequently $\text{DoneRec_P}(K)$, $\text{RemainRec_P}(K)$, $\text{NextFrontRec_P}(K)$, all next-item selection predicates, all values needed to determine future committed Σ labels, and P's normal-completion status agree with their operational definitions at σ . Proof. Project H to P, include the WC/witness choices and RESET epoch markers, and apply deterministic replay I.DR/I.DR'; the replayed process state together with Definition R.6 determines the resulting value and frontier facts. $\square$

Lemma R.21c (Abstract channel reconstruction).

Let σ and K be as in Lemma R.21b. For every explicit abstract channel c declared by E , $\text{ChanRec}_c(K)$ equals the E4 abstract channel state of σ . For $B(c) > 0$, occupancy and logical contents are uniquely obtained from reset/initial contents and the committed Push/Pop sequence and per-channel ordinals in H . For $B(c) = 0$, occupancy is identically zero and current rendezvous enablement additionally uses the endpoint offers in O . In $\text{Sys}_B^{\text{elab}}$, the same statement holds at each explicit proof boundary, and Π_{elab} supplies the declared outer projection. Proof. Induction over the committed channel-history projection of H , using E4, B-faithfulness, RESET/RW1–RW3, and Π_{elab} conservation. $\square$

Lemma R.21d (Residual-offer, BoundaryReq, and frontier reconstruction).

Let σ and $K = \langle E, w, H, O \rangle$ be as above. For every process P and blocking message-operation frontier item x , $x \in \text{Pending}_P(\sigma)$ iff $x \in \text{PendingRec}_P(K)$, and $\text{BoundaryReq}(x, \sigma)$ iff $\text{BoundaryReqRec}(x, K)$. Hence $\text{Front}_P(\sigma) = \text{FrontRec}_P(K)$. For every point-to-point rendezvous channel, Req_{prod} and Req_{cons} at σ are exactly the existence of the corresponding producer-direction and consumer-direction offers in O . Proof. O was defined as the exact set of current operation- and boundary-attributed blocking endpoint requests. Apply Definitions R.14–R.15 and take the $\leq_P$ -minimal subset. The one-offer-per-endpoint-direction invariant makes the rendezvous projection functional. $\square$

Lemma R.21e (Enablement and wait-for-graph reconstruction).

For every residual offer x at σ , $\text{ChannelEnabledRec}(x, K) = \text{ChannelEnabled}(x, \sigma)$, and likewise for ChannelDisabled . Consequently $\text{WFGRec}(K) = \text{WFG}(\sigma)$. Proof. Use Lemma R.21c for buffered occupancy/content state, Lemma R.21d for rendezvous endpoint requests and attributed frontier membership, and Definitions R.11–R.13 and R.20 at the explicit boundary supplied by E . The no-hidden-cross-channel-disablement convention ensures that no additional enabling fact is required. $\square$

Lemma R.21f (DrainClosedNow and K-predicate factoring).

For every non-empty process set D , $\text{DrainClosedNowRec}(D, K)$ holds iff the operational cutpoint σ is drain-closed for D in the snapshot sense used by Appendix K. The unwaived ordinary predicate $\text{Dead}_K(\sigma)$ is therefore determined by K . If $\text{KObsClosed}_{I, E, w}(W)$ holds, $\text{Dead}_{K^W}(\sigma)$ is determined by $\text{DeadKRec}^W(K, I, W)$. If $\text{EnvTerminalAdequate}(I)$ holds, the optional diagnostic $\text{WFG}^+(\sigma)$, EnvStop , DoneStop , and unwaived $\text{Dead}_{KS}(\sigma)$ are determined by $\text{WFGPlusRec}(K, I)$ and $\text{DeadKSRec}(K, I)$; with KObsClosed , the diagnostic waived predicate is also determined. No $K.\text{RespClean}$ or $K.\text{RespFail}$ conclusion follows from KObs .

Proof. Lemmas R.21b–R.21e reconstruct process completion, consumed ordinals, frontier membership, endpoint requests, channel enablement, and ordinary WFG edges. The optional terminal reconstructions use the stated environment adequacy premises. KObsClosed supplies waiver extensionality for cutpoint predicates. The snapshot drain clause is exactly the absence of an enabled non-frontier residual offer owned by D . No continuation-level claim about Definition R.16/DrainDiscipline or response-monitor age follows from this factoring result. $\square$

Corollary R.21g (KObs extensionality).

Let σ_1 and σ_2 be reachable ϵ -quiescent Sys_{ref} cutpoints of the same fixed instance with $\text{KObs}_{E, w}(\sigma_1) = \text{KObs}_{E, w}(\sigma_2)$. Then their reconstructed process slices, explicit abstract channel states, NextFront and Front sets, operation-attributive BoundaryReq values, channel-enable predicates, ordinary WFGs, DrainClosedNow predicates, and unwaived Dead_K truth values are equal. If $\text{KObsClosed}_{I, E, w}(W)$ holds, their Dead_{K^W} truth values are equal. If $\text{EnvTerminalAdequate}(I)$ holds, their optional diagnostic $\text{EnvStop}/\text{DoneStop}$ classifications, WFGPlusRec graphs, and unwaived Dead_{KS} truth values are equal;

with $KObsClosed$, their diagnostic $Dead_KS^W$ values are equal. The conclusion is independent of legal historical Issue timestamps not retained in O , and it makes no claim about $K.Resp$ timer activation or age. Without waiver closure or environment-terminal adequacy, the extensionality conclusion is correspondingly limited. Proof. Functional extensionality of the named reconstruction definitions and Lemmas R.21b–R.21f. $\square$

Cross-model-use note. Corollary R.21g is the source-side extensionality theorem for reachable records. Appendix J supplies $J.OfferReach$ and $J.OfferConf$ and proves through $J.KObsConf$ that the selected post certificate and source cutpoint share one record. Lemmas R.22/R.23/R.24 and their Appendix K counterparts state their cross-model consequences directly from that equality.

R.11 Explicit frontier-classification bridge

Definition R.19 (Derived blocking-frontier slice at ϵ -quiescent cutpoints).

At an ϵ -quiescent cutpoint σ and for a process P , define the asserted blocking message-operation-item slice of the next source-level frontier-item set by

$FrontFromNext_P(\sigma) := \{ x \in BlockingMsgNextFront_P(\sigma) \mid BoundaryReq(x, \sigma) \},$

where

$BlockingMsgNextFront_P(\sigma) \triangleq \{ x \in NextFront_P(\sigma) \mid x \in \Omega_msg,P \text{ and, for } q = MsgOf_P(x), q \text{ is defined and } q \text{ is a blocking source-level message-operation instance with } kind(q) \in \{Push_c, Pop_c\} \text{ for some channel } c \}.$

Here $BoundaryReq(x, \sigma)$ is read operation-attributively for the specific source-level blocking message-operation frontier item x , through its owning dynamic message-call instance $q = MsgOf_P(x)$, exactly in the Appendix C sense: the asserted endpoint-owned request at the cutpoint is attributed to x only if q is the currently outstanding requesting source-level operation instance on that endpoint direction. For blocking Push/Pop, that attribution cannot change before commit. Non-blocking PushNB/PopNB call instances are excluded from $BlockingMsgNextFront_P$ unless represented by a frontier item in Ω_msg,P for non-WFG committed-transfer reasoning; successful non-blocking calls may contribute Push_c/Pop_c Σ -labels, and failed polls are ϵ , but neither creates a pending blocking frontier member for WFG purposes. This definition is over source-level message-operation frontier items in $\Omega_msg,P \subseteq \Omega_P$, not over the message-instance slice Q_Q,P itself and not over already-committed Σ -event labels.

Remark R.4 (derived bridge, not extra premise).

Corollary R.21a aligns $NextFront_P$ and the relevant operation-attributive $BoundaryReq$ values only on the common blocking message-operation-item slice $BlockingMsgNextFront_P$ of that frontier. No $BoundaryReq$ predicate is defined or required for non-message frontier items, and successful non-blocking frontier items do not create pending blocking frontier members. Appendix K.2.2 (Lemma K.0) then derives, from the Appendix B drain-only blocking discipline and the Appendix C Issue/Commit linkage, that this asserted blocking message-operation-item slice is exactly the pending blocking frontier.

R.12 Front / NextFront classification lemma

Lemma R.22 (Front reconstruction; compact restatement of Lemma K.0).

For every reachable ϵ -quiescent Sys_ref cutpoint σ and $K = KObs_E,w(\sigma)$,

$Front_P(\sigma) = FrontRec_P(K) = \{ x \in BlockingMsgNextFrontRec_P(K) \mid BoundaryReqRec(x, K) \}.$

If $K_post = K_ref$ under Corollary J.1, then $FrontRec_P(K_post) = FrontRec_P(K_ref)$, and the corresponding operation-attributive $BoundaryReqRec$ values agree. This is a classification of current pending blocking offers only; younger already-asserted non-frontier offers remain in O but outside $FrontRec$ while an earlier blocker is minimal.

Corollary R.22a (Rendezvous endpoint-request extensionality; compact restatement of Corollary K.0a).

For a point-to-point rendezvous channel c , ReqProdRec_c and ReqConsRec_c are the direction projections of O . Equal KObs implies equality of both projections. No equivalence is asserted between a raw endpoint request and frontier membership.

R.13 Wait-for graph refinement

Definition R.20 (Wait-for graph).

At an ε -quiescent cutpoint σ , define the wait-for graph $\text{WFG}(\sigma)$ exactly as in Appendix K: its vertices are the modeled processes, and its directed edges are induced from the frontier members $\text{Front}_P(\sigma)$ by the corresponding channel-disabled dependencies on internal message-passing channels only. Equivalently, a directed edge $P \rightarrow Q$ is present when some frontier item $x \in \text{Front}_P(\sigma)$, with owning message instance $q = \text{MsgOf}_P(x)$, is channel-disabled at the chosen boundary and the unique complementary endpoint needed to enable q belongs to process Q .

Here “internal” means that both endpoints of the channel are modeled processes of Sys_ref / RTL_B . Channels whose complementary endpoint is the external environment/testbench (the DUT boundary) are excluded from the WFG and from the internal message-passing deadlock notion used in Appendix K. Buffered and rendezvous channels are both included, with $B(c)$, $\text{occ}_c(\sigma)$, BoundaryReq , ChannelEnabled , and ChannelDisabled interpreted at the chosen ε -quiescent cutpoint on the chosen abstract channels of Sys_ref .

Lemma R.23 (WFG extensionality; compact restatement of Lemma K.2).

Let K_{post} and K_{ref} be the equal records selected by Corollary J.1. Then $\text{WFGRec}(K_{\text{post}}) = \text{WFGRec}(K_{\text{ref}})$.

The result is immediate from the functional definition of WFGRec using FrontRec , $\text{ChannelDisabledRec}$, ChanRec , and the residual-offer projections. It applies uniformly to buffered, rendezvous, and explicit $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$ boundaries.

R.14 Deadlock preservation

Theorem R.24 (KObs-level deadlock-predicate preservation; compact restatement of Theorem K.1A's transfer step).

Let K_{post} and K_{ref} be the equal records selected by Corollary J.1. Then the ordinary WFG, every closed-component classification, and $\text{DrainClosedNowRec}(D, \cdot)$ are equal for each non-empty process set D . Therefore the unwaived ordinary predicate DeadKRec has the same truth value on both records. If $\text{KObsClosed}_{I,E,w}(W)$ holds, DeadKRec^W also has the same truth value. Under $\text{EnvTerminalAdequate}(I)$, the same statement extends to optional diagnostic WFGPlusRec and DeadKRec , and with waiver closure to diagnostic DeadKRec^W . This is a cutpoint-observation result only and makes no claim that the two executions have the same continuation-level DrainDiscipline or $K.\text{Resp}$ monitor history.

R.15 Summary of dependency structure

For convenient reference, the compact dependency chain is: (1) Appendices B and C define pending/frontier, Issue/Commit, request persistence, and drain-only semantics. (2) Appendix I proves deterministic replay and finite process-local preparation scripts with explicit shared-decision holes. (3) Definition J.LocalGWR supplies process, channel, atomic, environment/reset, action-footprint, request-

snapshot, dependency-generator, and agreement certificates; J.DepComplete/J.DepRank/J.DepAcyclic derive J.CanonicalRank; and Theorem J.GWR-Comp constructs the global source witness and J.GWR package. (4) Proposition J.0/Theorem J.1 prove trace compatibility; J.HCanon/J.OfferReach/J.OfferConf/J.KObsConf produce equal KObs at selected cutpoints. (5) Appendix K reconstructs and transfers the wait-for/deadlock predicate and discharges A5-L through the selected route.

Appendix S – Lean Proof Strategy Document

A separate Lean proof strategy document is under development. It should import, rather than duplicate, the normative interfaces fixed here: J.ConstructionAction and typed ReadSet/WriteSet; J.ReqSnapshot/J.NBDecision; J.BufSameCycle; J.DepJ/J.DepSound/J.DepComplete/J.FoundationRank/J.DepRank/J.DepAcyclic/J.CanonicalRank; J.PCert/J.CCert/J.ACert/J.EnvCert/J.ResetCert/J.LocalAgree/J.LocalGWR; the frame, local-lift, preparation-commutation, unit-enablement, and J.UnitExt lemmas; J.RequiredPrefixCandidate; J.ConstructionOrderProvenance/J.ValidatedConstructionOrder; Theorem J.GWR-Comp and Definition J.GWR; KObs and its reconstruction functions; J.HCanon/J.OfferReach/J.OfferConf/J.KObsConf; K.CertHdr/CF-0/K.A5Cert; and the Appendix K/K-P operational premises. The Lean document may choose different internal structures, but its exported theorem statements must preserve the distinction between locally supplied facts, the theorem-derived dependency order and shared-state decisions, the proved global construction, the stable J.GWR semantic interface, and the later KObs cutpoint interface.

Appendix T – Scheduling-Specific Obligations Beyond Standard Simulation Theory

T.1 Purpose and Nature of the Formal Result

Standard formal-methods libraries provide reusable foundations for labeled transition systems, weak or ϵ -abstracted transitions, forward simulation, finite and infinite executions, trace inclusion, well-founded induction, fixed-point reasoning, and related proof techniques. Those foundations can substantially simplify a mechanization of the results in this document. They do not, however, establish the HLS scheduling contract or its safety and liveness guarantees by themselves.

In particular, the top-level safety result in this document is not ordinary trace inclusion or trace equivalence. It is the document’s witness-relative ordered trace-compatibility relation, written $\approx$, over the selected proof-internal observable alphabet Σ . This relation is defined over complete observable units and bucketed executions, preserves the required $\prec_J$ ordering constraints, and permits independent observable units to commute or to appear in different cycle groupings in Sys_ref and RTL_B. It also treats the Post $\rightarrow$ Ref and restricted Ref $\rightarrow$ Post uses differently. Consequently, a generic result of the form “forward simulation implies trace inclusion” does not directly yield the compatibility theorem proved here.

The principal proof obligations arise from features specific to HLS scheduling and hardware communication: source-order constraints, same-cycle and atomic observable behavior, witness-selected replay, explicit channel-boundary semantics, back-annotated capacity, process composition, KObs cutpoint observation and certificate correspondence, fair channel progress, pipeline drain behavior, and the connection between overlapped execution and conservative serial-source deadlock. This appendix summarizes the obligations that must remain explicit in any faithful formalization, even when standard transition-system and simulation libraries are reused.

The obligations divide into two structurally different groups. Safety has local design evidence and a generic global conclusion: process-local scheduling/replay certificates, explicit-channel certificates, and named atomic-interaction certificates are combined by the proved J.GWR-Comp construction and then by pairwise trace composition. Liveness is a conditional global preservation result over complete admissible executions and wait-for components and cannot in general be obtained by composing independent per-process liveness theorems.

The purpose of this appendix is not to prescribe a particular theorem prover, transition-system library, or Lean architecture. Rather, it identifies the scheduling-specific semantic and proof obligations that a mechanization must discharge in addition to any generic infrastructure supplied by standard formal-methods libraries.

T.2 Safety-Specific Obligations

T.2.1 Initial-State and Reset-Epoch Correspondence

The induction used to construct a matching `Sys_ref` execution requires a valid base case before the first observable unit is matched. The post-reset `RTL_B` state must correspond to the prescribed source initial state, including process control locations, source-visible values, channel state, request state, and the selected abstraction relation.

For the document-aligned theorem instances, A10 requires reset-empty initial occupancy at the selected abstract channel boundaries. There must also be no unaccounted pending endpoint request, stale synchronization state, or hidden accepted message that is absent from the source reference model. Reset correspondence is not necessarily a one-time property limited to initial system startup. When dynamic reset is supported, each affected process enters a new reset epoch, and the formalization must re-establish the applicable state, channel, anchor, and direct-input correspondence for that epoch. The hold-stable and synchronization-controlled rules for direct inputs are part of ensuring that reset and restart do not introduce a pre-HLS/post-HLS mismatch. In this document, that re-establishment is formalized by the RESET boundary observable unit, the reset well-formedness conditions RW1–RW5, and Lemma J.RS (MatchedResetEpochSplice) in the Common Formal Definitions, which add an explicit reset-splice case to the Theorem J.1 induction.

T.2.2 Source Enablement of the Next Selected Observable Unit

A compatibility proof cannot merely observe that `RTL_B` performed an action and then assert that `Sys_ref` can perform the corresponding action. It must prove that, in the currently constructed source-reference state, the specific dynamic operation instance represented by the next selected `RTL` observable unit is enabled.

The required source-side prerequisites can include the process control position, branch predicates, loop-iteration identity, prior source-ordered operations, synchronization boundaries, signal anchors, channel occupancy, channel availability, and witness-selected non-blocking outcomes. The proof must also establish that the selected unit is the correct dynamic occurrence rather than another static call at the same source location.

This obligation is central because `RTL_B` may contain added FSM states, overlapped loop iterations, internal pipeline stages, or eager/same-cycle issue of operations that were sequential in the source. The document no longer packages this bridge as an unexplained global premise. Appendix I proves finite process-local preparation (Lemma I.3/J.PCert); J.CCert checks the common boundary state and witness-significant non-blocking outcomes; J.ACert checks simultaneous atomic participants; and Lemma J.UnitExt proves the complete next unit has a legal global source extension. Theorem J.GWR-Comp iterates that result to derive Definition J.GWR.

T.2.3 Same-Cycle Independence and Atomic Observable Units

A single hardware cycle may contain multiple observable events that are independent and therefore have no meaningful intrinsic order within that cycle. Imposing an arbitrary total order on such events

could introduce false dependencies or make two compatible executions appear different merely because independent actions were listed differently.

Conversely, some groups of events must be treated as one indivisible observable unit. Examples include the paired endpoints of a rendezvous transfer, a synchronization handshake, and a stutter-canonical R2C fixed-point observation unit. The formalization must prevent the internal pieces of such a unit from being split across different matching steps.

The resulting observable model is partial-order and independence based, and is analogous in some respects to pomset or Mazurkiewicz-trace semantics. It is not, however, assumed to be an exact instance of a fixed trace-monoid model, because the relevant independence and ordering relationships may depend on dynamic operation instances, channel relationships, atomic grouping, and the execution-specific RequiredJOrder relation.

T.2.3a Same-Cycle Buffered-Channel Sequentialization

For a positive-capacity channel, a same-cycle Push and Pop are not modeled as fall-through operations. E4 evaluates both from the common pre-cycle occupancy. Therefore both can commit in the same cycle only when the channel is neither empty nor full. Lemma J.BufSameCycle proves that, in precisely that interior-occupancy case, the two corresponding source transitions may be serialized in either order while retaining their common RTL-cycle annotation and producing the same FIFO contents and occupancy. At empty or full occupancy the operation disabled at the cycle boundary remains disabled; the other same-cycle operation cannot enable it. Capacity-zero endpoints remain one atomic rendezvous unit.

T.2.4 Derived Validated Construction-Order Ideal Chain

The J.1 construction does not extend the source witness in an arbitrary ordering of observable actions. It follows the finite $<_J$ -ideal chain carried by one J.ValidatedConstructionOrder. On the compositional route, J.GWR-Comp derives that order from the concrete RTL_B operational annotations and locally certified prerequisites through J.FoundationRank, J.DepRank, J.DepAcyclic, and J.CanonicalRank. On the direct route, the package supplies an independently validated well-founded order and proof that every required and operational predecessor occurs earlier. In both cases the chain remains tied to the concrete RTL_B behavior; no separately supplied time-based selection rule is normative.

At each induction step, the next ideal adds one complete observable unit whose required predecessors have already been included. This ensures that the constructed Sys_ref prefix corresponds to the actual RTL_B behavior being analyzed rather than to an unrelated legal reordering of the same actions.

The validated construction-order chain provides the induction index needed to maintain process replay state, witness consistency, channel occupancy, synchronization state, signal anchoring, and matched-prefix compatibility. Its order is not supplied as phase metadata on the compositional route. Definition J.DepJ generates local operational prerequisites from typed process, request, snapshot, channel, reset, environment, and elaboration facts; J.DepComplete proves that every unordered action commutes; J.FoundationRank and J.DepRank prove that every generated edge advances one graph-independent semantic rank; J.DepAcyclic follows; and J.CanonicalRank derives the theorem-produced total proof order. Stable keys only list otherwise commuting actions. The direct route instead supplies an independently validated order satisfying the same J.ValidatedConstructionOrder interface. Thus the enumeration is either a construction produced by J.GWR-Comp or an explicitly checked direct certificate, never an unexplained externally supplied time chain.

T.2.5 Witness Compatibility and Faithful Witness Selection (WC)

The source reference model may admit multiple internal ε -step choices, non-blocking outcomes, arbitration outcomes, or replay paths that produce superficially similar observable behavior. A selected witness therefore cannot be treated as an unconstrained proof artifact. WC requires the witness choices used by the proof to be compatible with the actual RTL_B-observed behavior and with the relevant channel and boundary state.

This is especially important for failed or successful non-blocking operations that may be represented partly or wholly through ϵ -state. WC prevents the proof from selecting a successful poll when the actual boundary state required failure, selecting a failure when the operation was available, or attributing an issue or outcome to the wrong dynamic operation instance.

Snooping, NB-CF, direct witness construction, and mixed per-site reasoning are methods for discharging WC. They are not alternative theorem premises that replace WC. The theorem application must ultimately carry evidence for the actual WC predicate used by Appendices I and J.

WC is load-bearing for both source enablement and deterministic replay. Those arguments determine a source state and next action relative to a chosen witness; WC is what ties that witness to the implementation behavior rather than to a hypothetical source schedule.

T.2.5a Common Request Snapshots and Non-Blocking Decisions

A witness-significant non-blocking call reads shared channel/request state and therefore cannot be decided independently inside a process-local replay path. Lemma I.3 stops at a marked decision hole. Appendix J reconstructs one ReqSnapshot for the exact dynamic call after all dependency-predecessor request/attempt writes are present and before the decision or channel update. J.NBDecision then derives success or failure from E4 and that common snapshot. Request issue and a poll that reads the request are read/write dependent and may not be commuted; the generated Dep_J relation orders them. A failed call changes only the caller's continuation and leaves committed channel history unchanged. A successful call is the corresponding observable decision/transfer unit; it cannot be consumed as an ϵ preparation step for a later unit. This is the formal reason that a failed rendezvous PopNB cannot coexist with a matching persistent Push in the same snapshot.

T.2.6 Deterministic Replay Under the Selected Witness

Equality of visible labels alone does not necessarily determine the source state reached after a prefix. The source model may contain control-flow choices, failed non-blocking polls, hidden ϵ -state, arbitration choices, or witness-selected outcomes that affect later behavior without appearing as independent Σ labels.

Deterministic replay states that, once the fixed stimulus, WC-compliant witness, dynamic-operation attribution, and complete process-local observable-unit history are fixed, the replay-derived source control state is fixed. This includes control location, source values that influence later guards or payloads, completed-item status, candidate NextFront, anchored signal values, Pop return values reconstructed from committed channel history, and normal completion. It does not by itself determine which uncommitted blocking requests are currently asserted; that information is supplied by the residual-offer set O and audited by J.OfferConf.

The formalization must distinguish the canonical immediate post-unit replay state from an explicitly ϵ -normalized cutpoint. Plain J.1 may use the immediate post-unit form without claiming ϵ -quiescence after every matched unit. Corollary J.1 and Appendix K may instead use the normalized form when a canonical cutpoint is required.

T.2.7 E4 Occupancy and Explicit Boundary Behavior

E4 defines the legal message-transfer behavior at each explicit abstract channel boundary. For a bounded FIFO, this includes the occupancy update, full and empty conditions, and the circumstances in which Push and Pop are ChannelEnabled or ChannelDisabled. For a rendezvous boundary, it includes the coordinated producer and consumer behavior required for a same-cycle transfer.

The compatibility proof must show more than equality of transferred values. Every committed transfer must be legal under the selected boundary semantics, occupancy must evolve consistently, and the source and RTL_B interpretations of boundary availability must agree at the points used by the theorem. Generic simulation theory does not distinguish an ordinary bounded FIFO from a rendezvous boundary, synchronization gate, staged channel, join, bundle, or another elaborated boundary structure. These

semantics are supplied by the scheduling model and must be proved for the selected comparison instance.

T.2.8 B-Faithfulness

The back-annotated capacity $B(c)$ is intended to summarize all storage or credit that can accept, retain, or backpressure messages between the selected explicit producer and consumer boundaries. That storage may be physically distributed across FIFOs, pipeline stages, skid buffers, registers, credit state, or other implementation structures.

B-faithfulness is stronger than a capacity upper-bound claim. The selected RTL boundary must exhibit exactly the Push and Pop behavior permitted by E4 for the declared $B(c)$, including the corresponding ChannelEnabled and ChannelDisabled behavior. Internal movements within the represented realization may be ϵ -steps, but they may not create, delete, duplicate, reorder, or relabel the Σ -visible boundary transfers.

If hidden implementation structure changes availability in a way that cannot be represented by an ordinary E4 channel with the declared capacity, that structure must instead be represented by explicit $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$ boundaries. B-faithfulness is therefore an implementation-side compliance obligation, not a consequence of the abstract scheduling theorem itself.

T.2.9 Proved Local-to-Global Witness Construction

Process-local replay results do not by simple conjunction imply one common source execution. The missing step is explicit and proved. Definition J.LocalGWR supplies only process-local preparation scripts and typed footprints, explicit-channel histories and request snapshots, atomic-participant records, environment/reset records, locally generated dependency facts, component-local commutation evidence where needed, and equality/coverage checks on shared fields. It does not supply an arbitrary unit phase or a global replay order.

Lemmas J.Frame and J.LocalLift embed a certified local segment in the product state of Sys_ref . J.PrepareCommute interleaves actions only when their read/write interference test or J.BufSameCycle proves commutation. J.DepComplete proves that every other non-commuting pair is ordered; J.DepRank proves every edge advances one foundation rank; J.DepAcyclic and J.CanonicalRank then derive the construction order. J.NBDecision evaluates every shared-state poll from the one common boundary snapshot. J.UnitEnable derives complete-unit enablement from the constituent channel/atomic facts, J.UnitExt performs one global extension, and Theorem J.GWR-Comp iterates it to construct the reachable source execution and J.GWR package. The optional direct route must supply the same validated-order and extension interface independently; it does not borrow J.CanonicalRank from an absent local package.

The non-blocking request-co-presence case is load-bearing. A process certificate records the implementation-selected outcome but stops before deciding it. The incident J.CCcert reconstructs the complete request/availability snapshot, and J.NBDecision proves the unique source outcome. Thus a persistent matching rendezvous request and a failed complementary poll cannot coexist in a valid package even when the committed channel history is empty; nor can a local path commute the poll backward across a request write that its snapshot reads.

Dependency completeness is also load-bearing. The flow does not supply a convenient phase/rank. Every edge must be generated by a specific local control, request-snapshot, channel-state, reset/environment, or explicit-component rule. J.DepComplete proves that actions left unordered are genuinely commutative, including the explicitly proved interior-occupancy same-cycle buffered Push/Pop case. J.DepRank proves every generated edge advances one global semantic foundation rank, J.DepAcyclic follows, and stable proof keys totalize only commuting actions. A custom $\text{Sys_B}^{\text{elab}}$ component must provide a local footprint/commutation certificate, not a global replay certificate. Proposition J.0 remains separate. It assumes an already selected compatible source/RTL trace pair and lifts the process/channel facts to $\approx_{\text{sys}}$; it does not construct the source trace. This separation keeps the

global witness construction auditable and prevents circular use of a composition lemma whose trace pair has not yet been shown to exist.

T.2.10 KObs cutpoint correspondence and direct Appendix K consumption

Trace compatibility alone does not distinguish a process that has not reached a blocking call from one that currently has an attributed uncommitted request. The interface therefore augments the enriched committed/replay history H with the terminal residual-offer set O and uses the compact KObs record $\langle E, w, H, O \rangle$.

Lemma J.HCanon is the named history-side bridge: compatible annotated source/RTL prefixes under the one J.GWR package produced by J.GWR-Comp or supplied by J.GWR-Direct map to the same canonical replay-history quotient H . J.OfferReach proves that $\langle E, w, H, O \rangle$ is realized by the selected reachable Sys_ref cutpoint. J.OfferConf proves bidirectional unique correspondence between O and the complete set of KObs-relevant asserted RTL boundary requests. B-faithfulness/E4 interprets the committed history at the explicit boundaries. J.KObsConf packages these facts and yields equality between KObsPost_J and the source KObs.

The process slice, channel contents, frontier, endpoint requests, enablement, Front, WFG, and snapshot drain facts are then reconstructed by typed functions. Mechanization should therefore target a small record plus pure reconstruction functions, rather than a relation containing seven independently supplied state clauses. The initial mechanization targets should include: (i) CanonHist and Lemma J.HCanon; (ii) the typed physical-boundary request set RelevantReqSet_E(p_{post}); (iii) the projection ReqProjection_E(O); and (iv) the equality RelevantReqSet_E(p_{post}) = ReqProjection_E(O), together with unique attribution and endpoint-cardinality invariants.

Historical Issue remains in the transition semantics and in any operational witness needed by Theorem J.1, but it is not part of the cross-model KObs equality. For the RTL request-abstraction boundary, the mechanized checker or certificate must range over the complete selected explicit-boundary request interface, not merely over requests for which attribution records were successfully produced. A missing or unattributed KObs-relevant asserted request is a failed OfferConf proof, not an absent observation. Appendix K now consumes the equal record directly: K.0, K.2, K.2a, and K.1A should be mechanized as reconstruction/extensionality theorems rather than as a broad state-relation transfer.

T.2.10a Certificate and independent-checker boundary

The certificate interface deliberately separates facts that are recorded from facts that are reconstructed. K.CertHdr fixes the theorem instance and trust boundary. CF-0 records H , O , the complete selected-boundary physical request inventory, and the evidence that connects the source and RTL cutpoints. The checker then reconstructs process state, channel state, Front, BoundaryReq, enablement, WFG/WFG+, DrainClosedNow, and the selected deadlock predicate. A certificate that directly supplies those derived objects may include them as caches, but they are non-authoritative and must be checked against the reconstruction functions.

This design concentrates implementation trust in auditable boundary obligations rather than in an opaque full-state relation. In particular, OfferConf completeness is checked against the entire RelevantReqSet at every selected explicit boundary, not only against successfully attributed requests. B-faithfulness and the instance header bind the same physical boundaries and capacities to the channel reconstruction. HCanon and OfferReach bind the replay history and residual offers to a real source witness. Large histories may be content-addressed, but the independent checker must be able to retrieve and replay them.

Historical Issue is intentionally not duplicated in CF-0. That omission is safe only at the cutpoint-observation interface. OfferReach and the A5 route must still validate the operational Issue/Commit, fairness, persistence, and DrainDiscipline facts needed for reachability and continuation reasoning. The certificate schema therefore references those proof artifacts rather than pretending that KObs determines them.

T.2.11 Finite-Local-Trace Continuation

A process may cease producing local observable units while the overall system continues to execute indefinitely. In that case, the proof cannot simply append idle cycles to the process by invoking B6, because local inactivity does not imply that the complete system has reached a global fixed point. Instead, the proof must construct or select an admissible infinite global Sys_ref continuation and project that execution onto the process whose local observable trace is finite. The process-local projection may remain constant while other processes, channels, or the environment continue to evolve.

A separate case applies when the entire system eventually reaches a genuine B5/global fixed point. Only in that case may B6 justify indefinite global idle stutter.

This distinction is required to construct valid infinite reference witnesses without incorrectly treating a process-local terminal projection as a globally terminal execution.

T.2.12 Finite ϵ -Normalization and Existence of Canonical Cutpoints

An ϵ -quiescent cutpoint cannot simply be assumed to exist. The proof must establish that the selected internal ϵ -normalization terminates, or is otherwise bounded so that a finite canonical cutpoint can be reached.

B4 provides the applicable finite ϵ -stutter or normalization bound for the safety and cutpoint layers. B5 identifies the stronger global fixed-point conditions used where complete system quiescence is required. In the Appendix K layer, K ϵ additionally requires the relevant ϵ behavior to be WFG-inert and appropriately bounded so that normalization does not alter the blocking structure being analyzed.

The proof must establish both the existence of the normalized cutpoint and preservation of the certificate facts needed afterward. These include the canonical history H, residual offers O, B-faithful boundary interpretation, and the J.OfferReach/J.OfferConf premises required to construct the common KObs record. Appendix K then reconstructs frontier, enablement, WFG, and snapshot drain facts from that record.

The immediate post-unit state used by plain J.1 and the ϵ -normalized cutpoint used by Corollary J.1 or Appendix K must therefore remain distinct formal objects unless an explicit theorem connects them.

T.3 Liveness-Specific Global Obligations

The safety obligations above are largely local or compositional. The remaining obligations concern global executions and cannot generally be discharged by proving that each process is locally live. The liveness theorem depends on the interaction of all processes, channels, fairness assumptions, environment behavior, drainable work, and the global wait-for structure.

T.3.1 B2, B3, B5, and Admissible Global Executions

Definition R.LAdm is the normative source-side execution domain for Appendix K. It distinguishes a stepwise Policy-L-legal path, a finite R.LAdm-admissible prefix used for A5-L reachability, and a complete R.LAdm-admissible execution used for continuation, stabilization, fairness, and limit arguments. A syntactically legal transition sequence is insufficient if it violates the fixed witness/environment choices, the L1/L2 cycle-settle boundary, nonwithdrawal, K ϵ , or Definition R.16/K.Drain after activation.

B2 supplies the applicable fair scheduler or arbiter progress condition: an action that remains continuously ChannelEnabled must eventually be selected and commit. B3 supplies the corresponding channel-progress property for persistent blocking requests at full, empty, or rendezvous boundaries. For a simple explicit channel boundary, B3 may be derived from B2 plus E4, but it remains a useful modular obligation for checking channel realizations and elaborated boundary chains. Under R.LAdm these are complete-execution obligations; they do not retroactively reject an otherwise legal finite prefix merely because fairness cannot yet be decided.

B5 governs global ϵ -quiescent fixed points and environmental stability. It prevents the proof from declaring a state terminal while hidden internal or environmental progress remains possible under the theorem's assumptions. It is likewise part of complete R.LAdm admissibility and of the normalization/terminal-state arguments, not a substitute for the finite-prefix phase and freeze rules.

Together with Definition R.LAdm, these premises determine which complete source executions belong to Exec_ref for the liveness theorem. The post-HLS domain is qualified by its corresponding operational, fairness, progress, environment, and normalization obligations. The proof therefore reasons over phase-correct finite reachability prefixes and fair, progress-respecting complete continuations rather than over arbitrarily stalled transition sequences.

T.3.2 Drain Normalization and Drain Closure

An ϵ -quiescent state need not be drain-closed. No internal ϵ -step may be available even though already-issued downstream message transfers can still commit and reduce the amount of in-flight work.

Drain normalization permits such previously issued work to complete fairly, subject to B2/B3, without accepting or issuing new work beyond the blocked source frontier. It therefore requires the applicable drain-only blocked-frontier discipline: no new source-later dynamic operation may be launched past the blocked point, already asserted requests are not withdrawn, and only already-issued downstream work may drain. The resulting cutpoint is drain-closed when no further permitted downstream drain transfer associated with the relevant blocked component remains enabled.

Snapshot/continuation separation. Lemma K.2a transfers only DrainClosedNow at a selected cutpoint by equality of KObs. Appendix K-P reuses the same cutpoint interface inside Appendix K-P: current outstanding requests are $O = \text{ResOffers}$, and the finite non-front subset DrainBag is the drain-normalization measure. Neither step establishes future issue legality. Definition R.16/K.Drain, B2/B3 progress, nonwithdrawal, and the no-replenishment proof remain operational obligations used to show that DrainBag cannot increase and that drain normalization terminates.

This construction separates persistent blocking causes from transient pipeline or channel contents. Without drain closure, a wait-for graph cycle might disappear merely because already-issued work had not yet been allowed to complete.

The drain-normalization proof must also show that the relevant closed WFG component and source frontier survive the normalization, that the witness correspondence remains valid, and that the normalized cutpoint still satisfies the KObs reconstruction premises required by Lemmas R.21b–R.21f. K_ϵ is used to ensure that the ϵ behavior involved in this process is WFG-inert.

The applicable discipline is not limited to pipelines. Automatic flush supplies it for pipelined or otherwise overlapped control. Ordinary non-overlapped control may supply it through a structural proof that no new source-later dynamic operation can be launched after the blocked point. In either case, finite B-faithful explicit boundary storage or credit makes the already-issued drain set finite, and the no-new-launch rule makes it non-replenishing.

T.3.3 K.2b Dominance and Bounded-Response Extraction

[Revision note: this subsection summarizes the deterministic Policy-S-primary proof architecture of Appendix K.4b and Appendix K-P.]

The Sys_ref witness selected from RTL may use liberal/overlapped issue. Policy S withholds source-later blocking issue. SDet fixes the actual pre-HLS Policy-S simulator as a functional selected transition system and selects one run artifact p_S^{det} ; every other artifact generated under the same selected semantics has a prefix-comparable committed history modulo finite WFG-inert ϵ -stutter, and no incompatible history exists. A5-S/CF-S separately establish maximality, fairness, and completeness under K.CompleteS and validated bounded-response coverage/cleanliness under K.Resp.

Lemma K.2b proves deterministic dominance. It compares the liberal counterexample with p_S^{det} . An identity-aware first-violation argument prevents the serial execution from overtaking the jointly frozen liberal component and leaves its members permanently non-advancing at process-facing serial frontiers. K.RespCov maps those frontiers to non-waived finite-bound monitors, and complete-run reasoning produces a finite timeout, maximal-pending, or cancellation witness. The proof no longer follows complementary owners or requires an exhaustive EnvStop/DoneStop/live-owner taxonomy.

Any Policy-L internal deadlock therefore forces ρ_S^{det} to produce a finite $K.\text{RespFail}$ witness. A complete proof that the $K.\text{CompleteS}$ -certified selected artifact is $K.\text{RespClean}$ discharges A5-L. There is no family of incompatible Policy-S histories to reconcile under one selected SDet instance, so confluence and universal quantification over serial scheduler interleavings are absent.

The historical $K.\text{EnvOrd}/K.\text{Done}$ and Dead_KS machinery is retained only for diagnostics. It can explain a fired monitor through an environment-starvation cone or normal-completion terminal, but it is intentionally not exhaustive: the H2 perpetual under-supplier stays live on unrelated channels and may produce no closed terminal component. Soundness rests on the pending process-facing monitor, not on classification of its remote owner.

The proof still requires $K.\text{CV}$, point-to-point evaluated boundaries, nonwithdrawable requests, $K\epsilon$, Definition R.16/ $K.\text{Drain}$, $K.\text{BF}$, and complete $K.\text{Resp}$ coverage. Multi-frontier elaborations require the separate $K.\text{O2}$ joint-freeze/monitor-trigger composition lemma; the standard $K.\text{PSF}$ profile may initially remain single-frontier.

T.3.3a A5 certificate interface

The primary CF-S certificate is a deterministic-execution, completeness, and bounded-response certificate. It identifies the concrete simulator/scheduler, arbitration, environment, witness and normalization semantics; supplies SDet evidence that they generate one committed history; records or symbolically represents ρ_S^{det} ; proves progress/drain/fairness and $K.\text{CompleteS}$; records the total process-facing monitor set and finite bounds; and proves $K.\text{RespClean}$ over the complete artifact. Timer state is an operational certificate component, not a $K.\text{Obs}$ field.

CF-3 and CF-4 must keep the snapshot/transition distinction explicit. $K.\text{Obs}$ is the right observation component for the bad-state predicate, but it is not by itself a Markov state for Policy L or Policy S because it omits historical Issue timing and future issue eligibility. An invariant or exploration abstraction may add operational phase, fairness, or drain-control state, and must prove that its abstract Post relation soundly overapproximates the selected operational semantics. This is the mechanization-facing reason the certificate checker should expose separate modules for $K.\text{Obs}$ reconstruction, operational transition validation, fairness/completeness, and route composition.

A5 certificates also bind response-waiver reasoning. CF-S records the exact dynamic classes that may be cancelled or left pending and proves $K.\text{RespCov}$'s preservation condition: a non-waived liberal deadlock cannot map only to waived monitors. Optional diagnostic Dead_KS evidence may additionally record $\text{EnvTerminalAdequate}$ and $K.\text{Obs}$ closure, but those records do not substitute for $K.\text{RespClean}$.

T.3.4 WFG and Conservative Serial-Source Deadlock Reasoning

The WFG identifies the liberal closed component transferred through the equal- $K.\text{Obs}$ correspondence packaged by $J.K.\text{ObsConf}$. The serial route does not replay that state. It names the liberal source cutpoint K_L , uses operational dominance to establish a permanently pending process-facing serial frontier on ρ_S^{det} , and applies $K.\text{Resp}$'s finite-bound monitor. Thus A5-L reduces to A5-S for one SDet-selected Policy-S execution: $K.\text{CompleteS}$ supplies maximality/fairness/completeness, $K.\text{RespCov}$ supplies total monitor coverage, and $K.\text{RespClean}$ supplies the contradiction.

A6 remains essential for the dominance and request-reachability arguments: point-to-point ownership gives each frozen boundary one actual complementary endpoint and fixes transfer ordinals. Shared resources must be represented through explicit arbiter processes and point-to-point channels before K.2b applies. The revised proof does not need to continue an owner walk beyond the permanently pending process-facing frontier.

Once A5-S/CF-S establishes $K.\text{CompleteS}$, $K.\text{RespCov}$, and $K.\text{RespClean}$ for the SDet-selected Policy-S execution ρ_S^{det} , Corollary K.2c supplies A5-L and Theorem K.1A rules out the RTL-matched deadlock. No Dead_KS or $K.\text{EnvOrd}/K.\text{Done}$ avoidance theorem is required.

This argument is specific to the scheduling contract. It is stronger than ordinary trace inclusion or per-process local progress because it connects a global implementation-level blocking structure to a

permanent process-facing obstruction in the selected serial source semantics. The bounded-response certificate is source-side proof machinery only; it does not state that RTL completes within the same bound.

T.4 Summary

Reusable transition-system and simulation libraries can reduce the amount of generic proof infrastructure needed to mechanize this document. They can provide definitions and standard theorems for finite and infinite executions, ϵ -closure, simulation, trace lifting, well-founded induction, and temporal reasoning.

The substantive guarantees nevertheless depend on the scheduling-specific obligations summarized above. In the safety layer, locally checkable process, channel, atomic-interaction, environment, reset, action-footprint, request-snapshot, dependency-generator, and agreement certificates are converted by J.GWR-Comp into a globally realizable source replay; the dependency order and shared-state non-blocking outcomes are theorem-derived. The remaining theorems establish witness-relative ordered trace compatibility, reset correspondence, and KObs cutpoint agreement. In the liveness layer, the obligations establish admissible global progress, canonical drain-closed liberal cutpoints, deterministic serial dominance, total process-facing response coverage, and finite bounded-response extraction from any liberal internal deadlock.

Accordingly, standard simulation theory should be treated as reusable proof infrastructure, not as a replacement for the scheduling model or for the named assumptions and implementation-side obligations on which the formal guarantees depend. The certificate architecture makes those obligations independently checkable: K.CertHdr binds one instance, CF-0 validates the source/RTL KObs cutpoint boundary, and K.A5Cert validates the selected deadlock-freedom discharge route. For the primary Policy-S route, the checker separately validates operational transition/fairness/completeness evidence and the K.Resp monitor coverage, finite bounds, trigger/response attribution, waiver preservation, and complete-run cleanliness.

Appendix U – Revision Record

17 July 2026 — H2 bounded-response serial-route revision.

The primary K.2b/K.2c/CF-S route now uses validated process-facing bounded-response monitoring rather than the incomplete missing-supply owner trichotomy and Dead_KS terminal taxonomy. Definitions K.RespMon/K.RespCov/K.RespFail/K.RespClean require default-total internal-site proof coverage, process-facing trigger/response attribution, maximal-finite and cancellation handling, complete-run evidence, and waiver preservation. Lemma K.2b.E and mechanization obligation K-O7 explicitly construct the fair complete frozen Policy-L continuation from a bare A5-L counterexample prefix; K.2b.Q then proves that the liberal K.1 deadlock forces a finite Policy-S response failure, and K.2c converts K.RespClean into A5-L. The perpetual under-supplying-owner example is added explicitly. Dead_KS, EnvStop, DoneStop, K.EnvOrd, and K.Done remain optional diagnostics only. CF-S, K.PSF, Theorem K.1, Appendix R's KObs boundary, Appendix T, the side-condition record, and both the abstract and main-body Summary are aligned; no Policy-S response bound is transferred to RTL.

17 July 2026 — Policy-L admissibility and settle-window clarification.

Definition R.LAdm now supplies one normative execution domain for Appendix K. It distinguishes Policy-L step legality, finite-prefix admissibility for A5-L reachability, and complete admissible executions for fairness, stabilization, and limit arguments; binds the fixed stimulus/environment/witness/arbitration choices; and defines the L1 pre-settle issue window, the L2 ϵ -settle snapshot, the exact activation point of Definition R.16/K.Drain, and next-cycle availability of committed results. A5-L, K.1A, K.2b, K.Ser, Examples K.CE-2/K.CE-3/K.CE-4, Appendix R, and Appendix T now cite this single definition. The change

resolves the ambiguity without changing which independent eager issues Policy L permits or making K.Drain part of the basic Policy-L issue rule.

17 July 2026 — sequential-result-availability clarification.

The Issue/Commit semantics now state explicitly that a result committed by a sequential process in cycle t may affect a dynamically succeeding dependent operation only in a strictly later cycle. The clarification is added to the main Issue definition, Appendix C linkage rules, the Sys_ref/Policy-L operational interpretation, Lemma I.3 and Corollary I.4, J.DepSound, J.FoundationRank, and the D1 case of Lemma J.DepRank. Same-cycle rendezvous, buffered-channel updates, eager issue, and pipeline overlap remain permitted for requests whose reachability, control, and operands were established independently before the cycle boundary.

15 July 2026 — J.GWR formal-ordering and SDet clarification revision.

The J.DepAcyclic proof now uses one graph-independent semantic foundation rank and the new Lemma J.DepRank; the prior union-of-local-orders argument is removed, and Height/J.CanonicalRank are defined only after acyclicity. J.RequiredPrefixCandidate removes the circular reference from J.PCert to the not-yet-derived canonical order. J.ConstructionOrderProvenance/J.ValidatedConstructionOrder provide one interface for theorem-derived and directly validated J.GWR packages. SDet now states functional history determinism as prefix-comparability/no-incompatible-history for run artifacts, while K.CompleteS separately establishes maximality, fairness, and completeness. Remaining legacy time-chain terminology is replaced by the derived or directly validated construction-order ideal chain.

15 July 2026 — J.GWR snapshot, same-cycle, and dependency-completeness refinement.

The local-to-global construction now derives its proof order from a generated typed dependency graph rather than accepting J.UnitRank/phase metadata. Definition J.ConstructionAction introduces explicit ReadSet/WriteSet footprints; J.DepSound and J.DepComplete prove prerequisite soundness and non-commutation coverage; J.FoundationRank/J.DepRank prove every edge advances one graph-independent semantic rank; J.DepAcyclic follows; and J.CanonicalRank is reconstructed only afterward. Lemma J.BufSameCycle proves legal sequentialization of simultaneous positive-capacity Push/Pop commits without permitting empty/full fall-through. Definition J.ReqSnapshot and Lemma J.NBDecision move witness-significant non-blocking outcomes out of process-local replay paths and evaluate them from one common attributed boundary snapshot. Lemma I.3, J.PCert/J.CCert/J.LocalGWR, J.PrepareCommute/J.UnitEnable/J.UnitExt, the expanded J.GWR-Comp proof, the side-condition record, and Appendices S/T are updated accordingly.

15 July 2026 — J.GWR compositional-construction revision.

Definition J.GWR is retained as the stable semantic interface but is no longer a mandatory unexplained implementation-side premise in the normal Post $\rightarrow$ Ref theorem path. Definition J.LocalGWR introduces process-local, explicit-channel, atomic-interaction, environment/reset, action-footprint, request-snapshot, generated-dependency, interface-agreement, and coverage certificates. Lemma I.3 is localized to finite process-owned preparation scripts with explicit shared-decision holes. Lemmas J.Frame, J.LocalLift, J.PrepareCommute, J.UnitEnable, and J.UnitExt establish the generic gluing machinery, and Theorem J.GWR-Comp proves that the local package constructs one reachable Sys_ref witness and J.GWR package. Proposition J.0 remains the separate pairwise composition lemma.